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THE KIRGIZ'S HEROIC EPIC OF CHINA

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MANAS

BOOK ONE

MANAS

Volume Three

XINJIANG PEOPLE'S PUBLISHING GROUP
XINJIANG PEOPLE'S PUBLISHING HOUSE

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Manas

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Manas Went on an Expedition Again

Manas Went on an Expedition to Afghanistan

In vast central Asia,
Oboler peak towered up into the clouds,
Kebezto mountain was covered with snow,
Afghanistan was called Pamirto.
Stretched away to the west,
Was the place where Kapchaque people lived and multiplied.
They stationed in Badak mountain area,
Unyieldingly and never lost their dignity,
The hero ruled the tribe,
Was called Qinacha who was very brave.

He wore an angry expression one day,
Blustered to his people like this:
"Kirgiz roamed around with no fixed homes,
It is hard to tell their exact population.
Manas battles around and swaggers,
Make us disgrace,
I will go and wipe him out."
Qinacha talked wildly,
Beyond his ability.

Kunwuer Bayi stood behind him,
Instigated him with best effort,
Like blowing a leather bag up,
Made him walk on clouds:
"Kangayi mountains rolled thousand miles,
Connected to Himalayans.
I stationed one side,
And you stationed the other side.

"Let Manas the bloodsucker,
Be the ruler in central Asia,
How disgraced I am!
Are you terrified of the despotic power of Manas?
Please say something, Qinacha!
Jedigair is your territory,
How can you bear Kirgiz trampling.

"Because of you Qinacha, your poor management,
Make Barsi raise his head up proudly.
You should treat Kirgiz,
Like you rub sheepskin.
If you sleep in comfort at home,
He must get the chance to step in like a scorpion:
He will shoot your heart like a sharp arrow,
He will throw you into deep valley.

"Stretched out from Sarikoler,
They plundered my yaks.
Arashi of sixty tribes,
Are now gathering,
If we let their plot prevails,
It will be a great disaster to us.

"You should go and conquer,
Jedigair and Keyiba immediately:
I will deal with Kazakh in person,
Who station in Kapaler.
No matter the south or the north,
Those Turks with sheer bravado,
We must make them bow down and yield.

"You probably have not noticed yet,
Brute have conquered the north:
The central Asia ruled by Karamark all the time,
Now also has been occupied by them.
You are a famous Khan,

How can you know nothing about these things? "

Kunwuer Bayi tried his best to sow discord,
Then stupid Qinacha was moved as expected,
Qinacha led his troops for an expedition,
They plundered and killed Keyiba people.
People escaped from the death narrowly,
Roamed around like lost lambs!
Qinacha got his first victory,
Which made him dizzy and proud of it.

Keyiba were forced to leave their hometown,
Complained to Manas in tears.
Manas asked to give them livestock,
Made them settle down for a peaceful life.

"He might just drive livestock from Chatkaler,
And drove sheep flocks back in secret with his evil practice.
He might just talk wildly of evil speaking,
And displeased the local nobles."
Manas thought over and over,
For the matter of Qinacha's punitive expedition to Keyiba,
He did not believe it all.
He thought it was not a big deal,
It skimmed through his mind soon.

But it did not stop,
Misfortunes came from Jedigair again.
Manas went on expedition to Afghanistan,
This was the reason.

Please listen carefully to the news,
Of being plundered and killed from Jedigair:
From the outside of Himalayan,
From the west of Oboler mountain,
To the border line of Afghanistan,
Kirgiz who lived as nomads here,

Interacted and herded with each other as neighbors.
Akunhan lived on Yurkechy riverside,
Paid taxes to Qinacha every month.
Drove numerous livestock every year to Qinacha,
The old, the young, men and women all complained.

Qinacha threw his weight around,
Akunhan dare not resist.
On the outskirt of Huloshan,
One thousand households Jedigair,
Who lived in Kumshburak,
Were plundered.
Yurts were trampled,
Cry of children got on people's nerves.
Qinacha drove the people he plundered,
And climbed over Lamu ridge.

"Go and ask Manas for help quickly!"
Hero Barsi, the headman of Jedigair,
Sent his minister in a hurry.
The old minister came in person,
Reported Manas the bad news.
He told what he saw and heard,
Every word was true and honest,
Poured out the injustice in his heart.

Hero lion Manas,
Was infused with anger as he heard the bad news.
Hero Manas was beyond endurance,
Gave the order of going on expedition to Afghanistan right away.

Arrows and spears were all got ready,
One thousand camels carried knives and arrows,
One thousand camels carried food and clothes.
Kara Kalerpark and Kalercha,
Tajik and Juda,
Lion Ayikoler went around these places,

Then approached the territory of the devil.

In a place called Kuytunut,
Manas pitched his camps.
They sent the letter of challenge to Afghanistan,
Without meeting anyone on the way.
People were so surprised,
That Afghanistan was of a large population,
Only a troop of four hundred and eighty soldiers was sent.
The sentry on patrol whipped horse fast,
To send message to Qinacha immediately.

Qinacha called his troops right away,
Got ready to fight against Manas:
"I will go to war against Manas,
Stab the sharp sword in his heart.
I will twist his neck off,
I will gut him with his heart and liver.
I will throw his bones into fire,
Let his bones and fat burn to ash and be wafted.
I will take over his throne,
Let his ring of light shine over my head."
His horses and soldiers were countless,
Blue yurts were connected together.
He counted his troops,
Which were over one hundred and fifty thousand.

"Death drove Kirgiz people,
Let them be on one-way road:
Good luck surpasses normal people,
How lucky I am.
No need to climb over ridges,
No need to bear the hardship on journey;
No need to undergo the burning hot Gobi desert,
No need to experience the danger of going through forest;
No need to walk across the swamps,
No need to make my steed tired,

Good luck descends in front of me.

"Each hero here,
Is in charge of three hundred and fifteen people.
Cast the net,
Capture that swaggering Manas alive.
After I wipe Manas out,
I will storm into his palace in Taras.
It is said that he has fourteen Khans,
I will descend disasters to them all!"

Qinacha blew his own horn pretentiously,
As a ball of burning flame.
He shouted fiercely:
"We Afghanistan have ample soldiers and generals,
He only sends four hundred and eighty here.
Please look at them carefully,
They all behave with unbearable insolence,
They look down their noses at us.
I have so many giants,
They are all as strong and tall as mountains.

"Sorcerers with power of calling for wind and rain,
Please practice your spell hard.
Once I give you the order,
Just descend disaster on them!
Let them suffer all hardships in the world,
Let these pains stay in their hearts forever.
I will cast a spell for a furious snow,
Make them have no place to hide.
Make those lost soldiers,
Freeze to death in the wilderness."

Received the order from Qinacha,
Two sorcerers Apey and Napey,
Came up and responded extremely pompously:
"Qinacha, what you said is not worth mentioning at all,

I will cast a heavy snow,
The sudden freeze can make rocks crack.
Let us two deal with enemies coming to invade,
We will trap them to death with none fleeing."

The sorcerers took out the magic stone from animal guts,
Put it in the bowl with clean water.
Suddenly dark clouds floated with the spell,
The sky clouded over.
Wind howled up from the ground,
Fierce wind and rain came,
On the territory of Kirgiz,
Rainstorm came first,
Then hails came in with wild wind,
The weather turned piercingly cold in an instant,
Flurry snow then stirred the earth to a blur.

Hero Ayikoler was very vigilant,
Lion Manas had superior intelligence,
He sent someone to call sorcerers Cheyit and Muyterk,
Asked them to come to the crack between two armies:
"My Cheyit and Muyterk,
Why do I call you here?
Do you see clearly the spell they cast?
That's what Qinacha did to wipe out Kirgiz.
It must be Afghans who practice the spell,
Make clouds float over our heads.
Do you have any ways,
To disperse the dark clouds over our heads?"

Cheyit and Muyterk,
Answered together with no hesitation.
Facing lion Manas and many heroes,
They made promise for themselves.
In a blink of an eye,
They grabbed some dirt and threw to the sky,
Dispersed clouds with their spell,

Make the sun shine again over the world.

Two sorcerers Apey and Napey,
And all Afghans,
Surrounded Qinacha and looked up to the sky.
Seeing the sudden change in the sky,
People asked worriedly,
"What on earth happened?"
Every one was astonished and speechless.

Cheyit and Muyterk did not stop,
They felt calm facing the whirling snow,
Did not lose their mind as enemy's sorcerers.
Wild wind blew again,
Dark clouds rolled in the sky.
Wild wind like the crackling hunting gun,
Bent the trees as curved bows,
Leaves were all blown off with bare branches left.
Dark clouds rolled and rumbled,
Lightning flashed and thunder rumbled.

Afghan soldiers were scared out of their wits,
And could not identify the direction.
The two sorcerers, Apey and Napey,
Tried their best and stopped the storm.
Before two troops fought head-on with each other,
Secret spells had made earth trembled.

Wild wind stopped, rain and snow passed,
Battle flags held up again.
"Warriors, start off toward the battlefield!"
Qinacha gave out the order to his troop,
Groups of soldiers went into battle,
With full of their courage.
The long line of soldiers and horses,
Was too thick to count the number,
The earth was quivering under the steps,

Drums beat, shook heaven and earth.

There were four elephants,
Clearing the way for a hundred and fifty thousand soldiers;
There were five giants in the troops,
They looked arrogant and in a threatening manner.
Bloody mouths breathed fire,
Huge bodies were tied tightly with chains.
Fierce dogs were totally one thousand,
Chains made of brass,
Were interlinked with iron hoops on the dog's neck.
Each one led a fierce dog,
Walked in the front of the troop with barks of dogs,
It was like the grass,
Wholly covered the earth.

Qinacha was of strong arms and horrible expression,
The steeds behind him stood in lines,
All kinds of weapons were piled at the side of battlefield,
Iron hammer on the shoulder was as big as a yurt,
Battleax in the waist was like the door sheet.
Spears were like towering trees,
Tall figure was like iron tower reaching to the sky.
Pillar-size arms made people terrified,
Two deep black eyebrows,
Were like the black feather of soaring condor.

Two armies were pitted with each other,
Soldiers shouted and horses neighed, pierced into sky.

Manas refused to admit being inferior,
Whipped his steed forward.
Golden-edged red flag,
Was held tight in the hand of Bakay,
He went to the battlefield regardless of his safety.

One general rushed out from Afghan troops,

He was well-known for his high military skill.
In the one-to-one fight,
He never fell onto the ground.

The famous hero from the Qinacha side,
Angkatay was his formal name,
Like wind blew from the side,
The ferocious expression was horrible to look.

He rushed to the center of the battlefield,
Like a demon in great majesty.
Opened his cave-size mouth,
Clacked his teeth,
Flames burned in his eyes,
Great figure was like a mountain.
He shouted ceaselessly:
"Who dare to fight with me to death!"

"I must take him down!"
Hero Chuwak could not control himself,
Whipped his black steed Koktikai,
Held the spear and charged forward.
He did not inform them of his name,
Just made an attack to the enemy general directly.
Kirgiz hero Chuwak,
Was like a real fierce eagle,
Among numerous Kirgiz,
He was a hero acting agilely.

He whipped his mount Koktikai,
Wore his blue Erapis battle robe,
Waved the long sharp spear,
With great figure, stocky build.
He was a hero hard to find in the world,
Many generals as great as dragons,
Died or fled away in his hands.
He enjoyed the power of a dragon,

He was as agile as an eagle:
His earth-shaking shout,
Was like sixty tigers roaring together;
He rushed into thousands of enemies,
As free as a tiger rushed into sheep flock.

Seeing Chuwak moving to him,
Angkatay lifted his spear immediately to respond:
Grasped the deadly spear in his hand tightly,
And fought against eagle Chuwak bitterly.
Spear point and spear shaft knocked against one another,
The cracking sound quivered the heaven.
Like a storm with lightning and thunder,
Big noise went into people's ears.

"I must stab him off his horse!"
Angkatay poked his spear out fiercely.
Leopard Chuwak, such a great hero,
How he could be poked so easily!
He drew his battleax out of his waist,
Kicked the enemy's spear with his ax back.
When Angkatay bent to draw his ax,
Hero Chuwak as agile as an eagle,
Shouted the slogan "Manas" loudly,
Whistled the spear in the air,
Gathered all his strength and poked the enemy.

How could Chuwak's long spear let enemy off?
Mountain-size Angkatay,
Fell off the horse and crashed to the ground.
Aimed at the lung of the enemy,
Chuwak gave a hard poke again,
Red blood spouted out,
Splashed and reddened the spear.

Qinacha saw it clearly in the front,
Then sent another general quickly.

The general dashed to the battlefield,
Was famous Kamut.
He was brave and skilled in battlefield,
He did not miss any bloody battle.
As he witnessed the death of his fellow,
The fire of fury flamed in his chest.
Facing matchless hero Chuwak,
He swung his spear with no fear.

Chuwak whipped his steed,
Met the enemy head-on.
Grasped the grand spear tightly,
Urged the steed forward and fought,
Ignored the death completely.
Chuwak encountered with enemy general,
Kamut cried out loudly,
The deadly spear dashed down to Chuwak.
Chuwak was stabbed by the spear of Kamut,
And fell off the horse on his back.

Seeing the dangerous situation Chuwak met,
Khan Jagurp's son Sirak,
With black edge-rolled felt hat on his head,
Spurred steed Tilkezler forward.

Dust rose up behind them,
He held the sharp spear,
As fierce as an eagle swooped to a hare.
He whipped his mount Tilkezler,
Grasped tightly the halter of black goat steed.
He handed Chuwak the halter,
Hero Chuwak then sat firm on the saddle.
He grasped the wolf-tongue spear with black tassel tightly,
Vowed to fight it out against Kamut again.
The strong lion strained each of his nerve,
Stabbed Kamut in one poke.
The Afghan like a drifting bitter fleabane,

Fell off the horse on his back.

In order to save hero Kamut,
Giant Borosh spurred his horse for an attack,
He met head-on with hero Sirak.
He swung his spear and spurred his horse forward,
Deadly spear poked toward Sirak.
Unusual Sirak was of unique skills,
Right as the spear point going to poke into his chest,
Hero Sirak acted agilely,
Jumped off his steed and stood on the ground.

Borosh's mount jumped,
And galloped past Sirak.
Sirak took a leap,
Then sat firm on the saddle.

As Borosh was going to turn his horse,
Sirak galloped his steed ahead,
Swung the spear and attacked from the side,
Gave a violent poke in Borosh's hip.
Then he drew his ax out quickly,
Slashed to the head of Borosh with full of his energy.
Borosh embraced the earth with his arms,
Lay on the ground with no breath.

Sirak and Chuwak killed two generals,
Stood side by side in the battlefield in majesty.

Qinacha was pissed off,
Screamed aloud:
"We have troops of a hundred and fifty thousand soldiers,
All turn out, do not leave anyone.
Anyone who has super power,
Had better capture Manas alive.

"I have observed our enemies clearly,

Have known their actual strength.
Besides Chuwak and Sirak,
There is a hero rides steed Sariala,
Stands aside quietly,
I believe he is not a normal man.

"The four heroes are their backbones,
Other heroes who can fight in the battlefield,
Are only about forty.
You'd better capture and tie tight,
The four heroes and these warriors!"

Qinacha shouted the order loudly,
Asked his soldiers to turn out and attack.
Dense flags waved in the wind,
Moved towards Kirgiz gradually.
Horses' neigh, soldiers' shout, hooves' sound,
Made the earth shake.
Giants lifted flags high,
Swarmed forward and shouted slogan loudly.

Under lips rustled,
Ears shook with wind;
Like women,
Men's breasts wiggled as leather bags.
Every one was like a crazy male camel,
Pattered their feet on the ground.
Let Khuda bless,
It was hard to describe their fierce manner.
There was a mess of high-pitched voice,
Dust risen up was high into the sky.

Facing countless enemies,
Almanbet gave out his order:
"Kergel chooses ten people and stay,
To protect uncle very carefully.
The other thirty warriors,

Please listen to the order carefully.
You should be on a heightened security alert,
Protect the camps and weapons well.
If enemies rob our food and weapons,
We will not win no matter how brave we are.

"Our food and weapons are all in camps,
Uncle Bakay and forty heroes,
Please be alert every second.

"Afghans turn out to us,
I have watched carefully,
You'd better attack from both wings.
Afghans have prepared in secret,
Hope to trap us with the iron nets.
If we are not careful enough,
We will fall into their iron nets.

"Cheyit, Muyterk, Chundoker,
Kalijir and Gurikai know how to practice spells,
You five run out by yourselves,
Watch the change of battlefield carefully.
If the sky turns cloudy,
You should deal with it calmly in time.
Whether Afghan sorcerers Apey and Napey,
Have other tricks and moves,
You five should pay close attention.

"You five sharpen your eyes,
No matter the flying birds,
Or the crawling beetles,
You need be alert and watch carefully,
You can not be careless at all."
Almanbet arranged elaborately,
Specially let them monitor crafty enemies.

The noisy and crowded Afghans,

All turned out.
Four elephants cleared the way in the front,
Swung their trunks and walked fast.
"Places of Kirgiz,
Must be trampled flat by us.
All the blood debt on earth,
Must be paid off by Manas."

Qinacha was extremely excited,
Shuttled back and forth in the troops.
He had forty thousand men to cast nets,
They waved solid iron chains in unison.

Qinacha shouted with no stop,
Gave out his order to soldiers and generals:
"Make up four groups with ten thousand soldiers in each group,
Rush to those four heroes separately.
Each group takes one elephant,
Seize the chance and cast the net.
The enemy elephant which cannot deal with,
Will be killed by me in person!

"Sixty sorcerers led by Apey and Napey,
You'd better stay aside with the troops;
Unexpectedly manas does not know me,
You feel free to practice your spells.
You need try all your best,
To take away their food and carriages.
Make them no place to stay,
Make them no food to eat,
Make them starve to death.
I will descend the end of the world,
Over their heads."

Overwhelmingly arrogant Qinacha,
Had a monster-like mount under him:
Short tail, narrow eyes,

Sparse mane, shriveled mouth,
Small and short hocks, straight hoof wrist,
Narrow chest, floppy ears,
White spotted color, very ugly.
Qinacha rode on such a freak,
Directed the battle under the flag menacingly.

Two eagles, Chuwak and Sirak,
Ran into dense enemies swiftly.
Qinacha's soldiers set iron nets,
They were in groups with countless number.
Ten thousand soldiers cast the net together,
Surrounded Sirak completely.
In the dense iron nets,
Sirak was trapped in the center.

Sirak was brave enough,
Drew the sword out of his waist,
Slashed and chopped swiftly.
Iron net of a hundred and eighty meshes,
Just like rotted hemp rope,
Was pierced through and broken apart.

Among generals who had conserved their energy,
Among giants raised in iron cages,
Two Afghan warriors urged their mounts,
Swung spears and dashed ahead.

Hero Sirak met the challenge head-on,
Rushed to strike coming enemies fiercely.
Suddenly he leaned to one side and dodged the edge,
Made enemies confused.
Before they could turn themselves round,
Before they could turn the halters round,
Sirak had swung his long spear,
Poked in the back of one warrior.
A head lowered could never rise again,

The warrior died immediately.

Numerous enemies like jammed ants on the ground,
Surrounded Sirak again.
More nets flew to him from afar,
Swung and flew over his head.

Seeing enemy's weakness of lacking tactics,
Wolf Sirak showed his talent of agility.

Another Afghan warrior,
Gasped and charged bravely.
Like climbing out of the tomb,
Like devil licked his lips,
He looked right and left fiercely,
Like a rising mountain peak.
He held a one-thousand-Bataman shovel,
Like tigers meeting together,
Opened his mouth and roared.

Sirak held the long spear in his hand,
He would not let the chance of killing enemies off.
Afghan generals charged forward were like mountains,
Hero Sirak met their challenge calmly.
Enemy general rushed out of the jammed crowd,
Waved his weapon bravely,
The deadly shovel waved ceaselessly,
Which was swirling noisily.

Sirak was going to hit by the shovel,
He would be stamped to meat if he fell off,
The skilled hero hit on an idea in desperation,
He got the idea to deal with the enemy.

The enemy came in his face,
Lifted the shovel with both hands.
Sirak swung and then lifted,

Halter of Tilkezler to one side hard.
The experienced magical steed,
Leaped one-arrow far.
The shovel ran deep into the earth,
It needed great energy to get it out.

Hero black mane wolf turned round,
Waved the spear to the enemy:
"Lie on the ground!
It is right the center of your lung."
The spear inserted from the armpit,
Sharp spear point pierced through the strong chest,
The imperious and arrogant enemy general,
Fell off on the ground right away.

Brave hero Sirak,
Broke their vain hope of capturing with nets.
He was like tiger saw antelope,
Killed enemies delightfully.

Enemies casting nets threw away everything,
Fled for their life without turning their heads.
Well-trained elephants were driven to the battlefield,
A new round of attack to Sirak began.
"He should be stamped flat."
Deadly hammer fitted on elephant's trunk point,
Was made of cast iron and lead.
Elephants arched their backs and charged forward,
Hammers swung along with their trunks.

Seeing the coming elephants,
Sirak could not help asking himself:
"It is a great shame to me,
If I give up before I meet their general."
He held door-size battleax in his hand,
Tried to seize a chance to slash at elephant's head.
"Elephants have great strength but they are clumsy,

How it can compare with my agile steed!"

He opened his sharp eyes wide,
Observed the situation quietly.
Elephants charged forward fast,
With their long trunks swinging.
Sirak pulled his steed and ducked aside,
Dodged the elephant's trunk,
Swung his axe and slashed at its head.
He seized the chance when the elephant turned round,
Before its long trunk curled,
The axe slashed at it.

Elephant's head was bleeding hard,
It turned round desperately and ran away.
Sirak did not give up at all,
Chased the elephant in hot pursuit.

Qinacha saw things were in a bad way,
Asked sorcerers to cast the magical nets immediately.

The spells conjured out many iron nets,
Fleeing elephant ran freely among iron nets,
However, the tightknit nine-layer iron net,
Surrounded Sirak in the center.
They let the fleeing elephant stop,
And tied the net on the neck of the elephant,
Attempted to drag Sirak back to their camp.
Sirak was trapped in the net with his steed,
Enemies waved arm-size ropes,
Whipped the elephant forward violently.

Right at this critical moment,
Noise of hooves from Almanbet's steed came.
White sword presented by Jurenduo,
What spell could function on it?
What curse could control it?

A flash of cold light went through the sky,
The head of elephant was chopped off.
Enemies' spell was out of its action,
Sirak escaped out of the iron net.

Looked at the expression on Sirak's face,
It was like a jumping dragon,
Spear in his hand made loud noise,
Killed enemies and made them cry and flee.
Wherever the hero went,
There was blood shed.
Self-glorified Afghans,
Lost their lives for nothing.

Akberita's son Chuwak,
Was like a ferocious wolf;
He was surrounded in the iron nets,
Cast by ten thousand enemies.
Two giants were swaggering,
One elephant was rushing to him.
The hero was trapped in the center,
Misfortune was going to descend on his head.

Great hero Chuwak.
His huge figure was like a mountain peak.
He drew pure steel sabre Zulepkar out,
Grasped it in his hand,
Started a breath-taking fight.
The nets casted by enemies,
Were all cut into pieces.
He cut a reddened road out.
Two warriors fought against him,
Had their heads rolled to the ground,
Before they figured out what happened.

Chuwak killed two enemy generals,
Then began to fight against the elephant.

As in the game of catching sheep,
Chuwak seized the elephant's trunk tightly.
The elephant could not shake off his hand,
Had to pull back and forth with the hero.
Chuwak drew out his sword,
Killed the elephant without difficulty.
He simply fought against the elephant,
Forgot how dangerous he was.
It was such a pity,
Hero Chuwak was covered and trapped by five-layer nets.

Although he was caught in nets,
They could not drag him.
"Pull harder! Be quick!"
Enemies pulled and twittered.

Any spell did not work on,
Almanbet's unequaled sword,
To be a living being,
Who could possess such treasure?
When the sword was drawn out from the sheath,
Layers of iron chains broke,
Invincible hero Chuwak,
Then could escape from the nets.

Ayikoler Manas and Almanbet,
Lion Chuwak and hero Sirak,
They four gathered together,
Almanbet said:
"Afghans have been crashed,
In less than one day.
Generals died in confusion,
Elephants are killed,
Iron nets are abandoned in wilderness.
Let us turn round,
And check uncle Bakay's situation."

Afghans had tasted bitterness,
How did they dare to get close to four heroes?
Heroes burst through the sweeping dust,
Their flags waved with wind.
A fierce battle began here,
Soldiers and horses surged.
In the cut-throat battle,
Blood flowed in rivers and corpses covered the plain.

Cheyit, Muyterk, Chundoker,
Kalijir and Gurikai,
Five sorcerers fully practiced their spells,
Which were difficult for ghosts to guess.
Qinacha once sent thirty thousand soldiers,
Surged and stopped at nothing,
They took away food and weapons,
Tried to rob carriages, food and money.

When the spearhead of Afghans,
Invaded swaggeringly,
Gurikai practiced a spell first,
Made a gale out of nothing.
The blowing gale made eyes closed,
Made clothes edges wave as wings,
Made hats fly in the sky,
Made clouds of dust covered the sun.

Sorcerer Apey cast a spell as well,
It rained cats and dogs immediately,
The rain washed dust away,
Afghans began a new round of charge.

Hero sorcerer Chundoker,
Had superior spells different from others:
He was mumbling on his lips,
Turned enemy soldiers into stones.

Sorcerer Apey hated to show the white feather,
Other sorcerers worked together,
Balls of fire rolled in,
An ocean of fire appeared.
Food, hay, carriages and yurts of Kirgiz,
Were going to be consumed by the fire soon.
At the critical moment,
Sorcerer Kalijir showed a great miracle,
A wild wind made earth shake under his spell.
The wild wind turned the raging fire round,
The tongues of fire rushed straight to enemies.
The sudden turning fire,
Burned numerous enemies to death.

Sorcerer Taytalan saw this,
He made a storm of hail descended,
Rumbling thunder sounded throughout the sky,
The deafening noise was like roaring sea.
Hail turned into stones immediately,
Pounded soldiers and horses off their feet.

How Muyterk could be indifferent,
He grasped a handful of loess and murmured the spell,
Then threw the loess toward Taytalan.
Taytalan disappeared suddenly,
There was only a willow tree there.
"Pull the tree out together with its root quickly!"
Two young men came out from Kirgiz camp.
Taytalan was going to be cut down.
Afghan sorcerer Otakor cast a spell,
Turned those two young Kirgiz into wild ducks.
Then he made a sudden change,
Turned himself into a ferocious sparrow-hawk.
Cheyit turned into an eagle,
Came to save those two young men.

Afghans all knew some spells,

They began to cast spells to the earth.
The earth shook and spring spurted in a moment,
Rivers ran with big waved churning.
Soldiers were surprised as seeing this,
Rocks rumbled down from the mountain,
Numerous soldiers were stiffened with fear.

Gurikai and Chundoker,
And Muyterk,
Used their spells and turned the earth over,
Surging river and rolling rocks,
All flushed to Afghan soldiers and horses.

Shaking earth calmed down temporarily,
Crafty Afghans,
All turned into leopards,
Pounced mercilessly,
On hero Bakay directly.
How sorcerer Kalijir could look on with folded arms,
Those four hundred Kirgiz,
Turned into mighty tigers immediately.

Leopards could not defeat tigers,
Could not bite tiger's neck in two.
Enemies turned into blue pigeons then,
Fluttered into the sky.
Kirgiz sorcerers,
Turned into white eagles right away,
They all spread their wings,
Fought the pigeon enemies.

Kirgiz sorcerers did everything possible,
To ensure the safety of food and carriages.
Both sides attacked and counterattacked,
The fight continued till the dusk,
Both sides beat drums and retreated.

Days and nights alternated,
Times went by.
Three stars set, night veiled,
Velvet morning sunshine appeared in the east.
Qinacha was in a total confusion,
The defeated general was extremely anxious,
Which kept him awake all night.

The sun just rose from the east,
Drums for fighting sounded again,
Nervous Qinacha,
Ordered Afghan soldiers to run to the battlefield.
Diligent soldiers just finished their breakfast,
Slow soldiers had to put down bowls in hunger.
They turned out with much noise,
Poor soldiers had no choice but to obey.

Damned Qinacha,
Filled him with full of murderous look,
Mounted his short-mane bald-tail spotted monster,
Whipped it and charged forward,
With cold look on his face,
Led his soldiers to the front of the battlefield.
His heroes all wore a distressed expression,
Every one planned for himself:
Cowards imagined,
Their body had already lain in wilderness.

Sentries and patrol soldiers of Manas,
Were all great detectives with accurate judgment.
Clearheaded soldiers,
Could deal with nine heroes.
Carefully selected archers,
Could shoot both eyes of birds.
Kergel was in charge of the line of duty,
Soldiers relieved guard in turn on time.

Agile Kirgiz warriors,
Mounted their horses in majesty:
The golden flag of Ayikoler,
Was surrounded in the center,
Waved in the wind, pierced the air.
Warriors were all confident with high morale,
Every one sat firm in the saddle.
Kicked both sides of the horse,
With the hard heels of their boots.
Troops of both sides swarmed forward,
And stood on each side of the battlefield.
Old hero Bakay held the golden flag high,
Black mane wolf Manas stood erect in front of the flag.

Lion Ayikoler rode on magical steed Ackura,
His face was shining as fried wheat grain.
Watched him carefully,
He showed different expressions.
His shouting was like surging river,
His friendship was like warm spring.
He was cold as winter to enemy,
His great figure was like mountain,
His mind was as broad as vast plain.

The patron god was guarding over his head,
The hero was in majesty with heroic bearing as a wolf.
When enemies saw his majesty,
They were scared out of their wits.
He was as cold as the wind in wilderness,
Which could pierce through the bones:
He was as hot as the summer sun,
He was as powerful as the surging flood.

He wore the white battle gown,
Crescent axe was shining cold light,
Sabre's frost blade was glittering,
All kinds of weapons were ready.

The crown on his head,
Inlaid with jewelry and glittered.
Manas whipped his steed and dashed into the battlefield,
Qinacha marveled secretly:
"This hero is great like a mountain!"

On the right of Ayikoler Manas,
There was a hero rode on a yellow horse,
He wore the black battle gown,
With a row of huge shining buttons,
Dignified manner made people scare.
His face was of the color of pink gold,
Shined charmingly.
He was full of high spirits,
He was frank in character and talked neatly.
He could set a broken bone,
His spell could control the universe:
He could let the dead come to life,
He mastered all skills in the world.

He was a matchless general of a thick build,
He had super wisdom and was good at scheming.
This hero was nothing in common,
He was unparalleled in the world.

On the left of Ayikoler Manas,
There was another proud hero,
He looked around greedily,
With an expression of an eager tiger.
His mount was a Koktikai steed,
It could go one thousand miles in a single day.
He looked down everything on the horseback,
His mighty expression made people scared.

He had thick build, broad shoulders,
Big eyes and bushy eyebrows, and was brave and dashing.
Even you traveled around the world,

It was hard to find such a hero.
He was strong, thick and steady,
The earth seemed to collapse under his feet.
He was straightforward and hot-tempered,
Chivalrous spirit was right in his chest.
Koktikai steed under him,
Was bearing with its malicious eyes.

On the death-or-life battlefield,
He himself could confront ten thousand soldiers.
If he whipped steed and charged,
Any rival would be smashed.
The spear he stabbed out never missed the target,
He would not retreat even facing millions of troops.
He wore black felt hat with blue tassel,
He was super wise and brave enough.
Even fought seven days in a row,
He would not feel tired at all.

Generals and soldiers were in humble reverence,
To the elder under the flag;
He was wise and respected with sharp words,
All Kirgiz respected him very much.
Rows of warriors on both sides,
Were all heroes with their hot blood boiling;
They were all like burning charcoal,
Who dared to fight against them!

These imposing heroes,
Were all great Kirgiz heroes.
Augurs and scapula diviners could foresee,
Patrol soldiers of good ears and eyes,
Sentries guarded beside roads,
Magicians and sorcerers,
They were all great detectives on watching enemies.
Accompanied by these heroes,
Manas had proud dignity.

After the careful observation,
A dark cloud of worry came into the heart of Qinacha.
He thought in fear:
"Station in huge Kakan city,
There are Kara Ketay and Karamark,
Kangayi people are as dense as cattle hair,
The commander administering all these people,
Is right Kunwuer Bayi.
I sent messengers to deliver the message,
And made a pledge with him.
If I am defeated by Manas,
Kunwuer Bayi must revenge for me."

Had Kunwuer Bayi as his backbone,
Qinacha seemed to have full of confidence.
He had a hundred and fifty thousand soldiers,
But in the battle yesterday,
He lost tens of thousands of them.

Like a big tree broke down with its root cut in two,
Like the sparse hair on a bald head,
The rest of troops were scattered,
And in low morale.

A hero called Shaplark,
Had astonishingly high skills.
He was hero and Khan,
He had exalted position in Qinacha's camp:
"I will clear us of yesterday's shame,
Revenge for all the dead!"
He was driving by the death,
Hot blood in his chest could not be stopped.

He rode on a strong mule,
Held cast iron hammer in the hand,
Shaplark was in a threatening manner,
Whipped his mule and galloped forward.

Clouds of smoke ran out of his mouth,
Like gale blew,
Like bitter cold descends on hill,
Turned fire in people's heart into ash.

Shaplark came to the center of the battlefield,
Did not ask the name of his rival,
But screamed loudly:
"I am celebrated Shaplark,
Who does not fear death and dare fight against me?
I have watched the battle yesterday carefully,
I have known your ability.
Warriors who can have a contest with me,
Can be counted on my fingers.
The young man with a black edge felt hat,
Looks confident enough on your grey horse.
You seem to be a hot-tempered daring general,
Come and contest with me if you are brave enough!

"Hey, the young man rides on Sariala horse,
Wears blue battle gown!
You look like being eager to have a try,
It seems you are a brave warrior,
Please stand out and have a fight!
Look at that yellow steed,
Its hair is as soft as the velvet.
The hero rides on yellow steed,
Your dignified manner is like a king;
You have proportional build,
Broad shoulders.
You have super skills,
You are a great man.
He is a hero of trouble:
If you are really highly skilled,
Come out and fight against me,
I promise this is a one-way road for you,
I will not show mercy to you at all.

"No matter who comes to fight against me,
Even if he has one thousand lives,
No matter you are a lion or an eagle,
No matter how many rings of light and good names you have,
I will revenge for the dead.
I will cut his chest open and drag his heart out,
Cut his head off, drink his blood,
Grab his steed, take off his battle gown!
Let him see the ancestors in nakedness!"

Warrior Shaplark screamed,
Whipped his mule forward.
Kirgiz hero Sirak,
Did not care about his power at all,
He asked giant Bakay for a battle assignment,
Spurred steed Tilkezler forward,
Rose clouds of dust,
Charged forward to Shaplark bravely.

Whipped the mule under him,
Shaplark met head-on.
Two heroes confronted,
The battle of life-or-death began.
Spears rattled,
Fly-cutters shined;
No rules, no procedure,
Braced up, neither gave in,
Spears waved in each hand.
No one stabbed the other,
They were equal in match.

The helmet covered tight on head,
Did not sway at all.
One poked, one parried,
Battleax flew over the head with cold light,
Ax back cracked, blade curled,
Spears rattled on chest,

Ax clashed on the helmet,
Spearhead rustled battle gown,
A shout came from time to time,
It was like bursts of waves.

Hooves made clouds of dust rise,
And cover the sun,
Brown earth was shaking slightly,
It could not bear such heavy burden.

Heroes still fought against each other,
From morning till dark.
Shaplark and Sirak, two heroes,
Were evenly matched,
They had to stop and go back to camp separately.

Sirak returned his tent,
Talked about the fight:
"Shaplark is highly skilled,
He proves himself to be a hero.
I come through countless battles,
I have never seen anyone braver than him.
In the cruel battlefield,
I never have stage fright;
I tried my best to fight today,
But I felt really tired.
Now I am still scared,
If Shaplark comes tomorrow,
I am not sure I can defeat him."

Night went by, dawn gleam shimmered,
The time for fight came again.
The sun had not risen yet,
Shaplark had galloped his horse in the battlefield.
Hero Chuwak charged forward bravely,
He grasped the long spear with tassel waving,
Urged his blue-goat steed,

Heroic bearing was like a towering peak.

Seeing the figure of Chuwak,
Shaplark laughed sarcastically:
"Why do you dare to come alone?
Is the guy yesterday a blockhead?
No matter who comes to fight against me,
I will pull his heart and liver out.
That guy dare not come and fight today,
What I only can do is laugh at his cowardice."

For such a self-glorifying big talk,
Chuwak had already been sick of it.
Lion Chuwak had shining battle exploits,
He was covered all over with armor.
He wore layers of armors and helmet,
Iron stick crossed the front of saddle,
Shining breast protector was hanging on neck.

Shaplark talked with his harsh tongue,
Chuwak could not bear him any more.
"I will drink his blood,
His blood makes me excited."
Chuwak's anger rankled him,
He was quivering all over,
Murderous look on his face had shown,
His hair stood up horribly.
He whipped his steed and dashed forward,
Wherever his blue-goat steed went,
There was deep hole like a ground stove.

Clouds of dust rose up behind him like thick fog,
Went straight into the sky.
Chuwak was too impatient to wait,
He let the halter off his hand,
Did not make comments,
Did not report his name either.

Like a hungry leopard pouncing on its prey,
He charged forward to Shaplark.

Hero Chuwak was beyond endurance,
He was like a soaring eagle,
Shouted the slogan "Manas",
Waved the spear and poked the rival hard.

Deafening shouting was like a thunderclap,
They were well-matched in strength.
Opened their eyes wide and gazed at each other,
Then put forward the way of taking turns to fight it out.

Chuwak gave up the chance bravely and stood erect,
Shaplark did not decline at all and attacked fiercely.
The spear Shaplark poked out,
Broke into eighty pieces and fell.

Chuwak still stood erect as a cliff,
Considered the deadly spear as a wheat-straw.
Like the eternal carved stone,
Chuwak kept unmoved with his eyes open wide.
Shaplark faced the braveness of Chuwak,
He fell in panic,
Heart leaped up, panted heavily,
Quivered all over the body,
Lost himself in what to do,
But could not turn round and flee.

It was time for Chuwak to attack according to the agreement,
But Shaplark did not want to follow the rule,
Shameless Shaplark,
Drew his sabre out secretly.
Facing the shameful action of Shaplark,
Hero Chuwak was exceedingly wrathfull,
Said sonorously and valuably:
"Hey, Shaplark, you are so barefaced,

Worm into the earth quickly!
Is this your heroic action,
Does Afghans have such rules?
You drew out your sabre crazily,
Do you forget the rule of the duel?
How swaggering you are just now,
How do you forget it shamelessly? "

Heard the sharp reproach from Chuwak,
Shaplark was brought to his sense right away.
He lost his mind in fear just now,
And forgot the rules of duel for a moment.
Then he stood still in the center of battlefield,
Waited for Chuwak to attack.

Hero Chuwak had an energetic-looking,
Shrank his muscles and nerved himself,
Waved his spear and launched an attack,
Poked to Shaplark in full energy.
With a sound of rattle,
Chuwak's spear broke in two and fell.
Shaplark grunted softly,
Felt weak in every muscle and eyes flashing.
He clenched his teeth and nerved himself,
Launched another attack.

Shaplark pulled and turned his mule,
Grasped the huge battleax in the hand,
Attempted to slash at Chuwak.
Intelligent Chuwak dare not neglect,
Drew out his white light shining battleax fast.
Another round of heart-stirring battle,
Began between them two.

Shaplark slashed in the face,
Chuwak parried it with axe back immediately,
The axe in the hand of Shaplark,

Flew away like a bird.
Chuwak adjusted his ax,
Lifted it to the knee of Shaplark.
Shaplark's knee was cut off,
Cannon bone was swinging under a few tendons.
Bone exposed, blood spurted,
He passed out and fell on the ground.

Afghans began to cast spells again,
It was not magic but well-trained dogs this time.
One thousand mad ferocious dogs,
Broke loose chains and dashed forward.
Barks rose one after another,
Went all the way forward.
One ferocious dog barked and pounced to Chuwak,
Snapped the pastern of steed Koktikai.
The mad dog bit casually,
A piece of muscle was snapped in its mouth.
Kirgiz sorcerers never saw such thing,
Were all struck dumb with terror.
No matter how hard they worked,
The mad dog cared nothing of their spells.

The thigh of steed Koktikai,
Was torn into pieces,
Blood spurted to the ground.
Steed Koktikai,
Proved itself to be the pick among horses,
It endured the agony,
Began to attack those mad dogs,
About fifteen mad dogs,
Were bit off necks by the steed and died,
More dogs were kicked and turned over.

Mad dogs tried to win with their numbers,
Screamed and then returned again.
They continued to charge crazily,

Revealed more of despotic power.
Shaplark was rescued by his attendants,
They moved him quickly.

Chuwak did not dare to stop awhile,
Whipped steed Koktikai,
Dashed ahead regardless of his safety.
Mad dogs chased tightly after him,
Surrounded him in the center.

Seeing this, Almanbet arranged in a hurry:
"Choose ten from forty warriors,
Start off right now to save Chuwak,
Injured Shaplark fled away,
Let me go and capture him alive!"
Ten heroes urged their horses,
Galloped forward as tigers and wolves.
Almanbet rode on the yellow steed,
Went by like the wind to chase Shaplark.

Barking dogs divided into several groups slyly,
With their red tongues hanging out,
Tried to trap Almanbet.
Almanbet flew into a rage,
Who ever had seen such situation?
Almanbet held Kelaty firelock in hand,
Shot the mad dogs fiercely,
A single shot made twenty dogs die.

Brave hero Chuwak,
Chased after Shaplark relentlessly.
Fleeing enemies were still suffering from the shock,
How could they flee from the hand of dragon-like Chuwak?
Before Shaplark turned round,
Door-size crescent battleax,
Had fallen on his head.
White brains covered over axe edge,

Shaplark lay on the ground unmoved.
Black mane wolf Chuwak braced himself up,
And claimed Shaplark's life.

Thirty Afghans behind Shaplark,
None of them escaped,
Warriors led by Showtu,
Captured them all alive.

Qinacha witnessed all what happened,
Lowered his head bashfully.
His face was pale as if he drank poison,
Named Manas to fight it out with him:
"Do not let me see anyone else,
Manas, just come out!"
Manas wore his white battle gown,
Whipped his steed forward as a galloping white tiger.

Qinacha went in the battlefield in advance,
Swaggering and ferocious,
Angry and blood boiling,
Each hair stood up,
Sparks spurted from eyes.
Long spear cast in bronze,
Was grasped in hand tightly.
Fire breathed out of the mouth,
Teeth were clenched with rattle sound.
Like the malicious lion,
Made earth-shaking shouting.
He was a tall and sturdy giant,
Standing in the battlefield aggressively.

Lion Manas pushed on with no stop,
Urged Ackura forward.
He was like the tall Arato mountain,
Admired and praised by others.
He was clever and agile,

Like a leaping antelope.

Seeing lion Ayikoler coming,
Qinacha made a loud scream,
Furious flames flashed in his eyes,
Saliva splashed out of his mouth,
As a burning charcoal was swallowed.

Qinacha was getting to the side of Ayikoler,
He whipped his steed forward,
Fury rose in his chest,
Endless words were coming out of his mouth,
Then he shouted beyond his ability:
"Manas, you come into battle by yourself,
I am famous hero Qinacha.
Big guys like you,
I have met and fought against them countless times,
You have fought everywhere and acted like a lord,
Have you ever seen a hero like me?

"Since I got the name of Qinacha,
Countless heroes came to me,
No one has his return journey.
Your life is only long enough to cook meat,
I will kill you mercilessly,
Kunwuer Bayi has no need to come and fight;
If I cannot do this,
How can my heart be calm?"
He talked wildly with full of confidence,
Stared his eyes wide with fierce-looking.
Devilish Qinacha,
Adjusted the spear in his hand.

Lion Manas continued the talk,
Responded Qinacha loudly:
"You are a guy lack of self-knowledge,
Please open your blurred eyes,

Look, who is standing in front of you!
I am Manas, win in every battle,
Who do you think you are when I am here?
You boast with full of confidence,
Soon you will lose your life.
When you are at a loss of what to do,
You can send minister for negotiating peace."

Heard the response of Arashi commander,
Qinacha's patience had been taxed to the limit,
He harbored the great shame,
Swung his spear and charged toward Manas.
The warhorse Qinacha rode,
Had its tail tied up;
On the swinging spear head,
Balls of flame spurted out;
Roared like thunder,
Earth-shaking sound echoed a long time.
Some timid soldiers,
Had huddled themselves up in terror.
Qinacha lifted his spear and poked aggressively,
Attempted to stab Ayikoler Manas off.

Ayikoler Manas shouted loudly,
Ackura galloped its hooves forward,
The lion whipped the steed and lifted the spear,
Spear met spear with a clash.
Qinacha was highly skilled in martial feat,
Manas was brave and matchless,
One poked, one dodged,
One attacked, one parried,
Long spear knocked long spear,
They spared no effort and fought against each other,
And were generous to their own life.

They took turns suddenly,
Fought according to the rules.

The well-matched fight was from the dawn to the dark,
Blood bled, but came out even.
Soldiers watched in each troops,
No one came to help and cheer.

They did not know how much time had passed,
Qinacha hit upon a scheme,
He said to Manas:
"There is no moonlight tonight, it is too dark,
We are both hungry and tired,
How about we call a truce today,
And come and meet here tomorrow morning."
Cunning Qinacha played a stalling tactic,
But Manas accepted his idea frankly.

Qinacha Was Defeated and Surrendered

Qinacha returned his camp hurriedly,
Convened sorcerers the same night,
Called sorcerers Apey and Napey,
Gave confidential instructions in person:
"Tomorrow I have to fight again,
But I have no energy,
To fight against Manas again.

"I support you for so many years,
Provide you with battle robes and delicacies,
I am like a box full of gold and silver,
You cannot use up in lots of years.
You all have your own capable brains,
Please concentrate and reckon carefully,
Before the dawn of tomorrow,
You must get wonderful scheme to kill enemy.

"One single shot killed thirty dogs,
Who has ever seen this?
Kirgiz people are very crafty,
Wisdom and skills are all better than us.
Their warriors are all regardless of personal danger,
They are all strong and highly skilled;
Manas fought against me today,
Who has ever seen a hero firm as him?

"Like a dagger stuck in the rock, blade rolls,
My spirits have drained away.
My eyes are dim and in eclipse,

I have pins and needles all over and cannot move.
My former heroic spirit,
Lost somewhere and I cannot find it.
Once I killed sixty heroes,
No one could live more than three rounds in my hands.

"I have no energy to fight tomorrow,
Have no confidence in winning.
At the critical moment,
I asked Manas for cease-fire.
He agreed on my request generously,
Only from this point,
Manas is a great graceful hero."

Qinacha finally finished his long talk,
Convened his generals and ministers,
Discussed the scheme secretly.
He blamed the sorcerer cast spells,
Blamed incapable headmen,
Anger rose, flew into a rage,
Rebuked ceaselessly,
Gave out the order of taking action at last.

Begans and generals of Qinacha,
Stared at each other and reckoned secretly:
"We have to act according to his order,
If there is even a slightest mistake,
He will kill us all first."

Sorcerers could not sleep in fear,
Tossed about in bed,
Schemed secretly to wipe out Kirgiz.
They dug ditches on the ground at the same night,
Flood converged into rivers.
Made water holes everywhere and bottomless,
Once fell in and could never get rid of it.

They did not let it go like that,
They schemed magic array accurately.
Led by Apey and Napey,
Ten sorcerers gathered together.
They summoned wind and called for rain,
Made snowstorm descend;
From the night till the day time,
Thick snow was up to the neck.

Except Almanbet,
No one knew this was a spell,
He asked Cheyit, Muyterk and Gurikai,
To convene all sorcerers together.
He revealed the secret of the whole night snow,
And warned sorcerers:
"This is not an accidental snow,
We cannot turn a blind eye to it.
The sun shines tomorrow morning,
Then flood will spread out the valley.
Clouds cover the sky,
Like haze of spray.

"If we do not take steps to prevent,
We will all lose our lives in the flood.
If you are really skillful,
Go and make ice now,
Let chilly winter comes.
This is an earth-shaking issue,
Let Afghan headman shiver with cold,
And dare not get out of bed.

"Let running water turn into thick ice,
Turn the world into chilly winter.
Let enemies have no possiblity to stretch hands out,
And walk out of their doors,
Let them despair and lose confidence.
Their mounts are all short-hair monsters,

Make them freeze stiff,
Like rocks in Gobi desert,
Cover with snow and lie in wilderness.

"If you are really skillful,
You should act decisively and perfectly,
Make Afghan sorcerers,
Have no idea of your track."

Heard what Almanbet said,
Sorcerers all felt awkward and discussed:
"Awe-inspiring hero Almanbet,
Your order is difficult to follow.
Cast spell and let no enemy notice,
It is not easy to do.
We can make the winter come,
But how can we not startle our enemies?
If it turns into chilly winter,
How can we Kirgiz deal with it?
Not only Afghans,
But also we Kirgiz will be tested."

When sorcerers said it was very difficult,
Almanbet frowned and clouded with anger:
"Kirgiz live on high and cold mountains,
Use ice to cut umbilical cord instead of using a scissor.
You are afraid of chilly weather and shrink,
How can you be called Kirgiz heroes?

"Make your mounts,
Get ice on right ear,
Get sunshine on left ear,
Like the summer breeze,
That is the real magical spell.
If you do not have such ability,
How can you call yourself sorcerers?
Twitter without acting when anything comes up,

Then what achievement you can get! "

Almanbet was pestering them,
Blamed them with no hesitation.
Distance of two troops,
Was half-day journey.

Almanbet was a versatile hero,
He was highly skilled in seventy-two types of feat.
He was perfect in,
Magic of all forms.
In a blink of an eye,
He made the sky have six ghost-convinced changes,
Flying snowstorm,
Only roared at Afghan side.

Dense fog covered the middle strip,
Wind blew from Kirgiz troops,
As long as a pot of tea being boiled,
The wind then stopped suddenly.
Stars began to twinkle in the sky.
Wild wind blew again in a moment,
Chilly wind swept Afghan camp.
The snow turned into white ice,
Ditches were leveled up with snow.
The rugged wilderness,
Was smoothed with snow,
Trees were bending,
With snow wrapped all branches.

High skilled Almanbet,
Changed the appearance of the earth.
Suddenly a violent wind blew,
The sun shined and showed its smiling face.
Half was cold, half was warm,
Half with snow, half with sunshine.
In the mortal world, nothing was too strange,

All Kirgiz praised Almanbet's power.

Afghan sorcerers were full of themselves;
They thought Kirgiz camp had been flooded;
Thought they had made a miracle in the world,
Now they were resting secure in their yurts.
When they opened their blurred eyes,
They saw there was no snow at all,
In the place where Kirgiz stayed.
They did not know why the spell they cast hard the whole night,
Did not take effect at all.

They thought hard and still did not know the reason,
Felt shamed about what happened.
Hundreds of thousands of soldiers got into panic,
They rushed out of the camp and looked.
They were at a loss,
Since they could not approach their horses.
Afghans watched their horses carefully,
All horses except Qinacha's were frozen stiff.

They lost their horses,
And shivered in the piercing wind;
They only could huddle beside the fireplace,
They seemed to have seen the end of the world.

Clouds and fog dispersed slowly,
Sunshine came back again,
Chilly wind stopped suddenly as well,
Streams flowed under snow.

"Flood will arrive soon!"
Afghans fell in a fluster.
Suddenly waves rolled in,
Flood brimmed over their armpits gradually.

Afghans could not escaped from the flood,

They struggled in the flood.
Qinacha urged his mount,
Found his way out hard in the flood.
Though he continued to explore the outlet,
He kept sinking to the lake bottom.
With a sudden sound of flopping,
The horse panted for breath.
After the time of a meal,
He still did not find a way to escape from danger.

The hem spread in water,
Hooves kept skidding.
If metting depressions on the ground,
They staggered and it was even harder;
Waves kept coming head-on,
It seemed to turn him over thoroughly.
He looked like a lean ox,
Quivered in the chilly wind.

The basin turned into a white vast.
Places where people stood,
Turned into shining ice.
The earth changed three times in a moment,
The miracle occurred in front of their eyes.
Did not stab out the spear in hand,
Sabre was not wetted with blood,
Did not nerve themselves,
Did not swing battleax and slash at head.
No matter the victory or the failure,
Had no chance to show abilities in battlefield.
Qinacha was at the end of his rope,
He could not get out of the water to revenge,
Shame and hatred tortured his heart.
Though it was just the suffering of one day,
It was like a whole month.

Frank hero Manas,

Seemed to know nothing about sorcerers' power matching.
He was open and straightforward.
He was broad-minded as Taras prairie;
The bloody sucker talked like this:
"Do Afghans come today,
Go and check for me.
Qinacha fought against me yesterday,
We agreed to fight again today.
He'd better not arrive before me,
Then says I am too timid to ride on the horse."

Kergel continued the talk:
"Spirit-noble lion,
No one can shake your dignity.
From yesterday till now,
You have not stepped out of your camp.
There are a lot of weird things happened,
You may not notice the weird sky,
May not notice what happened around you.
My lion Ayikoler,
Please walk out and watch the situation around."

"You are an attentive person,
Am I so careless?
Let's go out and have a look,
To see what on earth happened."

Hero Manas walked out of the camp,
Looked around and observed,
What came into his eyes shocked the lion:
"What weird thing actually happened?"
Black mane wolf gave out such order.
"This is the miracle spells created."
Kergel responded in this way.

Hero Manas gave another order:
"Where are our sorcerers?

Call them and I need ask them."
Kergel left in a hurry,
Took sorcerers in almost immediately.
Manas was filled with anger right away,
Frowned with a fierce expression.

He fixed his eyes on them,
Questioned them loudly:
"You base person, carry out plots,
Always do such unfair things.
Last time he provoked,
So both sides showed each abilities.
The unfair plot like this,
Why do you still carry it out?

"You are all capable brains,
Tell me who did this?
If outsiders know this,
I will be laughed at as an incapable man.
Do not push innocent people into fire,
Because you have grudge with their Khan.
Those weak old people,
You should care them like your pupils.

"If powerful enemies bear down,
We are all matchless heroes,
We should hold our weapons,
Fight it out in the battlefield.
How can we use spells,
To hurt innocent people,
We should step on blood and attack,
Have bloody fight with enemies."
Manas' blood was boiling inside,
Fury made him aggressive.

Uncle Bakay,
His eyes were as sharp as falcon,

His silver beard swung,
His words were to the point:
"Hey, my sincere friend,
Please let me tell you what happened last night.
It is not a casual movement,
It has its reason, you need judge by yourself.
After you returned from the battlefield yesterday,
A heavy snow came suddenly,
Snow mixed with storm,
Our camp was almost being leveled.

"I need tell you the truth of it,
This sudden snow,
Was a magic array Afghans cast.
They cast a spell for snowing,
Tried to bury we Kirgiz.
Then when the sun rises,
Flood would sweep all of us away.

"Almanbet penetrated into enemy's plot,
Asked them to transfer the snow to enemy's camp,
And let Kirgiz get out of danger.
He gave the mission clearly to eleven sorcerers,
Sorcerers all said they were unable to do it,
And lowered their heads quietly to their chests.
At this critical moment,
Hero Almanbet cast the spell by himself,
Saved Kirgiz's lives.

"There is no tiger giving up eating people,
And no wolf giving up eating sheep,
Afghans are working to kill us all,
Did Qinacha discuss with you when he casts a spell?"

Manas was still angry,
Did not change his mind at all;
Strode out of the camp,

Then called Almanbet in a loud voice.
Almanbet had known the reason,
He strolled in front of the hero calmly.

Ayikoler said to Almanbet:
"You are also a lion hero,
Such tricky thing,
Only comes from base person.
Try to save Afghans as soon as you can,
We cannot wipe them out like his.
Heroes need fight in battlefield,
Drive enemies away frankly.
We should line our soldiers,
Fight and defeat them in battlefield."

After hearing what the hero said,
Almanbet praised the hero in his heart,
He brought out his original thought:
"All things have its reasons, its gain and loss,
And also the way with no alternative.
This is the approach aimed at them,
Afghans cast the spell first,
Descend disaster to Kirgiz.
They attempted to block the world with snow,
It is us who would be drowned.

"At the helpless moment,
I called the sorcerers in,
Looked for who was out,
I warned them again and again,
Do not let Afghans notice what we do.
It is said as long as you can defeat enemies,
You can resort to all sorts of tricks.
I just play a few tactics,
Transfer the snow to enemies' camp.
Afghan soldiers are safe and sound,
Only their horses are frozen to death.

"I have known you will blame this,
So I have blocked road and trapped them in.
The matter is as simple as the button on a coat,
Untying them just need move your fingers slightly."
Almanbet explained such and such,
Of his action.

"It does not matter, my friend!
But do not make such things happen again."
Almanbet continued the talk:
"Ayikoler, please listen carefully:
Our enemies are all very cunning,
To deal with such enemies,
They do not deserve our kindness.
If there is no full of hatred,
How can a battle be started?"

Almanbet finished his words,
Shook the edge of his coat,
The earth restored its original appearance,
Flood receded, it seemed nothing had happened.

Afghans breathed a sigh of relief,
Smiles were put back on their faces.
Qinacha did not reconcile to,
Horses he had lost.
He looked up to the sky,
It was right at noon,
The appointment made yesterday was still in his mind,
How could he stay there any more?

He called all wise old men and ministers,
To discuss the countermeasures:
"I will ride on fast steed,
Waste no time to fight.
Pierce through the livers of those Kirgiz,
Slash their heads open with my battleax!"

Qinacha released such a big talk,
To show his power and prestige.
A sage called Muto,
Questioned his firm words,
Described the advantages and disadvantages to Qinacha:
"Everyone wants to show his prestige,
But forgets there is better steed among fine steeds,
You defame great heroes unreasonably,
I am worried about your big talk.
Everyone wants to show his power,
But forgets there is faster steed among post-horses,
You ignore the value of pearls,
I feel ashamed of your boasting.

"Even if you hang me on gallows,
I cannot hide the truth in my heart.
Qinacha, you stand here,
Swagger yourself and want to level everything.
We failed in yesterday's battle,
You barely escaped from the hand of the death.
Quivered, eyes blurred,
Dust was full on your eyelash.

"You screamed to sorcerers,
Called them in person;
You break the rules of battlefield,
Cast a spell to them first.
The spell did not work to Kirgiz at all,
But made ourselves fall into disaster.
Numerous horses are buried in snow,
No single warhorse is left for us now,
Our soldiers have to stride forward.

"If we walk to attack the enemies,
Like a lame duck,
The cavalry of Manas must stamp us flat,
Like a lion swallows the prey.

Manas is not a hero of no calculation mind,
He comes here not for a meeting and a talk.
You occupied Jedigair and Keyiwa,
This is why they come to give a lesson.
You ask us to fight on foot,
This is not pleasant to hear.
If you cannot make your anger calm down,
You can fight against them.

"Over the years,
The name of Manas has long resounded in our ears,
He is a real great hero in this world,
How can you live if you are defeated by him?
You live in Afghanistan,
But you form an alliance with Kunwuer Bayi.
You launch an attack to peaceful Kirgiz,
Make many warriors and generals injured and die.

"Do you ever think about the death?
You will lose your life in vain with your arrogance.
You have tested his braveness,
You cannot defeat hero Manas.
For Almanbet, Chuwak and Sirak,
What kind of actions do we need take?

"You gave out the order blindly,
You do not know the rope and with no careful plan,
Braveness has another meaning,
Brutal battle sometimes makes you bend."

Heard what sage Muto said,
People present put their heads together and discussed:
"What Muto said is very reasonable,
Honorable commander Qinacha,
Please listen carefully and think carefully.
Let us put our profile low,

To present Kirgiz lavish gifts,
Both sides need mutual understanding,
Bury previous hatchet, reach peace."

After Qinacha heard this,
He pounced on them angrily:
"People do not want to fight,
I have known they have some ulterior motive,
It is not for protecting me,
It is for their own greed and wild ambitions.
I have understood your thought,
It seems you ignore my fame.
I am like a mountain,
Which point am I inferior to others?

"I live in this world but render tribute to others,
Make people in this world laugh at my incompetence,
How can I still live in this world?
If the end of my life is coming,
Fire of life will turn to ash,
I will let Manas witness my power,
At the last minute.
Saddle my steed now,
I will launch the attack right away.
Since heart is still beating in my chest,
I refuse to surrender as a base person.

"I will cut the head of Manas off,
Make his blood run like a river."
In a very threatening manner,
Qinacha gave the order to all soldiers.
Soldiers stood in lines,
Rushed to the battlefield according to the order;
They all felt uneasy,
Like fleas on broken coat,
Inched forward in low spirits.

Qinacha was armed to teeth,
Like a towering mountain,
Head covered with helmet,
Shield hung on the shoulder,
Battleax crossed the saddle,
Chest protector shined,
He urged his mount the spotted mule,
Nerved himself and came to the battlefield.

Lion Manas rode his steed,
His majestic looking was like a mountain peak.
Spear swung in his hand,
Blue boot tip was towering into the sky.
Like an excited ram,
Hung sabre at the side;
Forty warriors held spears and sabre in their hands,
Showed their great braveness behind him.

Qinacha met with the hero,
A fierce battle began again.
Qinacha still had his wishful thinking,
Of winning the battle.
"I will drive gods on his head away,
Seize the chance and stab him quickly."
Qinacha launched the attack with full of confidence,
Hung firelock on the shoulder, and bow in the waist.
Stanch Qinacha called up all his courage,
Poked the shining spear to the hero.

Hero Manas did not spare a glance,
He considered swaggering Qinacha,
As his trouser legs.
He was beaming in spirit and face was glowing,
Like a hill gave out white light;
He did not stab his spear and parry the coming spear either,
He just watched the coming spear quietly.

Qinacha's thirty-span spear was coming,
The spear barrel was broken into forty pieces and fell.
Manas was not scared at all,
Looked forward calmly.
He was worried about a great misfortune,
Would descend on heads of Afghans.

Qinacha was burning with a frenzy of fury,
Turned and drew his sabre out.
Ayikoler Manas turned his steed,
Raised his Sire spear,
Facing his mighty expression,
Qinacha dare not resist,
Turned round immediately and fled away.
The hero urged his steed Ackura,
Leaped and rose dust up high in the air.
As Qinacha was going to enter his camp,
Sire spear was like a forceful dart,
Poked into his shoulder,
Qinacha flopped down the saddle.

Afghan soldiers were all in panic,
Came up from all directions.
Qinacha lay on the ground,
He jumped and stood up straight:
Took the belt off and hung on his neck,
Shivered and fell on his knees in front of hero Manas.

It was said: "The sword drawn out,
Will not cut a lowered head."
The saying came true at the moment.
As the lion held the spear and was going to turn round,
Qinacha acknowledged allegiance to Manas reverently.

"Enough, battle between us will stop here."
Wise hero Ayikoler said this,
Then turned his steed and returned.

Qinacha gave orders to his attendants immediately:
"Ask Muto to take five ambassadors,
And go and invite black mane wolf Manas to my palace."
Muto was a quick-minded sage,
He reported the thought of Qinacha word by word.

Akunhan appointed special messengers,
To observe the progress of the battle.
He made his request to Manas,
Asked to give Qinacha to him.
Akunhan and Muto,
And Qinacha,
Were all called by Manas,
All things would be supervised and planned by Akunhan.

Informed by Qinacha,
They knew Kunwuer Bayi and Georoy led a camel group,
Came with tea and silk.
The leader of the group was damned Kokchykoz,
He took camel groups and came twice.
Heard the news of Kokchykoz,
The face of Manas became black with fury:
"My fellow Akunhan,
I will start off now to revenge himself on Kokchykoz,
Take tea and silk of Kunwuer Bayi and Georoy,
As spoils of war.
Then turn the steed and return,
Gather in Ayinla and celebrate."

He turned round and told Qinacha:
"If you Qinacha feel defiant,
You can choose another day to fight against me,
I will fight it out with you.
Now I will revenge myself on Kokchykoz,
To remove the wrath in my heart."

Let us put this aside,

Talk about how angry Manas,
Makes Kokchykoz screech,
And root out this perfect villain.

Almanbet Wiped Out Kokchykoz

Left Afghans behind and started off,
Manas led a group went forward.
Sarabel mountain pass of Saraart mountain,
Had a prairie vast and boundless in the middle,
Peaks around it interlocked like dog's teeth,
Steep cliff towered in the sky.
The hero urged his steed day and night,
Went a long journey without stop.
Climbed over Kerktdobot mountain,
Headed toward Kashgar.

Magical steed Ackura pranced,
Its forelock swung toward the sky;
Beads of sweat on the chest,
Rolled down like pearl.
Expressions on Manas, face changed continually,
Sometimes it was like the bright moon,
There was no anxiety on his face at all,
As clear as the blue sky;
Sometimes it was so depressed,
That it was like thick clouds covered the sun.
Aji Bayi and Chuwak followed him tight,
Noticed the feeling of Ayikoler,
In order not to disturb the hero's thinking,
They opened the distance with Manas.

Two steeds went shoulder to shoulder,
Kept marching in step all the time.
Like an opened net,

Forty warriors followed them tight.

Almanbet cleared the way in the front,
He was half-day journey ahead from his companies.
On the vast Yarkant Gobi desert,
Two figures galloped at full speed came in sight suddenly,
He watched carefully though his telescope,
One was Kokchykoz himself.
He thought as seeing Kokchykoz:
I am so lucky today,
Qinacha once mentioned,
Kunwuer Bayi and Georoy,
Their camel group must come.
I need try to captutre Kokchykoz,
Otherwise Manas will not be happy."

Almanbet used a few tactics to make wind blow,
Clouds of dust covered the sky.
Kokchykoz was totally bewildered in terror,
Turned to a door of a yurt and dismounted.
Before he could step into the yurt,
He heard the noise of hooves of Almanbet's steed.
Gulidur's son Arabye,
Erchywuler, Bozwuler and Showtu,
Hero Majik of Kara Nuoyi,
And Sirak all accompanied.

They were all highly skilled heroes,
How could they let the enemy off!
Kokchykoz was captured soon,
His arms and legs were all tied tight,
Like a ball of yarn,
Falling like a drowned mouse.

Right at the moment,
A hero called Kampalan,
Followed Kokchykoz to guard Georoy's livestock,

Led six personal attendants,
Before they knew what had happened,
They were captured alive quietly.
"Where is the camel group now?"
Almanbet began to interrogate.

Six guys captured,
Looked through their glassy eyes.
Kampalan and Kokchykoz,
Told the track of camels before the interrogation:
"Camels stay in Toalaler,
We choose a short cut to go,
The destination is Chechnya.
Camels suspend now at a checkpoint called Chelan,
Without our order,
Camel group will not take the liberty to act."

Heard the detailed statement of captives,
Almanbet gave out the order:
"Eagle Sirak,
I will leave Majik here,
You take four warriors and start off now,
You must go toward east day and night,
Let the Plough lead you ahead on your left.
Within sixteen days,
You'd better come back and report to me.
Do Kokchykoz and Kampalan,
Tell us all the truth?
Or do they still hide something?
We cannot neglect it.

"You should know how many people in the camel group,
Then count the number of camels.
You must not go to Kashgar,
Not let Yarkant people notice either.
There is a big mountain pass in the east of Afghanistan,

I never see it but I heard about it,
You just go there.

"On the hill of Dandonbash,
Plenty of fat and strong wild goats walk there,
Heroes led by lion Manas,
Will stop and rest there,
When you return you must meet them there,
I will wait for you on Tubela hill."

Sent Sirak on his way,
Almanbet still felt reluctant to part.
Majik drove Kokchykoz and Kampalan,
And six attendants went with hands tied behind their back.
They arrived at Yarkant city,
The mission to detain the captives was transferred to Malabek,
He put them in prison and watched strictly,
Then Almanbet,
Welcomed lion Manas into the tent.

They stayed in Yarkant for eight days,
Asked to frog-march Kokchykoz to them.
In front of Manas,
Clove his belly from his navel,
Pulled out his lungs, liver and heart,
Threw to wild dogs and let be dragged to wilderness to be eaten.

Kampalan was frog-marched to them too,
Both hands were bolted in shackles,
Jolted and was driven on foot.
The other six captives,
Were still guarded by Malabek,
They need to be detained for nine months.

Dandonbash was on the edge of Oboler,
Flocks of wild goats wandered there.
Heroes searched in the mountain again and again,

Bucks there were strongest.
The skin of wild buck was invaluable,
It was the best to make embroidered clothes,
One colt,
Only could exchange one wild buck's skin.

Heroes shuttled back and forth in mountains,
Shot wild goats on cliff,
Shot antelopes in valleys,
Took eyas out on the cliff.
They hunted animals to their heart's content,
Jackals, wolves, foxes, snow leopards and brown bears,
And snow cocks on high mountain,
Were almost all hunted them.

Heroes were in high spirits,
Went round the peak in line,
And moved toward Yurkenichy river,
Marched toward Akunhan's city.
Crowds led by uncle Bakay,
Came to Akunhan's palace.
Akunhan's warriors took halters over,
Welcomed them into the yurt warmly.

Let us put this aside,
Look at the situation of Sirak.

Sirak took four attendants,
Galloped in the vast Gobi desert,
Along the hilly and rugged mound,
Marched forward toward Chelan.

A lonely white calf,
Ran in front of them suddenly,
It was a little female calf,
It had charming and pure hair,
It made miserable moan,

And followed heroes tight.
"We are patrolling in the wilderness,
But a moaning calf follows us so tight,
It will bring us misfortune."
Sirak wanted to kill and eat it,
But he was moved with compassion.

Like talking with a company,
Sirak said to it like this:
"White calf,
In this lonely wilderness,
It is white saline all over,
This is a land which should be cursed,
There is no grass to eat and no spring to drink.
There is a red willow woods in front of us,
And a populous woods too.
There is no craggy ravine here,
It is your right place.

"Please wait there for a while,
I will take you with me when we are back.
I will say you are the king of desert Kumala[①],
As an unusual gift to the lion.
Kumala presents white calf,
I will let them know.
When we call you gently,
Please come to me immediately."

After fondled the forehead of the calf,
Sirak held his horse immediately.
Whether he said goodbye,
He could not remember,
The calf shook its head,
Stood still at the place.

① Kumala: The king of desert in the legend.

Steeds galloped and sweated profusely,
Warriors complained Gobi desert was too vast.
After two days and one night trudge,
They arrived at Chelan at dusk.
Merchants were busy,
Gathered camels they were responsible separately together;
As seeing the figures of heroes,
They were all filled with anxiety with their eyes open wide.

Drums were beating loudly,
Managers of camels all gathered.
Asked about the information,
Counted the number of people at the same time:
"Who is your leader?
Tell the details right now!"

Under the prestige of heroes,
These poor guys did not dare hide the truth:
"Kunwuer Bayi and Georoy,
Each of them has five hundred and fifteen camels.
There are one thousand and thirty camels totally,
One thousand camels carry tea, silk and food,
Thirty camels carry yurts and grains,
One person is responsible for three camels,
We go on the trip like this,
This is the detailed information of the camels group.

"There are eight of us,
They are managers of the camels group.
They have their own duties,
That is to watch us, the servants.
Kokchykoz and Kampalan,
They are our leaders.
Manas is the hero of the age,
Giants such as Kunwuer Bayi and Georoy,
Have deep hatred to him.

"Lands we have passed on our journey,
All have Kirgiz people lived on.
Kokchykoz and Kampalan,
Led six people and went first to explore the way.
They asked us to wait here,
Not take any action without their order.

"There is a knowledgeable lama among us,
He is a person who can predict the future,
He opened the book in his hand,
Informed us to gather camels together quickly.
We are busy with what he told us to do,
But he left first with himself,
If you go and search him,
We will give you direction."

Bozwuler continued the talk:
"You told us the information of camels,
We believe your loyalty initially.
Are you a Kirgiz?
I hope you tell us the truth.
I am a warrior of Manas,
I accompany him all the time."

The poor guy burst out crying as he heard this,
Complained all his sorrow:
"I am from Shankay tribe of Kirgiz,
Betbakto mountain is my hometown.
Ferocious devil Georoy,
Drove us to here.
To see subjects of Manas,
Is my dream for a long time.

"Please urge your horses and start off soon,
Must not let that cunning lama flee away,
He is really a dangerous enemy."

Arabye took that camel manager,
Chased that lama tight.
Cunning lama had preparation,
Camel he rode was chosen strictly,
He whipped the swaying camel,
Fled along the main road crazily.
Arabye did not catch that lama,
He had no face to go back to report,
So he had to nerve himself and continue chasing,
He urged Koychabuta steed,
But the galloping camel left him far behind.

Arabye had a unique skill,
He was a hotshot in archery.
The quail in the grass,
He could shoot just in its chest.
Koychager firelock hung on shoulder,
He wanted to shoot at that lama,
But unfortunately the lama was out of the range of fire.
Arabye drew and bowed,
Shot out a forceful arrow.
The arrow flew forward fast,
It shot on the leg of the camel lama rode,
Lama fell off from the camel back,
As his body landed he died.
Though there was full of gold and silver in his bags,
Though he sincerely put the figure of Buddha in his pocket,
Buddha did not bless him,
Gobi desert became the home of his life.

Arabye took the gold and silver,
Turned his horse round and returned.
Totally one thousand and twenty nine camels,
Sirak asked to connect them one after one.
Put tea and silk on camels,
Each person was responsible for three camels,
Went on their journey as fast as they could.

They arrived at the place where the white calf stayed,
Sirak shouted at the Gobi desert:
"The white calf presented to us,
By king of the desert Kumala,
Are you still here?
You are not a normal animal,
You are the camel god who can understand human's words;
I come to meet you according to our appointment,
White calf, please come out quickly!"
Heard the voice of Sirak,
The white calf made a bellow,
Galloped its hooves forward,
With its humps swaying.

Sirak dismounted,
Branded his father Jagurp's mark on the ear of the calf.
Took out silk-weaving bridle,
It was the right size to put it on the calf.
White calf of hero Manas,
Its good name then resounded in the world,
People still recall and sing it till today.
From then till now.
In the Gobi desert Keltaylark①,
They spent a night,
And continued the journey the second day.
The name "Keltaylark",
Printed in people's mind forever.

① Keltaylark: In Kirgiz language, it means "Come, calf!".

Khans Pointed Prenatal Betrothal for Semtaiy

Sirak did not pass Kashgar city,
They climbed over mountains in Afghanistan,
Drove camels group to report the completion of the task,
Manas stationed there and rested.

In the morning breeze,
Almanbet enjoyed the landscape,
He saw a young married lady,
Held a baby and walked past him.
Sharp-eyed Almanbet,
Watched the lady carefully,
The baby in her arms,
Shined special lights in his eyes.

Almanbet fixed his eyes upon the baby,
The baby was unusual,
The sound of baby's crying,
Was pleasant to ears and made people comfortable.
"If I am right,
This is a girl's crying."
Almanbet called that lady softly,
The high-spirited young lady,
Directly came to Almanbet.

Almanbet asked her excitedly:
"Is this baby a girl or a boy?
Does he or she have a name?
Who is his or her honorable father?"

The lady said when she heard this:
"Our Ayinla is very famous,
Well-known Akunhan is our Khan,
He urged steeds into mountain with attendants a few days ago.
In the remote wilderness,
Akunhan met this little baby girl.
There are a pair of white wings on her back,
Generals were all surprised with no idea.

"A baby like her,
Who in the world can find her?
The baby has been taken to us seven days,
Not even a fly stops on her face.
Her name has not been decided yet.
Khan has sent invitations to all,
To have a cradle ceremony for the baby.
In order to wait for your coming,
Respected Akunhan delays the time of the ceremony."

Almanbet really wanted to have a look,
But he was afraid the baby touched by evil eyes;
How could he resign himself not to have a look?
Too many thoughts went through his mind.
He was kind and fair,
Great braveness and deep affection rose in his heart,
He attempted to seize the chance,
Made a bold idea:
"Lion hero Manas,
I will make a decision for him."

On Kokotoy's ceremony,
There was one thing happened.
Like a river of fortune,
Good luck fell on the head of Kanikai.
If Koshaoyi's blessing could come true,
Kanikai would give birth to a boy.

Self-sufficient Almanbet,
Never changed his words and actions by others.
Once he had a good idea,
He must put it into effect right away.
For that famous yellow steed,
Did he show any stinginess?
On the forehead of the steed,
He tied bowl-size brocade flower.

When he prepared everything well,
Almanbet entered the palace,
Uncle Bakay and Akunhan,
Ayikoler Manas sat there.
Almanbet walked up to them,
Sat beside Chuwak.
He explained to Chuwak,
His thoughts in details.
Chuwak said after he heard that:
"My lion Almanbet,
You are frank and wise,
Your words are just to the point;
Besides your mount Sariala steed,
Please count one thousand camels with bags in."

Two lions decided secretly,
Then Almanbet reported to Bakay in details:
"Uncle, you are the sage,
There is one thing you need make a decision.
For the blessing of uncle Koshaoyi,
I never doubt any of it.
He prayed a boy for Manas,
Semtaiy is the name of the boy,
If his blessing can come true,
Kanikai must bear a boy.

"Akunhan has a baby girl,
She is shining and hard to find in the world.

Do you think it is suitable,
For Semtaiy to be Akunhan's son-in-law?
Do you have a different opinions,
On letting that pretty girl be Manas' daughter-in-law?
Akunhan and Ayikoler,
Do you agree with it?

"I have tied bowl-size flower,
On the forehead of Sariala steed;
Camels group of Kunwuer Bayi and Georoy,
Has been placed by me to the back of the steed.
Drank the pure milk of mother,
Make us become brothers related by blood.
For my relative-like Khan,
I will present all the treasure,
Even the gifts presented by Birmiskaler,
The shining diamonds are also included in it."

Akunhan and his wife Zulaika,
Were stunned speechless.
For the pleasant words Almanbet said,
Manas also kept quiet at the moment.

Uncle Bakay gave a little cough,
Then he spoke as loud as the bell:
"Lovely Almanbet,
What you said is reasonable.
You just discuss with Chuwak,
You two can make the decision by yourselves."

Almanbet led Sariala steed,
Came to Akunhan's yard.
The steed was tied on a big post,
It was a high-spirited unusual animal.
Shining twelve-color lights,
All jewels presented were pure gold;
The shining necklace,

Was put on the neck of the baby girl.

"Her name will be Ayichulek."
Almanbet gave the name to the girl.
When they were going to part,
Judicious Akunhan,
Informed his subjects,
Called all rich merchants and celebrities,
Chose Mukam artists skilled in singing and dancing,
To praise Manas and his heroes,
To hold the betrothal ceremony for the princess.

According to Kirgiz traditional customs,
The ceremony held on a green hill.
Venerable old men of both sides,
Sat in a semi-circled ox horn shape.
People talked and praised,
Manas and all heroes,
Then began to discuss the matter of betrothal.
Akunhan talked confidently and fluently:

"Four Khans, forty warriors,
And wise Bakay, please listen to me.
Manas, Bakay and Chuwak,
An embroidered camel hair coat for each of you,
A leather coat for each of forty warriors,
Please accept them,
Do not let the saddle go back empty.
Magical Sariala steed as a gift,
It can be the gift I present to Almanbet in return.
Bakay, the lavish gifts you presented to me,
I need one thousand camels to carry them.

"All Khans here,
You just put up with it today,
I do not have more suitable gifts here,
Otherwise I will not be stingy to present in return,

As long as we advance hand in hand,
There will be more journeys in the future."

Almanbet continued the talk right away:
"Use twenty-nine camels as gifts,
I want to know from you,
The name of the future daughter-in-law."

Akunhan responded immediately:
"I have given her a name,
Her name is Ayichulek.
I also want to ask you,
Please tell me the name of my son-in-law.
To thank him for hearing the name of my son-in-law,
The last Suputan① camel hair coat will be the gift,
I will present it to brothers of son-in-law's father,
Present it to hero Sirak."

Every elder put on Suputan camel hair coat,
Others put on fur cloak,
Every one was happy.

Many warriors worried secretly,
They put their heads together and talked:
"Almanbet presented his mount,
How he could fight without his mount!"
They did not attend the ceremony on the hill,
How could they know the secret in it,
The yellow steed as a gift,
Akunhan had presented it to Almanbet in return.
"Steed is the wing of the hero,
How could a hero's mount be presented so easily."
Do not be surprised,
This is just a process of the game.
The yellow steed had been presented as a gift,

① Suputan: It means valuable cloth in Kirgiz language.

This had not been the first time,
Though it was presented generously,
Finally its master was still the original one.

Under the morning breeze,
Heroes urged their horses to a long journey.
Went back to Taras and rested secure,
Enjoyed the peaceful time.
They had nothing to do everyday,
Had to play the game "Capture Palace" for fun.
The game of grabbing sheep could not forget,
Butchered colts, invited each other,
Baby camel meat was very fresh.
Free from care, peaceful and calm,
Every one lived a happy and peaceful life.

Let us put this aside,
Tell the story of eagle Manas invites seven Khans,
On purpose for going on an expedition.

Manas Led an Expedition

Khans Discussed on the Expedition for Saving Their Compatriot

Kazakh and Kirgiz were about equal numbers,
Many of them lived together in one area,
Some tribes even had Karamark as neighbors,
Numerous Arashi people lived a nomadic life in Kapaler.
Kunwuer Bayi sent his troops out,
They did not invade any other tribes at all,
But only launched attack to Arashi people,
Carried out astounding slaughters.
Weak old people,
Were all horribly mangled;
Babies in swaddles,
Were all abandoned in wilderness and could not see parents.
They plundered as brutally as hungry wolves,
Kirgiz fell in an endless abyss of misery.

Treasure was carried on camels' backs,
Tied tight with ropes;
Asked nomads to drive their own sheep,
Kept urging them cheerfully;
Then chose capable young men,
Asked them to guard the prisoners;
Quick and neat young ladies and men,
Workers spared no efforts,
Young married ladies and unmarried girls,
Were all driven to Kangayi as going to tombs.

Men were treated as drudges,
Women were treated as servants;
Family members could not go back to hometown,

Roamed remote and suffered all humiliation.

Ten years passed,
Some of the suffered people,
Got the chance to gather and flee away,
Went round enemies' blockade and back to Kirgiz.
Hero lion Manas now got to know,
The humiliation and misery his people suffered.
Recalled Arokai's all-time behavior,
Counted clusters of crimes of Karamark,
He was filled with great fury.
In order to save his suffered fellows,
He made the decision to go on expedition to Begin.

Kirgiz peaceful life,
Was disturbed by evil Karamark.
Brilliant Khan Manas,
How could he be completely indifferent and do nothing!
After many sleepless nights' thinking,
He finally confirmed the plan for expedition.

One day at dusk,
At the moment of walking out of the yurt,
Black mane wolf told Kanikai:
"Please make all preparations well as early as you can,
My respected wife Kanikai,
Many honorable Khans will come to my palace,
And headmen with gold crowns as well.

"Some are well-known heroes,
Some are very influential generals.
If they fight against invading powerful enemies,
They must make enemies' blood redden the earth,
No one can flee out of their palms,
Ferocious lions are coming."

Heard the orders of Khan Manas,

Madam Kanikai turned that over in her mind,
Then she turned round and stepped out of the door fast,
Looked at the hillside opposite her.
White yurts stood in line on the hillside,
Colorful ropes decorated them brightly,
That was where forty warriors lived.
With a slender waist as sparrow hawk,
Kanikai wore long laced silk skirt,
The skirt swayed slightly,
She walked slowly into Ayinla of forty warriors,
She was shinning with high spirit.

Bursts of frolic noise,
Came out of Erchywuler's yurt.
"Play your chess piece quickly, do not hesitate!
I will see how your soldiers dare pass the line."
"I must not let you get it!
How do you deal with it if I eat your queen?"
Chatrasi chess and marble game were lively,
Tying string ball game and running mouse game①,
Were going hectically,
Bustling and being quiet by turns,
They enjoyed themselves.

Decent madam Kanikai,
Walked into the yurt with light gaits.
Warriors stopped games immediately,
No one talked or bustled.

Madam Kanikai looked seriously,
But she was peaceful when she talked:
"Send capable young men,
To Susamur meadow at top speed,
Fat mares of empty embryo are being herded there.
From groups of six stallions,

① Tying string ball game and running mouse game: Both are Kirgiz traditional folk games. They are similar to the children's game "Throw handkerchief" of Han people.

Choose ten fat mares separately,
Drive them back to Ayinla before evening prayer time,
The number should get sixty,
Please count carefully.
Boil the meat and make soup with traditional way.

"Our lion Manas,
May go for hunting,
And need taste fresh wild meat,
Or he will pack for an expedition."
Kanikai gave the order and turned round hurriedly,
To work busily on welcoming guests.

Five yurts were used as living rooms for guests,
Six yurts were used as kitchen,
Two yurts were especially for boiling water and meat,
One yurt was especially for warriors to rest,
Rest ten yurts had no certain usage.

All yurts were lined neatly,
Kanikai was in charge of everything.

Smart and capable Kanikai,
Chose handy married and unmarried girls,
From neighbor nobles' families,
To decorate the yurts elaborately.
Spread five-color pattern carpets,
Put out all kinds of embroideries
And different patterns decorations.
The seams between carpets,
Were pressed by special Kochego① ornaments.

Soft bears' skins were placed on honorable seats,
Seats of elders and Khans were placed by splendid cushions.
Thick and soft black sheep skin cushion,

① Kochego: It is the red tapestry hanging in the back of the yurt the bride sits in Kirgiz wedding.

Was sewed with brocade and Manat①.
On seats for young warriors,
Were black and brown velvet cushions.
Skylights were inlaid with tin foil,
Arch wood was lit up by them.
Fences of yurts were carved in patterns,
All wooden structures were made with highly skills.

Lofty white yurts,
Were decorated as grand as palace.
Windproof belts made of iron chains hung down from skylight.
Which were used to fasten the yurt,
The top of the doorframe was inlaid with pure gold,
Left and right sides were decorated with silver.
They used shining copper wires rather than leather belts,
To tie and connect the netted fences.

Embroidered ornamental strips on top of fences,
Had four-finger-wide fur edged its bottom,
And had brocade as its side ornaments.
All strips and ropes in yurts,
Were colorfully weaved Kajary② ribbons.
Between fences and perimeter felts,
Silk thread wound and knitted Achnatherum in bright patterns.
Tassels and beads hung down,
From edge seams and top,
They were splendid and very beautiful.

Decorations outside the door curtains,
Were patterns of eagles and tigers,
Which were strikingly vivid.
Skylights were painted as red as pomegranate,
Outside of yurts was dazzling white.
Such splendid yurts,

① Manat: One kind of valuable silk cloth.
② Kajary: Ribbons weaved with yarn of many colors.

How could others not praise.

Every time when Khan Manas and madam Kanikai,
Were at leisure and unoccupied,
They rested in the yurt;
Beks and Begans stood on both sides in the yurt,
Were ready to give opinions and discuss.
There was a vast place in the center,
It was for forty warriors to play.
In the right corner of the yurt,
It was where Tazbaymart put up pot to boil meat.
Such trivial matters,
Were all arranged in perfect order.

During the days the ceremony was held,
Seven hundred people could live in this yurt;
This was a capacious yurt,
Bright and tidy with elegant Decoration.

Got the order from Manas,
With the certain advice from madam Kanikai,
No warrior dared to neglect,
No one dared to stand aside woodenly.

Erchywuler and Bozwuler,
Urged horses as a bird flew,
Stirrups knocked together with clanks,
They spurred bellies of their horses hard,
Arrived at Susamur meadow as whirlwind.
From groups of six stallions,
They chose sixty fat mares separately.

Horses rose dust all the way,
Hooves shook the earth.
Watchers stood aside with terror.
At the time approaching the sunset,
Horses arrived at the palace on time.

Kanikai commanded personally,
Watched and scanned aside.
Every one performed his own duty,
Butchered the mares quickly.

Married ladies were quick and neat,
Girls were diligent and capable,
They cleaned the guts well.
With any guts smell on,
Guests would ridicule and not be satisfied.
Immersed guts in warm water,
Washed off the blood on intestines.
Sausage was made one-span long,
Boiled fresh meat was as high as a hill.
One plate of mare meat was in front of them two,
Everything was well prepared.

When the sky showed whitish rays in the east,
After a busy night,
Madam Kanikai crept back to the bedroom.
She did not want to wake lion Manas,
Just lay beside Khan quietly.

The sun rose, east was bright,
Lion Manas took a glance to bright skylight.
Stretched himself, put on his clothes,
Kanikai opened the door for him and stood aside.

Wide silver belt wore on his waist,
Light like the moon shined on his face.
His wisdom convinced others completely,
Making enemy with him could only lose life.

Wide gold belt wore in his waist,
Light as the sun shined on his face.
Did not need give orders to force others,
Convincing through reasons had full power.

All enemies set themselves against him,
Could never flee away from his hands.

Ayikoler Manas stepped out of the palace,
Twelve guards guarded there powerfully.
"My warrior Bolanchy, come here quickly!
You lead trumpeters and trombonists.
You need let them blow together,
To deliver news to others.
My seven Khans[①],
You need let them hear clearly.

"Everyone takes one hundred elite troops,
Come to my camp as soon as possible."

The lion repeated his order,
Turned round and returned his palace.
He entered five living rooms in turn,
Watched yurts for receiving guests carefully.
He specially went in and looked,
Six yurts for providing food.
Yurts were clean and tidy,
Everything needed was there.

Like an older brother,
Kanikai was his backbone;
Like a younger brother,
Kanikai arranged everything well.
Khan Manas felt everything was going as his wishes,
Praised Kanikai in his heart,
She did everything perfectly.

In the blink of an eye,
Drums shook the earth, horns blew together;
Sound of trumpets made a deafening noise,

① Seven Khans: Manas has fourteen Khans under him, namely inner seven Khans and outer seven Khans. It refers to inner seven Khans.

Sound of drums roared to the sky.
Each one led one hundred soldiers,
Seven Khans started off in a hurry.

Orders of Khan Manas,
Spread to all directions clearly.
Heroes with no preparation,
Were in a great bustle for a moment;

When there was good news,
Trombone sounded melodious;
Spread afar slowly.
When there was bad news,
Trumpet sounded harsh and sad.
Now trombone and trumpet sounded together,
No one knew what the truth was!

"Black mane wolf summons,
Where does he want to go for an expedition?
We cannot guess out of thin air,
We'd better go to meet our noble Khan."

Jagurp set out from Jaktash,
Leaped on his steed and led one hundred attendants.
Bakay lived in Mayburak,
Urged his steed with one hundred elite soldiers.
Garmgirchy stationed in Jaylerma,
Whipped his steed forward and took one hundred soldiers.
Tirkechy lived on north side of the mountain,
Led one hundred soldiers and mounted his steed.
Shihay lived on south side of the mountain,
Mounted with one hundred guards following him.
Hero Chuwak in Karabura and Chatkaler,
Went on his journey with one hundred soldiers too.
Almanbet in Saritala,
Leaped on his steed and galloped with his one hundred soldiers.

Seven Khans swayed halters and urged steeds in a hurry,
Seven hundred attendants followed them tight.

Among numerous soldiers guarded the palace,
Forty warriors were well known in the world,
They neatly lined up,
Welcomed the coming of Khans in succession.

Placed these steeds head and intersected,
In Sart's special way,
Tied halters of the steeds tight:
"We cannot let steeds break loose and run away,
If we make the mounts run away,
That will be a great shame for us."

Baymart opened the door of the palace,
Welcomed these Khans in the palace.
Seven hundred attendants after them,
Came in the palace as well.

Highly disciplined forty warriors,
Also sat in the roomy palace.
Neat and quick young people,
Spread tablecloth in a blink of an eye.
Samawar bronze teapots with seven handles,
Boiled together at seventy different places.
A great variety of delicacies,
Were placed on the broad tablecloth.

Fried fruits had golden color,
Crystal sugar was shining like emerald,
Stir-fried meat and butter was attractive,
Honey in the jars had a pleasant smell.
Cream was added in Katma naan,
Delicious mare meat was fresh and tender.
Strong tea were carried out in crystal cups,
Fragrant milk tea gladdened people's heart.

As they finished eating and tablecloth was folded,
Young men carried water in silver pots for them to wash hands.

Tablecloth was spread again,
Appetizing "Naren"[1] was carried out.
Guests were all full,
Stretched their hands and prayed.

Khan Manas was in high spirits,
Ordered servants to open the door leaves in palace,
Guests walked out of the palace politely,
And stood on the capacious lawn in front of the palace.

In Manas' front yard,
There were two big phoenix trees,
Luxuriant leaves made a good shade,
Which could hold a thousand people.
Big issues were always discussed here in summer.

Two lines of seats placed under the shade,
Were made of wood and painted red,
In the upper center and on seven stairs,
The seat of Khan Manas was placed right in the middle.
Three on the right, four on the left,
Seven Khans sat there.

Golden seat with brocade silk,
Black mane wolf right sat in it.
Three seats on the right,
Were taken by uncle Bakay,
Lions Almanbet and Chuwak,
At the same time.
Four seats on the left,
Were taken by Jagurp, Shihay, Tirkechy,
And giant Garmgirchy.

① Naren: A special Kirgiz food had flour food in meat soup.

Red lacquer benches opposite the royal seat
Were seated by forty warriors in two lines.
Seven hundred attendants of seven Khans,
All sat on the ground.

Lion Manas spoke first,
Exposed his white teeth,
"Jagurp is my father,
Sage Bakay is my bosom friend,
Giant Garmgirchy is my uncle,
Tirkechy is of the same generation with them,
Khan Shihay is of my father's generation,
And is my friend as my life too;
Black mane wolf Chuwak,
Is my fellow grown up together with me,
Ketay prince Almanbet,
Is my brother forever,
Please listen carefully.
Many of our fellows captured by Karamark once,
Now they are still under Ketay's oppression and torment.
As Khan of Arashi,
How could I bear it if I do not rescue them.

"I am pricked by my conscience for years,
I cannot sleep at ease like I am on the thorns.
We build up energy and have sufficient strength now,
I decide to dispatch troops to revenge.

"I decide to go on a punitive expedition to Begin,
To wipe out those imperious enemies,
I will lead thousands of troops,
To defeat Kunwuer Bayi.
In order to avenge Arashi's blood debt,
To wipe out the enemy Kunwuer Bayi,
Rescue our suffered fellows.
Let's oppose enemies hand in hand,
Who will be my strong backbone?

Who is willing to go together with me?

"We share hardships together,
Who is willing to go to Kakan in the east?
Who is willing to fight against enemies with me?
I know all your past,
Drifted away, no place to stay,
Had humble position, reduced to slaves,
Between Andijan and Tashkent,
Pulled sleighs, turned into refugees.

"Since I, Manas mounted my battle steed,
You have never been humiliated,
Each of you throws poverty away and turns into rich man.
You had to drink Jarma① to allay your hunger in the past,
Now black tea and honey from Yarkant are daily food,
Do not eat lamb, only eat unweaned colt meat,
First class Hohan silk is on young people,
Old people now can enjoy precious mink coat.

"I pillowed snow to hoard livestock,
Make you live a happy life;
Now I will go on expedition to Kakan,
Please help me with plans.
I pillowed ice to collect wealth,
Make you throw poverty away;
Now I will launch an attack to Kangayi,
Please fully support my action.

"Elders here today,
You are my kinsfolk through hardships.
We could not protect our life and wealth in the past,
Suffered all kinds of torments.

"Under the oppression of Karamark,

① Jarma: A kind of thin soup Kirgiz people made from flour of highland barley and corn. It is the food for the poor to satisfy their hunger.

We became homeless and roamed about,
Karamark punished us at will,
Made us taste all bitterness in the world.
Pregnant woman's belly was cut open,
The haze of misery enveloped us.
Separated people of the same clan by force,
Made Kirgiz reduce to slaves.

"Swaggering Karamark people,
Bullied us as livestock.
We roamed about with no homes,
Drifted like clouds in the sky.
Though evil Arokai was expelled,
His son Kunwuer Bayi,
Now is still ferocious and savage.

"Altay and Andijan,
Are connected by Tianshan mountain and cannot be cut apart.
Though we have returned back our homeland,
From now and then,
They still plunder our livestock madly.

"They plunder not only we Arashi,
Ketay is also on their list.
Vast land descends to their territory,
Countless Ketay live a miserable life.

"For this imperious guy,
I must fight it out with him.
I decide to attack Arokai's son Kunwuer Bayi,
Khans and fellows, what are your opinions?

Manas gave a moving and fiery speech,
Khans lowered their heads without a sound.
White-beard elder kept silent,
Young men said nothing.
They stared speechless at each other for a good while,

Then left without saying goodbye.

Hero Manas looked around,
People had left with slow pace.
Only lions Almanbet, Chuwak,
And uncle Bakay still accompanied the hero,
Except forty warriors led by Kergel,
All others had already disappeared.

Seeing this Manas was burning with wrath,
His thick beard stood one by one,
His body shook as a gale blew,
Sleeves and coat edge swayed in the wind.
Flames spurted out of his eyes,
As scary as a hungry lion,
People were frightened out of their wits.

"Degrading Nuoyi people,
I do not want to look at you any more,
I will skin you,
And crush your home first,
Then go on my expedition!

"It seems I should not take pity on you,
What happened today depresses me very much!
Aji Bayi, saddle the steed right now,
Do not delay, seize every second!"

Lion Manas was angry beyond his control,
Elder Bakay began to speak.
He had wise and clever mind,
He was brave enough to take responsibility.

He could tell the right way at night,
Could have excellent plan in despair,
Could find the truth in argument.
He clenched Manas' hands,

Said reasonable words.

His silver beard swayed with wind,
His words were as sweet as honey:
"Oh, my friend, do not worry!
Please listen to me patiently.
With your protection,
Your people can live happily without sorrow.

"Once we fought side by side,
Took the city Kashgar,
Held our flag high and marched forward,
We captured the devil of Kashgar,
Cut the devil's head off.

"Forty warriors marched along shoulder to shoulder,
From the vast plain in Sariala,
From the upper reaches of Sarkoler river,
They chased bandits of Kunwuer Bayi.

"Did you find these people then?
Until we won the final victory.
We took Kunwuer Bayi's yaks,
Our horses gallop on that land freely.
Nuoyi people did not participate in the battle then,
These Begans were not in the battlefield then either.

"We blocked the road to Chelan,
Kunwuer Bayi and Georoy's one thousand camels with tea,
Were captured by us,
Went around the hills of Oboler,
To the broad Yurkenichy river,
Where were Nuoyi people then?

"We defeated powerful General Ayi,
Built the palace for Manas,
Then proposed a marriage,

For Akunhan's Ayichulek,
Where were Nuoyi people then?

"We launched attacks to Afghanistan,
Defeated numerous heroes,
Where were Nuoyi people then?

"Nuoyi people cannot go to Begin,
Cannot turn into reliable people;
Nuoyi people cannot go on expedition,
Cannot be our fellow travelers.

"Our people are frightened by Karamark,
They tremble with terror like frightened birds,
It is for our fellows and folks,
What do we complain?
If you insist on going on expedition,
I will give you more support."

Khan Bakay finished his words,
Then began to make comments on all heroes:
"On the plain of Atbash,
On the edge of Chechdoby,
Sage Koshaoyi built a city.
We need send him a letter,
Collect his troops first,
Then advance against Begin.

"In Erkechtam valley,
In Kebizto mountain,
On the edge of vast Kashgar,
Elaman's ninth son Toshtuk lived there.
We send a letter to Er Toshtuk,
Ask him to lead Kapchak's troops,
Like rocks rolling down the mountain,
Advance against Begin.

"Going further is Andijan city,
Holding the post of hundredor there,
Holding the post of thousandor in Margelan,
Is Senchybek with fork beard.
He holds the power of Namangan and Tashkent,
He is the Khan of vast Hohan for a long time.
We send a the news to Hohan,
Let Senchybek collect troops of Hohan,
To the imperious enemies,
Hold the flag up high.

"Continue going forward,
On the north side of Ketmandoby mountain,
The brave hero,
Kandir Bayi's son Kerkokuler is living there.
He became an orphan when he was little,
Being hardened in hardships,
He develops a firm and unyielding character.

"He has a steed of dirt color,
He is twenty five years old and of his prime age;
He is a giant suffered a lot,
He is eighteen Gez① tall.
His heart is even higher than his height,
He wants to be the commander of the world.
His eyes are like bright stars,
His words are as sweet as honey
We send a letter to Kerkokuler,
Let him collect Ketmandoby's troops,
Advance against Begin with us.

"Continue to the upper reaches,
The headman stationed Jetyoguz,
Is Kulitan's son giant Ageshi,
He has strong muscles,

① Gez: It is the length unit used by ancient Kirgiz. One Gez equals one meter.

Long journey cannot make him tired,
His will is as hard as iron,
He can be considered as a hero.
We will send an invitation to Ageshi,
Let him collect troops of Jettaguz,
Form a powerful troop to advance against Begin.

"Going forward from there,
It is fertile and vast Big Kemin,
Big black horses are tied all over prairie of Big Kemin;
While in Small Kemin,
Small black horses are tied all over its prairie.
Skins of black goats,
Are sewed to cloaks and put on;
That guy had a flat nose,
His offspring is Khan Yurbi.
Now he sits on the throne of Kokotoy,
The person administers Kazakh now is Khan Yurbi.
We will send a letter to Yurbi,
Let him call Kazakh troops,
Like the roaring river,
Clash Begin.

"Like the shining stars in the sky,
Budayk's son Muzburchak,
Has an armful beard,
We are on very intimate terms with each other.
He is of one heart with us,
He will go to Begin with us.
He had already made solemn promise,
We will send Muzburchak the letter,
Lots of Kazakh troops can be callled up,
Then fight against Kangayi."

Heard this, lion Manas said:
"My respected friend Khan Bakay,
Are you exhausted after the long journey?

Is your energy limited because of your old age?
If so many places need to be visited,
Who will be the hero to accomplish the mission? "

The lion just finished his words,
Aji Bayi stood up immediately,
To give his statement,
He said such words in haste:
"As long as you write letters in person,
Let me ride on the magical steed faster than clouds,
Even if I go to the ends of the earth,
I will go around four times without stop.
Even if with high mountains rough roads and thorns,
I will send messages to Khans.

"Khan, if you are in a hurry,
I will urge the steed day and night,
Not put up for the night at Ayinla,
Not stop at all,
I must return back within sixteen days.
Lion, if you are not in a hurry,
Within twenty days,
I must appear in your palace."

Eighty clerical staff stood on both sides,
Impatient hero Sirak,
Laid out the pens, ink, tables and chairs,
Asked them to sit by the tables.
Look at those splendid tables and chairs,
Carved on four sides, inlaid diamond in the center,
Gold was beset on corners,
Ink, pens and paper were put on the tables neatly.

Sirak wrote swiftly,
Elegant handwriting showed on paper.
All words were well-balanced in size,
With plump and skilled strokes.

He worried if the letter arrived at night,
Khans must read hurriedly.
For the convenience of reading,
The letter must be written clearly.

The letters were finished and dried in the sun,
Ayikoler's gold seal stamped at the lower part of the letter.
Folded all the letters,
Put in silk bags.
When mares were tied and milked,
First rays of the sun had showed in the east,
Aji Bayi walked out and went on his journey.

Well known Aji Bayi,
Held Khan's secret letter in his pocket,
Black whiskers were hard and thick,
Beaver pelt coat, mink hat,
Steed under him galloped its hooves,
The imposing appearance was even more prestigious than Khan,
He was not a nobody.

People all came up to him during his journey,
To greet and salute him,
He responded politely,
Explained his mission.
Hooves crushed hard rocks,
The steed galloped its hooves as flying.
For those soldiers waving a greeting to him,
He had no time to return a salute one by one,
He was in a big hurry.
Cared nothing but going forward,
Galloped with no stop at all,
Covered five hundred kilometers in a single day.

When the sun sank in the west,
He arrived at Kochykor valley.

That was the famous sacred place white cemetery,
In the near future,
Forty warriors would be buried here.

He went forward along the Karakoy valley,
He remembered he had never been here before.
He looked up to the night sky,
Stars were all moving toward the west.

Roared river waved high,
Brave Aji Bayi was not scared at all,
He swam across the river with his steed.
Tashlabat, Shilerk,
Were Gobi deserts even antelopes could not go through.

In the hot summer brains could be boiled,
The steed took heavy steps forward.
Aji Bayi panted heavily,
He had to lead the steed and walk.

Arrived at Atbarsh riverside,
Pulled the halter and had a rest.
Took off the bit,
Relieved the tiredness of the steed.
The long night passed slowly,
Rays of the sun came out from the clouds.

Aji Bayi raised his hand to shade his eyes from the sun,
Watched all directions carefully.
In the broad Kochybos forest,
The figure of a big guy showed in his eyes.

He mounted a mountain-size steed,
A vigorous eagle was held on his right arm,
With a folded halter in his hand,
A hunting dog followed him tight,
Behind him were streams of people.

This was right the hero Koshaoyi,
He was hunting in the forest excitedly.

Aji Bayi looked at the back of Koshaoyi,
He bridled his steed,
Leaped on the steed and swam across the river,
Urged the steed and chased as a bird.

At the distance of one arrow's range,
Aji Bayi drew his feet out of the stirrups,
Dismounted and came forward,
Bowed himself like a new daughter-in-law,
Expressed his admiration,
To sage Koshaoyi.

He saluted the elder modestly,
They kissed each other's fingers.
After they greeted and saluted each other,
Koshaoyi led them back to the city.

Soldiers guarded the city gate,
Came up and led their steeds and helped them dismount.
Koshaoyi and Aji Bayi stepped in the palace,
Attendants were eagerly attentive to lift the door curtain.

Gold-inlaid red sanders bed,
Was placed above the seat,
Its gold decorations were shining.
Cushion was made of silk floss,
Peak-size Khan Koshaoyi,
Was sitting on it steadily.

The thick cushion spread opposite him,
Had unique bright patterns,
Its soft hair was like green prairie.
The cushion changed its color all the time,
Made eyes confused.

Silver-tongued Aji Bayi,
Sat up on it.

Cooks were coming and going busily,
Carried hearty and delicious tea and food.
Horse neck fat, horse intestines,
And horse meat could not cut off by little knife,
Were filled full in the basin.

Honey was full in calabash,
Oil naan mixed with creme made people greedy;
Pure silver spoons shined,
Stir fried meat was delicious, milk tea was strong.
Diluent cheese was stirred together with butter,
In order to relieve the thirst and tiredness,
Beverage Boz① in big bowls was placed in the front.

They enjoyed delicious horse milk wine very much.
Host and guest stretched their hands to pray,
Servants folded the broad tablecloth.

Hospitable Khan Koshaoyi,
Asked Aji Bayi seriously:
"Aji Bayi, my child,
What business have you come here for at night?

"Day and night,
You put yourself out on the journey,
You go at night,
You suffer hardships;
You urge your steed fast with no stop,
Exhausted expression is hanging on your face.
Do you bring me a letter from Khan,
What order does the bloodsucker give out? "

① Boz: A traditional beverage among Kirgiz. It is fermented by the mixture of malt and flour of corn, highland barley and barley.

Served the Khan for many years,
Been familiar with all kinds of courtesy and rules in palace;
Gold-handled battleax was hanging in the waist,
Aji Bayi took the letter from lion Manas,
Out of the silk bag,
Held it in his hand reverently.

Koshaoyi opened the letter hurriedly,
Read the letter carefully.
He swayed his beard and showed a smiling face,
Then gave out such sincere admiration:

"Respectable Khan Manas,
He is shining as the moon.
Each of his words is reasonable and careful,
It is just what I ordered, it makes me happy.

"Karamark wear cotton-made felt boots,
Twine wide belts on their waists and black tassels fly on their heads,
Kunwuer Bayi now is their commander,
All Kangayi people are his servants.
Khan Chingeshi of Ketay,
Who lives in a fort with forty gates,
Is my enemy forever,
I cannot die in peace if I do not revenge.

"I will not shrink at all,
I must go on the expedition.
General Ayi's daughter Burulcha,
Aisanhan's daughter Birmiskaler,
It is said that they are matchless beauties.
Why do not we capture them,
Put them on horsebacks,
To enjoy our lives happily.

"My long beard has been white,
If I am not so old,

Your uncle Koshaoyi,
Is right at the age enjoying the life.
My hair has turned grey,
If I am not so old,
Your elder Koshaoyi,
Is right at the age of elegant bearing.

"Poplars cut down lie in river,
If I am shot by enemies,
For me, such a dim-sighted old man,
My child, where else can I find such a heroic death?
Poplars cut down lie across the river,
If I am poked by Kunwuer Bayi,
For your uncle Koshaoyi,
My child, where else can I find such a glorious death?

"I have enjoyed enough fresh and delicious lamb,
I am almost ninety years old;
I also have enjoyed enough fresh meat of ram,
My child, I have been an old man over eighty years old.
Even if they put me in a iron box and take good care,
I will still die when the time is coming.
Destiny finally will stretch its hand out,
How can I flee away from its tracking?

"My child, you have wide knowledge and experience,
Warrior, you have good source of information,
Have you ever heard Begin?
Tell me, how far is the journey if I go and come back?"

Aji Bayi was very happy,
He responded to Koshaoyi right away:
"I have heard Begin,
You need six months to go there
And half year to come back,
Totally it is a journey of one year,
It is just like this.

"You'd better arrive at Taras,
Within seven days to check in;
If you use more than seven days to get there,
Anxious Manas,
Must punish you severely."
After finishing all these words,
Aji Bayi said goodbye,
Supported his body up with his halter handle,
Stood up and stepped forward.

"Aji Bayi, my child,
Only Khuda can decide the matter of death.
Whether I can return safely,
Whether I can see my children and wife again,
Whether I can chat with fellows again,
Whether I can sit by the same tablecloth,
Whether I can have dinner with families and friends in one plate,
It is only Khuda knows clearly."

Aji Bayi responded to Koshaoyi:
"This is the most urgent order,
I need go and give letters to other Khans,
Khan gives me this very urgent mission,
I have arranged the returning time,
It was true and clear,
I have said all I need say,
We will have time in the future,
To sit down and chat.
If I cannot accomplish the mission on time,
Black mane wolf must punish me severely,
My innocent head will be chopped off."

Five towering peaks crossing,
Appeared in eyes of Aji Bayi;
The hill called Mazhayiler,
Lay across in front of Aji Bayi.
"If Khuda blesses me,

Let me climb over Mazhayiler."
Aji Bayi told himself,
Whipped his steed over Mazhayiler.

Crossed Arpa prairie,
Went through Toyun of plenty water and lush grass,
Passed beautiful Suyork grassland,
The brown steed under him was faster and faster,
Like an eagle shot across the sunny sky.
At the time the sun set,
He arrived at Erkechytam's basin,
Got to the border of Kanjuan.

This was Toshtuk's Ayinla,
Aji Bayi galloped to his gate.
Huge white palace,
Shined the light of prestige;
Ninety yurts neighbored it,
Surrounded it neatly.
Thirty attendants and forty guards,
Guarded on both sides of the gate.
The guards came up,
Helped the warrior off the steed;
Attendants led Aji Bayi,
Into Toshtuk's palace.

Toshtuk was like a towering mountain,
Sat on the thick cushion awe-inspiringly.
They greeted each other,
Kissed each other's fingertips.
Expressed great concerns for each other,
Gave ground to each other for sitting;
It did not show respect to call name directly,
They used the word "You" often.

They sat shoulder to shoulder,
Cooks spread food over the table in a moment.

Enjoyed the food and strong tea happily,
Sixty kinds of food were all tasted,
Prayed after the dessert,
Folded tablecloth and stretched body.
"Let Aji Bayi from afar,
Have a good rest to relieve his tiredness."
Having visited numerous times,
He knew the place very well.

Aji Bayi dipped his hand in the bag calmly,
Took out the huge letter from Khan Manas,
Aji Bayi tore the silk envelope,
Handed the letter over to Toshtuk.

Toshtuk leaned and took the letter,
Read the letter carefully word to word.
He was filled with fury suddenly,
Gave vent to his hatred toward Kunwuer Bayi.

"Since man is deliberately designed to be mortal,
Why do we stay at home to wait for its coming?
As long as we urge our steeds forward,
We will see endless sceneries.
Let us mount our steeds,
Go to the distant journey.

"Karamark and Ketay people,
Niskara and Kunwuer Bayi,
Ketay giant Georoy,
Committed monstrous crimes against Kirgiz.
They harassed from time to time,
Bullied recklessly.

"Ayikoler Manas made a brilliant decision,
His words are all reasonable,
He is a Khan able to see future,
We must strongly support him.

"You are a boy of good source of information,
You are a hero of wide knowledge and experience,
Please tell me right now,
Have you ever heard of Begin?
How long does it need to go and come back?
When can we step on our journey? "

"I have heard of Begin,
You need six months to go there,
And half year to come back,
Totally it is a journey of one year,
It is just like this.

"Hero Manas stations in Taras,
Set you a seven-day limit for you to go to him;
If you delay to the eighth day,
Disaster will descend on you."
Aji Bayi did not stay any more,
Said goodbye and went on the journey again.

Toshtuk went up,
Tried his best to persuade Aji Bayi:
"My lovely child Aji Bayi,
Can you stay one night here?
Who knows the life and death?
Who can judge the fortune from misfortune?
Part with wife and children,
Part with fellows and brothers for ever,
Who knows the time of meeting again? "

Aji Bayi continued the talk after hearing this,
Expressed himself politely:
"I am sent by our brilliant Khan,
Go day and night with no stop,
I will send Khans like you,
The letter from Khan Manas.
If I put up for the night everywhere,

Play freely everywhere,
I must miss the set time;
I do not want to cause myself any trouble,
Do not want to regret the whole life.

"The sun and the moon alternate,
No matter it is one week or one month,
Since I cannot return on time,
My apple-like head will be in danger."
Aji Bayi rode on his steed and went out of the village,
Urged his steed toward Simuhana.

Aji Bayi had never been to such a place,
He tried to recall what he heard about it once again.
"Go through Erkechtam,
That is a path I can turn round."
He thought for a long time to confirm the direction,
Then he marched forward toward Kokarit mountain.

On high Karakum mountain antelope could not climb over,
He dismounted and walked carefully.
He was worried the steed would fall off cliff,
So rolled his coat edge and tied it on waist.
Burum battle robe had been torn up,
Thick soles of his battle boots had been worn through.
He led the steed carefully,
Climbed over the mountain under the cover of night.
He got hillside when it was dawn,
Tail of the steed had been tied up.

Till the evening,
Night was going to come,
Travel-stained Aji Bayi,
Arrived at Kulizhani forest finally.

Here was the paradise of farmers,
Many kinds of fruits were flourishing and lush;

A family even had only one goat,
They still could live a prosperous and happy life.

Fruits of cornflowers and strawberries were big,
Raspberry and red rose had sweet fruits and fragrant smell,
Lamb-ear grass and mare-breast flowers,
Morning glory and Kemzidik grass,
Five-flavored herb and wild lily had flourishing leaves and stems.
Wild rose and wild berry,
Wild garlic and wild strawberry,
Tulip and Chinese rhubarb spread all over the hill.

Like decorating by god,
It was colorful and made eyes confused.
A spring stream gurgled forward,
Oil was floating on water,
It was the place black oil spurted,
It was the place suitable for sheep to roam and colts to play,
People lived a happy and peaceful life there.

The warrior enjoyed the exotic scenery,
He felt excited and comfortable.
Urged his steed down the hill fast,
Brown steed was short of breath.

When the dusk was approaching,
Aji Bayi got to the gate of Big Hohan's city.
The brown steed's hooves stopped,
Made noise, and whinnied.
The galloping steed made passers-by dumbfound,
They dare not speak but watch silently.
The streets got into a panic,
People did not dare to go out of the door.

Aji Bayi went straight into,
To Khan's palace.
Forty guards on both sides of the palace gate,

Came up and took the halter in his hand over.

Led him into the magnificent palace,
Welcomed him into the bright living room.
Butchered fat colts,
Took hearty food out,
Carried mellow wine out,
Aji Bayi enjoyed himself to the full.
Then he was led to a plush felt yurt,
Soft bedding and mattress were very comfortable,
The fatigued messenger,
Fell into his sweet dreams immediately.
Attendants untied the brown steed's halter,
Put the hay in the manger.

When the sun rose the second morning,
Aji Bayi opened his eyes.
He washed his face and hands and tied the belt,
Put on his battle robe and hung his sabre,
When the sunlight flooded the earth,
He stepped in Senchybek's palace.

Senchybek raised his head proudly,
Sat on his purpose-made gold throne;
He bared his head and feet,
As prestigious as a mountain.
Aji Bayi bowed ahead and saluted,
They greeted each other.
Senchybek stepped down to welcome him in person,
Let him sit beside the throne.

Cooks were going and coming busily,
Took out different food and drink,
Carried out all kinds of delicacies,
Strong tea was placed on tablecloth,
Mellow grape wine was in front of the hero.

After he was perfectly satisfied with food,
Tablecloth was folded away.
Senchybek began to speak:
"My child, Aji Bayi,
You do not dismount day and night,
Your mount has been exhausted,
You are so fatigued that your face is like wax,
Does Khan Manas have an urgent letter to me?"

Aji Bayi took off his gold-handled crescent ax,
Got the letter out from the silk bag under the ax,
Presented the letter to Senchybek with both hands.
Senchybek opened the letter right away,
Read the letter word by word.
He bit his fingers,
And sat there silently.

Aji Bayi looked at his expression,
Worried and doubted:
"Whether you go or not,
Why do you keep quiet?
You bite your fingers and weigh your steps,
Have you forgotten the majesty of a Khan?

"Manas came here not long ago,
Collected carriages' gold and silver,
Have you already forgotten,
The moment of collecting donation and tax?
I will report to the lion,
What you have done today."
Aji Bayi was going to stand up after his words.

Terrified Khan Senchybek of Hohan,
Jumped up from his throne,
Held Aji Bayi's shoulders with both hands,
Asked the hero:
"You are a boy of good source of information,

You are a hero of wide knowledge and experience,
Have you ever heard of Begin?
How many days do I need to go there? "

"I have heard of Begin,
You need six months to go there,
And half year to come back,
Totally it is a journey of one year,
It is just like this.

"You need arrive at Taras within seven days,
To sign up to Manas;
If you cannot show up in seven days,
When the eighth-day sun rises,
You have no place to flee,
Away from eagle Manas' severe punishment."

Aji Bayi finished his words,
Asked to bring his steed from the manger,
Leaped on the steed and left Hohan,
Waded across Karasu river and advanced forward.

Aji Bayi urged the brown steed,
Rose sky-high dust all the way,
He whipped and spurred the steed at top speed,
Dashed toward Ketmandoby.
When the sun was going to set,
Aji Bayi went into forest of Ketmandoby.

A cliff lay across in the front,
About ninety people were on the cliff top.
One hero was like a divine soldier from heaven,
Spurrd his horse out the crowd.

His mount was a steed of dirt cliff color,
He wore white cloak,
Eyes were as shining as stars,

His words were as sweet as honey.
His age was between twenty five and thirty;
His ten-span-tall figure made people nervous.

That man was as agile as a bird,
Came up fast to salute and greet.
They stretched palms and held together tight,
Kissed each other's fingertips.
He spoke to Aji Bayi like this:
"You come here after long hard journey,
Look, how tired your steed is now,
Are you hero Aji Bayi?"

Kerkokuler had never seen Aji Bayi before,
But had heard his illustrious name for a long time,
Now they were like well acquainted with each other,
Asked Aji Bayi with a good grace.

Went to visit Khans many times,
He felt quite used to such occasions,
Khan's messenger Aji Bayi,
Did not respond to the questions.
He took out the silk bag from his pocket,
Handed it to Khan with both hands.

Kerkokuler opened the letter,
Gave his whole mind to the letter.
Under the light of the sunset glow,
It was like in the daytime,
He finished reading the letter.

After hero Kerkokuler read the letter,
He was very satisfied and said:
"Respected messenger Aji Bayi,
You have been exhausted, please rest for a while."
He said and stretched out his hand,
Held the halter of Aji Bayi's mount in the hand.

Aji Bayi responded immediately:
"Hero Manas stations in Taras,
I set the exact time line with him.
If I pass the time line,
I will have no good life any more.
I still have mission to invite other Khans,
Do not have time to stay long here."
"If this is the case, my Ajikai①,
You are a man of good source of information,
You are a hero of wide knowledge and experience,
Have you ever heard of Begin?
How many days do I need to get there?
When can we come back home?
Please explain to me in details."

"I really have heard of Begin,
You need six months to go there,
And half year to come back,
Totally it is a journey of one year,
This is the information I know.

"You need go to Khan of Taras,
Within seven days;
If you arrive at the eighth day,
Khan Manas must blame and punish you."

Aji Bayi finished his words and said goodbye,
Turned his steed round and galloped forward.

From Yizbez plain,
Aji Bayi whipped and spurred the steed,
Galloped toward Kutba in northwest,
He did not spare his steed at all,
Galloped day and night.
Energetic brown steed,

① Ajikai: The nickname of Aji Bayi.

Galloped its hooves without knowing tiredness.
It clenched the bit,
Like heavenly steed soared across the sky.

When the early sun bathed the mountain in light,
He arrived at Kezler Moynok col of Jitu.
A barley field was in the front,
Lush grass grew on both sides of the road.
Aji Bayi was going to let the steed eat grass,
Six carriages with hay appeared suddenly,
Drivers swayed the whip leisurely.

Six drivers saw the majesty of Aji Bayi,
They were terrified and did not know what to do.
Aji Bayi borrowed one cart of hay,
Took off the bit from steed's mouth,
Let the brown steed eat full,
The whole cart of hay,
Was eaten up by the brown steed soon.
He got to the river to water the steed.
He took out a shining gold coin,
Brought it to the driver.

The master of grass carriage was frightened,
Looked at the gold coin but dare not came up:
"Oh, the young hero,
Please give me the suitable price.
One gold coin can buy a carriage,
But you only take the grass on the carriage,
I cannot make money from you.
I am an honest man,
What can I do with the extra money?"

Aji Bayi put the coin in the youth's hand,
Turned round and mounted his steed.
Along the smooth road,
The steed galloped forward.

Climbed over Yuzuk hill,
Went around Korpo mountain,
Along Chaterkoler lake,
Galloped through Aksay prairie,
Went through Koburkan rock bank.
Climbed over Kelintaygak hill,
Went around Talakay mountain,
Went across Janajer grassland,
Grass here was waist-high,
The green was boundless.
At the time of dusk,
Aji Bayi arrived at Jetyoguz prairie.

Hero Ageshi had gone to sleep,
Young attendant helped Aji Bayi dismounted,
Led the fatigued guest,
To a yurt to rest.
Hospitable host butchered mares of empty embryo,
Carried horse milk for guest;
Took out big bowl of barley wine,
Let exhausted Aji Bayi,
Lie down and rest quietly.

The night disappeared slowly,
Libra stars faded away gradually,
Larks chirped ceaselessly.
The morning breeze blew gently,
Stars in the sky,
Faded to the west gradually.

When the east showed a light like eyebrow,
Aji Bayi got up immediately.
He asked to bring his steed,
Let the steed eat grass on the broad meadow;
He ordered a young man lead the steed,
And take care of his mount;
Reminded the young man to be careful,

The steed might flee away toward Susamur.
Celestial Aji Bayi got dressed and washed his face,
Walked into Ageshi's palace in a heroic bearing.

Giant hero Ageshi,
Sat in his golden throne.
His favorite concubine,
Was Kokotoy's daughter Kokmencho,
She snuggled up close to Ageshi,
Helped Khan put on his coat slowly.
Cooks around carried prepared tea and cakes,
They tasted happily and leisurely.
After they prayed,
They received the messenger.

Giant Ageshi thought for a moment,
Asked Aji Bayi seriously:
"You come from afar and busy with traveling,
Your straw-colored wan face,
Has suffered a lot,
It seems you are exhausted.
Does lion Manas have a letter to me?
Do you bring his news here?"

Aji Bayi untied his belt and took out the letter,
Handed it over reverently.
Ageshi took the letter,
Read rapidly.
He felt his blood was boiling and talked excitedly:
"Kara Ketay and Karamark people,
Kunwuer Bayi is their Khan;
All people in Kakan,
Consider him as a disaster.
It is better to fight him out in battlefield,
Rather than hide from place to place like this!

"Kanderbye with cotton-padded boots on his feet,

And ferocious Kunwuer Bayi,
They come and disturb us every year,
Make us have no peaceful life at all.

"It is better to die in the battlefield,
Rather than be humiliated and slaved,
Khan Qingeshi of Karamark,
Lives in the city with forty iron gates.
He is well known for his incredible skills,
No one dare touch even one of his branches.

"Under the support of Khan Qingeshi,
Under the harbor of Aisanhan,
Arokai's son Kunwuer bayi,
Runs wildly and commits all kinds of crimes.

"I have heard from a lot of people,
He plundered innocent people in Kapaler.
There is more hearsay about him,
Different sad news comes into my ears continually.

"A damned devil like him,
How cannot we go on a punitive expedition?
The deep hatred of our ancestors,
What is the time we are waiting to revenge if it is not now?

"It is a coward who stays at home to escape death,
Who can escape the destiny of death?
What Manas said is reasonable.
Respectable hero Manas,
We will step on stirrups right away,
To wipe out all our enemies.

"Give your life when destined age is coming,
We will defeat hardships and dangers together.
Please, when do we start off to Taras?
How far is it from there to Begin?"

"I have only heard of Begin,
You need six months to go there,
And half year to come back,
Totally it is a journey of one year,
It is just like this.

"Khans lives in Taras,
Orders you to meet him there within seven days,
If you cannot get there within seven days,
Black mane wolf will blame and punish you mercilessly."

Aji Bayi said goodbye,
Asked to bring his steed,
And saddle it,
Mounted and left Ayinla,
Went forward around the lake as an arrow.

The brown steed galloped in Kizilsu,
Red-nose Aji Bayi was like a bird.
He went forward along the north side of Jargelchak,
Running like a male camel.
His silk barrel robe,
Shined under the sunshine.
The steed was shod again,
Sparks splashed in valley.

Passed Yeshaata and Chokutaler,
Passed Ekoruk and Gurmant,
No matter it was going up the hill or down the hill,
The brown steeds galloped as flying dust all the time.
Khan's messenger spared no effort,
Crossed Kemin basin day and night.
The fertile land Yisek lake,
Was a place Aji Bayi had not seen before.

Here was the territory of Kazakh,
Narrow-minded Khan Yurbi,

Malicious Khan Yurbi,
Lived on this beautiful and fertile prairie.
He got up in the morning like a bird,
Held the telescope in ebullient mood,
Stood on a hill and watched around.
He turned the telescope ceaselessly,
Suddenly Aji Bayi appeared in his eyes.

He turned round and back to Ayinla in a hurry,
Shouted to his people:
"Humble Aji Bayi is coming,
All families close doors and windows,
Just turn a blind eye to him,
No one is allowed to hold his halter.
Loose your dogs,
Let dogs give him a lesson!"

Yurbi drank horse milk and ate cakes,
Made bedding comfortably thick,
Put his head on high pillow,
Turned side to stretch himself.

When rosy clouds reddened the east,
Mares to be milked stood in front of the yurt,
Aji Bayi went into the village.
It was a village of ninety households,
All yurts neighbored each other densely.
Suddenly ninety vicious dogs dashed out,
Surrounded the brown steed and barked.

Vicious dogs blocked the way,
Barked and leaped up to the steed.
No one came to welcome Aji Bayi,
No one came to stop the vicious dogs either.
Aji Bayi was angered beyond all control,
The long whip swayed over his head.
He turned his steed suddenly,

Toward the coming dogs,
Slashed with full energy.

A vicious one of black donkey size dog,
Was whipped by him severely,
Before he drew the whip back,
The black dog died.
Hero's long whip carried sound of wind,
Slashed numerous dogs down,
The rest dogs all scattered,
Hid aside with tail between its legs.

Aji Bayi rode on the brown steed,
Approached one big and tall yurt.
No one came to open the door and welcome him,
No one helped him hold the halter,
He had to dismount by himself,
Tied the steed on the post in person.

Aji Bayi pushed the door and looked inside,
On the white silk valance,
Khan Yurbi lay on it,
Stretched his dropping body,
With his eyes half-closed,
Lay in his bedding.

Jezbilek from Jerkan sat in front of the curtain,
She raised her nose high arrogantly,
Did not look at Aji Bayi at all,
Did not say any greeting word either,
Completely ignored Aji Bayi,
She was even more cunning than her husband.

Aji Bayi walked directly into the yurt,
Came to the velvet cushion,
Calm and unhurried,
Sat with his legs crossed.

He waited from morning till the sun went west,
Aji Bayi considered and weighed in his heart,
He took out his brass pipe,
Filled with prime tobacco from Andijan,
Lit a piece of pyrophoric cotton,
With Ketay flint,
Put sheep liver-size fire on the pipe.

He exerted himself to a deep suckinhale,
The smoke he exhaled filled the whole yurt,
Dark smoke ran out of the skylight.

"Whether Khan's yurt is on fire!"
Neighbors all shouted with surprise.

Yurbi was irritated with the smoke,
He raised his head from the bed,
Pretended he saw Aji Bayi suddenly.
His tone of speaking was biting and odd,
Questioned Aji Bayi in loud voice:
"You, the talkative lackey,
What bad news do you bring to me?
You such an opportunistic flunky,
There must be disaster when you come.

"Do I need to avenge on you,
Should I gouge your eyes out?
Do I skin you,
Send you to death to suffer?
Do I tie your arms and legs,
Expose you publicly?
Do I cut your head open,
Pour thick salt water in it?
Do I nail iron nails on the sole of your feet,
Make you suffer all kinds of hardships?
Let you remember the pain all the time.

"On Kokotoy's ceremony,
In that great meeting,
Who made my crown down?
Who made me lose face?
When my face was whipped with leather lash,
I was completely discredited and had no place to hide.
I have never seen a giant like Manas,
I have never seen a flunky like you either."
Yurbi gave vent to a torrent of abuse,
Grasped a sword with no sheath in hand.

Hero Aji Bayi had traveled all over the world,
He never saw such a flunky.
If he did not carry a sacred mission of Khan,
He had already drawn his sword out.
Aji Bayi looked perfectly calm,
Held Khan's letter over his head in both hands.
He got down on his knees,
Lowered his head and kept silent.

After the time of one meal,
Yurbi took the letter from Khan,
Then threw the letter aside with contempt.
After the time of another meal,
He picked the letter and opened it.
Aji Bayi's knees hurt a lot,
His waist was tired and sweat ran down his cheeks.
For the sacred career of Arashi people,
He could bear any kind of misery and humiliation.

Hero Sirak wrote the letter,
Uncle Bakay gave advice,
The content of the letter was clear and concise:
"Anger between brothers were only in mouth,
It could not be remembered in the heart.
Two straps twisted into one halter,
You should be fair.

Fourteen Khans will all go on expedition,
How you will deal with this.

"If we are lucky enough,
We can take Begin easily,
It is possible for you to sit on Khan's throne."

Yurbi was lost in thought after reading the letter,
He felt shamed with his beard shaking:
"Oh, dear Aji Bayi,
It is not a normal matter;
Fourteen Khans will go on expedition together,
How I can stay!

"What hero Manas said is reasonable,
Conflict between fellows and families,
Is only trivial matter,
How it can be in the heart forever.

"You are a boy of good source of information,
You are a hero of wide knowledge and experience,
Have you ever heard of Begin?
How many days do I need to get there?
Please tell me, Khan's messenger,
When can we set out on the return journey?"

Aji Bayi continued the talk immediately:
"I have heard of Begin,
You need six months to go there,
And half year to come back,
Totally it is a journey of one year,
This is the information of the journey.

"You need arrive at Taras within seven days,
If you cannot get within seven days,
You will miss the meeting there,
You will know what is the result for you."

Aji Bayi stopped here,
Turned away with an angry expression.
Did not eat one piece of naan and one mouth of tea,
Leaped on the brown steed and galloped forward.
Loess like smoke blew out from bellow,
Covered the sky.

The brown steed,
Galloped like an antelope outstretched its legs,
Leaped over creeks and cliff like flying sparrow eagle.
At the time people did evening praying,
He arrived at the forest outside Alma-Ata.

Khan Budayk's son Muzburchak,
Was playing with dogs and eagles in the forest excitedly,
Three hundred attendants followed him,
The long line weaved in the forest.
Agile hero Muzburchak,
Saw Khan's messenger at his first glance.
Seeing Aji Bayi's heroic figure,
Muzburchak went up to welcome warmly.

They greeted each other,
Showed great concern to each other enthusiastically:
"Aji Bayi, my boy,
Please explain the matter to me now.

"You choose a fine steed,
High quality battle robe stains dust,
Did not dismount day and night,
Are you taking Khan's letter to me?
Is there a letter from black mane wolf?
Please explain immediately!"

Served Khan Manas in palace,
Dealt with all kinds of noble occasions,
Loyal Aji Bayi,

Took out the letter from his pocket,
Carried with both hands to Muzburchak.
Muzburchak opened the letter in a hurry,
He said excitedly after he read the letter:

"Khan Manas is of great talent and bold vision,
His proposal right suits me.
To go on a punitive expedition against ferocious Kunwuer Bayi,
I am ready to mount and lead my soldiers to go.
He is so unscrupulous,
That goes even further in bullying Kazakh and Kirgiz.
A few days ago,
He sent some attendants to plunder Kapaler prairie.
I am planning to go to Khan,
Report him the crime Karamark committed.

"You are a warrior of good source of information,
You are a messenger of wide knowledge and experience,
Have you ever heard of Begin?
How many days do I need to go there,
When can we go on our return journey?"

"I have heard of Begin,
You need six months to go there,
And half year to come back,
Totally it is a journey of one year,
This is the information of the journey.

"You must get to Taras,
Within seven days,
If you cannot get there on time,
Lion Manas will not be happy."

Aji Bayi turned round to lead his steed,
He was going to leave hurriedly.
Muzburchak persuaded him to stay again and again,
He said some moving words:

"My child Aji Bayi,
Please go to my house and stay one night,
To visit us and leave tomorrow morning.
Only Khuda knows everything,
Whether we can return safely,
Whether we can reunite with our wives and children.
Whether we can enjoy the food on one tablecloth,
Whether we can taste the delicacy in one plate."

Aji Bayi continued the talk:
"My respectable Khan Muzburchak,
I understand very well.
But I have an urgent mission,
And time is really limited.
If I cannot complete the mission on time,
It will cause endless misery to me,
Since there is an appointment,
I cannot stay long here."

He finished his words and said goodbye,
Mounted the steed and started off right away.
The brown steed galloped its hooves,
Rose clouds of dust behind them.

Aji Bayi calculated the days by himself,
Sixteen days had passed.
When the midnight just passed,
Aji Bayi returned back to Taras palace.

Karahan's daughter Kanikai,
Khan Manas' good wife,
She tossed and turned restlessly all night,
Planned the sacred expedition for Khan by herself.
The sound of hooves came into her ears,
Kanikai put on her clothes and stepped out.
Aji Bayi tied his steed well and turned round,
Met madam Kanikai face to face.

Hospitable Kanikai lifted the door curtain,
Invited the hero in and sat in the honorable seat,
Carried horse intestines and horse stomach,
Fresh and tender lamb tail fat,
Fragrant horse milk,
Let the hero enjoy the food.

After the hero ate full,
Kanikai asked:
"My respectable messenger Aji Bayi,
I am asking for the details,
Which Khans are willing to go on expedition,
Which Khans are not willing to,
Please do not hide,
Tell me now."

Aji Bayi reported in details:
"Khan's letters were in my hands,
I went to deliver them in person,
Who can disobey the lion's order?
Even if some Khans went through the motions,
How Aji Bayi could let them succeed!

"I give them seven days limit,
Order them to gather in Taras.
Please tell majestic Khan,
His servant completes the mission."

Aji Bayi explained in simple words,
Then left Khan's palace hurriedly.
Nazhar's daughter Wurumhan,
She was Aji Bayi's capable wife,
She knew Aji Bayi's heroic spirit,
She was convinced that he could come back on time.

As soon as Aji Bayi entered the door,
She held a wood bowl with full of water in her hand,

Moved it round three times over Aji Bayi's head,
Then poured the water,
To disperse the evil influence he got on his journey.
Then held her husband arm,
Walked into the room with sweet words.

Let us put this aside,
Talk about how the Khans from afar,
Come to meet Manas.
Please listen carefully,
How Bakay was chosen to be the general.

Bakay Was Chosen to be the General

The morning star faded away quietly,
First rays of the morning sun showed up;
A new day had come,
Golden light shined all over the world.

Hero lion Manas,
Blinked his sleepy eyes,
Got up and twisted his waist,
Strolled out of the palace to relieve himself.

A sound of horse neigh pierced the dawn,
And entered his ears,
He turned round and watched,
Aji Bayi's brown steed,
Was tied on the post and neighed.

"Aji Bayi has returned,
His mount has not gone to eat grass,
Does it get good rest?"
Manas came to the brown steed,
Loosed the tied halter.

Hero Manas unsaddled the steed,
Together with the bridle.
The steed had relieved fatigue,
It did not lower the head to eat grass,
But lifted its tail up high in the sky,
Frisked around and whinnied.

It was a six-day journey away from the horses in the mountain,
The brown steed galloped at top speed,
When the sun shined on the mountaintop,
It had run into the big flock of horses.
The magical steeds in ancient time,
Truly had such ability.

"Aji Bayi's mount,
Was taken care by Manas in person."
The story came down the ages among Kirgiz.
Hero Manas was as common as an old shoe,
Who could blame him with no emotion!

Right at this moment,
The news of Aji Bayi's returning spread over Ayinla;
People came in succession to ask,
The white yurt was thronged with people.

When the bright sun shined in the yurt,
Aji Bayi got up hurriedly.
Two empty sleeves swayed with wind,
He put on his cloak quickly,
Walked into lion Manas' palace gracefully.

All elders and Khans had gathered there,
When Aji Bayi entered the door,
Forty warriors stood up to show their respect,
They let Aji Bayi sit on the honorable seat,
To show their lofty respect.

When everyone took a seat,
Attendants spread big white tablecloth,
Put all delicacies on.
After everyone got full,
Tablecloth was folded.
Manas asked Aji Bayi excitedly:
"Aji Bayi, my brave messenger,

Is everything as you wish on this long journey?
What the situation is of these Khans,
Do not hide and report me the details."

Silver-tongued Aji Bayi,
His words flowed out as beads:
"My respected Khan Manas,
You gave the letters to me to deliver,
I rode on the magical steed faster than clouds,
Galloped to seven Khans at top speed.

"Held Khan's decree in hand,
Conveyed Khan's order,
No Khan dare say he does not want to go,
How can I allow them to act casually?
I decided all by myself of a seven-day deadline,
This is my fault,
Khan, please do not blame your messenger."

After heard the report of Aji Bayi,
Manas gave out another order to him:
"My messenger Aji Bayi,
I am very satisfied with what you have done.

"Please ride on the fine steed and start off,
To urge six tribes' Kara Nuoyi,
And Eterk, Noyigut tribes,
Ask them to gather quickly with no delay.
Tell them they cannot come with empty hands,
Ask them to choose fat sheep and horses,
Food for troops of seven Khans from afar,
Should be arranged and provided by them."

Heard the order of Khan Manas,
Aji Bayi opened his eyes wide,
Asked servant to lead him magical steed Ayimanboz,
Saddled it and urged it to the journey.

Aji Bayi was not tired at all,
He looked energetic,
He went forward along Kangkoler valley,
Those rich people who found excuse to refuse,
Were all punished by him mercilessly.

In order to show riches and honor,
Put brass bells on ram,
A few rich men cold-shouldered deliberately,
Were lashed severely and bleeding all over.
In order to show respect,
Put silver bells on ram,
A few rich men were too arrogant,
They were lashed by Aji Bayi and fled in panic.
Some stubborn men disobeyed his order,
Were trapped in the field by him.

People under Jagurp's administration,
Were arranged in Jaktash;
Subjects of Bakay,
Were arranged in Mayburak.

He arranged Garmgirchy's people,
In Jayilerma;
Attendants of Tirkechy,
To pitch camps on Tiskey hill slope.

He arranged Shihay's troops,
In Artu;
Chuwak's people,
With pure white yurts,
In Karaburachat.

Attendants of Almanbet,
Stationed troops in Saritala prairie of Jergay,
Khans pitched their own camps respectively,
Nuoyi people all made good preparations,

To welcome seven Khans' coming.

Do not want to mention more,
How many gentlemen came loftily;
Wore cloaks and Chapan,
How many young men were of valiant bearing.

As attractive as peacocks,
Beautiful girls walked leisurely;
Short fine hair just came out around mouth,
Pretty young boys were full of confidence.

Good mares were better than steeds,
Good daughters-in-law were better than daughters;
Splendid yurts were countless in number,
Celebrating activities of wide variety gladdened everyone.

Tomorrow was the deadline for Khans to come,
People were all waiting for them.
From hills of Susamur,
Clouds of dust rose up to sky.
Hot air rose as towers,
White flags waved with wind,
Like rolled white clouds.

People walked up to watch carefully,
Hohan people still in a state of shock,
Rode on high steeds,
Blue battle boots stepped steadily on stirrups,
Galloped forward on the main road in a hurry.

Senchybek with great beard,
Led sixty-line soldiers to come first.
Counted number, registered,
They were arranged in Shihay's villages.

Each household received three guests,

You could imagine how many yurts were put up.
Other Khans' troops had not showed up yet,
Tired people took the chance to take a nap.

Wise uncle Bakay,
Lion Chuwak and Almanbet,
Were like spears stood straight.
Brave hero Sirak,
Also made good preparation.

When people were busy with everything,
From the hill of Burina,
Below the clouds in the sky,
Clouds of dust rose up high.
Battle flag of many colors,
Waved high with wind.
Like sheep all over mountains bleated together,
Great noise was deafening.

Looked ahead,
It seemed unstoppable in the front.
Elamen's son Eir Toshtuk,
Led seventy lines of soldiers,
Iron hooves stepped on the ground,
Marched ahead along the main road.
People went up to welcome heroes,
Arranged Eir Toshtuk's troops,
In Garmgirchy's villages.

After counting the number of the troops,
And registering clearly,
One household took care of three guests,
Look how many yurts there were.
People rushed to the fore,
To receive guests.

On the hill of Tojaylo,

Sky-high dust rose up again.
Uncle Bakay panted heavily for breath,
Almanbet and Chuwak rushed in action,
Lion Sirak was all smiles,
They went to meet the coming troops.

Kandier Bayi's son Kerkokuler,
Just formed a troop,
He was full of confidence.
Never showed mercy on invading enemies.
He was right in his prime age,
Tall and sturdy and very strong,
He led twenty five lines of troops,
It was in massive streaming.

Counted number, registered,
Then the troops went into Tirkechy's village,
Every household received three guests.

In the blink of an eye,
At the side of Eshlermay beach,
Deafening sound of trumpet came,
Clouds of dust covered the sky.
Wise uncle Bakay, Almanbet,
Chuwak and lion Sirak,
Went up hurriedly to welcome.

Kulitan's son hero Ageshi,
Led his troops and galloped fast.
He had ninety one lines of troops,
He was with too many attendants crowding round.

Counted number, registered,
They were arranged in Chuwak's village.

From Tarasha hill of Totnish,
Massive columns people appeared.

Battle flags waved with wind,
Deafening horns sounded.
Golden arrows shined,
Strong mounts galloped their hooves.

Roaring shouting shook mountains,
Clouds of dust covered the sky.
Kazakh Khan Yurbi,
Led his streaming columns of troops and came,
Totally seventy five lines of troops.

Counted number, registered,
In order to let his anger lapse,
Arranged him into Jagurp's village.

Just made Yurbi's troops arranged,
On Karatao mountain top of Kapuka,
Sky-high dust rose up again.
Almanbet and Hero Chuwak,
Tiger-like hero Sirak,
Led by uncle Bakay,
Mounted and went to welcome.

Khan Budayk's son Muzburchak,
Had an armful long beard,
His golden arrows shined.
He led eighty four lines of troops
Went into the village in majesty.

Registered, counted number,
Venerable hero Bakay,
Saw his old friend coming,
Urged his black horse,
Arranged them in his village in person.

The sun sank in the west, the night turned deep,
Koshaoyi and his troops still did not show up.

When people were discussing about this,
Khan Shaoruk's daughter Nakelai thought:
"On Kokotoy's ceremony,
Koshaoyi's blessing to Kanikai was so accurate,
She gave birth to the son Semtaiy.
Giant Koshaoyi is a real sage,
Why he did not show up till now.

"I will go to Orolermo mountain,
Welcome him at the place he must pass,
I will ask servants to butcher mares and prepare,
Wait for the coming of uncle Koshaoyi,
Invite him to my home,
Let him bless me to have a boy."

Nakelai ordered to take down her yurt,
Folded everything on her yurt,
Asked servants put bags on camels,
Moved out of the village under the cover of night.

Clever madam Kanikai,
Had already known Nakelai's intention.
She would discuss what she thought with heroes.
Wise elder Bakay,
Two lions Almanbet and Chuwak,
Hero wolf Sirak,
Gathered in the study and discussed the matter of second day,
Madam Kanikai came in a hurry.

Kanikai said such words:
"Bakay, my Ayasi,
Heroes, you are all here,
I have something to tell you all,
Please listen carefully.
I heard from some ladies,
Nakelai has started off hurriedly on her journey,
She is going to wait Koshaoyi in his way.

"Once I predicted carefully,
I have known what to do.
In Kardhachy valley,
There is a white poplar wood,
I have taken care of them carefully for six years,
Do not allow anyone to go in,
Do not allow anyone to cut even one tree,
Now they all turn into good timber.

"Please call high skilled craftsmen,
Cut all trees in the wood,
Build a bridge there,
Let others know it is built by Kanikai,
Let our names go down in history.
Stop incapable person to go,
Body of the bridge should be splendid,
Everyday after working,
Each man can get a four-year old horse as award."

Heard what Kanikai said,
Bakay turned round and looked at Almanbet,
Heroes Chuwak and Sirak,
Nodded and praised the idea.

As soon as Kanikai stepped out of the door,
Heroes called Bolanchy immediately:
"Please blow the horn now,
Inform people right away,
Let all people know what happened.
Every person can go.
Everyone need take capable tools.
Skilled craftsmen must go,
Tools of carpenters and black smith,
Cannot be left.
When finishing one-meal long working,
A four-year old horse will be the prize."

Kazakh warrior Bolanchy,
Accepted Almanbet's order,
Called in buglers and blew horns,
Took out the loudspeaker,
Informed everyone,
With Almanbet's order.
When people heard the news,
They were in mad rush to the first.
When they heard horse was the award,
Craftsmen were all excited,
They bustled around in fast paces.

Carpenters took their saws, axes and rulers,
Swarmed forward.
Black smith took their iron drills, hammers and bellows,
Igniting sticks and iron tongs,
Tied separately and carried on shoulders,
Walked forward with light pace.
Totally ninety thousand craftsmen,
Went into the wood in a mad rush.
Trees were cut into quadrangular prism,
Inserted both ends into rocks,
Lengthened those which were not long enough,
Then connected and fastened with iron bars.

During the time of horse meat being cooked,
A wood bridge of two-lane for carriages,
Crossed over the valley,
Craftsmen all returned.
Before they said goodbye and left,
Young horses had been gathered,
Divided as award,
Presented to each of craftsmen.

When the dawn came quietly,
When larks made cracking sound,
Khans all got up,

Walked around with whips in their hands.
Cooks were all busy,
In preparing the breakfast.

Khans led by Ayikoler,
Forty warriors led by Kergel,
Turned out to welcome.

Madam Kanikai kept a cool head,
She ordered to harness to the splendid two-horse carriage,
Tazbaymart was the driver,
Avoided everyone,
They went to the bridge at top speed.

Manas rode on magical steed Ackura,
No one could be more imposing than him;
Uncle Bakay cleared the way in the front,
Warriors all followed him tight.

When they were going excitedly,
Koshaoyi's troops appeared in the front suddenly.
Totally there were eighty six lines of troops,
Many of them were highly skilled generals.

Khan Bakay also kept a cool head,
He whispered to Erchywuler and Bozwuler:
"You two go and lead the way for Koshaoyi in the front,
Invite him to live in Almanbet's village."

Hero Manas urged the steed,
Tightly at the end of the troop.
Erchywuler led the streaming troops,
Swaying flags flew with the wind.

Nakelai was waiting right there,
She was in high spirits:
"Warriors, wish everything go smooth,

Does uncle Koshaoyi come?
I am waiting for him here confidently."

Eraman's son Erchywuler,
Had forty buttons on his belt.
This young man was daring and naughty,
He suggested Nakelai with no scruples:
"My sister-in-law, you do not sleep at night,
Just stand and wait here foolishly,
How can I know,
Whether Koshaoyi comes or not?
You'd better lie in bed to have dreams,
Rather than have hard time here."

Bozwuler was also silver-tongued,
He was of round head and round cheeks,
With sweetest words and hardest heart.
He spoke his mind:
"Seek to prevail over a lucky person,
But without knowing your circumstance;
Compete with powerful and wise person,
But without knowing you have been fatigued.

"Why do you decide by yourself to move here,
How can Kanikai let you be satisfied?
Kanikai harnessed a pair of black horses,
Sits in gold carriage in majesty,
Tazbaymart is driving the carriage,
I saw she is coming this way.
You'd better move back quickly,
Do not try to satisfy your vanity here."

Bozwuler persuaded her and went on,
Followed tight after the troop.
Poor Nakelai was absent-minded,
She did not know how she could wind this up.
She ordered to take down the yurt again,

Moved back dejectedly.

Khans led by lion Manas,
All came up,
Looked toward Koshaoyi's troops.
Koshaoyi rode on mountain-size maroon steed,
Fierce eagle was standing on his arm,
Hunting dogs followed tight,
Whip of honeysuckle handle was held in his hand,
Two generals went on his heels.

Khans opened their eyes wide,
Saw Koshaoyi's great figure,
Dismounted quickly and walked up,
Greeted and saluted to show respect.

Pulled the halter and helped the elder Koshaoyi dismount,
Let him sit on brocade cushion.
Carried all kinds of delicacies,
Poured horse milk and wine out of the leather barrels,
People sat around Koshaoyi,
Talked in a happy atmosphere.

When they were talking excitedly,
Two black steeds pulled a beautiful carriage,
The carriage was covered with splendid silk,
Brass bell sounded crackingly.
All kinds of embroidery,
Decorated the carriage gaily.
Distinguished madam Kanikai,
Came in time with her servants.

When Koshaoyi saw the coming carriage,
Sqinted at the carriage carefully:
"My bosom friend Bakay,
What are you doing? "

Bakay said with smile:
"She is the shining diamond among mineral reserves,
She is the best quality steel.
In order to welcome you,
This is your nephew's wife Kanikai's great work."

Koshaoyi was satisfied with loud laughter:
"Good! Bakay, that is very good."
Kanikai stood aside reverently with her hands down,
Bowed to show her respect.
Keshaoyi and Bakay was invited into the splendid carriage,
Then went forward along the main road.

When lion Manas saw this,
He shouted loudly and worriedly:
"Hey, wise Bakay!
This woman lacks wisdom and she is a demon,
Isn't it going to throw Koshaoyi into huge waves?
Kardhachy river is too deep to measure,
Who can escape the soft sand whirlpool in the river?"
Hero Bakay burst into laughter:
"Please go ahead and look,
Who knows what tricks she has?"

Manas rode on Ackura steed,
Urged the steed as fast as a flying bird;
Long edge of the silk robe waved,
Back edge of the robe swayed with wind.
Gold-decorated helmet shined brightly,
He arrived at Kardhachy river in a blink of an eye.
The mountain path had turned into a wide main road,
A bridge crossed over the river.
The bridge was splendid,
In its building skills.

Lion Manas was very happy with this,
Too many past events began to show in his mind:

"What a clever and virtuous wife!
I admire her high skills.
I should not believe evil persons' slander,
Make her suffer wrongs for six years."
Hero Manas felt guilty,
But suddenly he was enlightened like the full moon,
He watched Kanikai's figure with deep love,
His love to her flew again in his heart.

Khans had got together gradually,
Walked into Manas' palace.
The hall swarmed with high rank officials,
Troops thronged in Ayinla.

When the night came,
Kanikai walked with feline grace,
Came to meet four heroes again,
Told them her decision:
"Ayasi, I come again,
I have something to tell you,
The treasure your lion gathered,
Piles up forty one granaries.

"It seems the hero has made up his mind,
To go on expedition against enemies far away.
Among people have come here,
Some are cavalries, some are foot soldiers,
Some have horses with no harness,
Some are just of a bag of bones.

"Please check carefully,
The condition of soldiers' mounts.
We still have ninety thousand steeds,
Wandering in mountains out of bridles.
Semtaiy is too young to ride a steed,
These steeds should be put into commission.

"Beside this,
There are strong soldiers, weak soldiers,
Well-prepared soldiers,
And soldiers prepared nothing.
There is the difference between strong and weak, rich and poor,
So it is impossible to make everyone equal;
Some people have no regret,
But someone else fall into dilemma of having nothing:
We should gather these people together,
Can we distribute our existing treasure,
To the poor as largess?
As long as Semtaiy grows up,
How to get treasure depends on individual's ability."

Felt hat rolled a black edge①,
Black mane wolf's brother hero Sirak,
Totally agreed with Kanikai's proposal,
Remembered Kanikai's opinion in his heart.
He called Bolanchy to his side,
Explained what he wrote down one by one.
Asked Bolanchy to call buglers and trumpeters in,
Gave out orders according to the notes:

"Bolanchy, my dear brother,
Please inform all people through your horn,
Let them receive Khan's presents tomorrow morning.
Do not rush up in a crowd noisily,
Should form neat lines like wild geese.

"Every soldier only receives one bowl of gold,
Remember firmly that do not be greedy.
If anyone takes away two bowls of gold,
It must damage his reputation.

"Do not think white color is pretty,

① Felt hat rolled a black edge: A metaphor is used here. It uses a white felt hat's black edge to show hero Sirak's important position in lion Manas' troops.

Tie silver behind the saddle,
Make horse back callused,
And bring troubles to yourself.

"Soldiers with no mount can choose one,
With weak and old horses can change them to steed,
With inferior horses with sores can choose better steed.
You can let your mount off,
Choose a strong steed in mountain.

"Soldiers who need mounts,
All assemble tomorrow morning,
On Kardhachy meadow,
I will be in charge there tomorrow.
At the entrance of the storehouse,
Almanbet will sit there personally;
At the exit of the storehouse,
Chuwak is supervising,
Soldiers should know it clearly."

Heard the order of Sirak,
Bolanchy announced the order right away.
Around forty thousand soldiers came for the gold,
More than thirty thousand cavalries came for better steeds.
The crowds pushed and yelled,
Who had ever seen such bustling scene?

When the sun rose the next morning,
People thronged in front of the storehouse.
The treasurer servant was a guy of white face,
He was busy with both hands.

Kanikai led her servants,
Stood at the door of the open storehouse,
A mint coat with lapel,
Was perfect on her,
Two sleeves swayed with wind.

Beside the door of the open storehouse,
People came and went for the gold in constant streams.
Beside the red gold,
There were plates with red gold in them;
In front of the piled gold,
Plates were all full of gold,
Each one got one bowl of gold,
And went out of the storehouse happily.

From morning till the time of noon praying,
Soldiers coming for gold became less.
Kanikai came up to watch,
Six out of forty storehouses' gold,
Had been given out.

There were still piles of gold in the seventh storehouse,
Rest storehouses had no one to care.
"Although only seven storehouses are given out,
There are still endless gold here,
It is a good sign to have something left,
Storehouses are still not totally empty,
We can defeat our ferocious enemies."

Kanikai talked to herself,
Felt easy and satisfied.
"Soldiers can choose freely,
Thirty thousand steeds have given out to soldiers who need them."

Sirak got the report from horseman,
He counted the number of soldiers.

When the next morning came,
Giant Bakay got up early,
Fourteen Khans led by Manas,
Were called into the hall.
He talked about his happy feelings with smile:

"Since I Bakay was born,
This is the first time I see such a grand sight.
Troops gathered from all directions,
Are totally five hundred and forty thousand.
On the way of the great expedition,
Who can be the chief general of the troops?
If the general cannot be chosen,
Don't you have regret?
Please present your opinion freely here,
Do not gossip behind backs.
Please exchange your opinions,
Decide it here today."

Khan Manas said first,
Every Khan listened carefully.
"Fourteen Khans present here,
Please listen clearly,
I recommend Yurbi to be the general,
Do you agree, please discuss?"
Some were quiet, some were obsequious,
Khans put heads together and discussed.

Khan Yurbi on the honorable seat,
Stood up and declared uneasily:
"I am slow-witted and lack of talents,
Some people from my clan even oppose me,
Many people here are not familiar with me,
How I can give orders.
Horseman knows how to tame a fiery horse,
Ambitious person does not have mediocre sight,
I am a common person,
How I can take a task of the pillar.

"I have never been to the place we will go,
I know little about enemies.
It is too kind of you all,
Recommend me to be the general.

Let me express everyone's opinion,
We should recommend the elder Bakay.
He is of wide experience and level-headed and resourceful,
He should take this heavy responsibility.

"If this is Ayikoler's kindness,
If this is everyone's sincere thinking,
After we take the city Begin,
If I can be the king for one day,
It will be worthy for my whole life."

"What you said is reasonable,
Khan Yurbi, we have no different opinions."
Everyone jumped for joy with the result,
Held the waving flag,
All agreed Bakay to be the general of expedition.

Nine thousand camels carried armors,
Nine thousand camels carried food,
Nine thousand camels carried weapons,
In massive columns,
They were ready to go toward Begin.
Uncle Bakay organized very well,
The troops marched toward Begin in succession.

Hero Manas went back to his palace,
Gave out strict order to his attendants;
In front of the palace gate,
There were lines of lush poplars,
Sixty ropes put on the big trees,
Tied and fastened tight.

Zhandolun artilleries were placed in front of the gate,
They were made of stainless steel,
Could go forward after hitching with ropes,
Could stay still wherever being placed.
Huge shells were loaded in bores,

Poured gunpowder out of the bag,
Loaded in artilleries carefully.
Shells made of lead,
Were all of the size of crouched-ox.

Hero Bakay gave out the order,
Attendants lit the fuses.
Zhandolun artilleries blew up with a terrible noise,
The earth trembled and mountains swayed.

Ocean waved,
Odobe houses all collapsed;
The old under the bedding dare not move at all,
Flocks of horses in prairie neighed,
Babies in cradles cried in terror.

Soldiers mounted their steeds,
Massive columns of troops marched forward.
The troops left Ayinla,
The time of expedition was coming.

Shaoruk's daughter Nakelai,
Understood now as if wakening from a dream:
"I need lead Arkborchuk out,
Put white silk on it.
Although Kanikai is younger than me,
She is the majestic Khatun.

"I will present Kanikai,
With fine steed and fur coat;
Send invitation to uncle,
Treat him sincerely,
Then he will leave a blessing to me."

Nakelai had cudgeled her brains,
She put tiger skin on Arkborchuk steed.
Carried white silk cloak in hand,

Led out the magical steed.
When she came in a hurry,
She met Kanikai face to face.

Nakelai stopped his steps,
Told Kanikai her heart:
"I am older but I lack wisdom,
You are younger than me but you are the head.
With the help of hero's reputation,
You get people's respect.

"Compete with a lucky person,
I did not know I have lost my fortune;
Compete with a powerful person,
I did not know I have been exhausted.
I present my steed to you,
I put my cloak on you.
Kanikai, I request earnestly,
Please let respected uncle,
Come to my house and stay one night;
Let me, a poor woman,
Appeal for his forgiveness of my misdeeds."

Kanikai continued to say:
"Sister, you come personally,
I know you are in all sincerity.
Whether uncle comes and stays at your home or not,
I cannot guarantee.

"I will report to him
Without hiding anything.
If uncle refuses to go,
I cannot urge him to;
If he decides to go,
I will definitely not stop him."
Kanikai finished what she wanted to say,
Turned round and left with full confidence.

Sage Koshaoyi and giant Bakay,
Talked cheerfully and jovially.
Koshaoyi opened his mind to Bakay:
"My bosom friend Bakay,
You might not notice what happened just now.

"A woman led a steed and carried a cloak,
Came in a hurry from the place ahead;
Another woman went to her head-on,
Stopped her on the way.
I could not hear clearly what they were talking,
Bakay, please make a guess."

Bakay responded like this:
"These two women are both your nephew's wives.
On Kokotoy's ceremony,
At the assembling place,
Kanikai and Manas went together,
She received your cordial blessing and got the fortune.

"Nakelai has been nursing a grudge for a long time,
She made up groundless talk to hurt Kanikai.
Poor Kainikai bore responsibility and blame,
She had suffered for six years in a far place.
Manas was depressed all the time,
He hid everything in his heart.
Until Almanbet came to him for help,
Kanikai finally regained her status.

"Except you were still on your way,
Other Khans all arrived in succession.
Nakelai started off at night,
Wanted to get your blessing on your way.
She acted on her own to pack her stuff,
Waited on the way to welcome you.

"Kanikai had foreseen it days ago,

She ordered to build a bridge over the river,
Drove the carriage bravely,
To pick you to her home to take care.

"If my judge is correct,
Nakelai presented steed and cloak,
In order to get your information,
And let Kanikai ask you to forgive her."

Right at the moment,
Kanikai walked in,
She bowed to them and said:
"Shaoruk's daughter Nakelai,
Is the first wife of the lion,
She led the steed and carried a cloak,
Came to ask about your information.
She invites you sincerely,
To go to her home to stay tonight."

Koshaoyi shook his thick beard,
Roared with laughter and said:
"For the defective family member,
We never bear grudges and revenge.
We are busy preparing,
For the expedition,
Let us accompany black mane wolf to go together,
It is the courtesy of a man."
Giant Koshaoyi was really a sage,
His words made everyone convinced.
Koshaoyi led fourteen Khans,
Came together to Nakelai's place.

Let us put this aside,
Talk about how Ayikoler Manas
Goes on to the distant expedition.

Manas Led the Expedition

"Khans will all start off tomorrow,
I must go and see them off."
Khatun Kanikai prepared adequately,
The grief of parting welled up in her heart.

From Nakelai's yurt,
All Khans mounted and set out,
The destination was distant city Begin.

When they passed Kanikai's yurt,
Almanbet said:
"Our respected sister-in-law is so lonely,
We should say goodbye to her.

"This is not a normal expedition,
The future is ambiguous.
How can you refuse to visit,
Your lovely only son?"
When Khan Manas heard this,
Indefinable sadness came up to his heart:
"I get fine steeds of the world,
Which one can be faster than Ackura?
I call in heroes of world around me,
Which one can match with you Almanbet?

"'The only son being left at home,
Should be visited specially.'
Only you remind me of it."

The conversation between them,
Went into Koshaoyi's ears clearly,
So he chipped in:
"My lion!
Those words are from the bottom of his heart.
Since your only son is at home,
We should go and visit."

Fourteen Khans all came,
Forty warriors urged their steeds.
Almanbet took the lead,
Went to the front of Kanikai first:

"Respected sister-in-law Kanikai,
What else do you need to warn us?
We stop here specially,
In order to say goodbye to you."

Well-bred guards welcomed sincerely,
Came up and held the halters of steeds.
Tied steeds on the posts to rest,
Lifted door curtain to show respect,
Welcomed Khans into the splendid palace.

Cut horse neck fat and sausage into small pieces,
Carried sugar and honey out,
Horse intestines and horse stomachs were all ready,
And lamb tails cooked with milk,
It was hearty and delicious.

Food spread on tablecloth,
Was in all varieties,
There were even swan and wild duck on the table.
Strong tea in Samor teapot was boiling,
Brown cubic sugar,
Was full on big tablecloth.

Put cubic sugar in strong tea,
Milk tea had strong aroma.
After drinking morning tea and eating,
People prayed and blessed,
Wonderful fragrance filled the living room.

Madam Kanikai said,
To Erchywuler and Bozwuler gracefully:
"Please come quickly,
Help me and do not be lazy around."

Got the order of Kanikai,
Two warriors followed madam Kanikai,
Stepped out of the living room with light paces.

There was a leather trunk in Kanikai's room,
It was a unique grand leather trunk in the world.
It was on a Tebaz①,
The Tebaz was not a normal one,
It was weaved into web with iron,
And it was six arm-span long.

The handle of the Tebaz was wound with brass,
Bottom of the Tebaz was wrapped with tin.
The black leather trunk was very exquisite,
Put it on the Tebaz gently.
Madam asked two warriors carried the leather trunk,
Went back to the living room the guests had meal.

There was a round button on the trunk,
Pushed the button gently,
The trunk would open automatically.

Kanikai knew the button,

① Tebaz: It is a traditional tool of production for carrying things in Kirgiz. It is like a stretcher, in the middle it usually is weaved with willow twigs. When using it, two people lift it as do the stretcher.

She touched the button slightly with her fingertip,
With a sound of "bang",
The trunk opened by itself.

Suddenly the living room was covered with bright light,
A faint fragrance of heaven,
Suffused the whole palace.
People present were all surprised,
Stretched their necks to look curiously.

Kanikai bent down deeply,
Took fourteen packages out of the trunk.
Put each package in front of one Khan,
And told them sincerely:

"The place you are going on expedition,
We only hear about it but never see.
People there live in abject poverty,
It is said that sand and saline covers everywhere there.

"It is a boundless open field there,
There is the high wall with sixty city gates.
The hero administers that place,
Is well-known Khan Kunwuer Bayi.

"I bought some silk from Buhara,
The gorgeous silk is very expensive;
Brocade I bought from Andijan is shining,
Silk I bought from Namangan is long and pliable,
They are a riot of colors of best quality.

"Even you sleep with it on for forty days,
There will be no dust falling on the edge,
No fleas hiding in the seam.
I sewed them into your battle robes specially,
They all can be used today,
I present them to you all today."

Kanikai took out a cloth bag,
People stretched their necks and watched,
The opening of the bag,
Was tied with a rope with tassel.

When people were all watching with curiosity,
Kanikai told them:
"My respected forty warriors,
You serve your Khan day and night.
Do not say I have a big mouth,
I need to talk to you all today.
I am not going to recall the remote past,
I just want to mention from Kokotoy's ceremony.

"Two years ago,
I came to your village,
I respect you all from the beginning,
I never neglect any of you.

"Minister is judicious and capable,
Khan is fair and just,
Wife is virtuous,
Husband has bright future.
This is the teachings of ancestors,
I always remember it.

"I make firm horse clothing,
For all you warriors' steeds,
Then button up tight with silver fasteners.
Except the hooves of steed,
It can cover all other parts of the steed.

"Now I will talk about how precious it is,
Do not look down upon the horse clothing.
Fire cannot burn it,
Bullets cannot shoot through it.

"Sword cannot pierce it,
Spear cannot poke through it.
I wrapped it with deerskin,
It can cover the steed tight."

Kanikai took out white felt hat she made elaborately,
It was shining in the palace like silver snowflake.
Kanikai explained the history of the white felt hat:
"On clean floor,
I ordered servants to cut curly sheep wool,
Asked girls to pick out the stray hair,
Put the wool on fine sand and fluffed,
Then rolled it into snow-white felt.

"Seam was sewed with small stitches,
Outside was pressed with strips.
White silk was used as the lining,
Black velvet was made into the brim.
The mixture of iron fillings and white powder,
Was put into the interlayer of the felt hat.

"Highly skilled forty warriors,
Each of you has one hat.
Please put it on your head,
Sister-in-law is sincere to you all,
You will understand me later.

"I call it Arckalpak①,
I wish till the end of the world,
Kirgiz with white felt hat,
Will have generations still pass down.

"Before this,
Kirgiz did not have white felt hat.

① Arckalpak: It means white felt hat in Kirgiz language. "Arc" means white, "Kalpak" means felt hat.

In the past, black felt was made into hat,
And put on head."

As a singer,
I only know its history,
The name of white felt hat Kirgiz,
Is from the mouth of your noble sister-in-law.
Please listen carefully.

Eloquent Kanikai,
Turned round and said to Aji Bayi:
"You are the Began of forty warriors,
You are unusual, you are my friend.
Adversity can test,
The affection between friends.

"I have another precious treasure,
I need to explain it to you.
After returning from Kokotoy's ceremony,
When the assembling ended,
I always had no chance to do.

"Since uncle led all of us,
Moved to Taras,
Three years ago,
I chose some archers,
Sent them to Daoboler mountain,
In Dangdonbash mountain,
On the towering cliff,
Chose strong antelopes to shoot.

"Put antelope skin in shady and cool place,
Did not allow any sunshine to go through.
Chose skins with no black spots,
No blood and stain,
Spread and dried.

"Chose capable young men,
Sent them to Alma-Ata.
Specially chose fresh bark of apple trees,
To move back to our place.
Let handy girls,
Collect twig ends of willow trees,
Tanned the skins softly."

"Ground the iron fillings,
And put in the interlayer.
Diamond-tip awls,
Were made of stainless steel elaborately.
In order to make this pants,
Numerous steel needles and awls were broken.

"Kanidahay leather pants I made,
Is magical and unique in the world.
Aji Bayi, if you stretch it,
It will elongate like a rope.

"If you loose it,
It will shrink to the size of a fist.
If you burn it with fire of honeysuckle or sacsaoul,
It will not be deformed and burned.

"When the hero faces Kunwuer Bayi,
Rushes to the battlefield and waves his spear.
When he puts on the iron gaiters,
His thighs will be abraded.

"When he wears black armor,
And fights against enemies regardless of his safety,
The armor will abrade his waist;
When he goes to battlefield and cannot retreat,
If his thighs are abraded,
How can't he blame and curse me?

"My respected Aji Bayi,
Please treasure it up under your saddle,
When Khan urges the steed to fight,
You must ask him to wear it.
Respected Aji Bayi,
Do not forget what I entrust you to do."

Seeing Kanikai's expression,
People present all praised:
"What a kindhearted woman,
How lucky this Kangkor is!
Among women with long hair,
There is no woman as virtuous as her."

When people were praising,
Hero Koshaoyi changed the topic:
"Kanikai, my child,
Where is Khan's son?
Please carry him here,
Let us look at the lovely baby."

In the cradle inlaid with gold and silver,
In the bedding sewed with silk and velvet,
The apple of Khan's eye was lying there,
He was sleeping sound at the moment.

Kanikai held the baby gently,
Gave him to Aji Bayi.
Aji Bayi bowed and walked up,
Gave the baby to Koshaoyi.

Koshaoyi kissed the baby's right cheek,
Then kissed his left cheek.
He let the baby pillow his right knee
With the baby's head facing west.

Koshaoyi pulled one of his long beards out,

Like winding the string of Kumuz,
He wound his long beard,
Round and round:

"Kanikai, my child,
This is the precious gift I present to him.
Let him wear it as the amulet,
Brave, wish him be of energy,
Happy, wish him live to a ripe old age!"

Koshaoyi gave the baby his blessings,
All Khans kissed the baby in succession.
Forty warriors rushed to be the first,
Kissed the baby happily.

The baby was back to Kanikai's arm,
Among all people present,
Manas with an energetic looking,
Sat aside with profound silence,
"If I stare at the baby carefully,
My eyes will bite the baby①."
He made up his mind,
Like being angry at someone:
"Take the baby away!"
He shouted out.

Seeing the apathetic expression of Manas,
Everyone present felt it was abnormal.
"He is so apathetic to his only son,
Is he iron-hearted?

"Whom does he treat kindly?
If anything goes wrong by accident,
Perhaps he will gather all of us together,

① My eyes will bite the baby: It is an old custom of Kirgiz. It is said that some great heroes cannot look directly at the baby's face. Otherwise they will bring misfortune to the baby.

And kill us all in one day."
People put their heads together and worried,
Cowards were quivering nervously.

Kanikai continued the talk:
"My dear hero Almanbet,
Flags inlaid with golden pattern,
Wave high in the sky;
People for expedition will go to a faraway place,
Lonely children and mothers stay at home,
No one takes care of them.

"Cane made of wood,
Is the support of a cripple;
Honorable commander,
You are the backbone of our soldiers,
Like the numerous soldiers and horses,
Where exactly do they go?

"You exchange food with gold cions,
Mount and go on expedition in hot summer.
Hero lion Manas,
Who knows what he is thinking."

Almanbet continued to say:
"In Kaspan mountains,
Beside grand Begin city gate,
Dense honeysuckle grow there,
Strong horses tie on them,
He is ready to attack us.

"That is the place where Kunwuer Bayi lives,
We are going to crusade against him.
We turned on our way,
Specially to say goodbye to you."

Heard what Almanbet said,

Kanikai said in this way:
"Horses of all colors play on hillsides,
There are a lot of fine steeds among them.
Khan's son is too young,
To urge the steed in battlefield.

"Flocks of horses of all colors run on hills,
Flocks of fine steeds spread all over the prairie.
Lion's son is young and ignorant,
He cannot mount and go for battle.

"Get no kiss to satisfy his love,
Get no chance to act in pettish on Manas' knees,
Semtaiy is the only son.
My Sultan's son Semtaiy,
He does not get his father's care,
He does not lie in his father's arm even one time.
At lion Manas' knee,
Semtaiy is his only son,
He is so young, whom can he rely on?

"When Khan is with me,
I can sleep in a warm bed,
Five tribes are our support.

"I harbor a mountain-size regret,
Except Semtaiy,
I have never heard the cry of other babies.
At the side of the hero,
I sleep well on soft pillow,
I am in charge of his issues.

"Great regret is buried in my heart,
Semtaiy is the only son,
I wish I could hear the cry of his younger brother.
This expedition concerns hundreds of thousands of people's lives,
It will be crowning calamity if we fail,

It will make us regret for the whole life.

"There are forty days for hot summer,
There are forty days for cold winter,
Totally it is eighty days,
Families could not see again will die forever.

"When on earth do you come back?
Ayasi, please tell me exactly!
When on earth do you return?
Ayasi, please tell me clearly.

"If you make a triumphant return,
Troops will be weak and exhausted,
I will make preparations in time,
To welcome you back.
Then, I will ask to butcher fat mares,
Spread hearty food on tablecloth.

"Bees' power comes from the honey,
Khatun's power comes from Khan;
Khan's power comes from his people,
Wife gets power from her husband.

"Flood's power comes from mountain torrents,
Cloud's power comes from gale;
Steed's power comes from fodder,
Fast horse's speed comes from its sweat;
Herdsman's power comes from prairie,
Farmer's power comes from the earth,
Fresh camel meat is delicious with salt on it,
Polo is smelled well when it is steamed.

"My backbone Khan,
Launch the dangerous battle faraway,
I do not know whether I can see him or not?
Or I will lose him this time,

Then I will die in misery and despair.

"I ever hear in the remote Begin city,
Kunwuer Bayi and Muradiler,
Are the commanders there,
There has been no one escaped from their hands.

"If enemies surround you,
The hero is attacked with flying arrows,
You are a brave hero,
You can rescue him out of the danger.

"I ask for your help,
If you really can take Begin,
Win the big victory in expedition,
Each of forty warriors,
Will get a dromedary with brown tail.
On the back of each camel,
First class red gold should be carried.

"Precious gifts you will look for,
Had better the silk of high quality.
Your poor sister-in-law,
Is lonely and has no other request.

"You need take a dozen maid servants to me,
Let them wash dishes, cook and sew for me,
In order to comfort my broken heart…"

When Kanikai said these,
Almanbet interrupted:
"Respected sister-in-law Kanikai,
Please wait a moment!
The enemies cursed even by gods,
Are not normal people.

"I have already lost my past dignity,

In the bloody battlefield,
Retreating is not my character.
Around me,
There are no old Ketay people.

"You said the hero is alone,
Arashi is of numerous people,
Whose families are they finally?
Six people have same father,
Two of them are of same mother,
He still has two younger brothers Awesh and Kobosh,
I am just a vagrant servant,
Is there any other family member besides you all?

"You are nervous about the lion,
You just tell me Almanbet.
You talked your heart to me,
You want Ketay people to be your servants,
Do you lack Ketay servants?
Almanbet stands in front of you,
My respeced sister-in-law,
Am I not your Ketay servant?

"We pray to Allah and mount our steeds,
Start off on the expedition.
If we ride at top speed day and night,
After the three-month long journey,
Cross rolling Elaman hills,
Go through countless lakes,
We can spend winter there,
Taming, training and flying eagle.

"When steeds have green grass to eat,
We can get to know enemies' situation in Begin,
Then get in front of the ferocious enemies.
No matter we will win or fail,
The battle will last for six months,

Then soldiers left will go on return journey.

"After one year and six months,
Totally eighteen months pass,
We are possible to come back,
And stay in Taras.
Sister-in-law, according to my estimation,
It will not be longer than this.

"The word lonely,
Recalls the secret anguish in my heart.
When I fight against a powerful enemy,
If I die unfortunately,
Who will find a place for my bones?

"Whose life will be immortal?
For me, such a vagrant servant,
Who will sing the elegy and cry for me?
Forty warriors fight shoulder to shoulder,
Too many orders, they will not accept,
Be distinguished, they will envy.

"If my life expectancy is coming,
In case I die in battlefield,
They will not carry my coffin to the cemetery carefully:
They will consider me as a lost slave,
Put the pot-frame on my neck:
'The Ketay like him,
Has to be thrown to wilderness.'

"At the critical moment,
If I meet the death by accident,
I lie in wilderness and no one will care.
In peaceful time,
If I sacrifice my life,
My bones also cannot get respect.

"I live humbly in the world and no one cares,
If I leave this world,
No one will cry for me and feel sad.

"I have no son to keep vigil beside my coffin,
I have no families to go for help.
If the death comes to me,
I have no panacea to stop it.

"At the real critical moment,
I only can be thrown to wilderness.
I have no descendants that cannot bear to part,
In this false and hollow world,
I have no wild wishes.

"I do not owe anybody,
Arukai is my beloved family.
If Arukai does not cry for me,
My life will be totally worthless.

"I do not owe anybody in affection,
Only my wife Arukai treats me best,
If Arukai does not weep loudly from sorrow,
My life will be just a wasted one…"

His body quivered ceaselessly,
Tears sprouted in his eyes,
With his voice roughened,
His lower jaw shook.
Like lost baby camels,
Almanbet wept his eyes out.

Forty warriors stood on both sides,
Showed sympathy for the hero's sadness:
"No matter how great a person is,
He has lonely and sad mood.
No matter how wise and clever a sage is,

There is always endless plight to tell."

Forty warriors surrounded the hero,
Tried to console the hero:
"Hero, please come,
It is not good to talk too much."

Someone took out Nasbay① tobacco bottle,
Mixed Nasbay tobacco with some Sahasa herb,
Filtered with chili water,
Smoked on pepper,
Inhaled one time would fog the mind.
If someone inhaled it on the way by accident,
He would roll on the ground right away.

They took out Nasbay tobacco bottles out of the pockets,
Poured a little in the palm,
Sent into the hand of Almanbet.

They all inhaled,
They could not stay long for parting.
Everyone said goodbye to families,
Comforted families and parted.

Clever madam Arukai,
Came hurriedly to see Almanbet off:
"My hero husband,
Do not cry for having no child,
Do not torture yourself out of any reason.
I do not feel well these days,
It is not clear I am sick or pregnant;
If I can bear a boy,
Then I can make your blood pass down."

Heard what Arukai said,

① Nasbay: Kirgiz herdsmen burn ephedra into ash, mix with leaf tobacco to make one kind of tobacco. It is usually in tobacco bottle, pour out a little when eating, and put it under the tongue.

Almanbet opened his eyes wide with surprise.
As if he was holding the baby in his hands,
And the baby was smiling at him.

Almanbet was delighted beyond measure,
He stretched his hand in his clothes quickly,
Took out a fist-size cloth bag,
Grasped in his hand tight:
"Arukai, my wife,
In the past, in Begin city,
I was a Khan administered a region,
I make friends with celebrities and sages.

"I sent people to catch magpie,
In dry wilderness.
Then invited famous fairy,
Let him turn forty tribes' language into spell,
And hide in the bird.

"Arukai, if you bear a baby boy,
You just let the boy eat this,
Then he will master forty languages,
He can have both ancient and modern learning.

"If you bear a baby girl,
You must not put this in her mouth,
Otherwise it will bring her disaster,
And waste my great pains.

"Precious belt is made of gold,
During Sorandick times,
I was on the throne of Khan,
I wore the belt all the time.
I will leave it to the baby as a souvenir,
Please remember it.

"If I can come back safely,

I will kiss the baby's cheeks.
If I die in battlefield,
How can I meet the baby again?

"Wait for my next life,
Let my child treasure the gift,
I will meet the child if I have chance in my next life."
When Almanbet handed the precious gift over,
People present burst into weeping,
Like great disaster descended.

Right at this moment,
Kergel, leader of forty warriors,
Beat drum and announced Khan's order of departing.

Disciplines had been developed,
Brave forty warriors,
Like eagles flying to battlefield,
Urged their steeds and galloped forward.
Flags waved, hooves galloped,
Drums beating, horns blaring.

Wise madam Kanikai,
Stood beside the main road.
Seeing the hero leaped on the steed,
And sat firmly on the back of Ackura.

She walked up to Khans gracefully,
Urged again and again:
"Respected Khans,
Do not say woman fancies herself smart.
I have some words,
Specially for the lion.

"Karato mountain of Kangayi has endless rising peaks,
Kapchaler cliff has clouds lingered,
Who ever conquer it?

Ancient hero Rustam tried to climb it,
But he lost the blessing of Allah,
It had to be given up halfway.

"Who climbed it after him?
Amirtimur① could predict the future,
He was in charge of the universe,
He also did not get to Begin,
Just because mountains and dangerous roads stopped him.

"Sikander② could not leave his track in Begin,
No one can step on that land since ancient times.
Sages also had not been there,
Charyar's wheels had not been there either,
Till now no people from other tribes steps on that sacred land.

"That one-way Begin,
You go on expedition persistently.
Even if you take Begin city,
Please do not indulge in exotic scenery.

"As long as three months pass,
It will be impossible to keep your noble life.
Do not be infatuated with beauties there,
Do not marry Ketay woman,
Do not hurt yourself with their spell.

"Do not say it is because of woman's envy,
And feel discontented with me.
No matter what happens,
Do not reveal Almanbet to them.

"Aputaba③ is gold, and not smelly copper,

① Amirtimur: Famous Khan and hero in ancient Central Asia history.
② Sikander: A great hero in history. It is said it indicates great Alexandria.
③ Aputaba: It is one kind of pot Kirgiz used to clean hands.

Giant Kunwuer Bayi and Aisanhan,
Now it is not the right time to fight;
Sakor tea boiler is gold, and not rusted copper,
Aisanhan and Kunwuer Bayi,
It is not the moment to go on expedition.

"This year you are sixty-one year old,
It is the critical age for you,
Why do you go on expedition against Begin?
Why didn't you go last year,
And why can't you go next year?

"Go on expedition in your birth year,
It makes me worry a lot.
My beloved Sultan Khan,
Wish you all the best and come back safely!"
Kanikai's eyes as wise as falcon,
Veiled with tears which wet her splendid clothes.

She stepped backward after her words,
Lion Manas gripped the whip,
Knocked the front of saddle with the whip handle.

The scene at this moment,
No matter Khans or ordinary people,
Among the crowd,
If someone said "Do not go to Begin!"
Khan might stop going on expedition.
But people all kept silent,
No one said such word,
Finally Manas went on the expedition,
Kanikai stayed at lonely home.

Troops started off on expedition,
Four days and nights flew away.
Among clansmen with great fame,
Totally four of them were left.

"The east frontier of Arashi,
Ayihan's son Kokboru,
Must guard and patrol carefully.

"Fortresses in south,
Will be garrisoned by Baersh from Jedigair,
Enemies are crafty with full of tricks,
Father Jagurp need stay in homeland.
In order to avoid enemies' sneak attack,
Ayidarhan's son Kokcher,
Should station the road to Kangayi."

When seven Khans were invited,
Before they arrived,
The order had been given out.
Foresighted bloodsucker,
Had his judgment for many things.

Khans stayed in homeland,
We will not mention now,
Let's talk about,
Commander Almanbet of whole troops.

Almanbet Was Appointed to be the Commander

Manas led the expedition troops,
Thirteen Khans moved forward one after one.
At the end of the day,
Hero arrived at Bulana① mountain.

He pulled the halter and turned to watch the troops,
He saw the troops flood into the valley,
The vanguard units like the burning fire
Had gone into Tablga piedmont②.
The back of troops still winded in Burana basin.
Troops the lion led,
Were powerful and mighty in streaming columns.
From Burana to Tablga,
It was totally sixteen-day journey.

Now look at the grand expedition troops,
They were surprisingly slack.
Some dismounted,
And chased antelopes and wildebeests intermountain.

Some pulled wild goats,
Wielded knife and killed the game.
Some dashed along riverbank,
Chased white swans and wild ducks.

Some went fishing in the river,

① Bulana: It is the name of a place. It is in Kyrgyzstan now.
② Tablga piedmont: It is the name of a place. It is in Kyrgyzstan now.

Waited for fish to bite the bait leisurely.
Some were naked to the waist,
Ran here and there, and jumped into water.

"Let's play the game Take Palace,
I will defeat them all by myself."
Some sat around and played Chatlasi chess;
Some continued clamoring on hillside,
Some got together and played marbles,
It seemed they all forgot the mission of expedition to Begin.

Almanbet watched carefully,
The state of troops made him worried very much.

Looked at the disordered troops,
Almanbet bellowed with great anger:
"Those who play chess scatter now!
Wake up, open your eyes.
Those who play marbles go to hell,
You must lose your life if continue doing these!

"Leopard Manas, where are you?
Are you still the headman administering your people?
I thought you are the headman admired by Kirgiz,
How can you be so incapable?

"How can such uncontrollable and slack soldiers,
Undertake the important mission of expedition?
I have lost my confidence,
How can lead such troops?

"If we do not neaten the troubled troops,
How exaggerating is it to talk a victorious expedition?
I want to turn my steed round,
Go back to Kangkoler to rest tonight."

Heard the complaints of Almanbet,

Recognized the meaning of his words,
Manas burst into laughter,
His front teeth were like door panel,
They were unusual and showy.

He pretended to turn a blind eye to it,
But laughed and said:
"Make such things happen,
Does Bakay have a swelling head?
Let soldiers be so slack and uncontrollable,
Why is respected Bakay so careless?"

He urged the troops marching forward fast,
Persuaded Almanbet to be patient.
They rode with whip and spur forward.
Shades of dusk deepened, stars shined,
He arrived at Tablga piedmont,
Numerous soldiers had gathered there,
Troops pitched camps and encamped there.

Almanbet stated flatly,
To Manas like this:
"Give order to the troops!
Let all officials and generals,
Assemble in two days.

"Uncle Bakay and you,
Please go with me to check.
Please take a look by yourselves,
On what has happened here."

Hero Manas sent out the orderly,
Gave out the order to all troops;
Asked those officials and generals,
Arrived tomorrow,
And stressed the order to Bolanchu.

The night faded away in silence,
Birds began to chirp.
Uncle Bakay and lion Manas,
Went shoulder to shoulder with Almanbet.
They three whipped steeds forward,
Went on the top of Karato mountain.

They dismounted,
Held telescopes in their hands,
Watched carefully the terrain toward Begin.

Almanbet pointed to the distance and explained:
"Khan Manas, elder Bakay,
Please watch through your telescopes,
Roads in front of us are crisscrossed.

"Mountain ranges ahead of us on the right,
The sky is shrouded in clouds.
The high mountain peak like bridge of nose,
Is Muzhart peak.
We must climb over Muzhart peak,
We need five months to get to Begin city.

"We will pass Kalashar① and Kambul②,
After that there is a Zhuzhu city,
Karamark soldiers are stationing there.

"Only after we wipe out these enemies,
We can march forward smoothly.
If we are defeated by these enemies,
We have to retreat dejectedly.

"Look farther,
The endless rising peaks,

① Kalashar: It is the name of a place, namely Yanqi of Xinjiang.
② Kambul: It is the name of a place, namely Hami of Xinjiang.

Is called Eshekart peak.
Climb over Eshekart peak,
We need three months to get to Begin city.

"Climb over the towering mountains,
Go through rough valley paths,
Only a short distance can go on horses,
The rest paths can only go on foot.
When we are exhausted,
We can get to Begin.

"High mountains, dangerous roads, no springs,
Infertile lands, naked of grass.
Continue going forward from there,
It is precipitous Sahezhan ridge,
Steeds cannot walk on those slippery roads.

"After we climb over this mountain,
No matter steeds or soldiers,
Will only have half left.
After we lose more than half of our troops,
Two months later we can get to Begin."

"Though it is only two-month time,
Only two places have water.
Except these two places,
Other places are all wilderness and Gobi desert.

"The faraway place wreathed in mist,
Is called Kordoy canyon,
Except goats, no people can go through,
If we can climb over this mountain,
We need three months to get to Begin.

"On our way to Begin,
Some places are of abundant water and grass,
There is a Gobi desert called Jadochu,

It is dry and barren there.

"Which way should we go?
Which way on earth need we choose?
Khan Manas makes the decision please."

Lion Manas did not speak,
Bakay stroked his beard and muttered:
"Heard the directions Almanbet showed,
Every way sounds totally strange to me,
I have never heard these names of places.

"I have never been there,
Have never drunk tea there,
Have never seen people there.
Let me lead the expedition troops forward,
I cannot accomplish the mission.
Lion Manas, if you agree,
Please let Almanbet be the commander of expedition."

Hearing the opinion of elder Bakay,
Manas did not make decisions rashly:
"If it is like this, my uncle!
I must make something clear.
Whether Almanbet can be the commander,
We will discuss and decide later."

Heroes leaped on their steeds,
Three heroes turned round and returned.
Wild deer ran in river valley,
Sixty of them were shot.
Skinned the deer and took out their guts,
Hang behind the saddles,
Then urged the steeds on returning journey.

Next morning,
Khans came in succession.

Heroes administered common people,
All gathered together with their troops.

Khans sat in a shape of ox-horn,
Listened to lion Manas' request:
"My respected fellows,
You are all brave heroes.
My respected fellows,
Who among you has ever been to Begin?

"My respected fellows,
Who is familiar with the road to Begin?
My respected fellows,
Who can look for the road for the expedition?

"My respected fellows,
Who knows the information there?
My respected fellows,
Who knows their habits and characteristics?
My respected fellows,
Who knows the information of mountains there?

"What is the situation of people there?
Who knows how to deal with them?
How to climb over these mountains,
Who knows the exact terrain?

"How to defeat the giants there?
Who knows the detailed information of enemies?
Generals and soldiers,
I have opened my mind to you."

Lion Manas stopped speaking,
Khans all kept silent,
It was as long as one meal.
Almanbet, the black-spot tiger,
What he said was pleasant to ears:

"Toward the remote east,
We have started off on our journey.
Once I was here,
And fought against soldiers who chased me.

"Which mountain to climb, which road to go,
I am very familiar with all of them.
Giants who fought against me,
I remembered them clearly.

"Where the mountain is, where the valley is,
I know clearly the terrain there.
How to deal with our enemies,
I know them like the palm of my hand.

"Until I grew up,
I was administering people there,
Once I assumed great responsibilities there."

Hearding Almanbet's impressive speaking,
Khans present were all filled with joy.
Manas continued the talking:
"Heroes Erchywuler and Bozwuler,
Please start off right now.
Go to ask elder Bakay for advice,
To see whether he wants to give up being the commander!"

Two warriors dashed ahead,
Whipped and urged, dismounted fast,
After greeting and saluting,
They sat in front of Bakay.

The elder Bakay had already predicted it,
He smiled and his beard shook,
He revealed the things behind:
"Two warriors come suddenly,
Do you have something important to tell me?"

Bozwuler wore his heart on his sleeves,
He spoke frankly:
"The hero gave out the order before starting off,
Hold flags high enough to stir clouds,
Recommended you as the commander.
The commander was appointed yesterday,
But the bloodsucker sends us here with an order,
Ask you to surrender the seal of the commander."

Bakay continued the talk:
"Almanbet is a peerless hero,
He is even closer than my son to me.
Ask me to give the seal of commander to Almanbet,
I raise both hands in favor of it."

Bakay called his clerical staff in,
Wrote the document of handing over the seal.
"From now on I will be free."
Bakay took out the gold seal,
Stamped at the end of the letter clearly,
Delivered the letter sincerely.

Bloodsucker made the decision,
Almanbet took charge of expedition seal.
Young soldiers were sent out immediately,
To deliver the news to all troops.

Put out the fire, stopped cooking and decamped,
Started off in the morning on their journey.
When the troops arrived at Dakakmandu,
They met with Karamark people face to face.

After a battle,
Enemies were wiped out,
The troops set out again.

The expedition troops continued marching forward,

And they got to Kordoy ridge.
Like the white antelopes squeezed under the mountain,
The troops prepared to climb over the ridge.

Almanbet gave out the order:
"The mountain pass is very narrow,
Troops must go through in lines."
After soldiers passed the valley,
Almanbet counted the number of the troops.
One group was formed with ten soldiers,
One was appointed as the leader,
To take charge of their matters.
Appointed a headman for every fifty soldiers,
And a headman for every one hundred soldiers.

Almanbet counted the number personally,
When he counted to the one thousandth soldier,
He appointed a headman for these one thousand soldiers:
"Any headman who loses his soldiers,
Will be called to account.

"We will go two days,
Climb the precipitous ridges first,
Then climb over this high peak.
Every soldier,
Should take two bundles of firewood,
Put on horseback to the encampment."

A group formed by ten soldiers,
Had one leader.
After two-day arduous journey,
Finally they climbed over the precipitous peak,
After five-day arduous journey,
They climbed over Kordoy ridge.

When the troops started off again,
Almanbet warned like this:

"When we shout the name of Manas,
Whip steeds for expedition,
You must be on the alert,
Clench our fists and keep up our spirits.
You cannot stop eating,
Cannot take care of our mounts,
You should endure the hardships on the journey.
When entering Wuguz Yotimok① and Tay Yotimok②,
You should be more careful when going through valleys,
When we begin to count numbers,
You can dismount and rest."

Sariala steed galloped forward,
Gold-badged flag waved with wind,
Almanbet cleared the way in the front.
He did not stop at all,
Did not loose the halter in his hand for a second.

The saddle shined under the sun,
Ayikoler Manas sat still on horseback.
Troops behind him,
Were in overwhelming streaming columns.

Eyes did not blink,
Legs could not move at all.
Cavalries' waists were intolerably hurt,
Horsemen were exhausted with swelling butts.
Troops endured hardships and marched forward,
Generals and soldiers endured all hardships on the way.

Weak Kergelchal,
Panted heavily and sweated profusely.
As the head of forty warriors,
He showed his power after forty years old.

① Wuguz Yotimok: It means the valley ox can pass.
② Tay Yotimok: It means the valley colt can pass.

He could not lift his heavy feet,
His body was shaking.

Ten-soldier leader warrior Bozwuler,
Urged him to follow the troops quickly.
Fatigued Kergelchal,
Got very angry at Bozwuler:
"Hey, ten-soldier leader Bozwuler,
Can it be that you want me to lose my old life?

"Since we mounted with shouting the name of Manas,
We are like the livestock being driven,
We have been on the way for forty one days,
We have no rest for forty one nights.
Days and nights,
We have marched for eighty two days.

"The troops flood forward,
Like night descends on head.
Hands grasped weapons do not stretch,
Battle robes do not take off.
There is even no time to feed horses,
So there is no need to mention the time of rest.

"I have lived sixty years,
I have never suffered such hardships.
The detestable Ketay man,
I cannot bear him any more.

"Illustrious Arashi people,
Look, how miserable they are now.
Our legendary hero Manas,
I do not know how is he now?

"Well-known Arashi,
Has been chased so many years.
Swaggering Manas,

Why does he keep silent? "

Bozwuler persuaded Kergelchal:
"Hey, hero Kergelchal!
Do not talk rubbish casually to disrupt the morale.
The expedition soldiers and generals regardless of ages,
Should all receive the test of hard journey.

"Almanbet is an extraordinary commander,
How can we go against his order?
Even if we trek continuously for one thousand days,
Indefatigable Manas,
Is still our Khan.

" 'Fish know the habits of frogs.'
Ayikoler takes control of everything.
Kergelchal,
Do not be angry,
What is the use of your ceaseless complaints? "

Kergelchal got angrier,
Scolded Bozwuler for his inconsideration:
"It is said that he announced the order of directing troops,
But the truth is to kill us.
Even if cut my beard off,
Even if let offspring laugh at me,
I still will shout loudly to report to Khan,
Tell him my difficulties."

Kergelchal lifted the whip,
Lashed Arkborchuk steed severely,
Went off with great fury.
He was disaffected with Bozwuler's supervising,
"Who sees damned Manas? "
He asked on the way about Manas:
"Who sees silly Manas? "
He inquired around with great anger.

"Should let the fire burn this bloodsucker,
He makes us miserable,
He makes us suffer so much."

People put heads together and whispered:
"Who is this angry man?
Is he an old man no one supervises?
Does he have no thousandor to supervise?

"Where is his ten-soldier leader?
Is he the hardest old man to deal with in the world?
He must be unusual,
He looks so ferocious."

Kergelchal looked for Kankor everywhere,
Hooves of his mount did not stop,
They climbed over ridges one after one,
The steed galloped forward at top speed.

He climbed over a hill and looked ahead,
He found Ackura steed in his sight.
Wide robe edges of Manas stretched in wind,
Great figure stood upright,
Like towering Arato mountain peak.

Kergelchal had no fear at all,
Scolded behind the lion severely:
"Stop, damned hero lion!"

Kergelchal's shouting roared in the wilderness,
Hearing the shouting,
Manas pulled the halter,
Stopped and murmured to himself:
"High Kumsari ridge,
Is between the rolling mountains in the front.
It is said that Georoy's massive forces,
Are stationing behind this big mountain.

"Has our operation been exposed,
Or are my troops fighting against Tangut now?
The news has been spread all over the troops,
Does Kergelchal come to find me,
At this critical moment?

Lion Manas thought over for a while,
Then turned his steed round and looked back.
Kergelchal's face was clouded with anger,
Facing lion Manas,
He talked wildly with no fear:

"Damned Manas, you are matchlessly powerful,
Don't you ever look at your poor fellows?
A vagrant fugitive,
But you let him hold the power,
And bring great disaster,
To our numerous soldiers.

"Unreasonable Manas, you are big and powerful,
You act on your own will and ride roughshod over us.
Recommend a roamed stroller,
To be the commander of troops.
Bring endless disaster,
To all generals and soldiers.

"From vast Gobi desert of Jadochu,
From that boundless basin,
We mounted steeds with shouting your name,
Trekked in wind and rain,
Not a week, but eighty two days,
My face is pale, I am exhausted.

"We do not stretch our bodies to rest,
Do not drink any water,
Do not hunt anything to eat.
We do not take unauthorized actions,

To part with troops freely.
But blood in the vessels has drained,
We are completely exhausted.

"You are our immensely brave commander,
Our bodies are not made of steel.

"If you think I am frantic and rude,
You just poke your sword into my chest.
I have lived sixty years,
I have been a man of silver beard and white hair,
I have never suffered such torment,
I almost lost my life in this wilderness!

"That dark minded Ketay lackey,
Plotted this frame-up deliberately,
What can we call it except frame-up?
Generals and soldiers are all down in spirits.

"He asked us to trek,
The silent scheme is more sinister,
We are going to be tired out to death.
This is Almanbet's plan,
He attempts to eliminate us all secretly,
But you are kept in the dark.
Lion, you may not know,
He is going to push us to abyss like this!"

Aggressive Kergelchal,
Had left life and death out of consideration,
Adhered stubbornly to his own idea,
Vented his resentment,
On ferocious Manas.

Lion Manas was filled with rage,
Interrupted Kergelchal's nonsense talking:
"You cannot go casually like goats,

Cannot sleep till noon,
If it is needed by the situation,
You cannot stop to rest and eat on the way.

"Our life is hanging by a thread,
We are wandering between life and death.
Enemies are around us,
Hometown is far behind us.
Kergelchal,
You should keep a clear head,
Shut your mouth and do not talk nonsense.

"Our soldiers regardless of ages,
Are all standing the test of the hard journey.
Without the hardships and misery,
How we can win the victory in battlefield!"
Manas turned his steed as he finished his words,
Whipped his steed forward.

Kergelchal glared with rage:
"I know what I said,
Does not please you.
We rush the whole day everyday,
Dirt has covered my face.
Without dismounting everyday,
My butt has been scraped.

"To hell with your expedition,
Let your Ketay lackey go bad.
Let Ketay and Kirgiz people,
All die."
Kergelchal stood beside road,
With towering rage.

Let him stand there,
Let us talk about ten-soldier leader Bozwuler,
Look at his situation.

What Kergelchal did made him annoyed,
Bozwuler was very unsatisfied about it.
"This troublesome old man,
How can he act so casually;
He is such a boor without knowing his limitation.
If he disappears suddenly,
How I can escape from the lion's reproach.

"He is an impetuous old man,
He can always make troubles.
If he flees away suddenly,
He must bring me troubles."

Bozwuler whipped and urged his steed,
Urged his eight soldiers,
Chased at top speed,
He asked about the information on the way:
"Do you see a long-beard old man? "

People they met on the way responded:
"He just passed us,
With lots of bad words,
And scolded Manas and Almanbet ceaselessly."

Bozwuler dashed forward in a hurry,
Kergelchal was still filled with rage.
Seeing the expression of the old man,
Bozwuler lessoned him harshly:
"Now I am the leader of you ten,
You are all under my supervision.

"If you go beyond the restraint at your will,
I must tie you up and lash you.
You can die if you want to,
If you take death as a game,
You just go and witness your next life.

"I will not throw your corpse into wilderness,
To cause trouble for myself.
I will cut your corpse in two through waist,
Carry them on the back of Arkborchuk steed.

"When I arrive at valleys only ox and colt can pass,
Generals will count the number,
I will report them clearly.
If I do not do this,
I must be punished by Manas,
Then I will lose my life in vain.

"For brave commander Almanbet,
Who dare contradict him.
If I cut your head off,
I will lose my life.

" 'You dare kill my Kergelchal,
How are you so bold? '
Lion Manas,
Must punish me severely.
Till the last moment of my life,
I will be in total dark with no crack,
Spend rest of my life miserably."

Dim-sighted Kergelchal,
Said such words:
"Ok, my dear lion Bozwuler.
At the moment I am going to die,
You are my most reliable friend.
That Ketay chose the ten-soldier leader,
Let him go to die right now."

Let us put this aside,
Talk about Manas and Almanbet,
Look at their situation.

Ayikoler Manas,
His reputation rose up from Kirgiz.
He counted the days carefully,
Kept recordings in his diary everyday.

He recorded the nights carefully,
Counted the number of nights.
Right as what Kergelchal said,
Eighty two days had passed.

Red flag inlaid with gold,
Held up high and waved with wind.
Almanbet led the troops and advanced courageously.
Urged the mount Sariala,
Almanbet led the troops and marched forward.

Manas rode on Ackura steed,
"Hey, Almanbet!"
He made a loud shout,
The shout roared to the clouds,
Like igniting the fuse of Arckelaty firelock,
The ringing voice echoed in the valley.

Hearding the shout of the hero,
Like hearing the call from afar,
Almanbet turned round,
Thought over in terror:

"The high ridge of Kumsari,
Is not far from here.
Climb over this ridge,
It is the camp of Georoy.

"Does he launch an attack from our flank?
Does he make troubles for us?
Does the hero call me loudly
Under such critical circumstances?"

Almanbet was in great anxiety,
Train of thought waved like Chaterkoler lake water.
He whipped and urged the steed,
Dismounted beside Manas.

Manas said to him immediately:
"Oh, hero Almanbet,
From Gobi desert of Jadochu,
We mounted and marched forward,
Stepped on this distant journey.

"Totally forty one nights,
And forty one days passed.
I calculated and added these two,
Totally eighty two days have passed.

"From then till now,
I have observed carefully,
We do not dismount to rest at all,
Steeds are almost pulled down,
The whole army is screwed up to the highest tension,
There is no leisure time at all.

"More than half become dejected,
Sit on horsebacks in low spirit.
Soldiers and horses are both tired out,
Torture by extreme sleepiness,
No one can make his sleepy eyes open.

"Some soldiers sleep on horseback,
Moving slowly is hard to stop.
They are too tired to sit still on saddles,
They had to be dragged off,
And put across their saddle.

Some soldiers bend and lower their heads,
Fellows scold them all the way.
If we do not care our soldiers' conditions now,
If we continue urging them forward,
Soldiers will lose their lives,
We'd better stop and rest for one day today.

"I just saw Kergelchal,
He has been extremely exhausted,
Clever boy Bozwuler,
Is ten-soldier leader.
Kergelchal was filled with rage,
He vented his anger on me.
I did not know his feeling,
So I scolded him severely."

Manas did not finish his words,
Almanbet had already been impatient:
"If my order cannot be executed,
If I am not qualified to take the command of troops,
I, the vagrant lackey,
Can be removed from the position,
I will get rid of this intractable job.

"If my plan cannot be carried out,
If you do not have your own view,
Please take back your decision.
Do not let me hear again,
About Kergel will be tired to death.

"Let me tell you sincerely,
I have never seen a troop like this.
If Kergel does not die,
If such person does not go to hell immediately,
Great exploit of Kirgiz will never be achieved."

Almanbet urged his steed away with rage after his words,

Left lion Manas beside the road.

Lion Manas thought for a long time,
Train of thought roared like waves:
"Kergel, you such a bastard.
It is all caused by you.
Because of your slander,
I lost my face,
In front of lion Almanbet."
Lion Manas looked around,
And stood there woodenly.

Brave hero Almanbet,
Gave Sariala steed a severe lash,
The steed leaped forward.

Look at this magical swift steed,
Its head swayed like antelope's head,
Its hair showed silver spots like beaver's hair.
Its mane shook,
As fast as the streamer in strong wind.
A pinch of white hair on top of its head,
Was shining as the moonlight.
Hooves knocked on the ground,
Amulet waved in the sky,
It went day and night without being fatigued.

Almanbet rode on his steed,
And went ahead for another sixteen days,
He arrived at Kobuldu bench-land.
Almanbet gave out the order,
The troops pitched camps.

The order spread over the troops,
Soldiers jumped for joy and laughter filled the valley.
"Oh, thanks for Khuda's blessing,
The day to have a rest finally comes."

Exhausted soldiers,
Were all rolled off the saddles.
They had no time to care their horses,
Had no time to remove saddles,
They lay on ground with arms and legs stretched,
It was like they went to their next life,
They all slept sound.

Horses saw Ayat river,
All dashed toward it,
Seeing horses running everywhere,
No one went to stop horses.

Almanbet attempted to stop horses,
"Ayi! Ayi!" he called ceaselessly.
No horse listened to him.
Almanbet hit on an idea suddenly,
He began to shout loudly,
"Kangayi, Kangayi, Kangayi!
Kaladay! Kaladay! Kaladay!"
The shout hovered like thunders.

When heard the name of Kangayi,
When the name Kaladay came to ears,
People opened their sleepy eyes in terror,
Got up in a hurry,
Stumbled and knocked each other,
Like stud rams were goring with each other,
They broke up in disorder.

Almanbet said when he saw this:
"Damned, you all should be lashed,
Go and get your horse quickly.
Then go back to take a good sleep.

"Anyone who complains from now on,
Like saying someone's horse gets a scab,

Saying others' horses will be infected.
Never let me hear such words,
Once I hear such words,
Do not blame me Almanbet,
I will not let such person be alive."

Soldiers ran to the river and led their horses back,
Almanbet then felt relieved.
Some put their heads together and whispered:
"Wish Khuda bless us,
This Ketay is so ferocious,
He gives us such a hard time."

Soldiers all went to sleep,
Generals were all quiet,
They all stretched their arms and legs happily.

Till this moment,
Almanbet began to feel relieved.
Drum was hanging on him,
He made the plans carefully:

"Muradiler of Kermzsha,
Has a bearing of Khan with his energetic looking.
As the general of stationing the frontier,
He comes here and patrols every year.

"That Kerzlart hill,
Is where he puts his sentry post.
Now it is time for him,
To go back from his patrol.

"I should seize the chance to go there,
And cut this ferocious enemy's head off.
Wipe the block on the expedition way,
And march toward Begin smoothly."

Almanbet made up his mind,
Without any hesitation.
Leaped on Sariala steed,
Galloped day and night,
Arrived at Kizil river and stopped.

He stared at the rapid river,
Rocks of pot size,
Were rolling forward in the river.
Ice of felt size,
Was floating on the surface of the river.

Sprays rolled with bubbles,
Dead twigs and leaves undulated in the river,
Big rocks stuck out from the river.
Big fish of horse and camel size,
Were thrown on the bank by huge waves,
Lay on the ground with mud all over them.

It was unable to detect the depth of the river,
Almanbet urged Sariala steed,
Jumped into the surging river.
Huge waves submerged the horseback immediately,
It became calm a moment later.

When he got to the center of the river,
It is impossible to control the rapid river,
Sariala steed was washed away like a lamb,
Almanbet was floating in the water like a hat.

He concentrated and bent down,
Reached out his left thumb,
Tightened the bridle tight,
Pushed the surging wave aside in his full strength,
Led Sariala steed,
Swam to the other side of the river.

Brave Sultan Almanbet,
Lived in Begin since he was little,
He was strong and young,
Always swam in the river,
He took to water like a duck.

Long-necked Sariala steed,
Shook water on its body off.
Brave hero Almanbet,
Finally defeated the raging river.
It was a day with burning sun and a cloudless sky,
Hero took off his battle robe and dried it in breeze.

Toward the evening,
Almanbet mounted again,
Went directly on Kerzlart hill.
He walked into the sentry post,
Enemies had returned at noon.

Almanbet watched carefully,
Found some arrows lying on where enemies slept.
Ash dug out from the tobacco pipe,
Was of the size of big yurt.

"I fail to capture the devil,
I just complain I come too late,
I do not fulfill my desire.

"I fail to rise the dust of expedition,
I fail to spill my blood,
I fail to cut his head off,
I fail to capture their fine steeds,
And drive back to our camp as spoils of war.
If people can jostle for spoils of war,
How proud and happy I will be."

Almanbet was very frustrated,

He watched the condition of roads ahead,
Then turned his steed round,
Went back to his camp soon.

He tied the magical steed,
On a big poplar tree,
Put a pillow under his head,
Stretched himself and fell into sleep.

Let us put this aside,
Talk about Kunwuer Bayi setting up defense secretly,
And how about his magical brute post.

Kunwuer Bayi's Brute Post Was Wrecked

After sleeping six days and six nights,
Soldiers all got up.
Almanbet puzzled his brains,
To arrange the next action.

He called all generals and soldiers in,
Gave out such order:
"The great barrier in front of us,
Is surging and rapid Erhun river.
If we do not use spells,
Not only cannot we cross the river,
But also we are facing the danger of total destruction.
Please all cheer up,
Tie your horses one after one."

Almanbet was absorbed in calling for wind and rain,
Put the magical rain-praying rock into water,
To cast his spell.

Clouds floated in the sky,
Rolled with strong wind suddenly.
A heavy snow with hail,
Descended in the wilderness right away.

Mountain area went into winter suddenly,
The basin was all over iced.
The joyful Erhun river,
In the hot season,
Now became a girl groaned in snow.

An arm-span width on the river,
Was totally covered with ice.
High officials sat in honorable seats,
Dare not come out from bedding.
Soldiers went to relieve themselves,
Dare not reach their hands out.

Almanbet gave out the order,
Soldiers all started off.
All troops stepped on the journey again,
Except Hohan soldiers.

Almanbet doubted,
And asked for the reason immediately.
Then he got to know,
Because they did not take good care,
One thousand horses froze to death at night.

Almanbet called Senchybek in,
Blamed him of not managing his soldiers well.
Where were the horses now?
Almanbet gave the order with wrath:
"Executioners, come on,
Cut the head of Senchybek off now!"
Executioners got ready to take action as one,
Surrounded Senchybek in the center.

Giant Berita and Garmgirchy,
Heard the discussion from others:
"Soldiers of Senchybek made a thousand horses frozen to death,
Our commander Almanbet,
Is going to kill him with rage."

They were worried about Senchybek's life:
"The damned Senchybek,
Do not lose his innocent life."
They came in a rush to appeal to Senchybek's mercy.

Garmgirchy said first:
"We have some spare horses,
We can provide mounts for them.
We come here specially,
Beg you to forgive him.
Since it has happened,
We only can blame him of his carelessness."

Berita continued to talk sincerely:
"Hero Almanbet, please listen to me,
Totally we have fifty four Lik troops come,
Ayikoler Manas leads the troops for expedition personally.

"There are Khans, soldiers,
Young men, old men.
They do not die in battlefield,
Do not spit out blood and pass away at home.

"Now it is not enemies' death,
It is the sacrifice of our fellows,
The person to be executed is not a common soldier,
He is a Khan and he is well-known.

"Our career cannot be fulfilled if it goes this way,
It will leave us the lifelong regret.
Almanbet,
We can offer our horses,
We can go on foot by ourselves."

Giant Berita and Garmgirchy,
Appealed so sincerely,
Almanbet gave Senchybek to them two,
Against his will.

They took Senchybek back to the camp,
Offered five hundred horses respectively.
They started off without any delay,

Expedition troops mounted and set out again.

Almanbet whipped and urged the steed,
Came to Kizil river of Erhun.
He glared and watched carefully,
He witnessed the river a few days ago,
The raging river,
Now was totally dried up.
On the wide riverbed,
Only a mere trickle wound its way ahead.

When the troops waded across the river,
Went through narrow valley,
Climbed on the path only ox and colt can pass soon,
Almanbet ordered to count the number of soldiers.

The result of roll-call was,
Khans and soldiers were all safe.
Ten-soldier leader Tazbaymart,
Only one of his soldiers was missing.

"You are the leader,
Who is this soldier and where did he get lost? "
Tazbaymart shuddered with terror,
Reported to Almanbet in a trembling voice:
"At Kordoy mountain pass,
I counted my soldiers,
Together with me there were totally ten.
I went at the end of the group,
I am afraid to lose any of them."

Iron-hearted Almanbet,
Refused to listen to the explanation of Tazbaymart.
"I only give one order,
Anyone tells lies should be sentenced to death.

"Executioners come and take actions now,

Capture this man now!
Take his ten-soldier clothes off,
Throw him into deep pool."

The news went to the ears of Manas,
He cared much about this matter.
He called Sirk in,
Ordered Sirk carefully:
"Go and find Almanbet,
Deliver my words to him.

"You go and check soldiers roster carefully,
To see which soldier on earth got lost.
Even if he must sentence someone,
We must let the person be convinced,
We cannot hurt innocent people."

Sirk took Khan's command,
He was astute to deal with such thing.
He was like the shade under the sun,
At the critical moment,
He was always ready to play his role.

Sirk galloped at top speed,
Came before Almanbet in a hurry.
His words became classic,
Which spread among people till now.

"My respected commander Almanbet,
Please listen to my advice,
Call your clerical staff in now,
Let him read the roster carefully."

Almanbet accepted Sirk's advice,
Asked the clerical staff to read the roster carefully:
"Go through Tazbaymart's roster quickly,
I cannot brew disaster because of my mistake."

Clerical staff carried the thick rolls of roster,
Looked over the roster from cover to cover.
The soldier Tazbaymart lost,
Was right lion Khan Manas.
The name of Manas jumped into their eyes,
Tazbaymart then turned from danger to safety.

Tazbaymart went wild with joy,
Like a crazy eagle,
Galloped to Khan Manas:
"Khan, how I can forget you,
My humble life is nearly doomed.
Your Ketay lackey ordered to kill me.

"Eagle, because I forget you,
I face endless disaster,
The lackey from Kangayi,
Almost makes me done."

"Even Manas was forgotten,
Whom else Baymart could remember!"
These words passed down generation to generation.

After the unexpected turn,
Tazbaymart① kept his life safe,
Facing the careless ten-soldier leader,
Manas burst into hearty laughter,
With his beard shaking,
"Tazbaymart,
You are my ten-soldier leader,
But to my surprise, you forgot me.

"How damned I am,
Among only ten people,

① Tazbaymart: Baymart is his name. Because he is bald, people were used to calling him Taz(Bald)baymart.

I am the one who is forgotten,
It seems I should go close to soldiers often!

"Baymart, I am unexpectedly forgotten by you.
Since it's the trouble you called in,
I should not mind your business."

Seeing soldiers were all safe,
Hero Almanbet beamed with smiles.
Seeing the troops remained whole,
Sultan Almanbet was simply delighted.

If looking for the track from legend,
It was necessary to know the expedition place,
There was a bubbled lake,
That was called Kokcherl lake of Elaman,
It was a unique strange lake,
Something weirder happened beside the lake.

Almanbet called in Khans and generals,
Gave out orders to them:
"You will pitch camp here and spend three-month winter.
There are many strange stories here,
Please listen carefully.

"There is an animal called Sankoru①,
Its urine can burn,
Make the burning place barren forever.
In front of its den,
No animal dared to approach.

"If it meets with people face to face,
It will grab people's heart directly.
If it chews rocks,
Just like eating soft naan.

① Sankoru: It is the monster in legend.

"Another animal is called Kaygolu[①],
It has a wing on one side of its body,
But there is no wing,
On the other side of its body.

"These two animals combine together,
Form one whole body,
Turn into bird flying in the sky,
Its droppings rained when it saw people.

"Its wing is as hard as pure steel blade,
Its tail is of an armful,
You need hide soon when meeting with it.

"Sankoru and Kaygolu,
Are deadly poisonous all over its body.
If you meet it suddenly,
Do not be panic-stricken.

"Take off dress shields of steeds,
Burn in the fire.
Take out men's insoles,
Burn in the fire too,
Since the smell of steeds' sweat and men's sweat,
Runs into its nose,
It cannot fly again.

"Argali will not die easily even it is old,
Till the end of its life,
It can never see human being.

"Wild deer run in the wilderness,
Their figures appear on every hill.
As they see a living person,
They will smell you continually.

① Kaygolu: It is the strange bird with one wing in legend.

"It is Kumsari in the south,
Warriors are on patrol there.
It is Gobi desert in the east,
It is boundless full of rocks.

"You do not go there recklessly.
If you meet enemies,
Merciless attack must be called in.
Since we keep a good lookout and are on the alert,
We can enjoy our freedom here,
And get complete rest."

Got orders from Almanbet,
Young men began to play freely.
Loosed steeds' halters,
Poked into place between deer horns,
With the long spears in the hands.
Many spears hung on deer horns,
Soldiers lost spears returned with empty hands.

"Shoot the deer quickly,
Cut it to death from that side."
"If the deer kick on my chest,
I will lose my humble life."

"The damned deer,
It drags my spear away."
Soldiers shouted,
They flew their tamed eagles,
And received meat for three-month winter.

Almanbet turned it over in his mind,
Began to arrange for the future.
Noble Khans,
Almanbet invited them all,
His mood was like the sunny sky,
He spoke excitedly:

"We have rested for a long time,
Soldiers and horses all rest well.
Karamark people Kunwuer Bayi,
Has too many magical tricks unknown by others.

"On the way of our expedition against Begin,
There are lots of things you do not know,
I need explain to you in details.

"In the lower reaches of Kokchel,
There is a lake wild ducks rest,
Dangers hide everywhere there.

"Go north for two days from there,
There is a towering mountain Ackulja①.
Continue going forward from there,
That is the desolate Gobi foxes haunt.

"Crafty Ketay people,
Have many mysterious things.
They choose agile animals as their sentries,
Those are animals but smarter than human beings.

"If we do not wipe out these barriers,
We cannot get to Begin city,
It is difficult to move even one step forward,
We have to go on our retuning journey.

"Ayikoler Manas and Bakay,
Chuwak and I,
We will lead forty warriors and start off,
Prepare well and plan well,
To deal with those mysterious wild ducks and foxes.

"Uncle Koshaoyi and hero Toshtuk,

① Ackulja: It means white argali in Kirgiz language.

Garmgirchy and Senchybek,
Kelkokuler and Ageshi,
Yurbi and Muzburchak,
You all please halt the troops and wait,
Feel at ease to station here.

"In twenty days,
We must return in triumph.
If it is a smooth journey,
We can capture wild ducks on the lake,
Shoot wild goats in mountains.
Trap foxes in Gobi desert,
Knock out Kunwuer Bayi's brute post,
We must win the victory.

"You can fully enjoy,
Taste fresh wild goat,
Smell the fresh meat of wild ducks happily,
You all will be thoroughly delighted.
I will let you wear fox-skin coats,
I will let you marry Ketay beauties.
You wait for our good news,
You need prepare Suyinchy for reporting good news."

Almanbet told Khans clearly about this,
Said goodbye and mounted.
Under the leadership of Ayikoler,
Forty warriors stepped on a hard journey.

Powerful enemies blocked the way,
In order to wipe out their animal sentries,
They started off in the morning,
Hurried ahead without stop day and night.
Warriors had arrived,
At the big lake where wild white ducks haunted.

The troops got to a rock hill,

Almanbet said in a reverent manner:
"My lucky uncle Bakay,
I need explain to you now.
You station and wait here please,
Do not complain I give orders.

"We will crowd around,
Look for wild ducks in dense reed.
If it is the destined time for white ducks,
We can get them shot.
If we do not shoot them,
Just let them go off luckily.

"My respected uncle,
Please guard the pass carefully,
White ducks will not fly high into sky,
They will just flap their wings,
And skim low over the ground.
Like swaying the whip,
Rose dust up.

"If it appears in front of you,
If you see it begins to flap its wings,
Try to escape from our hands,
Please aim at it.
If it flee away from your hand,
Then we will fall in danger.

"Please stare at clouds in the sky,
It will fly over clouds.
It flies all day without stop during daytime,
It does not sleep at night and continues flying,
It attracts enemies to this place.

"Lion Ayikoler Manas,
Do not shoot the wild duck personally,
You will be completely discredited if you shoot it,

This is the magical power the wild duck has."
Ayikoler Manas, giant Bakay,
Ambushed at the rock hill.

When the sun rose,
Heroes arrived at where the wild duck haunted.
Mysterious wild duck craned its head,
Opened its eyes wide and looked around.
The cunning wild duck,
Recognized Almanbet at a glance,
He used to feed it personally.

The duck thought over:
"Almanbet will see me,
I must wait quietly."
It lowered its body and lay in the mire,
Hid itself in the reed quietly.

Almanbet got the edge of the lake,
Said to his fellows:
"Forty warriors led by Kergel,
Chuwak please remembers my words clearly.

"Load bullets in your firelocks,
You must not load single shot,
Need load with full of grapeshot,
Ignite all fuses.
Even if a single wild duck in the lake flies away,
We will be in great danger."

Almanbet lifted the apple-head firelock,
Loaded with grapeshot.
Took out arrows beside him,
Gave his whole attention to draw the bow.

Ketay-style drums,
Beat by him suddenly loud enough to shake the sky.

With the noise of fluttering,
Startled wild ducks flew into sky,
And covered the sun and the sky.

Let Khuda bless,
Big noise deafened ears,
The sound of firelocks and arrows mixed together.

No single duck fled away,
Dead ducks dropped in the lake.
Carcasses of wild ducks in disorder,
Spread all across the earth instantly.

Almanbet examined carefully,
Said to Chuwak who stood beside him:
"Chuwak, my brother,
So many wild ducks died,
But there is still one duck that does not show up.

"It was not shining in the sky,
No golden light showed up.
On the tail of that wild white duck,
Precious diamond is inlaid.

"Both tips of its wings,
Wrapped with glittering gold flakes.
Because it is so magical,
It was not attacked by eagles.
All birds could do nothing with it,
White duck occupied the swamp.

"You start off right now,
Load your firelock.
Do not wet the fuse,
You cannot shoot a dud at the critical moment.

"Ask twenty people to stare at the sky,

Do not let the cunning wild duck,
Fly into sky follow the stars.
Ask another twenty search around,
Do not let it cheat our eyes,
Skim away over the ground."

Almanbet and Chuwak stood shoulder to shoulder,
He whispered to his fellow:
"Chuwak, my brother, please listen to me,
The damned wild duck is unusual,
It is a great disaster hanging over our heads.

"Ducks hide in the lake,
Had all been shot by us,
Only that duck did not show up.

"Maybe it had found us,
And hid behind the reed quietly,
Hid in the lake.
It may stay there still,
To avoid from our sight.

"We are skilled in the same level,
My brother, listen to me.
There is one reed like the spear barrel,
It seems that it shakes a little bit.
A mysterious shape,
Always sways in front of my eyes.

"Please do not feel wronged,
Take off your boots and sneak ahead.
You should walk on tiptoe,
To the reed in the front.
And bend down quietly,
Grasp its wings tight.

"I will draw the bow,

Once it flies I will shoot it.
If I make noise in water when I walk to it,
When the water goes deep to my waist,
It will take the chance and fly into sky.

" 'I must be shot when flying into sky,
To be shot even on the lake.'
Cunning wild white duck may flee away under the water,
You can catch it alive under the water."

Chuwak should get the curse of Khuda,
He did not listen to Almanbet's words:
"I cannot walk into the lake,
I cannot take off my boots and socks,
If I cannot see the wild duck in the reed,
How can I catch it?

"Since you know the habits of the wild duck,
Why don't you go and catch it personally?
If the duck escapes from your hands,
I will not let it off easily."
Since Chuwak said like this,
Almanbet had no more words to say.

Almanbet had to take his clothes off,
Took off his felt hat and showed his bare head,
Rolled the pants up to his knees,
Took off boots and socks and showed his bare feet,
Walked into the waist-high water with no hesitation.

Almanbet stood there,
The cunning duck had already moved to other place.
Almanbet stumbled forward,
Groped toward the target.

There was no support in the water,
He groped in waist-high water.

As he walked ahead the water got deeper,
It went as high as his neck,
Lake water went into his nose and choked him.

The lake bottom was very uneven,
He could not draw the bow.
Wild white duck found Almanbet,
It had to find a chance to get away.

The wild duck was glittering in the lake,
It was like a fish.
It glided forward quietly,
Rushed to the belly of Chuwak's steed.

When it got to the steed tail,
The cunning duck flew into sky suddenly.
None of forty warriors led by Kergel,
Saw the duck flying away.

Almanbet looked for it in the lake,
He did not find it throughout.
As Almanbet had no way to deal with it,
The noise from Bakay's Tashbaran firelock,
Crossed the sky and went into his ears.

"Could it be that the damned duck has flown away?
Uncle Bakay lifted his firelock to shoot,
From the dull sound of the firelock,
It seems the duck has been shot dead."

Hero Almanbet went wild with joy,
Got out of the water immediately.
He had no time to put on his clothes and boots,
Leaped on Sariala steed with bare feet,
Galloped to the direction Bakay stationed at top speed.

Let's look at the elder Bakay,

He was ambushed in the mountain col,
He found a hollow place,
Wore the sunshade cover over his eyes.
Ancient people did this,
Who knew the secret of their eyesight.

Bakay held Baran firelock in his hand,
Facing the valley to the lake,
Monitored it with a fixed eye.

Characters of the wild white duck Almanbet said,
Had carved in his mind.
His long beard swayed on his chin,
Bent down with his eyes fixed.
A shade of whip handle size,
Flew over his head.
"Is it an animal or just dust?
Or is it that white duck flying secretly,
It might have dodged from Almanbet's hunting,
It is trying to flee for its life."

Startled wild white duck skimmed over his head,
After the careful calculation,
Bakay aimed at the target and lit the fuse.
The fuse burned out slowly,
Then the flaming bullet rushed ahead out of the firelock.

A distance of one rope long,
Was right at the end of the range.
The bullet pierced the neck of the duck,
Its wings shined under the sun,
The wild white duck fell off on the ground.

Lion Manas arrived in time,
Did not know what happened with the duck.
Almanbet with bare feet and bare upper body,
With mud and grass all over him,

Rode on Sariala steed and arrived.

He dismounted hurriedly,
Bent down and picked the duck up,
Spitted on the duck happily,
And tied the duck on the saddle of Manas' steed.

Chuwak held Almanbet's boots and clothes,
Whipped his steed with an embarrassed looking,
He arrived in time with no delay.

Almanbet put on his clothes,
Said frankly:
"Come on, heroes, let's go!"
The heroes continued going forward,
Almanbet kept silent,
And made the plan to eliminate wild white argali secretly.

Heroes fed their steeds and rested,
Tasted the delicacy leisurely.
The lonely pine trees mountain,
Grass where wild argali hid,
Heroes went ahead toward their target.

Under mountains big head argali lived,
Eight valleys joined together,
Over them was towering high peaks.

Crisscrossed and led in all directions,
Nine roads joined here,
There were thirty mountain passes,
Straight cliff was on this mountain.
The highest peak of the mountain,
Was called Tutinchok peak.

That white big head argali,
Went to the peak once every six days.

From the entry of the thirty valleys,
To the junction of the nine roads,
Almanbet watched around carefully.

Almanbet counted on his fingers,
Counted the days one after one.
If the argali did not come in the morning,
At dusk,
It would be the time the argali went to patrol on the peak.

Almanbet thought for a long time,
Said to the warriors:
"Tonight, we will push on with our journey,
We can get on the mountaintop tomorrow morning.

"I count the days carefully,
Day and night,
Now it is the time the cunning argali,
To go on to the mountaintop.

"If it climbs on the mountain,
It must find us.
It must run swiftly,
Back to Begin to report.

"Kunwuer Bayi will get the news of our coming,
Aisanhan always stations in Begin,
He does not move to other places,
He will get to know the truth too.

"Kangayi people from sixty cities,
Must turn out.
Generals and soldiers gather together,
In Tonsha city.

"We must not let the argali climb on the peak,
We should launch an attack to it before that.

Diminish it as soon as possible,
Then go to deal with cunning foxes."

Almanbet guided carefully,
Forty warriors divided into nine groups,
Garrisoned the nine valleys and rivers respectively.
Divided forty warriors into groups fairly,
He did not choose specially.

There was a valley called Chinkolt,
If the argali chose a way to flee,
That was the only way it could choose.
There was another path which was easy to go through,
Called Titirjilga valley.

Chinkolt was garrisoned by Manas personally,
Titirjilga valley,
Was garrisoned by uncle Bakay.

There was some doubt in the mind of Almanbet,
Warned warriors again and again:
"Male and female argali are both numerous in number,
Do not mistake the white male argali;
Do not urge your horses,
Move back and forth casually.

"If male argali run out,
Please open your eyes wide and watch carefully.
The male argali we will kill,
Is the one with grey short hair all over its body.

"Iron wire is installed on its horn,
In the black night with no moon,
It was shining like burning flames,
It is its biggest character.

"Respected fellow Chuwak,

We are very close and talk everything with each other,
You go with me side by side.
Go to intercept the path of big head argali,
At Tuyinchok peak.

"I will explain everything to you,
I will use Almabash firelock to shoot,
Whether I will shoot the target,
You can judge from the sound.

"You do not shoot casually,
You'd better shoot in turn.
No matter who shoots the male argali,
Do not cut its head off immediately,
Put it at the original place with its head facing north."

Almanbet gave his steed a severe lash,
"Hero, it's our time to start off!"
Whether Chuwak obeyed his order,
Others had no way to know it.

Two warriors were like tigers rushed down the hill,
Came to the front of the mountain fast.
They dismounted agilely,
And climbed on the steep cliff secretly.

White light gleamed in the sky,
The earth was dimmed.
Eyebrow-like first faint glimmer of dawn appeared,
A breeze caressed the cheeks.

In the sky to the east,
Rosy clouds of dawn were like burning flames,
Red morning lights faded and sun rose,
Brightened the earth and mountains.
Yellow desert like fish scale,
Had remained the same till today.

If someone came here,
He would find the yellow desert,
With too many egg-size cobbles,
Which were all of the color of milk.
It would make sounds when stepped on them,
Walking on them,
Was like plucking Kumuz strings,
The sound traveled far away.
In order to deliver the message,
Ketay people remade the Gobi desert like this.

If the male argali was sleeping,
Almanbet knew what to do with it:
"Hero Chuwak, please come here,
You should concentrate,
Keep watching quietly here.

"I will take off my boots,
Creep forward with my socks on.
Get close to the target slowly,
Try to take the argali's life."

Almanbet took off his boots,
Crawled forward slowly,
Suddenly he found,
Chuwak was behind him.

"My respected Arakai[①]!
Where is that famous male argali?
You start off with bare feet,
But left me aside without any concern.
To shoot this mysterious male argali,
I will try my best too.

"If I aim at the argali,

① Arakai: The nickname friend gave to Almanbet.

I will never let it flee away.
Once I went to hunt snow cocks,
I never let them off.

"Since you have known this secret,
Please explain to me clearly.
As long as I meet it face to face,
I can shoot it."
Chuwak decided all by himself,
Insisted on going together with Almanbet.

Almanbet said to Chuwak:
"We argue here senselessly,
We must be discovered by the argali.
The damned animal is very intelligent,
It must flee away.
Our plan will fall to the ground,
All our efforts and hard work will be wasted.

"You bend down and look at the argali,
There is an old pine tree in the front,
There are roads on both sides to escape.
Do not let it run away.
You have the idea to shoot it,
But you must creep forward slowly to approach."

Almanbet let Chuwak go first,
He guarded in the rear,
With bare feet and bare upper body.

Chuwak bent down and stared at the pine tree,
That was a huge old tree,
It casted a yard-size shadow.
No matter how careful he observed,
He could not find the male argali.

Chuwak could not make up his mind,

He turned round and patrolled backwards.
Right at this moment,
The male argali found Chuwak.

The cunning male argali,
Said to itself:
"This guy does not come alone,
Because he looks backwards again and again.
Could it be that they have set trap,
And surrounded me in the center? "

The male argali swayed its head,
Watched around carefully,
Looked for the direction and prepared to flee.

Branches of the pine tree shook slightly,
Agile Chuwak had noticed too,
He held his breath and watched carefully.
Chuwak placed the firelock on the rock,
Got ready to light the fuse,
To shoot the cunning game.

Right at this moment,
The cunning male argali had a brainwave,
Ran off along the mountain road.
Chuwak saw its figure,
Squinted his eyes and aimed carefully.

He made a shot at the male argali.
The bullet pierced left side of the argali's belly,
A piece of felt-size skin fell off,
The startled argali jumped down into deep valley.

Almanbet crept forward with bare feet,
Left the bow behind.
He held the firelock in his hand,
Opened his eyes wide and looked ahead.

Chuwak stood there still blankly,
Like a gunman lost his game.

The big head argali ran desperately,
It almost ran into a cave,
That was not far in front of it.

"If it runs into the cave,
Our whole plan will be ruined."
Almanbet bared his feet,
Shook his wide trousers legs,
Chased after the male argali tight,
Regardless of knife-sharp rocks cutting his sole,
Ran fast like flying.

The male argali could not enter the cave,
Could not break through Almanbet's blocking either,
It had to run on a bumpy path,
Ran desperately like a gale.

"It wants to run away,
The skin on it
Is so magical."
Almanbet chased with full of his energy,
Rocks under his feet were as sharp as blades.

Every time he lifted his feet,
Blood ran down along his soles.
Rocks were reddened by his blood,
Almanbet was like an eagle spread its wings,
Bore the great pain and chased tight.

Magical creator,
Endowed people different characters.
The cunning male argali,
Went over the mountains and rivers around three valleys.

Almanbet rushed on the hill,
Intercepted the big head argali head-on.
A breeze blew in the face,
The male argali nosed the smell of Almanbet,
It turned round in a hurry,
Ran to the north side of the mountain.

Almanbet took his firelock down his shoulder,
And placed it on a rock right away.
Aimed at the running game in the mountain,
The bullet flew to the big head argali.

The bullet of the magical firelock Almabash,
Could not let the cunning argali run away.
A bucket-size pellet,
Shot into the neck of the big head argali directly.
The argali fell and convulsed on the ground,
Almanbet never made his shot wasted,
Proud expression shined on his face.

Almanbet tried to go forward,
But both his feet were dripping with blood,
His legs were impossible to walk,
He had to stay still there woodenly.

Ambushed giant Bakay,
Heard the sharp shot suddenly,
"Has Chuwak already shot the argali? "
He thought over and over.

A moment later,
The sound of the magical firelock went into his ears,
"Almanbet must have shot it."
He hurried forward like an eagle.

Uncle Bakay gazed carefully,
He saw Almanbet bearing an abnormal looking.

The soles of the hero,
Was horribly mangled and bloody.

Tendons were broken, and could be seen,
Some had disappeared,
Did not need careful look,
White bones just burst into your eyes.

"Damned Chuwak, look at what you did."
Almanbet was filled with rage,
His face was too ghastly to look at,
Stretched himself and lay on his back on the ground.

As seeing Bakay,
Almanbet poured out his complaints:
"Respected uncle Bakay,
I have shot the male argali to the ground,
Did not let it run away.

"Please look at my feet,
Because Chuwak did not obey my order,
Then I am pushed so far like this,
With pain and with broken tendons.

"Please according to the rules,
Make the argali head north,
Lie on the ground."

Bakay walked to the argali,
Only two horns were still hanging on its head,
Its eyes and nose,
Had shot away by the bullet.

He made the argali head north,
But he did not see any blood of the argali.
Though Bakay was over seventy years old,
He bent down from the horseback and lifted the argali.

The elder was highly skilled in catching sheep,
He carried the argali with its head,
With prestigious looking.

As Almanbet saw this,
He told Bakay immediately:
"Uncle, please listen to me,
I will tell you the story of the argali.
I was worried about destroying its carcass,
So I specially shot on its head.

"Please dismount right now,
And cut its throat.
I will use its blood from its artery,
To apply on my legs gently.

"Once Jurando mentioned,
Blood of the wild argali,
Can cure all kinds of wounds."

Bakay dare not hesitate when he heard this,
He dismounted and slashed immediately,
Applied the blood of the argali,
On the wound of Almanbet.
Before the blood got dry,
Almanbet could walk again.

Right at this moment,
Ayikoler Manas arrived with his Ackura steed.
Others also in a mad rush to the first,
No one dared to run slow!
Chuwak led Sariala steed,
Whistled and came with slow paces leisurely.
When he saw the wound of Almanbet,
He asked without knowing anything:
"What did you do?
Your feet seem to be soaked in blood."

"Chuwak, you did not shoot the argali dead,
I was worried the argali would run away,
So I chased it desperately.

"I, dignified Almanbet,
Broke nearly all my feet tendons,
And almost became a cripple.
I have to immerse my feet in the male argali blood,
To avoid the permanent disability."

He asked to take out the gall of the argali,
Applied on his wound,
The wound stopped bleeding soon,
Blood clotted immediately.

Almanbet said:
"I will talk about,
How magical the white duck's feather is.
No matter which hero,
Sways it three times,
Considers it as his coat,
People in Begin will mistake him as Kunwuer Bayi,
Salute him with hands hanging aside,
Beyond doubt, it will work at least once.

"If the male argali skin is dried under the sun,
And makes it into cloak and wears it.
It will be like my father Khan Sorandick's cloak,
It is too hard to distinguish the real one from it,
People wears it will get the power my father had.

"They are as magical as I said,
With the help of their magical power,
If god blesses us,
We can beat back enemies' attack at least once.

"If we can capture the white fox,

Skin it and tie on the saddle,
Keep it carefully,
It will not be a bad thing,
We can use it to exchange a beautiful girl.

"The wild white duck is mysterious,
It is gold outside and flesh inside.
The duck meat is fresh and tender,
The head and heart of the duck,
Right suits Sultan Manas' appetite.
Troops go on expedition with him,
Khans please share the meat of the male argali."

Tazbaymart took them two rear legs of the argali,
Let Khans taste the fresh meat of the argali.
In order to look for the white fox,
They turned their steed and kept searching.

"Wild ducks have been wiped out,
The water way has been cleared.
We shot the male argali dead on the hillside,
The mountain road is also cleared.

"We need manage to catch the fox,
And dodge the monitoring of Kunwuer Bayi,
Approach its den secretly,
And launch an attack surprisingly."

Warriors were all in high spirits,
Rode on their horses confidently.
Their feet stepped in the stirrups tight,
Some raised their heads proudly,
Some warned each other to be cautious.

In order to look for the white fox,
They looked all the way and kept going quietly.
To avoid the white fox's sight,

They marched ahead slowly,
Did not rise dust behind them at all.
Like soundless clouds moving forward,
Heroes searched ahead secretly.

Almanbet began to say:
"The troop please go in order,
Do not make any noise.
The cunning fox has a sharp nose,
It has extraordinary abilities.

"From the three-day distance,
It can nose the strange smell,
This is its most obvious feature.
I will make the strange smell to confuse it,
You guys please control yourselves and bear the smell,
Do not make complaints.

"Where to stop and where to start off,
Listen to and obey my order strictly.
Any road the fox passes no other animals dare go,
It also never let other animals approach itself.
It always changes unpredictably,
It can change to seven different animals like rabbit, cat and so on.

"It can change to poison snake,
Wriggles on the ground.
It can change to mouse,
Runs to everywhere agilely.

"It can change to turtle and crawls forward slowly,
It can change to hedgehog with poison spikes over its back.
It can change to lizard and turns easily to everywhere,
Lives in dry wilderness,
Does not need any water.

"If we let it run away,

It must bring countless enemies to us.
If we alert the powerful enemies,
We will be utterly routed without any surprise."

Almanbet warned again and again,
His words made everyone startled.

Mist covered over mountains,
Clouds and fog scudded,
Down along the valley,
It was shockingly smoky.

Like the gamy smell of wild goats,
The mist spreading all over mountains,
Made people have no place to hide.
Valleys and gullies around,
Were filled with the smoke in a blink of an eye.

Almanbet was extraordinarily excited,
He shouted out his order:
"Warriors make preparation to start off please,
Four heroes stay here."
He divided forty warriors into four groups,
Did not put Kergel in any group.
Divided them into groups,
And ordered them to guard ten valley passes.

"Respected uncle Bakay,
Please climb on the top of the mountain,
Monitor the actions of forty warriors.
Each group goes separately,
Urge your horses and begin to act."

Almanbet went shoulder to shoulder with Manas,
Said to Manas:
"My brother, lion Manas,
We are brothers feeding with one mom's milk,

Hero Chuwak,
Is outstanding and brave,
If I cannot shoot the white fox dead,
I should go to die for my faults.

"This is a towering peak,
There is a basin in its center.
And ten valleys are around it,
All valleys collect together.

"The habitat of the cunning fox,
Is called Kaloldoby peak.
I will not spare my steed,
Gallop toward the peak at top speed.

"I will watch carefully,
Whether the fox has nosed our track.
There is a desert in the distance of a steed can run,
Whether the fox will come out,
No one knows it.
In order to get the track of the fox,
I have made a snow descend in the desert.

"I will go there alone,
Watch the movement of the fox.
If the fox doubts the mist,
It will climb on the top of the peak.

"If it runs up to the peak top,
I must beat drums aloud,
Hold the flag and wave it on the peak top,
You all just spare no efforts to launch an attack.

"If the fox has already climbed on the top,
We must whip and urge our steeds at top speed,
We may get the chance to kill it.
If it still hides in the desert,

I will look down from the peak top,
And take its life."

Almanbet finished his words,
Whipped his steed and galloped ahead.

The yellow steed was as agile as antelope,
Clenched the bit and raised its head.
Almanbet went down long the slope,
Came to the desert to watch the track of the fox.

The fox did not take any action,
Almanbet cast a spell,
A gale arose from ground in an instant.

Clouds cleared away and mist disappears soon,
In the distance of one-day journey in wilderness,
Was sunny and clear.

The fox hid in the cave,
Sank its head deep in its forelegs:
"The bad whether descends and disappears suddenly,
Does it mean disaster will descend on me?

"It is so quiet here for three days,
Is there anything behind it?
It is the time only enough of making a pot of tea,
Does Almanbet cast a spell,
And clear the mist outside of the cave?"

The cunning fox craned its head out of its cave,
Watched carefully around the cave.
It nosed the smell again and again,
Smell of the medicine filled the air,
It could not distinguish any smell clearly.

"Does the god want to punish me,

Want to end my life?
Has the spell cast by Almanbet,
Already defeated me? "

The fox was too worried to be at ease,
It ran at top speed to Kaloldoby peak.
It nosed the smell continually,
Ran and jumped forward fast.

Almanbet tried to catch it by strategy,
Suddenly he remembered a past event.
Aisanhan once buried brass bell in the sand,
In order to subdue the enemy.

Once enemies' troops stepped on the bell,
The sound could spread as far as six-day journey distance.
If beat the bell with iron stick,
Sound of the bell would change.

Almanbet was very familiar with the bell,
He knew the story behind it clearly:
"Let the cunning fox have a wrong impression,
That mistakes Muradiler's coming as inspecting."

When thinking about this,
Almanbet drew out an iron stick under his saddle.
Bashed the hill where the brass bell was buried.

The mountain of ten valleys,
Who knew its mystery?
With an earth-shaking loud noise,
Rivers flowed back and mountains moved.

Those coward soldiers,
Were scared out of their wits.
Some lowered their voice,
Blamed Almanbet secretly as a poison scorpion:

"Before we arrive in Ketay place,
We may separate with our families forever."

Hero Almanbet,
Lifted the iron stick in his hand,
The stick flew away immediately,
Only left the handle in his hand.

"If Kunwuer Bayi comes to the post,
If my father Khan Sorandick is the commander,
Their battle robes,
Will be put in the iron box.

"This is what I did not know in the past,
It happened here now.
When I capture the fox,
Then I will know all these clearly."
Almanbet was lost in thought.

Before Almanbet folded its wings of thinking,
In order to check the situation of the road to Kangayi,
The cunning fox looked right and left,
Had arrived at the bottom of Karaldoby mountain,
Went onto a cyan desert.

As soon as its fore claws stepped on the desert,
It found the hoof prints of Sariala steed,
It was scared as its claws were burned,
It began to think about it with fear:

"The hoof prints in front of me,
Are very strange to me and I never see them before.
The steed of such hoof print,
Does not come from Begin at all.
No matter who its master is,
The person must be unusual.
Sorandick's son Almanbet,

He is never an enemy easy to defeated."

The fox was beset by doubts,
Suddenly turned round and ran aside.
Then dashed down the hill madly.

Almanbet urged his steed and chased,
Dust risen behind was high to the sky.
The fox concentrated on fleeing away,
It did not notice that,
It was running to the place where Chuwak ambushed.

Forty warriors grouped by every four of them,
Were fully alert and watched the track of the fox.
Warriors good at using spears,
Held the spears tight in their hands.
Marksman held the ignited fuse,
Just waited for the fox coming.

Warriors good at using sabre,
Drew out the sabre and prepared.
As a bloody battle,
It was going to start between Kirgiz and Ketay.

Heroes were fully alert nervously,
Archers good at shooting,
Prepared their bows and arrows ready.

When they were ready and waiting,
Suddenly Chuwak found the track of the fox.
Chuwak was highly skilled and brave,
The spear he poked out never missed the target.

Chuwak rode on Koktikai steed,
Did not let the fox off,
He was very anxious to attack immediately.
Clouds of dust covered the sand ridge,

Chuwak attacked from aside,
It seemed he wanted to let the fox die right away.

Almanbet was worried when he saw this:
"Chuwak may lose the good chance,
The fox must find a chance to flee away."
Almanbet was fully alert,
He was ready to attack,
He would not let the fox run away.

Chuwak dashed out from one side,
The cunning fox turned round quickly,
Talked to itself:
"This guy is like a sturdy tree,
It is hard to break with luxuriant foliage,
Facing such powerful enemy,
I should fight bravely.

"All passes of the mountain,
Have been blocked by this guy.
It seems I cannot run away easily,
I have to change to other shapes."

At the moment when Chuwak's spear poked out,
It leaped fast and dodged the danger.
The spear hero Chuwak poked,
Ran deeply in the sand.
"Damned fox gets its end point,
It must be poked by my spear."

Chuwak drew out his spear,
Checked the point of the spear carefully,
The fox had already fled away,
Even a hair of the fox was not found on the spear.

The fox had a quick idea in the emergency,
Dodged the chasing of Chuwak,

The cunning fox turned into a rabbit,
Watched around with its ears shrank.

It worried Almanbet would come,
So it ran and looked back continually.
Almanbet concentrated,
Drew his bow and aimed at the fox.

The fox exercised all its skills,
Ran in all directions.
Like a bullet being shot,
Hid in a secret place.

The rabbit had fled away,
But Chuwak did not notice it at all.
When it went to the distance of one arrow could shoot,
At a corner,
The rabbit was found by black mane wolf Manas.

Manas whipped and urged his steed,
Ackura steed galloped fast,
Went head-on to intercept the rabbit.

He whipped his steed and chased,
Fixed his eyes on the rabbit.
In front of lion Manas at this moment,
Three deep ravines appeared.

Hero Ayikoler Manas,
Was stopped by the deep ravines.
Ackura was an unusual magical steed,
It jumped over the three ravines.

Lion Manas could not see the rabbit again,
Ackura chased according to its feeling.
When the hoof of the steed almost stepped on the fox,
The fox turned into a mouse and sneaked forward.

Ackura was fatigued with profuse sweat,
Beads of sweat fell as raindrops.
The cunning fox deceived Manas,
Dodged the deadly attack again.

They four all felt terribly ashamed.
Stretched their tongues one-span long,
They four chased with full of their energy,
But still made the cunning fox flee away.

In order to keep chasing the cunning fox,
Two heroes stayed,
The other two continued to chase.

"They are all extraordinary people,
It is hard for me to get out of danger.
If I fight to the end with them,
I must lose my life."

The cunning fox thought carefully,
Secretly chose the tenth road to flee.
It was disoriented and dashed ahead,
And met hero Sirak face to face.

Seeing the expression of Sirak,
The fox lamented:
"The real fox is not me,
He is the rare fox in this world.
I cannot fight against him,
Otherwise I will be done immediately."

The fox turned into a mouse and quivered,
Drilled into sand and fled desperately.
On its way of fleeing,
It met hero Chuwak head-on.

Chuwak was not pleased to look at it,

He had already forgotten,
The fox had extraordinary skills.

The mouse dodged warrior Chuwak,
But it met face to face,
With black mane wolf Ayikoler.

Intelligent magical steed Ackura,
Was the close companion to the hero,
It was unique and matchlessly agile.
It saw the coming mouse,
It pounced on the mouse like a falcon.

Lion Manas on the back of the steed,
Almost fell off on the ground.
Manas also saw the little mouse,
Loosed the halter and chased.

The cunning fox rolled on the ground,
And turned into a turtle lay on its stomach.
Ackura steed chased for a while,
And stopped its hooves there.

Facing the magical change of the fox,
Hero Manas lowered his head and thought:
"The damned fox,
Turns into a turtle crawling slowly,
It is intelligent Ackura recognizes it.

"Things in the world change unpredictably,
Almanbet knows them all.
If these animals send the news out,
Kunwuer Bayi must turn out,
Block us here and make it hard for us to march on."

The hero urged magical steed Ackura,
Achy Abaris sword shined,

The lion sat firm on the horseback,
Came to the place where the turtle hid.

Intelligent Ackura,
Came by the side of the turtle,
Stopped its hooves and stood there.

Lion Ayikoler was very surprised,
He watched carefully from all directions,
The little turtle had disappeared,
A python lay on the ground,
Its long body was like a rope,
Its strong body was as thick as a barrel.

"The fox Almanbet talked,
Now turns into a python.
This cunning guy might think,
I will go around its body with terror."

Manas held the spear tight in the hand,
Aimed at the head of the python,
Poked to the head without hesitation.

The python disappeared immediately,
The cunning fox changed again,
A hedgehog curled up in front of the steed,
Crawled fast to find a place to hide.

Manas bristled with anger,
He could not bear the tricks,
Thought about the method to deal with the fox.

The cunning fox jumped right and left,
Dragged its long tail,
Dare not stay and got a chance and fled.

Hero Manas was burning with a frenzy of rage,

He shouted his name loudly,
Like having a bloody battle with enemies.

Heard the shouting from Khan Manas,
The cunning fox was nervous and flustered,
The hero poked his spear twice,
It dodged his spear twice cleverly.
The fox dodged the hero's spear,
Fled forward desperately.

The hero reached his spear out again,
Poked toward the fox from aside.
The magical and cunning fox,
Tried to dodge the spear again.

The spear came as a gale,
Poked into the side of the waist of the fox.
Its ribs were crashed,
The fox fell on the ground.

Its waist was injured and it was exhausted,
It had no energy to run away.

Before the fox regained its mind,
Before it got time to take a breath,
Eagle Manas poked his spear,
Held the fox high on his spear.

The fox was on the point of the spear,
Chuwak saw it right away:
"Hero, give it to me!"
Chuwak shouted and rushed ahead.
The shout roared to the sky,
All heroes heard it.

They did not know what happened,
Forty warriors urged their horses and came.

"Can it be that magical animals go to report,
Karamark turn out for the battle.
Almanbet did all these,
He must bring us crowning calamity."
Kergel whispered,
Gave vent to his resentment and grievance.

"This is his hope."
Tazbaymart also got angry.
Nine groups of warriors except Sirak,
All came full of complaints.

When Almanbet saw the fox on the spear point,
Happiness showed on his face.

Right at this moment,
A gale came from the north,
Covered everything crazily.
Crafty Kunwuer Bayi,
Had arranged everything in advance.

He believed Almanbet must come,
To avoid the secret being cracked,
He cast the mysterious spell on the fox.
As long as a gale blew the hair of the fox,
It could regain its mind immediately,
And run away desperately.

With the blowing gale,
The fox began to run desperately,
Brave hero Sirak,
Met the fox head-on.

Smart and alert hero Sirak,
Waved the whip in his hand,
Whipped his steed to the fox.
He lifted the whip and slashed severely,

A gale rose from the tip of the whip.

Like a thousand people shouted together,
And sent the sound to the fox ears.
Like Ochogor artilleries shot together,
Deadly shells came to it,
Like battle hammers waved over its head,
And bashed it over his head.
The fox dodged Sirak's attack,
Turned and ran to dark place.

Ayikoler urged Ackura,
Waved his spear and chased tight after it.
Before the fox could play a trick,
The sharp point of the spear,
Had poked into its liver mercilessly.

The lion killed the mysterious fox,
Heroes led by Bakay,
All laughed cheerfully.
It was a rare animal,
It became a precious colletion.

Patrolling post with wings,
Gods of wild animals,
Were all wiped out,
They could never deliver messages to Kangayi.

Heroes destroyed the animal post,
Turned round and went back to their camp.

At a place called Gurituldek,
White saline covered all over the place.
They went through the forest and slowed their paces,
Almanbet was free from anxiety,
Talked and laughed with others:
"It is said that Khan's tongue is round,

If Khuda and sages can make the presence,
They may present us generously,
The beautiful and noble girls in Begin city.
Please do not fight for that,
Heroes should act quickly,
Do not blame me that beat you to the draw."

People all laughed,
Almanbet said seriously:
"Led by sage Koshaoyi,
Khan Budayk's son Muzburchak,
Respected elders are waiting for our victory,
They are waiting for us to send them the news.

"If you have no dissent,
We'd better whip and urge at high speed,
Do not spare your steed,
Try to catch and go in the front of our troops.

"We wiped out three barriers in succession,
Mysterious wild white duck failed to cheat death,
We killed the white male argali in mountains,
The cunning fox did not escape from our hands.
We should deliver the news immediately,
And get the prize of 'Suyinchy' as soon as possible."

Almanbet finished his words and whipped his steed,
Sariala steed dashed out like an arrow.
Almanbet shouted the slogan loudly,
Clouds of dust rose up behind him,
Like the mist covered the whole sky.
Soft dirt splashed under hooves.

The galloping steed,
Opened its mouth as big as a cave.
Armors clanged,
And echoed among valleys,

Glittering shields hung on them,
Warriors' robe edge swayed with wind.

Forty steeds leaped,
And galloped ahead at top speed.
Warriors kicked steeds' belly continuously,
Whipped and urged their steeds.

Like the bullet coming out of the bore,
Steeds all ran at full speed.
Some ran down the depression, some rushed on the hill.
No steed was willing to fall behind,
Clouds of dust were like running river.

Heroes Almanbet, Chuwak and others,
Forty warriors led by Kergel,
They all started off on their journey,
Bakay and Manas followed them.

Massive columns of Kirgiz troops,
Were quartered in the front.
The distance between them and the camp,
Was as least a six-day journey.
Only after the time of one meal,
Sound of hooves of warriors appeared at campsite.

Koshaoyi was waiting for the message,
His anxious heart was like being fried.
"The days Almanbet promised,
Seem to end up.
It is the time to return,
For heroes led by black mane wolf,

"Whether warriors have wiped out,
The secret posts crafty Kunwuer Bayi arranged,
Do they clear the way for the expedition,
Or do they let the mysterious animal post off?

In the nights of future,
Will Kangayi troops come in massive columns? "

Koshaoyi thought over and over,
Guessed about both possibilities.
He climbed on the high mountaintop,
Sat on the thick cushion,
Concentrated and thought,
Planned for the coming battles.

Seeing the looking on Koshaoyi's face,
Garmgirchy and Muzburchak,
Shihay and Tirkechy,
Eir Toshtuk and Kerkokuler,
Yurbi and hero Ageshi,
And Khan Senchybek of Hohan,
These Khans all came to the side of Koshaoyi.
Humorous Akberita,
Broke the silence and said first:
"Oh, honorable Khan Koshaoyi, what's wrong with you,
To come here in the early morning?
And sit still without moving?

"I probably can predict,
Are you missing Atbash?
There is a hill,
Called Aramisik,
You always sit there and spread your wings of imagination…"

Before Akberita finished his words,
Kerkokuler stood up in front of Toshtuk,
And said:
"On the horizon of the east,
A gust of dust rose up.
In a blink of an eye,
It spreads further to the horizon.
I cannot see clearly how many soldiers and horses,

It looks blurred and grey."

Koshaoyi was surprised as he saw this,
He said to Khans hurriedly:
"Could it be said that animals have fled away,
And sent news to Kangayi?
Does Kunwuer Bayi lead its troops?
Coming to us in massive columns?

"Or are these our heroes,
Who have defeated enemies and come back?
Or our heroes bring us good news,
To make us happy?

"Are they smiling?
Are they too joyful to calm down?
Please watch carefully,
What is the quantity of the troops?"

Khans all stood on the hill,
Opened their eyes wide and watched afar.
The oncoming troops,
Were approaching and the blurred shape had been seen.

Kerkokuler was young with bright eyes,
He stood up and shouted suddenly:
"Khans present,
You are all respected Khans,
I see clearly the oncoming people.

"Steeds are as shining as the moon,
Diamonds on helmets are glittering,
Brighten the sky and catch eyes,
Two people are going side by side.

"I watch carefully,
One of them is tall and of wide shoulders,

His mount is a steed of light color,
It seems he is famous hero Chuwak.

"They are Almanbet and Chuwak,
They urge their steeds shoulder to shoulder.

"Or our heroes,
Captured those mysterious animals alive,
In order to send us the good news as soon as possible,
They whip and urge their steeds at high speed,
And make their steeds sweat profusely.

"I cannot see any of forty warriors,
Bakay and hero Manas,
Also do not come with them.
I cannot see eagle Sirak either,
Many heroes cannot be seen.

"Could it be said that they were broken up by Ketay,
And ran away separately?
Could it be said that they were defeated by enemies,
And Kangayi detains other heroes?

"If they left Ayikoler,
They would not flee backward.
Since they come in such high speed,
They must bring exact news to us."

Before Kerkokuler stopped talking,
Two heroes had arrived in front of them.
The yellow steed of Almanbet,
Ran in the twenty-foot front.
Hero Chuwak's blue steed,
Was twenty-foot behind it.

Two heroes whipped their steeds at top speed,
Came in front of them fast.

Hero Almanbet shouted loudly,
The voice circled round the hill.
Hero Chuwak shouted loudly,
The earth shook with his voice.

"Good news, Khans!
Please listen to our good news:
The mysterious wild duck post,
Male argali, fox and cunning animal posts,
Were all wiped out by us."

When Khans heard the good news,
Their tight nerves eased suddenly.
Koshaoyi was overjoyed,
He laughed loudly and said forcefully:

"Thanks for your good news,
I wish good fortune descend on you.
Children, you make me very happy,
As long as Khuda blesses,
You will have bright future.

"Brave forty warriors,
Are all left far behind you.
None of them,
Can compare with you.

"If Khuda answers your prayers,
There are two matchless beautiful Ketay girls,
Aisanhan's daughter Birmiskaler,
Has her name spread far and wide,
Almanbet arrived one-halter distance,
Faster than Chuwak,
As 'Suyinchy', you can marry her.

"General Ayi's daughter Burulicha,
Is the second beautiful girl in Begin city,

Chuwak, I betroth her as your wife.
If we can capture these two beauties,
You two get married with them,
This will surprise the world."

When they were lost in joy,
Lion Ayikoler and Bakay arrived.
Almanbet and Chuwak,
Went back to their own yurt.

Khans all came up,
Inquired after Manas' well-being,
Like welcoming a long departed family member.

Hero Manas was in good spirits,
Eyes were as bright as that of falcon,
Praised what hero Almanbet did,
In front of all Khans,
Khans concentrated their minds,
Listened and praised.

Five pieces of skeleton meat of the argali,
Were cooked by cooks,
And carried to Khans.
We destroyed the mysterious animal post,
We will never worry about it anymore."

Now I have to put this aside,
Let's talk about the grudge,
Between hero Almanbet and Chuwak.

Dispute Between Almanbet and Chuwak

Hero Almanbet was ardent in temper,
Got up in the morning in a hurry,
Washed and dressed up.
Tied his belt and braced up,
Walked to the yurt of lion Manas hurriedly.

He lifted the door curtain and walked in,
Uncle Bakay and Khan Koshaoyi,
Hero Toshtuk of Eramen,
All these respected giants gathered together there.

Muzburchak and Senchybek,
These respected Khans,
Giant Berita and Garmgirchy,
These silver-beard old people,
Were all present and conferred on the subject.

When hero Almanbet walked in the yurt,
They all stood up to show politeness and respect.
"Please sit in the honorable seat, hero!"
Khans spoke in one voice,
Led him to the honorable seat.

In an instant,
On the wide tablecloth,
All kinds of delicacies were placed.
They drank and ate lightly and happily,
Tasted the food with appetite.

They finished their prayers,
Servants folded the tablecloth,
Hero Almanbet said in this way:

"Our steeds are plump and sturdy,
They long for the expedition for a long time.
Warriors are all itching for the battle,
They long for the time of fight all the time.

"Who is the archer that never wastes arrows,
Who is the ferocious powerful person?
Who is the eloquent person that knows right from wrong,
Who is well trained good archer?
Who is the philosopher that has great foresight,
Who is the sage Khuda blesses?

"Who is the ever-victorious hero,
Who is the brute takes death calmly?
Who is the wise man that has a silver tongue,
Who is the general that never retreats and draws his spear back?
Who is the warrior that fights bravely and never knows fear,
Who is the hero that dares to Begin to gather enemy's intelligence?"
Almanbet spouted an unceasing flow of words,
In high spirits.

Damned forty warriors,
Bakburchin clan,
Seemed to have no daring heroes to battle,
Warriors fell into silence,
Khans kept quiet as if thinking of something.

Hero Khan Manas was excited,
Declared himself to all:
"You fight against powerful enemies for countless times,
Have accumulated rich combat experiences.
Never use sabre,
Twist enemy's neck off with bare hands.

You are relaxed when you face with powerful enemies,
People multiply under your protection.

"No things you do not know in the world,
Which hero present can compare with you?
You do not need hesitate,
Just send someone to patrol and gather intelligence.

"You grew up in remote Kangayi,
You know Khan's prairie like the palm of your hand.
Once you put yourself out of the way,
To rule the common people there.
You suffered a lot of blames and misunderstandings,
How much pain and misery you buried in your heart.

"You stand in sharp opposition to Kunwuer Bayi,
Redden the earth with blood.
My Almanbet,
You are brave and sagacious.

"You need think it over carefully,
Nerve yourself and mount personally to start off,
If you meet unexpected trouble,
I will go and support you in time.

"You need choose able soldiers and generals,
You need pick fine steeds out.
Almanbet,
Do you have any word to tell us?"

Almanbet responded decisively:
"With your order, how I refuse to go,
Now I will go and gather enemy's intelligence.

"Begin city in the front,
Who is brave enough to go,
Who dares to sneak there and spy on them?

Who dares to nose for the information?

"That is a one-way place.
We need more than two people,
It is a dream to approach that city.

"Never draws back spear that pokes out,
Never turns round the steed and flees away,
Words are sharp enough to shock others,
Never knows what is nervous.

"Tiger Sirak is a ferocious wolf in the world,
With his company,
I can go at ease,
To spy on in Begin."

Warrior Sirak continued the talk:
"We are willing to obey Ayikoler's order,
If you want us to go comfortably,
You'd better present two steeds for each of us."

Manas stated clearly after hearing this,
He said very apropos without hesitation,
Raised his voice,
Delivered his order into everyone's ears.

Tiger Manas gave out the order,
His loud voice was like beating the drum,
Delivered the order to everyone clearly:
"Tolukuman's maroon steed,
Can be called the wing of warrior.

"You can choose from the horse flocks,
To see whether the horses suit your desire?
If the master of the steed does not donate actively,
You can lesson him without sparing your whip.

"Karakarman's black steed,
Is the wing for soldiers on patrol.
You can tell its master,
See whether you are fond of that steed?
If someone does not want to give his steed,
You can grab the halter of his steed mercilessly."

Almanbet continued the talk,
His words were frank and reasonable:
"Tolukuman's maroon steed,
Is a magical steed that never has empty embryo,
But it is over ninety years old,
It is old and weak and always out of breath.

"Karakarman's black steed,
Is really the wing for soldiers on patrol.
But it is also too old,
It shows the sign of declining.

"Aji Bayi's brown steed,
Never gets tired when going up and down the hill,
Its neck is sturdy and back is bending,
It will not be fatigued even being ridden for six months.

"Even it gets the age of sixty Asiyi①,
It does not look old and has healthy teeth,
It is still as strong as a four-year-old horse,
It never stops its hooves if it does not reach the goal,
It never eats the tips of reed.
It will not get tired even being ridden for seven months,
It will never be out of breath.

"Even if it has already been over the age of seventy Asiyi,
Its teeth do not loose and fall.
Even if it goes to battle for three times in succession,

① Asiyi: It is the translation by pronunciation from Kirgiz. It is the name for a five-year-old horse.

It will not feel short of breath.

"In the burning hot summer,
Stinking marsh gas makes people dizzy,
In the life-and-death battle,
Even if without breeching,
Go down along the hillside where rocks run,
It still can gallop forward like whirlwind.

"Its flat back makes you comfortable,
Long mane sways in the wind,
It is moderate in temper,
It is outstanding and hard to find in the world.

"It will not stumble and feel dizzy even you whip its head,
Even if you put it in thousands of horses,
It can rush out of the horse flocks and find its master.
Even you drive it in the pitch dark night,
It will not get startled.

"It does not listen to your frightening 'Woo! Woo!',
It never has the habit to be startled.
It frisks as a newborn colt,
Let its hooves go, stretch its tail and dash ahead as arrow.

"Aji Bayi's brown steed,
Is so amazing,
Lion, as long as you get it,
We can start off on time."

Manas responded at this moment:
"Erchywuler and Bozwuler,
You two set out now with no delay!
Go to see Aji Bayi,
Borrow his brown steed quickly."

Two warriors started off like lightning,

Stirrups knocked together with sparks splashed,
They arrived at Aji Bayi's place in an instant.
They bent down and saluted Aji Bayi,
Knelt and took seats reverently.

Aji Bayi had already known their purpose,
He shook his beard,
Smiled quietly.

Bozwuler could not help talking,
His words were frank:
"We heard in your flocks of horses,
There is an unusual brown steed,
Honorable hero Almanbet,
Shows special favor to it and praises it a lot.
Bloody sucker sends us here,
Let you offer your steed soon,
And asks us to go back on time."

Aji Bayi responded immediately:
"The hero knows how precious the steed is,
If the hero does not know, who else knows?
Since we go on expedition together,
How I can refuse to present my steed.

"Such magical steed,
Is really hard to find in the world.
It is the spirit of livestock,
Now it is time for it to show its ability."

The steed was right tied on the post,
It was in high spirits,
The bridle was weaved with first class leather strips.
Aji Bayi handed the halter over to the warriors.

Two warriors were too excited,
They led the brown steed,

Returned joyfully.

"Clop…clop…", heard the sound of hooves,
Almanbet stood up quickly,
Walked to the steed and fondled its forehead,
Sirak led the halter for him.
Two heroes made up their mind,
Started off on their journey of patrol.

Golden face was glittering,
Khan Sorandick's son Almanbet,
The gold buckle of his leather belt,
Shined under the sun.

He was reliable and honest,
Spoke frankly and never dodged,
He wore Badana① battle robe,
Prayed to Allah with sincere expression.
Helmet inlaid with diamonds,
Reflected the sunshine and glittered.

He held iron-cast battleax in the hand,
Drums tied aside,
Flags waved in the wind.

Almanbet went to the battlefield,
Like towering Arato mountain.

Rode on Tilkzler steed,
Iron-made spear shook continually.
Battle boots with bronze heels,
Made him comfortable.

Leopard Sirak was heaved with joy.
In order to patrol the way of expedition,

① Badana: Kirgiz language. It means the battle robe made of felt.

In order to understand enemy,
Heroes mounted their steeds.

Seeing heroes Almanbet and Sirak off,
How could others bear the loneliness of waiting?
"We cannot wait boringly,
We'd better play the game 'Take Palace'.

"Two heroes go to Begin,
Will not return with empty hands.
One thousand or one,
We forty warriors go through thick and thin together,
The war trophy of one colt is held tight in our hands.
We can use it as a prize,
We can draw and begin the game now,
Play the game 'Take Palace'".

Did not know who made this proposal,
People discussed animatedly,
They all agreed,
The pattern of "Take Palace" was drawn soon.

The group led by Erchywuler,
Belonged to Chuwak.
The group led by Bozwuler,
Belonged to Almanbet.

The side of Almanbet was all of one mind,
Bozwuler played very well,
Defeated the rivals twice.

Erchywuler failed twice,
He was quite emotional and ashamed.
There was only one "Khan" left in "Palace",
If he could not fight it out,
Another failure would come.
If he could fight it out of the pattern,

Erchywuler's group could earn one point.

One warrior called Jaynak in his group,
He was hot tempered and went his own way.
"Give the ox horn square plate,
I can knock the 'Khan' out."

Hearing what he said,
Showtu responded sarcastically:
"Do not boast,
You, Jaynak,
When do you have such ability?"

Warrior Jaynak was not convinced in his heart,
In order to heal his shame of being laughed,
He took the ox horn plate immediately.
He walked in the circle and knelt and bent down,
Concentrated and knocked the "Khan" out.

People did not see clearly how far the "Khan" fell,
Secretive Bozwuler picked the "Khan",
Put it back to the "Circle" secretly,
Erchywuler witnessed what he did by accident.

Erchywuler questioned very firmly:
"Hey, Bozwuler, you such a damned bear!
It is so shameless to do this.
You have won in succession,
How can you be so greedy?

"We win the 'Khan' with difficulty,
How can you steal it secretly?
If you do not restrain your evil hands,
You will die when you are young.

"You think yourself smart,
Consider others as fools.

If you keep acting like this,
Are not you afraid of staining your reputation? "

Bozwuler turned angry from shame when he heard this,
He said insolently with great rage:
"Erchywuler, you do not show off,
You are just a poor servant.
I never did what you accused,
You cannot invent such things on me.

"You take good person as a thief,
How you can defame others like this,
You talk nonsense, you make me sick of you.

"Your words are without any reason,
I am not an irrational person.
You want to be on the par with me in vain,
Your wishful thinking is impossible forever.

"When Almanbet came here for the first time,
In order to show the respect,
The lion presented him Sariala steed.
Almanbet leaped on the steed,
With powerful and prestigious status.

"Ayikoler Manas,
Welcomed him by holding horse racing.
When setting heroes as prizes,
I was placed in the first to be the prize,
And you were placed in the eight.

"You should be punished by Khuda,
How you dare humiliate and slander me like this.
I am several times nobler than you,
My master is nobler than your master too.

"My master Almanbet,

Becomes the commander of expedition troops,
He is fair and makes strict disciplines,
He did not let you rest even a single day.

"He becomes the commander of the troops,
He did not allow troops rest,
Descended disaster on you.
Not only this,
He goes to patrol enemy situation today.
Your master Chuwak,
He is neither a top brass nor an adviser,
He has no place to vent his complaints."

When Erchywuler heard these abusive words,
He could not bear anymore with great rage,
He turned his steed round quickly,
Looked for Chuwak on the island they were quartered.

Facing this quick tempered guy,
He vented his complaints:
"I go through thick and thin with you for many years,
I accompany you at any time,
The heaven did not take me away,
And did not call you either.
That shameless Bozwuler,
Praised his master Almanbet,
He dug at me and laughed at me.

"He said his master is nobler than my master,
He said he is wider than me.
He said his master Almanbet,
Commands the whole troops,
And can lesson casually,
Every Khan and general.

"After hearing what he said,
Kergel was frightened out of his wits.

He said you, the famous hero Chuwak,
Also show your white feather and are compliant.

"He said Almanbet holds the power of the troops,
Went to patrol the enemy information personally.
Khans were dragged off their steeds casually,
They have no choice but to go on foot.
He said you are neither a top brass nor an adviser,
With no achievement, you have to obey Almanbet's order."

Hearing Erchywuler's stirring words,
Akberita's son Chuwak,
Flared up into a fury.
He asked to lead him Koktikai steed immediately,
Saddled it and grasped the whip,
Whipped and urged ahead.

Iron coat on him shined cold light,
Put hard chest protector,
On his mount Koktikai steed,
And took his pig iron battleax.

Blue flag waved with wind,
Shouted aloud the slogan "Noygut".
Chuwak could not control himself,
He led Noygut tribe and rushed forward angrily.

Let us put this aside,
Take a look at other officials.

Uncle Bakay stationed at the edge of the troops,
Had too many thoughts through his mind,
Mongolian gazelle meat was his food,
He stood on the cliff where snow cocks appear.
Held telescope in his hand and watched around,
Overlooked from the high point.

Heroes Almanbet and Sirak,
Climbed over the mountain side by side.
He turned the telescope to the troops,
He saw Noygut tribe in a big mess,
Clouds of dust covered the sky.
Wind blew the dust in the sky,
Blended into the moving white clouds.

As seeing this,
Bakay felt worried:
"If I do not stop them right now,
A disturbance will not be avoided."

He rode on Kokcholok steed①,
Went hurriedly from dark valley,
He came up to the black mane wolf first:

"It must be malicious servants,
Sow seeds of discord,
It is right their long-term habit.
It must be evil-intentioned people,
Start and spread rumors between them.

"Noygut's general Chuwak,
Is simple-minded,
He must lead Noygut troops with rage,
Start off and rush ahead."

Manas' mind was as broad as Taras,
He thought a while and told Bakay:
"Wise Bakay Dateka②,
Please mount and set out right now,
Lead the yellow and white steed,
Go and check immediately.

① Kokcholok steed: Kirgiz language, it means blue steed with short tail.

② Dateka: It is the name of an official position in ancient Kirgiz tribes.

"Let hot-tempered hero Chuwak,
Lapse his anger and then ask him about the reason.
Servant Saritaz who is in charge of the palace,
Let him accompany you and follow you."

Led the yellow and white steed as a gift,
Led Saritaz as an attendant,
Elder Bakay started off,
Galloped to Chuwak at high speed.

He said to Chuwak sincerely:
"Oh, respected Chuwak,
You cannot lose your mind.
As long as this happens,
It will cause a dispute beyond recall.
Such a stupid thing,
You should stop now and do not make it happen."

Saritaz was impatient,
He agreed and persuaded:
"Uncle Bakay is appointed Dateka,
This steed is a gift Khan Manas presents to you specially,
Lion Chuwak, please calm your anger and return."

"You said uncle is Dateka now,
Advises me against starting off,
I do not dream day and night to get this steed.
You can ride this steed,
You may have known how it comes out.
Please take the battle robe you gave me back,
But do not stop me from starting off."

Chuwak was a law onto himself,
He could not cease from fury.
Saritaz had more words to say,
But was beaten down on the ground.

Seeing this,
Sage Bakay scolded angrily:
"Hey, Chuwak, Chuwak,
Please control yourself, calm down.

"The hero came from Kangayi,
No matter who the person will be,
All admit that he is an ever-victorious Ketay.

"You tell me he charges forward regardless of his safety,
Whom does he try to protect?
All he does is for Kirgiz.

"He spares no efforts for Kirgiz,
But you are going to fight out with him,
All he has done here,
Whom he does this for?
He does all these for white felt hat Kirgiz.

"He goes through fire and water for Kirgiz,
But you do your utmost to oppose him,
Why are you doing this?

"I can call you my child,
Look at your widely opened eyes,
There is a proper limit for striving for supremacy,
You should analyze the reason carefully.

"Kirgiz has been split and disunited,
We will soon become the laughing stock of others.
Splitting will let enemy take advantages of our weak point,
You should see clearly the truth.

"Manas has his achievements today,
It is the effort of all of us!
If we split,
Even if the lion is an elephant,

Even if he has one thousand bodies,
If you hold his thigh,
You can make him fall.

"No matter men, women, the old or the young,
Khans, officials,
Or the lonely heroes,
If they do not hold together,
They will fall in deep trap."

Chuwak felt aggrieved after hearing this,
He said regardless of Bakay's face:
"Oh, my respected uncle,
We share life and death with each other.
Your eyes are bright,
Why do you turn a blind eye to me?
Do not let me participate in important matters' discussion,
How poor am I?

"Please think about it, my uncle,
Am I more humble than other heroes?
I, Chuwak, never know,
My life can be so miserable.

"In Tashkent battle,
In that life-and-death battle,
Nasara's son Karlof,
Was going to poke lion Manas,
Off the back of Ackura.
It was me, Chuwak, who charged forward and saved him,
Which point does the other do better than me?

"When we fought against Kaleday in Kashgar,
It was me, Chuwak, cut enemy's head off,
Did not make enemy's blood stain his battle robe.

"Kartkalan's daughter Sayikali,

Is a matchless heroine.
She hid in dark place and attacked suddenly,
Her spear was right going to Manas,
Poked into his shoulder,
And threw him on the ground.

"It was my lightning attack,
Stopped Sayikali to cut his head,
Saved his life again.

"You know all these but you pretend you do not,
You had witnessed these but now you are blind to these.
Your bright eyes and wise mind,
How can they ignore all that I have done?

"Uncle, please do not stop me,
I will wipe out on the hill,
Those self-glorifying Ketay people.
Drive Begin horses,
To our place.

"If I can drive horses here,
Who will not want to get some.
If I do not fulfill this dream,
I would rather go to die,
I will set out now and please step back."

"Warriors, look,
What have happened here."
With a loud shout,
Hero on grey horse Ayimanboz,
With white robe swaying left and right,
Manas just got there.

As hearing this voice,
Chuwak's anger still did not cool down.
He left Bakay,

Turned and shouted to Manas:

"From Arialer lake of Altay,
From Akcham Tultash mountain,
I came here when I was nine years old,
You were just twelve years old then.
From then on till today,
I follow you and suffer a lot of hardships.

"Once we pledged by licking the blade of stainless steel sword,
We used to fight against numerous powerful enemies together.
For the sake of the glory of you, Ayikoler Manas,
I am bathed in bloody battles till now.

"Where is the silk we tore when we made the pledge,
Where is the heroic saying when we made the pledge?
Where are the troops fought together with us?
Who can remember the spirits of the dead?

"A Ketay tramp from afar,
Now is more honorable than me.
How a small colt,
Can stamp on the hoof print of a steed?

"Manas, you are a steed,
But I become the nervous colt.
Manas, why do you make me sad?
Are you really so ungrateful and heartless?
Am I really so humble and poor?

"You forget me so easily,
Which point am I humbler and lower than others?"
Chuwak said in a tearful voice,
His words were sincere and shocking.

Manas had nothing to say but blamed himself:
"I feel worried about this,

If you still have complaints on gathering enemy intelligence,
Please go ahead, let us go forward together."

Manas urged his steed,
Chuwak dare not delay,
For the sake of their old friendship,
They urged the steeds together,
Two heroes dashed ahead side by side,
People were all happy to see it.

Bakay scolded severely,
Those people who followed them:
"You damned guys,
Shout Ketay in your mouths,
Why do you come here and heckle? "

Noygut turned and returned,
They were driven away by Bakay mercilessly,
They went back to their campsite,
Then Bakay began to feel at ease.

Let us put this aside,
To listen about,
The situation of Almanbet and Sirak.

Almanbet and hero Sirak,
Did not spare their mounts at all,
Galloped forward day and night,
Soon they arrived at the place they need investigate.

Towering mountains were like rolling waves,
Cool breeze made them comfortably happy.
They came to grassland,
Black rocks stacked on the grassland,
The scent of flowers greeted them,
Green grass swayed in the wind.
The beautiful scenery there,

Charmed them and made them reluctant to leave.

"I will let the steed eat grass and rest here."
Hero Almanbet,
Jumped down the steed gently,
Took off the bit of the steed.

In order to go on the journey better,
Sariala steed and Tilkezler steed,
And Kartkulan steed,
Were loosed on the grassland and ate freely.

He came onto the hill,
Sat on the black rock,
Turned his head round and looked back.

The troops had been left beyond their sight,
It was at least four-day journey between them.
He held the telescope,
And watched the movement of troops.

He adjusted the telescope in his hand,
Observed carefully,
He found on Kumusari basin,
It seemed two huge birds were flying.

They were birds but did not look like birds,
They were like two faint figures,
Raised dust went higher and higher.
He turned the telescope for six times to adjust,
The place at six-day journey distance,
Could be as near as six-rope far.

Almanbet watched through the telescope,
Observed the front carefully,
Fast Koktikai steed,
Galloped ahead at top speed.

Grey steed Ayimanboz,
Was left far behind.

As seeing this,
Almanbet asked himself:
"The hill of Kumusari,
Should be near here,
Numerous people living behind the mountain,
Are the subjects of Georoy.

"Do they attack our camp from aside,
Do two troops start a bloody battle?
Manas does not have Ackura with him,
Does he meet a dangerous moment?

"When the hero has no choice,
Will he come to me and ask for my help?"
Almanbet thought over and over,
He felt surprised and worried.

He adjusted the telescope again,
Watched the front one more time.
He saw Chuwak of strange expression,
Anger and grievance were on the face of Chuwak,
What in his heart was all showed on his face.

"It seems he comes to me specially and seriously",
Almanbet found this at this moment.
"He comes to go against me specially",
The judgment came up to Almanbet's mind.

He put his telescope back to the pocket,
Hung the rope on his neck,
Held the blue-tassel spear,
In his hand tight.

He inserted the spear on the ground,

Was ready to have a fight.
Almanbet's feeling at this moment,
Was noticed by Sirak.

On the coming way,
Chuwak was brought back to reason gradually:
"Uncle persuaded me again and again,
I did not understand his great pains.
If I was as clear-headed as I am now,
How can I come to revenge so rashly?

"The Ketay from Kangayi,
Does everything for us Kirgiz.
I should have taken Bakay's advice,
No matter what kind of response he had,
I should listen quietly without resisting."

Chuwak had the train of thought in his mind,
Jumped off the saddle from horseback,
His body was like a mountain peak,
Crossed his legs and sat on the opposite rock.

Two heroes sat face to face,
Sirak stood between them,
Did now show any fluster on his face.

Right at this moment,
Manas, the lion of the world,
Rode on grey steed Ayimanboz,
With his white robe swayed left to right,
Came to the place where they were.

Front teeth of door size,
Exposed rarely.
He laughed himself into fits,
Said frankly to them:
"What grudge do you bear between you two,

Do not hide and tell clearly to each other."

When Almanbet heard this,
Put Chuwak aside on the shelf,
Aimed at lion Manas,
And questioned in a stream:
"Hey, Manas, Manas,
Do not pretend to be ignorant,
I know clearly even you say nothing.

"Your Chuwak,
Seems to have known my background.
I am the son of the Khan in Kangayi,
Do I beg you to bestow me the throne?

"I came to you of my own free will,
What I praise are your people,
What I respect very much is Khan Manas, your humanness.

"Respected Khan Manas,
For this slave Chuwak who talks nonsense,
I will make him discredited thoroughly.

"I am the offspring of a Bek,
Do I come for the position of a Bek?
For the sake of opposing Karamark's rule together,
I come here voluntarily and exert my strength.

"Respected Bek Manas,
Facing what happens here,
I do not know what I should do!

"Respected Khan Manas,
Facing such companion who doubts me,
My passionate heart is cooling down,
My spirit seems to go to die.

"Respected lion Manas,
Please listen to my words from the bottom of my heart,
And remember my words in your mind.
Do not imagine I was cornered,
Then came under your shelter with no choice,
Have you neglected all other things?

"Respected black mane wolf Manas,
Never suppose you are invincible in the world,
If you fight against me,
It is right the time for you to shed your blood.

"Whether I should kill you,
Whether I should scratch your eyes out,
Whether I should take off your coat?
Whether I should witness your courage,
Whether I should pull your gall out,
To let you witness my ability.

"Respected Ayikoler Manas,
Do you think I roamed about everywhere,
Came here because I had no place to go,
Does such thinking come from you?

"Respectesd leopard Manas,
Do you think I am an incapable person,
If I, Almanbet show my power,
I will cut your belly open and never regret.

" 'Khan dies after he mounts on the splendid throne,
Wish he is free from suffering at his last minutes of life.'
If it is not the arrangement of Khuda,
How could I dismount at your Ayinla?

"I have suffered too many hardships,
How can I bear your contempt and blame?
Support and foster arrogance of the boor,

How can you be such an ignorant Khan?

" 'Khan dies after he mounts on the silver throne,
Wish he does not suffer a lot.'
If it is not the arrangement of Allah,
How could I come to your yurt?

"I have suffered all kinds of hardships,
How can I bear your bullying?
Support the random action of a fool,
How can you be such a fatuous Khan?

"You said you can shoot a lot with firelock,
You said there is no place you cannot conquer;
You said your bullet is like an ox,
You said your feet can measure any area;
You said your warriors are as brave as tigers,
You said your Chuwak is like a lion.
I have become your brother of same mother,
Why do not you put my contribution in your heart?

"Do you send your lion Chuwak to come first,
And then you come personally?
Do you want to make my blood drain away,
In my hometown?
Do you want to twist my neck off,
In front of Kangayi people?
Whether you send Chuwak to provoke first,
Then you come and sheer for him.

"Whether you want me to drain my blood away,
On the place where I was born.
Whether you twist my waist off and make me die,
In front of Kunwuer Bayi?

"The moon light in the sky,
Can only be reflected in the lake.

Guests who are not welcomed,
Only can eat naan without butter.

"Maybe I am a lonely wild goose went into wrong yard,
Oh, my Khan Manas,
What is the use of my words?

"Stars in the sky,
Only can be reflected on ice.
Guests without social status,
Only can have tea without butter.

"I cannot change my lonely destiny,
Oh, my Khan Manas,
What is the use of my complaints?

"You have owned the glory of victory,
You have climbed over many mountains,
You have gone over numerous dangerous rapids,
For your neighbor Hohan,
You rule them as sheep,
Collect their taxes and levies smoothly.

"You gathered various troops,
Attacked and occupied Aranick city,
Karaday in Kashgar city,
Was also captured and head was twisted off.

"You can boast you captured side Begin,
Spread the glory of it among the people.
You took Beshbalek city,
After General Ayi fled away,
Then you built Manas city there.

"You can say proudly that you captured middle Begin,
You can be joyful about it.
Do you know where Begin is,

Have you ever seen the palace of Ketay?

"Ayikoler, please listen carefully,
I will introduce you my hometown in details:
In the east is the sea,
In the north is the ocean covered with ice,
In the north is the boundless plain.

"It rains all year round,
With fertile earth and fragrant flowers.
People are as many as ox hairs,
That is the place where Ketay living.

"The prosperous Ketay,
Who does not want to be one of them?
Who does not yearn for their life?
Altay city is splendid,
Who does not want to occupy it,
How could not it be a place let people long for day and night?

"Could it be that you have more people than them?
Could it be that I am a tramp and lose my people?
Could it be that your land is more fertile than theirs?
Could it be that I am a lonely soul without a hometown?

"I should tell you,
The three islands of Yindichin.
It is called Botala,
It is overgrown with Kuchala[①],
People living there eat rice,
Do not mix with other food.

"It is famous Aisanhan,
Administers Begin city,
Which has sixty city gates.

① Kuchala: It means Ephedrine in Kirgiz language. It is a medicinal plant.

"Like crops being irrigated for five times,
There is one kind grass called Beshandy①,
Livestock will never feel full after eating it,
But they will not feel hungry,
Even going six days continuously.
There is one kind snake called Tuyinchaqi②,
It can extend its body to hundred spans long when it wriggles.

"Along the beach of the sea,
Beavers and minks play there freely.

"There is one kind beetle called Talalu③,
Its body is even larger than turtle's.
In my remote hometown,
Rich people grow wonderful flowers.

"There are some big eaters,
They can pig out six-pot porridge at one time.
There are some coward people,
They never dare go out at night;
There are some over-confident people,
Wave their fists toward camels.

"There are such animals,
They use their sharp horns as weapons,
Chase after warriors who have spears in their hands.
There are such ferocious dogs,
They never let their games run away.

"There are many wise men good at calculating,
Warriors there are courageous and brave;
Facing the unusual giant they are not scared at all,
Giants and heroes are braver.

① Beshandy: One kind high quality grass in the legend.
② Tuyinchaqi: One kind giant python in the legend.
③ Talalu: One kind giant insect in the legend.

That is a mysterious holy land,
That is my beautiful home.

"Because I crossed swords with Karamark hero Kunwuer,
Broke with Aisanhan,
And Fell out with my Khan father,
Then I tore myself away from my lovely hometown,
In order to seek the fellow-traveler to fight against enemy,
I left my home till now.

" 'There is no shelter for me in Kazakh,
He comes to Kirgiz in order to find the rich,
This vagrant Ketay,
Runs into a brick wall and cannot find a firm hold.'
Self-glorified Chuwak,
Is this what you are thinking?

"In Sorandick's time,
I ruled the whole Tongsha area.
In order to learn martial skills from Jurenduo,
We sent six hundred people there,
They died in six months,
There were only six left alive.

"When the second year came,
We sent another nine hundred people there,
In less than nine months they died,
And only had nine people left alive.

"In order to finish the three-year lessons,
We held on consistently and practiced.

"It only had three months left of three-year period,
I received a letter from home,
It said my father Sorandick was seriously sick.
Jurenduo called me to his home,
Took me to his bedroom and told me:

'Respected Khan's son,
This is your father's letter,
It is impossible you do not go and visit your father,
Because you are like his eyes.
You do not need to come back here when you leave here.'

"He wrote a letter to my father,
Then drew his dagger out of the sheath.
The dagger was of thick steel and sharp blade,
It was straight till its curled point.
The handle was made of pure gold,
The sheath was made of pink gold.

"When he took it out,
I found he had a pair of the daggers.
One was still kept in the cabinet,
The other was given to me.

" 'This is the gift I give you.'
When he finished his words,
Lowered his head to seal the letter,
Many thought went through my mind,
I thought like this,
He carried the other dagger,
And put it on the cabinet,
Did the dagger have some secrets,
That could not been known?

"Without being noticed,
I exchanged my dagger with the other one,
Put the dagger he gave me back to its original place,
Took out the one in the cabinet and hung in my waist.

"Jurenduo did not notice it at all,
I took the letter and put it in my pocket,
Said goodbye to Jurenduo and went on my returning journey.

"Beside a spur of Changbai mountain,
At a corner of the mountain,
On broad of the Yellow Sea,
I arrived at a rope bridge.

"Stood on the bridge,
I saw Kura①,
The big Kura before,
Was made by the sage.

"The Kura came later,
Was made by Ketay people.
I walked up and watched,
Heaven and seven layers of hell could be seen clearly.

"The heaven is a pure land,
In that paradise,
People living there are kind sages.
The hell is a horrible place,
In that horrible hell,
People living there are all ferocious criminals.
Flames rage in the hell,
Food people eat are stained by poison.

"After seeing the situation of heaven and hell,
One thought came up to my mind:
I should concentrate and practice to be a sage,
Rather than keep being a titular Bek,
Waste my young life,
And be excluded out of the heaven,
Be burned into ash in the hell.

"I came to Tongsha city with such thinking,
Sentries delivered the news immediately.
'It is young master Su who comes back,

① Kura: According to the explanation of the singer, Kura is the pictures and words carved on the cliff to show the prediction of the world to come.

We must give him solemn welcome.'

"Generals gathered forty people,
Sixty high officials came.
High officials sat,
On carriages made of pure gold.

"Thick cushion was put on my saddle,
Everything was good.
High officials helped me dismount,
Lifted me over their heads,
Walked to Tongsha city solemnly.

"Entered the royal city,
Splendid carpet spread in front of me.
They asked to sit on the carpet,
And made concerted effort and lifted the carpet,
Walked toward the palace.
'Young master Su comes back safely.'
The news got to my Khan father soon.

"In order to show the respect to my father,
I, Almanbet went to visit my father specially.
He was safe and sound without any illness,
He was worried Jurenduo would not let me come back,
So he wrote the letter of his illness.

"There were sixty generals,
Everyone was like a big mountain.
But only forty of them were there,
The other twenty generals did not show up there.
I kept up my spirit,
Asked to tell me the information of them.

"My Khan father had a secretary,
He was decisive and deft,
He reported to me immediately in details:

'Arokai's son Kunwuer Bayi,
Came here earlier,
Visited Aisanhan sincerely.

" 'He brought treasure carried with ninety camels,
Brought flocks of steeds stretching to infinity,
Said a famous lion Manas appeared in Brute,
Roamed about everywhere.
The vast land in west Asia,
Most of that was occupied by him.

" 'Kangayi's homeland,
Is on the verge of destruction.
I beg you to protect us,
Bestow us a land to live.
Twenty generals in the north,
Are just put under Kunwuer's administration.'

"Heard such words,
Flames raged in my heart,
I tossed and turned restlessly till next morning.
Anxiety tortured me and made my face pale,
My mind was like the wheat straw floated in the wind,
Brought me endless annoyance.

"First rays of the morning sun showed up,
The earth was lightened.
I led magical steed kelejeran,
Put gold saddle and silver stirrups on it,
Galloped to Tongsha city at top speed.
I visited mountains and rivers there,
Revisited my hometown.

"In big Tongsha city,
I met with the subjects in Shayang again.
Among the rich lived in Shayang,
Even the poorest among them,

Had at least hundreds of steeds,
They drove their steeds to Tongsha.
After the careful observation,
I found the pastures they depended on,
Were occupied by Karamark for a long time.

"I was busy on my way of patrol,
A young man came face to face.
He rode on a dark maroon steed,
He was strong and sturdy.

"I asked him about his identity,
He responded me loudly:
'My name is Karakuler,
My father is Hero Kataler,
He is Arokai's brother.

" 'Arokai's son is Kunwuer Bayi,
I am Kataler's son.
Ninety flocks horses on the mountain,
Are all under my control.

" 'Aisanhan bestowed us this place,
It is really a paradise in this world,
We just moved here.
It is a good pasture for herding horses,
Spread horses on hills and in valleys,
It is the best for the rich…'

"When I heard of name of Kunwuer bayi,
I could not bear anymore.
'Where is your Kunwuer Bayi?'
I asked about Kunwuer's news by the way.

"He did not notice my indignant mood,
Answered my questions immediately:
'Behind the mountain is Kurgektor,

Where Kunwuer relaxes,
You can go and find him there.'

"Hearing the news of Kunwuer,
I was excited and did not stop at all.
Climbed on towering Achybeler peak,
Dense tents appeared in my sight.

"I urged my steed and came before the tents,
One steed was tied on a post.
Looked at it,
The graceful bearing of the steed was admirable,
It was like the picture in the tomb.

"Karamark-style pink gold saddle,
Was connected with six billet straps.
The livestock walked with its hooves,
Was with great dignity.
I did not get the chance to see that steed,
It is my lifelong regret.

"I shouted his name loudly at that moment,
Do not say to meet him,
Even his name,
It was the first time to hear.

"One person ran out of the yurt,
With a very nervous expression.
He was tall and strong,
His face was black and glittering,
He looked like a bloodsucker.

"You, lackey Chuwak talks nonsense,
My miserable life experience,
You should listen carefully.

"That guy walked out of the yurt,

No one dare raise the head and look at him.
He asked me loudly:
'The young man on the horse,
Who are you? Why do you shout loudly? '

"Facing the arrogant guy,
I reported him my identity and name in loud voice:
'My name is Soroler,
People respectfully call me young master Su.
May I have your name? '
'My father is Khan Arokai,
He is the extreme honorable Karamark Khan.
My name is Kunwuer Bayi,
I am the ruler of people here.'

"Hearing the name of Kunwuer,
I could not control the fury in my heart,
I fired questions to him harshly:
'From the time before six generations ancestors,
We live and multiply here,
Why do you occupy for no reason,
The home we live for generations? '

"Kunwuer answered,
With rude and unrelenting manner:
'I have no time to listen to your rubbish,
Do not want to waste time to argue with you.
It is Aisanhan willing to present this land to us,
What is it to do with you? '

"His extremely arrogant expression,
His peremptoriness of caring for nobody,
Like a bolt from the blue over the head,
The hard words were bitingly chill.

"How I could bear such insult,
The spear with blue tassel and red handle was held tight,

Aimed at Arokai's son Kunwuer Bayi.
His face turned suddenly,
He leaped on his steed,
Held his spear tight with fury.

"Since the spear was in the hand,
How can I let him stay aside?
I aimed at the opportunity,
Charged forward regardless of my safety,
Knocked Kunwuer's spear off his hand.

"I turned the steed round,
Poked Kunwuer off on the ground,
From the back of Alekala steed.
When I turned the steed round again,
Kunwuer Bayi mounted and fled away.

"Kelejeran steed galloped with no stop,
Chased after Alekala steed tight.

"Seeing what was in front of me,
I was excited and told myself:
'Even if go into the ground,
I will catch you into my hand.'

"I leaned close to the saddle and swayed the whip,
But it was a pity that my Kelejeran steed,
Did not catch up with Alekala steed.
Sometimes I could see its blurred figure,
Sometimes it went out of my sight.

"Kunwuer Bayi fled in desperation,
I chased for two days without stop.

"Shameless Kunwuer,
Fled into prosperous Kantun city.
Then I got to understand,

He was trying to run into Aisanhan's palace.

"I whipped and urged my steed crazily,
Rushed into the grand gate of the palace.
Out of the palace,
I saw a beautiful girl,
She looked like only of twelve or thirteen years old.

"She was unusual with good fettle,
She came up to me with light paces,
Gestured to me with invitation:
'I have something to tell you,
Please stop and wait for a while.
It seemed you are filled with fury,
And strive to compete with giant Kunwuer Bayi.

" 'Any words about Kunwuer Bayi,
Will not make my father Khan moved.
I saw your appearance from a picture,
I always have a feeling of admiration to you.

" 'Without seeing you personally,
But I have been far gone in love with you.
You'd better listen to my advice,
Do not challenge my father blindly,
Because of Kunwuer Bayi.
You can report other things to him,
Do not provoke his annoyance.

" 'I am right here to wait for you,
Please act quickly and do not delay.
Then I will listen carefully,
The result of the matter.
I will watch secretly,
And guard your steed here for you.'

"The special uniform on me,

Is well known in the city,
I can act freely and no one dare stop me,
I walked into the palace.

"When I got near the palace gate,
Sentries stood by the gate,
Bowed to me,
To show their respect to me.
They stood modestly and politely aside,
Dare not lift their brows,
Hung their hands beside their body properly.

"I went straight into the palace,
Did not nod to anyone.
That fleeing Kunwuer Bayi,
Stood there rigidly.

"He went in before me,
So he had reported the matter.
When I went in,
He walked out of the palace silently.

"I saluted the Khan,
Poured my complaints to him:
'Twenty of my generals and territory,
Both have been occupied by Karamark.'

"After hearing my complaints,
What Aisanhan said was not worth listening:
'Brute people occupied most of the territory,
Others also have a hand in carving up.
I presented to Kunwuer specially,
That pasture on the mountain.
You still have forty generals under you,
I think that is enough for you.'

"Hearing what Aisanhan said,

He presented the territory as a gift to others,
I was angry but had to go out with no choice.

"I looked around outside the palace gate,
I could not see Alekala.
I rode on Kelejeran steed,
Outside of the palace,
That beautiful princess was waiting for me.

" 'Young master Su, please stop and listen,
I have some words to tell you.
Did you tell clearly to my father,
About your situation?
If he did not list what you said,
Do not keep it in your mind.

" 'If you report this to your father,
Your father will not sympathize with you.
Do not try to fight Karamark anymore,
You'd better turn your steed round now,
Join Aisanhan and your father's camp.

" 'If you have no thought of changing your mind,
Except Arashi,
There will be no place as your shelter.

" 'I have to stick to the state of virgin,
For forty years to wait for you.
You do not doubt at all,
About my royalty and love to you.'

"I said 'goodbye!' to her,
Urged my steed on the journey without stop.

"It was a journey of six days and six nights,
Jumped gullies, climbed over mountains,
With full of annoyance,

Arrived in broad Tongsha city.

"How my anger-filled mood,
Shined lights as the moon does?
I dismounted and got washed,
Dare not delay,
Went to my father's palace straightly.

"I poured to my father,
All complaints buried in my heart.
From the expressions in his eyes and on his face,
I had guessed his attitude and feeling.

"After hearing my complaints,
My father showed no sympathy for me,
His manner of speaking was fierce:
'It is Aisanhan presented the land,
Why are you so angry?
It is Aisanhan divided the people,
Why are you so disaffected?

" 'It is Khan who presented the land and people,
Why are you so sad?
Forty generals are enough for us to dispatch,
You do not need adhere to your opinion!'

"Heard what my father said,
I felt annoyed and disappointed.
'I will go and visit my hometown.'
I made six-day preparation,
Started off and visited my hometown.

"I stayed in the palace for nine days,
Inquired about everywhere,
Heard enough discussions and opinions.

"It is said that there is a place called Angkuer,

Finally I went there and fished for information.
Angkuer is a broad valley,
It takes at least fifteen days to get there.

"I urged my steed at top speed day and night,
Finally got to this magical place.
Exotic flowers and rare woods are in the field,
Forest is lush and woods are luxuriant,
It is the paradise for all kinds of animals.

"There are some gentle slopes in the west,
An uninhabited pasture is there.
Gazelles, argali and wild deer live there,
Except dying of natural cause,
Or being eaten by leopard and tiger,
In the forest,
There are no hunters to hunt them.
Wild wolves scare tigers,
So they never go there.

"Few people traveled there,
Animals never feel scared.
Once in a while someone goes there,
Animals will gather together,
Nose the person calmly,
With no abnormity.

"Wild boars grunted,
Piglets ran everywhere.
I caught a pair of them and hung on the saddle,
I went on the top of the mountain along the winding road.

"Lifted the telescope hanging on my chest,
Looked around,
And looked to the far west.
People were walking there,
Officials came and go.

"The place I was standing,
Was one horse journey,
From the big crowd.
Red flag was waving over the heads,
People thronged like flood.

"Which tribe is this?
Does it come from the sky? I was worried,
Regardless of my clothes edge waving in the wind,
I was ready to whip my steed and dash forward.

"When I approached the group,
Two warriors held the spears in the hands,
Came in my face and stopped me.
The comer was Ayidarhan's son Kokcher,
How I could yield when facing the powerful enemy.
He is the Khans of Kazakh tribe,
They made a detour and were just new comers.

"One person came up,
An interpreter beside him,
Knew Ketay language.
I said 'How are you?' and saluted him,
He seemed to answer me with 'Owa[①]!',
He seemed not to understand what I said,
Just responded me with gesture.

"He gabbled loudly,
The interpreter called Alebye,
Stood beside him and said:
'This is famous Kokcher,
You do not need oppose him.
His achievements stand out in the world,
And he is moderate in temper.

① Owa: Kirgiz language, positive tone, it means "good" here.

" 'His hometown is occupied by Karamark,
He comes here,
Because Karamark are chasing him,
Karamark invaders are his mortal enemies,
He pledges his life to fight against invaders,
And take his hometown back.'

"I was very happy to hear that,
I could form an alliance with him,
And resist the powerful Karamark enemies together.
I expressed my wishes sincerely,
He accepted it excitedly."

"Ayidarhan's son Kokcher,
Said sincerely and reasonably,
I was fully convinced of his words,
Tears of excitement burst out.

"He asked his fifty thousand troops to pitch camp,
And fulfilled a holy mission.

"He ordered to lead the yellow lamb,
And open the huge saddlebag,
Take out a lot of gold,
Throw them away to pray for the safety and good fortune.

"He sent his soldiers,
To deliver news to Ayidarhan.

"Kokcher was busy around,
And fulfilled his mission.
Returned back to the quiet home,
Rested for two days,
Then called in people of all directions,
Held the grand ceremony.
They gave me this name Almanbet.

"One morning,
I went to Kokcher's palace,
When he saw my expression,
He asked me what the matter was.

"I hid nothing from him,
Poured out the annoyance in my heart:
'There is no hero not missing his hometown,
No person in the world does not miss his hometown,
Even steeds are unwilling to part with its flock.

" 'I can form an alliance with you,
This is the fortune Khuda bestowed to me.

" 'My beautiful hometown and fellows,
And those relatives,
Especially my kindly mother,
Are in my heart all the time,
The deep thoughts of missing them,
Makes me restless day and night.

" 'Please allow me to return my hometown,
In the time we appoint,
I can come back.'

"Kokcher kept silent,
And did not respond to my request.
Six days passed in a blink of an eye,
Ayinla bustled suddenly.

"Fifty thousand troops were ready,
Kokcher held the flag with gold words in the hand.
Saddled Kelejeran steed,
Stood in front of me prestigiously.

" 'Hero Almanbet, please start off now!'
I followed them,

Arrived in a mountain I had seen before,
That was a place called Kokjalhaktu,
At the foot of Kuyroktu mountain.

"Next morning,
He rode on to the mountaintop,
With me and the interpreter.
"Kokcher pulled the halter,
Said to me like this:
'Almanbet, my child,
You said you go back and visit your hometown,
Told your annoyance to me.

" 'I come today to see you off specially,
You just go and carry out your hope,
Please take my sincere wishes,
And return to me safely.

" 'I will stay here,
Wait for you for three months.
If I cannot get your news in three months,
I will lead the troops personally,
Charge Begin for you where no one has ever charged before.

" 'I will wait here,
For six months.
If I cannot see you then,
I will lead the troops personally to your hometown.
Go ahead, my child,
Wish you go back to your hometown smoothly!'

"I said goodbye to them, I went forward.
After several days journey,
I arrived at Tongsha city.

"I did not stay long in Tongsha,
Then went straight to Begin city.

After I stayed in the city for two days,
Finally I saw my father.

"I crossed the threshold safely,
My father Khan sat on the throne.
I lowered my head reverently,
Saluted him.

"When he saw I was standing in front of him,
He got angry suddenly.
He lifted a yurt-size hammer,
Threw it toward me angrily.
At this critical moment,
I frowned with my eyes and mouth fixed,
I drew out my gold-hilt dagger,
Shouted loudly but could only endure.

"I really wanted to cut his head off at that moment,
Ended his life.
I was afraid of others' sneer,
To say I killed my father,
And stained with his blood.

"I gave up the intention of killing him,
Was ready to ride on Kelejeran steed,
And left my hometown.

"My mother appeared at the moment:
'My dear colt,
You are my eagle,
I am the frame on which you take the rest.
Since you have chosen your way to go,
Please let me kiss your hand.
Your father is your enemy too,
He strikes a vicious blow on you mercilessly.

" 'Sorandick has become a mad dog,

You cannot fall in his hands,
You'd better run far away from here.

" 'My child,
You are my collar decorated with mink,
You are my star in the sky,
You are my only son and my life.'

"I expressed to her with tears:
'The sky is infinite and the earth is connected,
Please forgive your unfilial son.

" 'The sky and the earth lasts forever,
But where can I find my way out?
Stars are eternal, the sun is eternal,
Where can my happy life stay?'

" 'I will go to strange places,
To look for the hero who opposes Karamark,
And form an alliance with him,
Take the prairie and land being occupied back together.'

"I knelt to my mother and kowtowed,
Expressed myself to her:
'I have made my decision and never go back,
I will make a living wandering from place to place.'

"My mother bent down and raised me up:
'I will accompany you and never part with you.
I will go together with you,
Never live in dishonor like your father does.
I have five attendants around me,
I will not abandon them.'

"Heard my mother's complaint,
I led six horses from the stable.
We together seven people,

Mounted and were ready to start off.

"A peal of brass bell rang out suddenly at the moment,
Dense soldiers,
Dashed to us from all directions.
I held the spear of blue tassel,
Charged ahead with dust raised behind.

"Killed the soldiers stopped and chased us,
One by one like killing crows.
Headman was killed,
Soldiers were struck down,
Blood reddened the earth.

"They had known my track,
Chose forty young heroes,
Stood in the street and stopped me.
I nerved myself and charged ahead,
Young heroes shouted together that I am their master.
It was the true feeling and not a lie,
Ask me to take them with me.

" 'You are our backbone,
Our words are sincere,
There is no concealment at all,
Please do not leave us in the evil hand of Kakan.'

"I told them at the moment:
'As long as you all go side by side sincerely with me,
Please go together with me.'
We went on the journey for six days,
Tongsha city appeared in front of us.

"Arokai's son giant Kunwuer,
The trouble-making powerful enemy,
Had intercepted our way in the front.

"He sent his attendant warrior Budanchang,
Soldiers he led were as thick as sand,
Maroon steed Kerikeguran under him,
Blocked us in majesty.

"He raised his head high and rode on his steed,
Determined not to make way for us,
The huge helmet on his head,
Was cast by pig iron.

"His tall figure,
Was like a towering mountain.
If he threw himself on me,
I would have no chance to be alive.

"I grasped the spear and charged forward,
Nerved myself into the battlefield.
Waved my spear and urged my steed,
Tilted that insolent guy,
Off Kerikeguran steed,
On the ground.

"I, Almanbet, come and go freely,
Is not it my braveness?
Over-confident Chuwak,
I have more words to tell you.

"That guy fell off the steed,
Knocked his head on the ground.
'Defeated hero Budanchang,
Poked the spear into his chest.'
Among Ketay people,
My reputation spread far from then on.

"Soldiers were like shifting sand,
The surrounded ring got smaller.
Red sheath and pink gold hilt,

I drew out the sabre.

"I rushed forward with no hesitation,
To the place where soldiers gathered.
The sabre waved all directions,
Who dare go against me,
Would have no chance to run away from my hand.

"Karamark who stopped me,
Slumped to the ground and died;
I went over the blood streams of Karamark,
Came to the camp of Arashi.

"Lackey Chuwak,
From then on,
No one dare stop me again.
Forty thousand troops who stopped me,
None of them was survived.

"I turned round and looked around,
I found no one was around me.
Whipped my steed forward,
I had no wish to stay there anymore.

"I went toward the west without stop,
Came to a narrow valley floor in a mountain.
As I went out of the valley,
A hero stood there in my face.

"He was as huge as a mountain,
His waist was as thin as a sheath,
With wide belt and cotton boots,
Long hair trailed over his shoulder,
Like maroon steed's long mane was flying.

"His eyes were like bubbles in the lake,
They seemed to devour everything in the world.

His head was as big as a pot,
With a pair of eyebrows like hunting dog.

"Long beard like quiver,
Dense beard was as thick as ax handle.
He was in a towering rage,
As chilly as the fierce wind in the wilderness.

"If he found a right rival,
He could fight it out;
He was as strong as a bull camel,
He braced himself up like raging lake.
He had broad shoulders and thick chest,
He is a hero hard to find in the world.

"He rode on Alekala steed,
The steel spear waved left and right.
He raised his head and pulled the halter,
Waited for me to have a fight against me,
His eyes were red as flames sprayed,
He seemed to burn everything.

"Behind him,
Was hero Niskara of black face,
If he came out and fought,
No one could defeat him.

"His neck stretched one-span long,
Face was black as burning lamb liver,
Red eyes burned with flames.
Cowhide quiver tied on the saddle swayed,
Shining sabre hung on his waist.

"Beside him,
Was Kermuzsha's son Muradiler.
He ruled four hundred thousand troops,
Warriors fought against him never could flee alive.

"He rode on maroon steed,
Its tail curled up in good spirits.
His look was prestigious and noble,
His vigor was matchless in the world.

"Beside him,
Was Karamark hero Wushan,
He is good at using weaved iron net,
Set up defenses at all intersections.
He is a daring general of Karamark,
In order to intercept and kill us,
He had made good preparations.

"Beside him,
Was Kartkalan's daughter Sayikali.
She broke away from Kirgiz,
Went to Karamark camp for shelter,
I do not need say in details about her.

"People in Begin are divided into five tribes,
And each tribe has its own headman.
Headmen of all tribes gathered,
Except Georoy.

"It was impossible to turn the steed and flee,
But I had no good plan to get rid of them.
At this critical moment,
Who is the hero, who is the coward,
Testing time was coming.

"I waved my spear and charged forward,
Kunwuer's yurt-size figure,
Was shaking in front of my eyes all the time.

"I loosed the halter of Kelejeran,
Dashed to the front of Kunwuer,
Poked my spear out,

Jabbed him off the back of Alekala.

"Right at this moment,
Firelock roared, arrows fell as rain,
Ochogor firelock rumbled,
Deafened ears,
They used up all their bullets and arrows.

"I could not imagine what happened then,
I only felt dizzy and earth shaking.
When I cleared my mind and opened my eyes,
I had been trapped in seven layers of iron nets.
Both my steed and I were trapped,
Neither of us could move.

"The dense enemy soldiers were boiling,
The powerful enemy hero Kunwuer was right the leader.
I was cupped under the iron nets,
Fell in their ring of surrounding,
Could not flee and stood at the door of death.

"They pulled me together with iron nets,
Into Zhandochu city.
They said I am a fugitive traitor discarded the throne of Khan,
Said I am a bastard abandoned my families,
Said they would let me die with my steed together,
Said they would let me suffer the hardship of hunger.

"They locked me and Kelejeran steed,
In the forty-span deep city walls.
Miserable days began from then on,
I fell in hopeless desperation,
I spent two days in tears.

"Till the third morning,
I stopped weeping and cheered up,
I knew the tears of praying,

Could not make an exchange with their mercy.
I would brace myself up and fight bravely,
Rather than fall in misery and lose my will.

"Holy Creator,
I prayed to him and shouted,
Sought for his directions.
Heroes and warriors in the past,
Legend I had heard,
All appeared in my heart.

"I prayed to their souls,
I begged the sages sincerely,
I tossed repeatedly,
Finally I went to sleep.

"Sleeping on the horseback,
I went into a special dream:
My ally friend hero Kokcher,
Galloped on Kokala steed,
Wore his blue armor,
With strange expressions on his face.

"Ackura was towering,
Lion Ayikoler Manas was standing there too.
'They both come to rescue me.'

"When I opened my eyes,
They disappeared completely,
Only the greedy death gazed at my life.

"I nerved myself,
Asked for the help of Shaymardan① sincerely.
Seven layers of iron nets were torn off by me,
The nets were broken and fell.

① Shaymardan: The god of strength in Kirgiz people's heart.

"Got rid of the shackles of the iron nets,
How I dare stay anymore?
I rode on Kelejeran steed,
Leaped and jumped.

"Once I built one layer of adobe wall,
Let the steed jump again and again;
Once I built two layers of adobe wall,
Let the steed leap over repeatedly;
Once I built sixty layers of adobe wall,
Let the steed jump repeatedly.

"My lovely Kelejeran steed,
Heard I was urging it,
Made a big jump,
Leaped over without hurting even a hair,
From the towering city wall.
I did not hesitate and stay,
Left that devil prison.

"Nine days later,
I returned Tongsha city.
Tongsha is a boundless plain,
I came to the place where I killed forty thousand pursuers.

"I searched every inch of that place,
Tried to find my mother's body.
I searched everywhere,
And finally found my mother,
Among piles of corpses.

"She was as quiet as a wild goat,
She was as serene as a antelope.
Facing the west,
Lying on the ground,
That was my dearest mother.

"Seeing the corpse of my mother,
I put my right hand on the hip,
Got down on one knee,
Shouted my mother and broke into outcries.

"I put my left hand on my hip,
Bent over and knelt on both knees,
Called my mother's spirit with tears.
I had no courage to raise my head,
Did not want to stop crying.

"Till the night came,
I gradually cleared my mind.
If I continued crying there,
I will lose my will in the wilderness.
No one would sympathize with and understand me,
No one would share my sorrow and indignation.

"Is this my destiny?
Desperately,
I had to carry my mother's body,
Went into deep valley,
Led the steed and rushed,
For totally eighteen days and nights.
I wandered in the mountain like this,
Finally I climbed on the top of the mountain.

"Young master Chuwak,
Please listen to words carefully.
My words have a meaning of advice,
Forty warriors,
My brother,
Especially Chuwak,
You should listen carefully.

"I am a lonely man far from hometown,
Akberita's son Chuwak,

Please do not feel bored just listen carefully.

"The words I am going to tell and teach,
Should be sent to people with freedom,
I am a fugitive ran away from home,
Do not be angry, Chuwak,
Please listen carefully.
If I did not pay so much price,
I do not need repeat so many times.

"I got rid of the trap countless times,
Why are you so ungrateful?
Because of sixty headmen's alienation,
I left hero Kokcher.

"Because you are narrow-minded,
I will have no hesitation,
To part with my brother Manas,
And pursue the own way of each other."

At this moment,
Almanbet's tears flooded.
He stood up quickly,
Rolled his sleeves up and went up,
Moved a yurt-size black rock.

A dagger inserted in the ground,
Its point faced downward and the hilt upward.

Almanbet drew out the dagger,
Said to the heroes again:
"My mother is buried here.
I inserted the dagger here,
Pressed a big rock on it,
Stretched my arms and prayed,
Today I come in front of the rock again."

He hung the dagger on the waist,
Put the rock back to its place:
"Goodbye, the lion!"
Almanbet was going to leave,
Manas stood there woodenly.

Hero Chuwak walked up,
Said to Manas in low voice:
"You should grasp his halter,
Persuade him to stay sincerely."

Lion Manas listened to Chuwak's opinion,
Grasped the halter of Almanbet.
Almanbet could not leave forcefully,
He was unwilling to part Manas and go far away.
He had to wait hopelessly but full of deep love,
He could not give up his admiration and respect to Manas.

Manas said at this moment:
"Hey, Almanbet,
My close fellow,
Do not be so sad,
All hardships you have suffered,
Make us feel heartache.
You do not bear the bitter alone by yourself,
And blame everyone.

"It is improper you do like this,
Finally you will hurt yourself and your friends.
You two lions always dispute,
The morning still comes without the cock-crow.
I really do not understand,
What kind of things can make you have such dispute?

"You complained tearfully with an unceasing flow of words,
Are you unsatisfied with Manas?
Almanbet,

You should think carefully,
Kirgiz people never misjudge you.
When you are in need,
We would rather dedicate our lives for you."

Ayikoler Manas said like this,
Almanbet felt the sky became blue suddenly,
His anger vanished in a flash,
Like the sun came out of the clouds.

Excited tears flashed in his eyes,
He suddenly saw the light with all smiles.
Leaped off the horseback of Sariala,
Then said to Manas:
"Because of Chuwak,
I am blamed by you.
I act too rashly,
I beg for you Ayikoler's forgiveness."
Almanbet waved his sleeves and coat edges,
Lowered his head and admitted his mistake modestly.

How Manas could be completely indifferent as seeing this,
He dismounted too.
The dispute happened just now,
Vanished in a flash in an instant.

Chuwak felt very embarrassed,
He kept quiet,
Dug his nails and looked at the ground···

Two warriors shook hands and made peace,
Manas was overjoyed:
"You just mentioned Begin,
I got to know your hometown,
You mentioned Ketay people,
I got to know your people;
You talked your miserable sufferings,

Karamark is our common enemy.

"Why do not you tell us earlier,
About your hometown and your people,
I can accompany you to go,
And comfort your broken heart."
Almanbet responded like this:
"If you express your opinion earlier,
Talk about your grand plan earlier,
If you wave your whip high earlier,
We surely can go forward side by side."

Manas said again:
"We fight for Kirgiz people,
If the death descends on us,
Under the sabre of Kunwuer Bayi,
Can Ackura lead me to dodge the disaster?

"We fight in the cause of justice,
If the death descends on us,
From Kunwuer Bayi's persecution,
Can Ackura save my life?

"We are destined to die in the fight,
The ring of the hero will never disappear from his head;
Ochogor firelock will take the life of the hero,
But hero's reputation will last forever.

"A hero like me,
Even if ride on the cloud and fly in the sky,
Also will fall off from the cloud,
Down to the other world.

"If Khuda bestows us the good fortune,
The mount Ayimanboz under me,
Will get a pair of wings to fly in the sky.
Hero Chuwak beside me,

Will achieve what he wishes,
Embrace his dreaming beauties."

Ayimanboz under Manas,
Was good but its butt was not round and strong enough,
If enemy came out suddenly,
It could bear long time running.
Wise Almanbet,
Had already noticed this,
He felt keeping on the anxious seat.

Four heroes talked and laughed,
Went on their journey together.

Let us put this aside,
Sing about the story of how they won the first battle.

Experience and Gains in Patrol

Sayaz was a famous mountain,
That was the hometown of Ketay people.
Four heroes arrived,
At a place called Talchok.

They loosed their steeds and let them to eat grass,
Toward the direction of Begin,
They took out the telescope and watched.
When they sat down to have a rest,
Khan Manas began to say:

"Hey, Almanbet,
On the curled hill of Sayaz,
You described Begin city in details.

"The place we stay,
You just called it Talchok hill.
Please tell us in details,
The information of other places,
Under the rule of Begin with sixty city gates."

There was one thing like an amulet,
It always hung on the neck of Almanbet.
This magical thing was unusual,
It had a handle made of iron,
Which was a long telescope.

He did not take the belt off his neck,
But drew out from his pocket,

Adjusted it continually,
At a best position,
Began to watch ahead carefully.

Almanbet finished his observation,
Then said to Manas:
"I will tell you in details,
The mountains and hills in my hometown,
And vast plain and ocean around it.

"In the north there are all rolling hills,
There are three islands,
It is information of the territory of Kakan.

"A place called Kaynander,
Is the paradise for birds and venomous snakes.
In the east lies an ocean,
One piece of the surface of that ocean,
Is belonged to Begin.

"Gold and silver there,
Are the richest mineral resources.
A place called Kunto,
Is still going among people.

"My lion,
Rolling mountains are in the north,
It stretches to the sea,
That is the famous Changbai mountains.

"From one tip of the mountain,
From the direction near the ocean,
Go around it for some distance,
It is Goliya,
That is where Jurenduo lives.

"Almanbet stands beside you,

Learned the martial skills there.
Living in the world for eight thousand years,
Jurenduo is ever young.

"Greater Higgnan mountains, Lesser Higgan mountains,
Stretch thousand miles and connect with the Arctic Ocean.
I have heard but have never seen before,
That is a garden with lush trees.

"A kind of animal called panda,
Rare in the world,
Can be found there.
That is giant Chinmachin,
With flourishing population and vast territory.
Chinmachin is not my hometown,
But it closely connects with my hometown.

"The Arctic Ocean is on its north,
Iran is on its west.
The vast land I mentioned just now
Is all under its name."

Almanbet finished his words,
Manas continued the talk:
"I adjusted my telescope just now,
Observed the situation of the south.
Mists swirled there,
I cannot see clearly its true look.

"Edges there are angular,
Dim and flickering.
Sometimes it is the endless whiteness,
Sometimes it is totally dark,
I can see nothing.
Hero Almanbet,
What is the name of that place?

It is like being covered with mist.

"Look nearer from there,
There is a low dirt hill,
One tip stretches into the sea,
Others spread to all directions.

"Look further near,
There is a black mountain,
With rounding ranges of hills.
Low ranges rolled and stretched,
There is a yellow sector in the middle.

"Look ahead from there,
Well-arranged houses connect together.
Orchard is spread smartly among houses,
It is blurred beyond that.

"I watched carefully again and again,
Did not find the secret in it.
What is the name of this place?
Mountains connect on its north."

Almanbet continued the talk:
"You have already seen,
Three heroes distinguish carefully please.
The place that is angular and well-arranged,
Is where the giants live.

"Powerful soldiers guard there,
It is the palace of Khan Chebchep.
It connects with Ketay,
Legend passes from long time ago.

"The completely white wilderness,
Is a salt field,
It can be made into bullets and table salt.

"The black you saw,
Is the connection of the sea and the earth,
The sea and the earth merge into one.

"On that ridge,
The classic buries there.
Along the seaside,
Water birds like wild ducks, mandarin ducks,
Play freely and make your eyes confused.

"It stretches into the sea,
It is called Sanduba.
The black place,
Is where tea is being produced.

"The yellow part in the middle
Abounds with gold and silver.
If disturbance starts and begins an attack,
Tongsha people will flood out.

"Rows of houses,
Sparse orchards,
It is used to be called Begin,
But its real name is Kantun.

"It is the place merchants have to pass,
Discard the high and the low,
Merchants come from all directions.
I wanted to catch rhinoceros and elephants years ago,
I inquired about the information from merchants.

"Now Kakan city is in front of us,
Please let me go personally.
Let wolf Chuwak,
Accompany me."

Almanbet introduced,

The information there in details.
He would go with hero Chuwak side by side,
To spy on the newest information of Kakan.

Lion Manas and hero Sirak,
And the unique maroon steed in the world,
All stayed there and waited.

Two lions Almanbet and Chuwak,
Whipped their steeds and galloped ahead.
Almanbet showed his power in his hometown in the past,
His skills were marvelous,
He built a big bridge.

As long as one piece of board on it was stepped on,
A thousand firelocks would shoot together automatically.
Bullets flew in all directions,
Sparks splashed.

If two pieces of board were stepped on,
Tigers and lions would show their teeth,
Pounced up and tore the rival.

Giants followed tight,
Flames sprayed out of their eyes.

Hero Chuwak went in the front,
Almanbet followed him tight.

When they got to the bridge,
Almanbet pulled the halter.
He wanted to feel out,
Hero Chuwak's courage:
"Your mount Koktikai steed,
Is powerful enough and irresistible.
Even facing the coming lion,
I will not stumble in panic.

"My mount Sariala steed,
Is easy to get startled and lacks courage,
It is a hot-tempered horse.
Even a sparrow flies over it,
It will jump and show the terror feeling.

"The magical bridge in the front,
Hero Chuwak,
You should clear the way in the front,
Step on that magical place."

Heard what Almanbet said,
Heard the praise of his steed,
Hero Chuwak had no hesitation,
Whipped his steed and dashed ahead.

When he stepped on the first board,
Thousands of firelocks shot from all directions,
Tigers and lions ran ahead,
Roared and pounced on Chuwak.

Hero Chuwak was greatly surprised,
Turned his steed and wanted to run away:
"You, the Ketay, should be cut into pieces,
What on earth is this trick?"

Almanbet now told him,
Chuwak was convinced then:
"The bridge has been here from the past,
Such thing still makes me confused.

"There is a lot of hidden talent among Ketay,
A lot of them have magical abilities.
Kunwuer is full of craft and cunning,
He may cast a spell on it.
We can choose other way to go,
Go on our investigation with no hesitation."

Almanbet pretended to know nothing,
Turned his steed round,
Said that tried not to be found by enemy,
Reminded Chuwak to leave quickly,
Made Chuwak very nervous.

In the boundless wilderness,
There was a peak called Kukazk.
Two lions Almanbet and Chuwak,
Went around Kukazk and observed.

On the top of Kukazk,
Arokai's son hero Kunwuer Bayi,
Wore his own battle robe,
The battle robe was of twenty Bartman heavy.

He called in a dark mass of troops,
Was giving out his orders,
"This··· that···"
Generals and governors,
Were dense,
Different level officials were countless in number.

They shouted,
They talked and laughed,
The sound lingered on,
Did not stop for a long time.

Cunning Kunwuer Bayi,
When he set the wild white duck post,
He was afraid the duck could not fulfill the task,
He put a duckling in the water,
That was a more agile post.

Almanbet shot the old wild duck,
He did not know another duckling hid in the water.
When he turned round and returned at ease,

The duckling flew to the sky,
Directly to Begin to report the news.

Kunwuer got the news,
He was calling the troops and prepared to start off.

Two heroes fixed their eyes and watched,
Soldiers got prepared were overspread,
Waving flags covered the sky.

Looked ahead from one direction,
The earth was reddened,
Like a burning sea,
The time of battle must be prolonged.

It became blue if looking from the other direction,
Like a boiling sea,
The matter became more complicated.

Flags waved, horses thronged,
It became black suddenly,
The earth was filled with troops in an instant.

Suddenly the white came out,
The world was totally white,
It seemed it fell into enemy's hand already.

Then the earth turned into yellow suddenly,
Like heaven splitting and earth sinking,
It seemed the end of the world was before eyes.

Hero Chuwak stood on the hill,
Worried seriously.
His voice was hurried,
He said to Almanbet like this:
"From my telescope,
I see countless soldiers.

That is not troops,
It is like flood,
I do not know what to do.
If we are found by them,
Which side need we retreat? "

Heard Chuwak's words,
Almanbet responded in a mocking voice:
"Brave hero Chuwak,
You just find the surface of the matter,
You have already been shocked and have no idea."

Almanbet turned his steed round,
Came to a col at the direction of Kantun,
From the villagers there,
He got a lot of useful information.

Since that duckling flew back,
Damned Kunwuer Bayi,
Reported the news to Aisanhan immediately.
He called in all troops,
Sent widely the signal of danger.

Aisanhan was not surprised after hearing the news,
He just gave out the following orders:
"You only need send one person,
Do not need bother all generals.
No matter he is the noble Khan,
Now matter how powerful he is,
Will be captured by this person alive."

Aisanhan had a giant attendant,
His name was Majili,
He only had one eye,
So he was called one-eyed devil.

His body was as huge as a mountain,

He was extremely merciless as a devil.
Kunwuer Bayi sent out six messengers,
To invite him specially.

Got the invitation of his master,
Majili started off right away without delay.
He led countless soldiers,
Swarmed ahead along the flat wilderness,
As powerful as roaring flood.

Facing willows they ate with no hesitation,
Together with the roots.
Facing ice they also ate greedily,
Seeing a little spring water,
They drank the water up.

From the messenger,
Aisanhan heard Majili's characters,
He specially asked to prepare,
Giant Majili's food.

He asked to gather ten thousand donkeys,
Every ten donkeys were looked after by one person.

Wild hogs and venomous snakes,
Frogs and beetles,
Were carried with ten thousand camels,
One person drove three camels.

Tea and naan were piled as a mountain,
It was impossible to count the number.
Food was ready,
And put in the bags.

He sent out the former six messengers,
And added a few more,
Sent all them again to the camp of giant Majili.

We have talked a lot,
Now please listen to other information.
Seeing giant Majili,
Messengers stood aside with a panic.
Common people there,
All came to watch.

The extremely ferocious guy,
Put everything he got in his mouth.
No matter venomous snake or wild hog,
No matter frog or beetle,
No matter camel or donkey,
He swallowed them with skin and hair,
Let them struggle and scream.

The best food he liked,
Was the rotted thing in animal's stomach;
Even the soldiers sending the food,
Were swallowed by him,
Only a few were alive.

As seeing this,
All messengers wetted their pants in terror and fled.
Soldiers reported to Khan,
What they had seen,
In details and in loud voice.

On Majili's coming way,
A wide river was roaring.
People carried a great quantity of tree trunks and timbers,
Built a grand bridge over the river.
In order to build this bridge,
The bottom of the bridge piers were cast with lead,
Gold and silver spent on it could fill a col.

Under the piers there were ring supports,
Gears for expanding the bridge deck,

Were set right in the ring supports.
Numerous soldiers,
Stood near the bridge and guarded it.

Aisanhan gave out orders,
To these soldiers:
"Soldiers and numerous common people,
All need set out,
Pull the bridge deck all of one heart,
To stop giant Majili to cross the river."

Khan gave out the order,
No one dare resist but lower the head and obey.
"You damned Aisanhan,
We hope you die in your boots."
Numerous soldiers and common people,
Surrounded the piers and worked hard,
Cried out in pain and tears.

Many people could not bear the pain,
Gave out such complaints:
"Kirgiz will occupy towns and cities,
Then plunder our livestock if they come,
We present gifts then we may save our lives.

"If this guy as greedy as centipede comes,
If he breaks into our land,
He will cut the wheat in the field,
He will eat our orchards up and take the throne.

"No matter men, women, paupers or heroes,
He will eat us all,
Prosperous Begin city,
Will be scattered in a mess."

Common people were full of grievances,
No one was willing to listen.

In all ages,
Once the matter is related to government,
Who could change it?
Khan's order is most majestic,
People dare not resist but obey,
Less than the time of one meal,
The bridge deck was drawn back.

Right at this moment,
Giant Majili had come to the opposite riverbank.
The depth of this river,
Was a good thousand spans which could submerge a hill.

Giant Majili's ability,
You should listen carefully:
One thousand spans deep river,
It was hard to see the bottom of the river.
He rode on a ferocious rhinoceros,
Like crossing a little stream,
He stepped in the raging river without hesitation.

Sometimes, water flowed over the neck of Rhinoceros,
Sometimes, water flowed over its butt,
Sometimes, water only flowed over its shanks.

Heard he had rivals to fight against,
He was overexcited for a fight.
He did not wash away by the water,
He did not die in the river,
But he crossed the river and got on the bank.
In a blink of an eye,
He arrived at the city gate.

Aisanhan put on his robes of Khan,
Waited in front of the gate,
Thought about how he could act with right etiquette.
Seeing the majesty of the royalty,

That guy took a look at Aisanhan,
Lowered his head gently to show respect and saluted.
Aisanhan made a sign with the hand,
Let him turn to west.

Majili walked out of the palace of Aisanhan arrogantly,
Shouted loudly in angry tone:
"Where is Kunwuer Bayi now?"

Kunwuer Bayi heard the shout,
Rushed forward hurriedly.
This Khan and headman,
Made a nod and bent slightly in greeting.

Other officials and generals,
As seeing the figure of giant Majili,
They were all scared out of their wits.

"Who is Khan Kunwuer?
Please come up soon!"
They could only see his gesture,
But could not hear what he was saying.

"What an incapable official,
How you can come so late.
If you do not prepare earlier,
I will make blood submerge you.

"What a Khan Kunwuer,
As hearing the name of Manas,
You are scared and worried.
Who is Manas,
How cannot you know my ability?

"What kind of devil is he,
Where is that Manas now?
I will tie his hands together.

You only need tell me clearly,
I can cut his belly open now.

"Even if he is a mountain,
I will knock him down.
Send him in front of you,
Before the big crowd,
Eat him as he is alive."

This guy bristled with great anger,
He carried a yurt-size hammer,
He lifted it over his head,
It seemed he wanted to pound a hole on the earth.
Giant Majili,
Shouted loudly and madly.

Khan Kunwuer Bayi stood in front of him,
Showed the majesty of a Khan with no fear.
Killed the innocent people in the front by hammer,
Such example he had never heard before.
He reached his hand in the pocket angrily,
Took out a surprising tobacco pouch.

Sixty libra tobacco was filled in the pouch,
His pipe was still not full.
Two huge flints knocked together,
Yurt-size flame appeared over the pipe.
The damned guy puffed at it one time,
"Hulu, hulu", the sound continued in his throat.

Who had ever seen such a heavy smoker,
Soaked the black smoke all in the chest.
He exhaled the smoke,
Black smoke flew into sky,
Crows and magpies chirped with fear.
Thick smoke diffused everywhere,
Floated among his beard.

People could not bear the thick smoke,
All tried to run away and hide.

No one stayed beside him,
People had been dizzy,
Who could bear this strong smoke?
"Khan Kunwuer Bayi coughs badly,
How hard our life will be in the future?"
People were haunted with fear.

After he fully enjoyed his smoking,
Then he opened his blurred eyes.
He poured the ash out of his pipe,
The ash stuffed one street,
People walked on the road,
Went around him with complaints.

The smoke he exhaled,
Covered more than half of Begin city.
Young men and women, lonely old people,
Lost their way in the smoke,
And could not find their way back home.

That guy looked around,
Kunwuer Bayi was very flustered,
He hit on an idea and waved his arms,
Pointed to the direction of sunset.

The guy as stupid as a beast,
Dashed ahead like a boar.
Kunwuer Bayi returned safely,
People chattered and discussed.

"Let this guy go to die,
Let him suffer great pains.
Let Almanbet kill him!
Let forty warriors of Manas,

Roast his heart and liver and eat up.

"If they do not want to eat his heart and liver,
Let them cut his belly open and take out his gall,
Cut his eyes and pull out his eyeballs."

People opened their eyes wide and prayed,
Recited lections,
In that big temple,
A hundred thousand people gathered there.

Mountain-size giant Majili,
Finally went out of Begin city.
Facing the west,
Toward the tall hills,
Stepped forward like wind.

Almanbet hid in the mountain,
Watched behind a rock.
He noticed a high mountain,
Was moving forward slowly.

When he saw this,
He told himself:
"In Begin city where I played when I was little,
I had never seen such a peak.
It does not stand there still,
But goes around the valley along the foot of the mountain.
Who has heard, a mountain can move."

It was a mountain,
But it looked more like a hill.
Almanbet watched carefully,
It was neither a mountain nor a hill,
It was a strong Ketay warrior.

He lifted the telescope in his hand,

Watched it carefully again.
Wrinkles on the forehead,
Of the coming warrior,
Were like rolling summer pasture.

Eyelashes and eyebrows,
Were as dense as pinewood.
The single eye on his face,
Was like a bottomless pool.

Straight nose bridge,
Was like steep cliff.
Look at his mouth,
It was like a collapsed grave.

Look at his huge teeth,
They were as ferocious as tigers and wolves.
His body was like a tall tower,
Strong arms and legs were like phoenix tree trunks.

Almanbet continued watching,
Prayed to the Creator quietly,
Showed the praise from his heart:
"The Creator,
You create towering mountains,
Let them stick up to the sky.
You create hands for people,
Put one on the left and one on the right.

"The Creator,
Why do you create such a big bastard?
You create glaciers do not melt in a thousand years,
You create precious life,
But let them be enemy with each other and fight all the time.
A devil like him devours all things,
Why do you make him appear in front me?

"Life is so precious,
It is better to flee away and save life earlier,
Rather than stay here and die."
Respected hero,
Had such an idea suddenly.

He whipped his steed at top speed,
Urged Sariala steed,
Came in front of mountain-size Chuwak:
"My respected hero Chuwak,
I have extraordinary arm strength and a stone-hard heart,
I never feel intimidated when I face the danger.
In the powerful Ketay hometown,
If someone dare fight against me,
I never let him be alive.

"The giant lives in Sazansha is single-eyed,
He is a bastard rules Manguwa people,
I have heard it but never saw.
He is the headman of Manguwa people,
I heard he is matchlessly powerful and brave.

"I heard the legend of giant Majili before,
I have been filled with anxiety all the time.

"His father is a despotic-tempered Ketay,
Once his father was a devil killed people in cold blood.
His mother was a prostitute among devils,
How can others subdue him?

"He is the evil son of the devil,
Fight against him,
No one would be alive.

"We cannot stay here anymore,
Let's go, Chuwak!
We need run away from here as soon as possible.

Go and find wolf Manas,
Tell him the information of here.
Let Manas fight against giant Majili personally.

"He is a giant like Majili,
If he feels scared and dare not fight,
We'd better not stay even for a moment,
But go back to remote Taras."

Heard what Almanbet said,
Chuwak did not regard it as right:
"Almanbet, What are you talking about?
Why you have the thought of running away!
You have said down the ages,
You are the only hero.
Seeing an one-eyed person,
Why are you so scared with sweat?

"Let me go and challenge him,
We must be brave enough.
Even if the time of our death is coming,
We still need witness it.

"If we can defeat him,
Let's pull his single eye out.
As long as we still have one breath left,
Do not have any distracting thought of running away.

"Giving your life in the battle,
Will leave you an illustrious name in the world.
Because I accompany you,
I can share the honor with you."

Heard Chuwak's impassioned words,
Almanbet felt terribly ashamed.
If he was not a coward, what he would be,
His face reddened all over like smearing with blood.

He was most complimentary about Chuwak's words,
Almanbet laughed loudly,
And said to Chuwak:
"You are a real lion,
I hope you can fulfill your dream.
I was not aware of your moral quality in the past,
Today I will put away prejudices against you.

"Chuwak,
I will intercept him on the hill,
First I will use Almabash firelock,
When you hear the shot,
You should whip your steed and dash ahead."
Almanbet turned his steed as he finished his words,
Came to the top of the mountain at top speed,
And made Sariala steed crouch in grass.
He cleaned his firelock with the mane of his steed,
Loaded the lead bullets in the bore,
Opened the bag and poured bullets in it.

Lead and copper mixed together,
Poured into the bore,
One piece of lead was as heavy as a calf.
A fuse extended from it,
He grabbed it tight in the hand.

Right at this moment,
Damned giant Majili,
Staggered like a rutting bull camel,
His roaring was ear-deafened,
The earth shook along with it.

The place giant Majili came to,
Was right a valley,
Cliffs on both sides were towering to the clouds.
It was the road wood-choppers carved out,
The road was more than enough for,

Six firewood carriages went side by side.
But giant Majili got his shoulders stuck in the valley,
Which made him impossible to move forward.

He opened his single eye angrily,
Looked around fast.
Waved the hammer made of cast iron,
With the size of twelve yurts,
Pounded severely to one side.

The mountain collapsed in an instant,
Rocks like the lid of a pot,
Broke apart and flew to the sky.
Black rocks on both sides of the valley,
Turned into small pieces and scattered everywhere.

Majili broke open a path for himself,
And walked ahead ferociously.

As Almanbet saw this,
He put Almabash firelock on the rock,
Lay on the mountain top and craned his head,
Lit the fuse with burning charcoal.

Strong Almanbet,
Aimed at the enemy accurately:
"Here is the front of the saddle,
Right above his bladder,
It is the point I can get his life with one shot.

"However he wears six-layer iron armor,
The bullet can only pierce two layers,
How about the other four layers?
If I cannot kill him with one shot,
Then my blood will redden the earth."

He lifted the muzzle a little higher,

Then he had such a thought:
"Here is below the collar bones,
I can right aim at his heart.
If I hit the target,
It is the fatal place.
But he wears the iron armor,
How can I shoot and pierce it? "

He lifted the muzzle higher a little more:
"If I aim at his huge mouth,
Even if I hit the target,
It only can break his teeth,
It cannot pierce his helmet.

"The bridge of his nose is straight,
If I aim at his nose,
Even if I hit the target,
His nose can only be hurt half.
If he does not die,
There will be no guarantee of my life."

Almanbet felt nervous,
He lifted the muzzle higher a little more again,
"He has only one eye,
If he loses the light from the eye,
Even if he will not be dead,
It should be most fatal for him.

"Facing this tall and strong bastard,
I am surely nervous and scared.
I lost myself and have no idea.
It is right in the middle of the forehead,
It is right the place where eyeball and eye socket connect."

Almanbet aimed carefully,
Lit the fuse full of confidence.
With the sound of a shot from firelock,

Akberita's son hero Chuwak,
Opened his eyes wide and gazed at the hill.

The fuse burned up,
Sparks splashed out of Almabash firelock.
Mountain-size giant Majili,
Between his upper eyelashes and lower eyelashes,
Felt a severe pain.

Barrel-size lead bullet,
Splashed away with his eyeball,
Fell on the ground and burned to ash.
The lead bullet of Almabash firelock,
Did not break his head up.

Chuwak watched carefully,
When he heard the shocking sound of the firelock,
A puff of smoke came to the face with hot wave.
Along with the sound of the firelock,
He dashed on the top of the mountain.

Heavily injured giant Majili,
Opened his scaring large mouth,
Stood there and staggered.

Akberita's son Chuwak,
Did not daunt by the mountain-size giant,
He whipped his steed and dashed ahead with his spear.

He waved the sharp spear in the hand,
Stabbed in the giant's opened mouth.
Spear point pierced the giant's lips,
Stuck tight in the giant's teeth.

He pulled it around the body of the giant,
Tried to pull the sharp spear out,

He never imagined that the spear could be broken in two.

Chuwak went round the giant,
And hit and knocked him continuously,
Fought against the giant for a long time.
Majili struggled painfully,
Fell off on the ground with a scream.

When Almanbet saw this,
He warned Chuwak loudly:
"My hero Chuwak,
Be careful, if he stands up suddenly,
It will descend disaster on us."

Akberita's son Chuwak,
Was quick and reckless in temper,
He dismounted and dashed ahead with no hesitation,
Rode on the chest of the giant.

The giant struggled and screamed,
Waved his arms desperately.
As his pinkie swept,
Chuwak was thrown away,
And fell off in the mountain of one rope far.

"Chuwak, take out your battleax,
Cut his head off right now."
Heard such prompt,
Chuwak lifted door-size crescent ax,
Aimed at the back of the giant's neck,
Slashed to it severely.

The body of the ax ran deep in flesh,
Could not be pulled out no matter how hard he tried.
Chuwak exerted all his strength,
Dragged and pulled,
But still did not pull the ax out.

Chuwak could think of no way at all,
Shouted to Almanbet like this:
"My respected Arakai,
How is this guy so powerful?
His neck is so strong,
That bites my ax and I cannot pull it out!"

Black mane wolf Sultan Almanbet,
Heard what Chuwak said,
He burst into laughter,
Till the tears rolled down his cheeks:
"My warrior Chuwak,
Solution depends on yourself.
Maybe the best solution,
Is to skin him."

Two heroes made concerted efforts,
Waved axes in their hands,
Began to skin the giant.

It was like cutting a big tree,
Slashed their axes in turn,
Cut the giant's head off with great difficulty.

Right at this moment,
Almanbet said to Chuwak:
"Tie the head behind your saddle,
Take it to the mountain to Khan Manas,
Let him look at it carefully."

Chuwak made leather strip go through the giant's mouth,
Lifted the head,
Went to the right side of the steed,
Tied the head behind his steed.

When Chuwak mounted his steed,
Koktikai steed stood still there,

Its waist was bent and stood with difficulty,
Stared its eyes round and could not move even a step.

"Respected Arakai,
This head should be cursed,
It may break the backbone of the steed."

Heard the childish complaint of Chuwak,
Almanbet was happy,
Burst into laughter again:
"Above the hole,
You should cut his lips off right now!"

During the time Hero Almanbet,
Lived in Begin,
He always rode on rhinoceros to play,
He knew how to drive rhinoceros.

He led that rhinoceros,
Twisted and weaved the long hair of giant Majili,
Into a long rope,
And tied the rope on a huge rock,
Kept balance between the head and the rhinoceros' back,
Then drove mountain-size rhinoceros,
Toward Khan Manas.

Hero Manas and Sirak waited in the mountain,
Manas said with great worry:
"Hero Sirak,
Two heroes went to Kantun,
Why they still do not come back.

"They have gone for many days,
It made me worried a lot.
You go to the hill in the front please,
Take your telescope and watch carefully,
To see whether you can find them?"

Sirak got the order and rushed onto the hill,
Gazed into the distance carefully.
Two heroes Almanbet and Chuwak,
Dragged the huge monster,
Had arrived at the foot of the mountain.

"Did they plunder the trade caravan,
Grabbed the treasure and drove the caravan here?
Do they think the lion is hungry and thirsty,
And drag the huge watermelon back?"

Before Sirak came back to himself,
Two warriors Almanbet and Chuwak,
Turned into a valley,
And disappeared from his sight.
Hero Sirak was over excited,
Urged his steed ahead to meet them.
He looked to the "war trophy",
Did not get time to greet them.

He found on the back of the rhinoceros,
The rock was on one side and the head on the other side.
Sirak took the head off the back,
Kicked it and walked forward.

He was overjoyed and reported the truth:
"What warriors Almanbet and Chuwak carry,
Is not a watermelon but a head.
It is not a rope,
But the hair plait that tie the head.
What keeps the balance with the head,
Is a rock not gold."

When Ayikoler Manas saw this,
He asked two heroes right away:
"Heros Almanbet and Chuwak,
Please tell me the truth without hiding anything,

Why do you carry such a huge rock,
All the way of great pains with you?

"If the enemy sentry does this,
What should their warriors do?
If the passers-by do this,
What should their soldiers do?

"If Khans see this head,
They must be frightened out of their wits.
Seven Khans come here passively,
They must flee away in one night.
If a riot starts,
Who can control such situation?

"Brave hero Sirak,
Please kick this head far away,
Like kicking a ball,
Till no one can see it,
Do not let soldiers notice it.

"My invincible heroes,
Even if the death reaches its sharp claw out,
I believe you two will never be scared.
My tough heroes,
Even if you pound by iron hammer for thousand times,
You will stand still like towering mountain.

"Even if drag you to all directions at the same time,
Your muscle and bones will not be broken.
Even if an enemy attack you with the artillery,
You will not fall off on the ground.

"You are my perfect generals,
In majestically great state.
People in the world are different,
Clouds in the sky do not distribute evenly,

Rains fall unevenly at different places;
The person controls everything,
Now why does he run away? "

Heard what hero Manas said,
Heard the blames from the hero,
Two heroes wanted to be praised first,
Now they could only keep silent.

Hero Sirak,
Jammed the head of giant Majili in a cave,
Buried it with loess,
Set the rhinoceros free in the nature.
After doing all these,
He trotted back to hero Manas.

Heroes urged their steeds on the journey,
Almanbet whipped the steed and loosed the halter,
Went in the front of them.
Almanbet had bright eyes,
Heroes dashed ahead with no stop,
Came to Tuyouktor pasture of Kerchindu.

This place Tuyouktor,
Was a paradise for wild animals.
It was an exclusive place for Khan,
Common people never dare approach it.

Seeing his homeland,
Almanbet said:
"Aisanhan comes here and visit,
Every other year.
Sometimes he stops at lower reaches,
Sometimes he goes to its end.
Any other ministers and generals,
Are never allowed to enter this pasture.

"Lion Chuwak, Ayikoler Manas,
You two stay and rest here please,
You can hunt when you feel lonely,
You wait till the sixteenth day,
You can get our news."

After finishing these words,
Almanbet rode on maroon steed and galloped,
Led hero Sirak,
Rose dust all the way.
They climbed mountains and crossed rivers,
Pulled the halters beside that bridge.

Almanbet said to Sirak:
"Your mount maroon steed can go thousand miles a day,
It does not jump angrily even if you lash its head.
It is moderate in temper,
It never exposes its track easily.

"My steed Sariala,
Is hot-tempered,
Even the slightest movement can frighten it,
I could not catch its habits.
You clear the way on the bridge first please,
I will follow you tight."

Felt hat had black edge,
Khan Jagurp's son hero Sirak,
Leopard Manas' younger brother,
Struck the stirrups hard,
Urged the steed ahead with no hesitation.

When they got to the bridge,
Abnormal situation appeared around them suddenly:
It was like artillery rumbled,
Cliff collapsed and rocks rolled down.
It was like lighting the fuse of Arckelety firelock,

Mountains collapsed and the sea roared.
Like the sun and the moon collided,
Threw the flames into the sky.

The firelocks shot with great noise,
Drums beat continuously.
Tigers and lions roared,
Noise deafened ears.

Sirak was perfectly calm,
All these illusory changes,
Had been penetrated by him:
"It is just some tricks,
It could only deceive three-year-old kid and cowards."
He sat on the horseback,
He was dismissive with calm expression.

Brave hero Sirak,
He was as brave as a tiger,
Which could compare with Manas.
Numerous other heroes,
None was better than him.

"The spell makes all these troubles.
How it could make a hero scared."
Sirak dashed ahead with no fear,
Did not put what happened in the front in his heart.

Tiger-like Sirak,
Urged the steed and dashed on the bridge.
As long as he could pass the bridge,
The way to Begin would not be far.

Almanbet lowered his head,
Sat on the back of Sariala steed and swayed.
Sirak led the maroon steed,
Accompany him tight.

They passed winding mountain paths,
Climbed over rolling mountains,
When the sky was of innumerable stars,
They arrived at the outside of Begin.

There was a Dongan named Kojoaler,
Who played with Almanbet when they were little.
When Almanbet was in Begin,
They were bosom friends of no secrets from each other.
"Forty years later I will come back,
We will meet at that time."
They had such a promise with each other.

Almanbet jumped off the steed,
Knocked the door of Kojoaler gently.
"If the promise will come true,
The time of Almanbet's coming is not far."
It was what Kojoaler told himself recently.

"The appointed date is coming,
I will dig a cellar for him to hide,
Let him rest and wait in the cellar."
He had already dug a cellar,
And built a secret pass to the cellar.

Kojoaler heard the knocking on the door,
He guessed it was Almanbet outside.
Kojoaler was out of his head,
He appeared in front of them fast.
He had no time to trim his beard,
He rushed to his friend with unkempt appearance.

Kojoaler held the halter,
Helped them dismount.
Almanbet and Kojoaler,
Long departed friends met each other again.
They shook hands and greeted each other warmly,

Kissed each other's fingertips.

He came to the city gate,
Pointed the ready secret pass,
To Almanbet carefully:
"The spring flows from west to east,
And goes to the entrance of the cellar,
With dense reed on both sides of the spring,
The entrance is under the marked reed.
All other entrances,
Are covered completely with black thorn."

Almanbet mounted,
Came to the spring,
Saw the mark Kojoaler made there,
He was filled with joy suddenly.

He sat on the back of the steed,
Held the spear in the hand firmly,
Pricked the marked reed.
A secret pass into the city,
Appeared in front of him right away.

He seemed to have known the secret pass pretty well,
Urged his steed all the way ahead.
Sirak looked right and left,
Was very surprised with the secret pass.
All daily supplies needed,
Were all prepared well there.

Almanbet and hero Sirak,
Stretched their arms and legs and sat down slowly;
They drank strong tea,
The fragrance of the strong tea overflowed,
It helped them relieve from tiredness.

When they ate and drank their fill,

Kojoaler said the following words,
To Almanbet:
"Almanbet, after you left,
Kunwuer Bayi and Muradiler,
These two rulers became unbridled.
They descended too many disasters to Begin.

"Your fiancee Turna gazed with eager expectation,
She is longing to have you back.
There is a young man named Keyiba,
He just turns into an adult,
But he is more ferocious than those two.

"The girl having been waiting for you for forty years,
Is going to marry Keyiba today.
Clouds cover over her head,
She will be occupied by that bastard.
Today they are holding the wedding,
It is a hundred percent true."

Almanbet was simple-minded in love,
When he heard Turna suffered in such bad fortune,
Red face turned pale immediately:
"Kojoaler, my best friend,
Please lend your steed to me.
If Khuda helps me and everything goes smoothly,
Let heads of Keyiba and Turna roll on the ground."

Kojoaler's mount the grey steed,
Did not have a showy appearance,
But inwardly,
It had the power of a fine steed.

Almanbet rode on the grey steed,
Turned round and warned Sirak:
"My hero lion Sirak,
Do not go out of Kojoaler's threshold rashly,

Rest here and wait for my news.

"When there are innumerous stars in the sky,
I can come back.
An angry servant like me,
Khuda must bless me."

After saying goodbye,
Almanbet whipped his steed ahead.
He went into the city freely,
Continued going forward with no scruples.

He looked right and left in streets,
People thronged in the streets with big noise,
They talked and laughed with gifts in everyone's hand.
Silks and brocades were riotous with color,
Bowls and dishes were complete.

Almanbet pretended he knew nothing,
Asked a passer-by about it.
The passer-by was honest,
He answered Almanbet:

"Many years ago,
In this well-known Begin city,
It is said that there was a Khan,
He left the palace and went to place far away.

"His fiancee was abandoned in this city,
She has been waited for him to come back,
She still does not get married till now.

"Recently, a hero appears,
Like a steed outstanding in horseracing.
Even Kunwuer Bayi and Muradiler will shake,
When they hear his roaring,
Both of them will be scared out of their wits

And demean to greet him.

"The fiancee of that run-away prince,
Is going to marry this hero.
People come from all directions,
To attend this grand wedding."

Proved the truth of it,
Almanbet held the halter,
Turned round and went into a musical instrument shop,
Bought a dual string instrument.

He was not only eloquent,
But also a singer who could play instrument.
He plucked the strings,
Sang melodiously:
"General's daughter Turna,
Has lost her looks but still pretends to be young.
The young general is going to marry her,
She will endlessly enjoy the high position and great wealth."

Almanbet plucked and sang along the street,
Melodious singing spread over the city.
Almanbet made the lyrics spontaneously,
He sang what was happening.
He looked right and left,
To look for someone who could sing antiphonally.

People were moved by his song,
The news flew into general's family.
Keyiba gave out the order right away,
Asked to take the singer to him.

Soldiers all turned out,
Pulled and dragged Almanbet,
Who pretended to be a singer into Keyiba's palace.
In front of a big gate,

An invitation was handed to Almanbet,
Soldiers pushed him in the gate,
And they still stood out of the gate.

It was cool and blurred in the garden,
Trees were dense and branches were lush.
It was bustling in a splendid white house,
It was the bridal chamber of Keyiba and Turna,
Laughter came out from their house.

Almanbet was like burning flames,
Came to the bridal chamber straightly.
He pulled his feet out of the stirrups,
Jumped off on the ground.

Turna clinging together with Keyiba at the moment,
Pushed and got rid of Keyiba's arms suddenly,
And knelt on the ground.

Keyiba was fazed,
Squatted and held up the bride's face:
"My dear, what happened?"
Turna was too scared,
There was no redness on her cheeks,
Hair stood up on her face.

She managed not to be scared,
Said in shaking voice:
"Someone dismounts out of the door,
The earth shakes under his feet.
Maybe it is young master Su coming back,
I feel thirsty and flustered,
My blood seems not to run and I feel hopeless…"

She did not finish her words,
Before her voice dissipated,
Almanbet had stepped in the threshold.

He waved his dagger,
Killed mercilessly,
Keyiba and Turna.
Blood reddened the earth,
Almanbet was still angry,
So he cut their necks off.

He took three coats,
Off from Ketay;
Took off a scarf from Turna's head,
And took her bracelet off her wrist.

Please listen carefully,
What on hell hero Almanbet wanted to do,
Each of five city gates were guarded by sentries,
People could not go out of the gates freely.

Almanbet was very conscientious,
He dressed up as a Ketay headman,
With no one noticed,
He took two heads,
Sneaked out of the city.

At the entrance of the city,
He hung the heads on the wall.
Whipped his steed and galloped at top speed,
Returned to Kojoaler and Sirak.

"Kojoaler, my friend,
You can return safely,
Listen to me, go back as soon as possible,
Spread what happened here to people there.

"If Ketay notice it,
You will be implicated,
You do not stay and go back quickly,
I must not let you suffer hardships with me."

Heard the caring words from Almanbet,
Kojoaler responded immediately:
"Respected Almanbet,
My family and property,
Has already been moved safely,
I stay here specially to wait for you.
Please take good care of you all the way,
I will go back as early as I can."

They shook hands and said goodbye,
Kojoaler stepped in the stirrups firmly,
Turned round and went on his returning journey.
He had known clearly,
The death of Keyiba and Turna.

Almanbet said at the moment:
"My hero Sirak,
We do not need wait here.
We need mount now and gallop at high speed,
Find a pasture to feed the steeds,
And discuss what to do next there."

Two heroes dashed ahead side by side,
Came to Saskburak spring,
Stopped by the bank of reed lake.

Kangayi augured Eranguduk,
Was the friend of the death.
This guy was highly skilled in spells,
Depending on drinking the sacred snow water in mountain,
He had lived for three hundred and fifteen years.

Before Manas was born,
He had made clear prediction.
His spell was accurate and effective,
He never misjudged.

Giant Majili had no news after a few days he was sent,
Kunwuer Bayi felt extremely uncomfortable.
He invited Eranguduk at night,
And said to Eranguduk:
"Come quickly, you damned Eranguduk,
Open *Esterrap* and read quickly.

"Only the duckling came back to me,
All other animal posts,
Are not seen till now.
No matter what happened,
Do not hide to me, tell me."

Augur Eranguduk,
Read the book *Esterrap*,
All the things had happened before,
Appeared in his eyes one after one.

The powerful place Kakan,
Would have great disaster descended.
He had seen this clearly,
How he could hide this truth.

He told the truth in details to Kunwuer:
"White wild duck, argali and fox posts,
Were all killed by Kirgiz.
Only one duckling,
Got rid of them and came back to you.

"Four heroes,
Came here and investigated.
Giant Majili started off a few days ago,
Was killed by Almanbet at the foot of the mountain.

"He carried Majili's head on rhinoceros' back,
Went back to Manas.
This is not surprised,

What was more surprising is that they rested for two days,
In Kojoaler's home,
But no one noticed it.

"Right at last night,
He sneaked into the city,
Cut off the heads of Keyiba and Turna,
Hung them on the city wall.

"If you take my advice,
These Kirgiz are rather complicated.
Please be generous with your wealth,
Livestock should be presented in flocks,
Ketay beauties should be chosen on their will.

"Do not make people bleed and injure,
Do not make people suffer from hardships either.
Do not sacrifice for the treasure,
Shake hands and make peace with them first.
Choose a suitable opportunity in the future,
We can get even with them.

"Kirgiz comes in stormy manner this time,
They will not retreat if they cannot fulfill their goal.
We need avoid their spirit,
Save our energy.
Be generous with all your wealth,
We'd better make them turn and go back out of the city.

"Golden throne must not be lost,
We cannot stain ancestors' illustrious names,
We cannot become a laughing stock of the history.
Kakan city with sixty gates,
Must not be occupied by Kirgiz.

"My respected Kunwuer Bayi,
You should seek a way right now,

To keep our dignity and reputation."

Eranguduk talked a lot,
General Chabalai who sat aside,
Shouted with anger:
"You damned Eranguduk,
You should go to hell now!
Do not talk nonsense here.
Why do we feel frightened with our enemies,
And present Kirgiz gold and silver?

"My mount is Chanduboz① steed,
I am strongly desired of drinking blood,
I cannot get satisfied for a long time.
I will mount and start off tomorrow,
Capture those four Kirgiz alive,
Tie them to the city.

"Sorandick's son,
Must shoot the single eye of the giant.
When Majili fell off on the ground,
They must take the chance and come up,
Dismembered him and slashed at him.

"Kunwuer Bayi, Georoy and Niskara,
Muradiler and Wushan,
You are all well-known heroes in the world,
Why are you all so scared now?
You all said Manas is an ever-victorious hero,
The only destination of going against him is to die.

"I am also a famous hero,
I will capture Almanbet and Manas,
Tie them and take them to palace.
If they swagger and show off their power,

① Chanduboz: Kirgiz language, it means the steed rising up dust.

I will be merciless on them.
I will skin them,
Put their skins on the ground and let everyone tramp.

"When the morning comes, I will start off,
Before Manas gets up,
I will get on the top of the mountain.
I will slash at him,
Make his head broken and bleed.

"When the sun sets,
You send out the troops,
Let them witness,
My power and ability."

Chabalai was too arrogant,
Totally regardless of his own destiny.
He did not let yurt-size Kunwuer Bayi say anything,
He chose four generals to go with him.
He criticized Eranguduk,
Did not turn round but walked out of the palace hurriedly.

No matter Khan or common people,
No matter men or women,
There were never people,
Said something to criticize Eranguduk.
Chabalai's words,
Made Eranguduk angry and felt wronged.

Eranguduk was boiling with rage,
His face looked ghastly.
He panted heavily,
With his nostril breathing like buck goat.

He staggered up,
Took out the towel and wiped the sweat.
At break of the day,

He came to the side of Almanbet.

As seeing Eranguduk coming,
Almanbet stared openmouthed.
He fixed his eyes and watched carefully,
He found Eranguduk had no evil intentions,
It seemed he had something to discuss.

According to Kangayi's custom,
Almanbet specially saluted him.
They seemed to miss each other,
They showed great warmth to each other.
Eranguduk said to himself:
"He deserves to be called the descendant of Khan,
Almanbet performed etiquette well.
He is clear-minded and very wise,
He showed great respect to me."

Before Almanbet asked him,
He had prepared what he wanted to say.
Eranguduk hid nothing,
Complained all wrongs in his heart.

He could not wait and said:
"What I said has two meanings,
I come specially to report to you.
Chabalai is new but very ferocious,
None of Beks and generals in Begin,
Can compare with him.

"If he becomes hot-minded,
Dare fight against Kunwuer Bayi.
If he continues acting only on his will,
His time of death will be coming.

"Now he can get to the swamp at most,
He can get to the black beach at least.

One of you attacks head-on,
The other one attacks from aside,
Surround this arrogant guy,
Kill this overestimated enemy,
Cut his head off.

"If we do not surround and intercept him,
Let him flee away freely,
Disasters out of our imagination,
Will descend on you.

"He is a very ferocious guy,
Khan's dignity did not make him obedient.
You all will be swallow by him,
It is not just an exaggeration to scare you,
I do not exaggerate his ability.

"Hero Almanbet,
The second words I will tell you are:
When you were killing the white fox,
Did you skin it,
Did you make its skin into a coat immediately.

"Thousands of soldiers,
Follow Chabalai.
You need defeat them first,
Then continue your investigation.

"On their prairie,
Livestock spread like clouds in the sky,
You can plunder the horses on your will.
In order to accomplish these missions,
You need search your mind.
I will not stay in Begin,
But run for my life to Kangayi."

Eranguduk finished his words,

Turned his steed round in a hurry,
Jumped like a hunting dog,
Disappeared at the horizon.

Looked at the disappearing Eranguduk,
Almanbet mapped out the battle quickly:
"My lion, Sirak,
You tie your steed Kartkulan tight,
On the red reed.
According to what Eranguduk said,
Forty warriors Chabalai led are very brave,
They are pouncing toward us like mad dogs.

"I will ride on Sariala steed,
Ambush at the side,
Before he comes.
You cannot recoil here,
You need attack bravely head-on.

"Even if he is powerful and matchless,
You do not recoil.
I will attack from his back,
You intercept head-on.
If you meet with him first,
You'd better nerve yourself and wave your spear,
Poke him off the horseback.

"Dear black mane wolf,
You cannot be soft-hearted.
As long as general Chabalai fall off,
Forty warriors beside him will be stricken dumb,
And scared to death on Kalasu bank."

Almanbet urged again and again,
Leaped on this steed firmly,
Toward the Kalasu swamp,
Whipped his steed and galloped at top speed.

Clouds of dust raised under the steed hooves,
Before Chabalai came,
He had climbed over the mountain,
Waited for the enemy to come into his trap.

He gazed into the distance,
Saw dust flew in the horizon,
Five blurred figures galloped forward.
Small stones splashed under hooves,
Like arrows piercing the sky.
Under the hooves of their steeds,
Tree branches were broken and fell.

Chanduboz steed under Chabalai,
Galloped forward at high speed,
With its mouth opened as a cave.
White saliva of yurt-size,
Splashed on both sides of the steed.

When Almanbet left Begin,
This guy was still nobody,
Now he became a famous hero.
He was stubborn and cared for nobody,
In the battlefield,
He always drank rival's blood up.

His sinister appearance scared others,
He had the courage of hungry tiger,
He had the power of ferocious dragon.
Normal warriors came to fight against him,
Would be gulped by him,
Together with their steeds.

He had a mountain-size body,
His sight was as ferocious as snow in winter,
Anyone who fought against him,
Was like meeting the death.

Chabalai swaggered,
Whipped and urged ahead.
Four warriors accompanied him,
Were not inferior to him at all.

Sorandick's son Almanbet,
Stood alone by himself,
Never feared when he was in danger,
Never soft-hearted when facing powerful enemies.

Heroes and warriors in the world,
Could never run away from his hand.
He was wise and could divine the unknown,
He was clever with boundless wisdom.
Warrior Almanbet,
Was suitable for all words of praise.

His shout was like a thunder,
He shouted the name of "Manas!",
Dashed to enemies from aside.
Heard the illustrious name of Manas,
Chabalai's panic heart was shaking.

Right at this moment,
Hero Sirak appeared in the front.
Facing such sudden situation,
Chabalai guessed:
"The person shouting behind,
Must be Almanbet.
I have heard the name of Manas,
But never know what he looks like.
Manas owns a grey magical steed,
The person riding on the grey steed,
Might be Manas himself.

"I need brace myself up,
March forward courageously,

I cannot turn my steed round and flee.
I will poke the Brute high official,
On the point of my spear.

"How can I turn round and flee?
I will urge my steed and run to the front of him.
Let this self-conceit Brute die,
I will make his blood drain up.

"Then I will turn round,
Tie lackey Almanbet's hands and pull him back.
It is my good luck today,
My hot blood is boiling,
I can meet such a chance."

He waved the deadly spear,
Big noise came from the spear point,
As loud as the bugle.
The one-span long sharp spear point,
Was angular and made of pure steel.
Numerous heroes and warriors in the world,
Had died under this spear point.

When he rode the steed and galloped,
Trees of yurt-thick on both sides,
Were knocked down by his stirrups.
When generals saw this,
They were all surprised.

Hero Sirak was unrivaled in bravery,
He looked down his nose at the giant,
He did not show any panic at all,
Did not turn round and retreat.

He waved the spear and galloped ahead,
He had no scruples even facing the powerful enemy;
In the fierce battlefield,

The hero had no time to consider his own life.

He had killed countless enemies,
Alone by himself.
He was clever full of wisdom,
Flames burned in his eyes.

He was brave and faced death calmly,
He was a vigorous general.
In the bloody fight,
He always gave no thought of his personal safety.

He was born of the same parents with black mane wolf,
He was the son of Khan Jagurp.

He urged Tilkezler steed under him,
Enemy general in front of him was arrogant,
He was filled with the rage immediately.
Poked the spear the general stabbed aside,
He attacked by the way and stabbed the rival down the steed.
The rival had seven-layer iron coat on,
He strained every nerve and poked his spear out,
The spear point pierced the shining shoulder pad,
Tore a one-span long opening.

Hero Sirak never missed his target,
Blood ran down along the spear shaft.
The bastard Chabalai who cared for nobody,
Finally rolled off on the ground from Chanduboz's back.
With his legs and arms stretched out,
He deserved it.

The other four warriors,
Were scared out of their wits,
And fled in panic.
Facing Almanbet who came in their faces,
They were scared dumb and dare not fight.

Witnessed the power of Sirak,
They were frightened in great desperations.

They dare neither wave their spears to fight,
Nor flee away for their lives,
They completely did not know what to do,
Like they fell in boiling whirl.

Two heroes on the expedition,
Killed five enemy generals in an instant,
The real hero was right like them,
With no blood stained on their battle robe at all,
They had killed and knocked the enemy off the horse.

Almanbet held his helmet up,
Said to Sirak:
"Please turn your steed round,
Go to see Kartkulan steed and take a look,
Enemy troops are as dense as cow hair,
They must come from Gobi desert and fight right away.
I will give them head-on blows here,
I will not let them go forward from here."

Saw hero Sirak off,
Almanbet acted quickly,
Wore the coat made of white fox skin,
Dressed himself up as Kunwuer Bayi.

He buttoned up on both sides,
And buttoned all up,
As he dressed himself up this way,
It was too hard to distinguish him from Kunwuer Bayi.

He caught a black steed,
Put the cloth prepared before on the horseback,
Dressed the steed up as Alekala steed.
He and the steed both dressed up,

He dressed himself up as Karamark Khan.

Soldiers did not know he was the fake,
They thought Kunwuer Bayi came to the battlefield.
Almanbet used his wisdom,
Rushed onto the tall mountain.

People thronged in the ground,
They swarmed forward.
Thickly dotted soldiers,
Moved forward as ants.

When Almanbet saw this,
He said in Karamark language first.
Then he ordered soldiers to stop marching forward,
But going back to the camp,
In Ketay language.

His voice was like lark's singing,
Gave out orders in different languages,
Fluently and loudly.

"It is our Khan who is coming,
To relieve us from suffering."
Tired soldiers took the chance,
Turned round and ran back immediately,
Like they got wings.

Almanbet stood there still,
Sirak came and stood beside him.
Let us put this aside,
Talk about how hero Almanbet,
Introduces his hometown,
To Sirak.

Almanbet's love knot of hometown

Two heroes joined together,
Discussed for the future things.
They witnessed enemy soldiers fleeing in utter confusion,
Their beard shook,
They talked and laughed freely and happily.

Accomplished Almanbet,
Spread Chabalai's battle robe,
And put it on hero Sirak,
Said to him to show his wisdom:
"We left Kopkoler,
Went through Gobi desert of Yellaman,
And arrived at this place.
Our beard got no chance to be trimmed,
They are shaggy and ugly."

He stroked his beard,
Continued saying with smile:
"We need trim them,
Otherwise we are easy to be found by enemies."
What Almanbet said was reasonable,
They shaved and changed their looking.

Chabalai's helmet,
Was put on the head of Sirak.
Almanbet took out a bronze mirror,
Asked Sirak to look into the mirror:
"Look into the mirror,

Look at yourself, my hero."

Sirak looked into the mirror,
His face turned and he got very angry.
He took the helmet off this head,
And threw it far on the lawn.

He gazed at Almanbet angrily,
Began to pour his complaints out:
"Dear Almanbet,
I do not want this ugly helmet,
To destroy my appearance.

"Where is my beard?
My precious beard was so pretty,
They are the symbol of good fortune.
There is beard full on the earth,
But you shaved all of mine.

"My respected Almanbet,
You make me so sad.
If I go back to my homeland like this,
Kirgiz are all good at talking,
They will laugh at me mercilessly.
They will discuss my appearance,
Which will make me embarrassed and hide nowhere."

Seeing Sirak's angry mood,
Almanbet gave way to uncontrollable laughter,
Guided Sirak with good words:
"For the sake of common people's interest,
Seventy two skills are not enough.
Shave beard and change appearance,
Change the appearance of the steed,
So we can cheat enemy sentries.

"From now on,

You should play deaf and dumb before people,
Do not say even one sentence.
If we do not do this,
It will be impossible to accomplish the mission,
How we can get to know the bottom of enemy,
How can we answer the questions from lion Manas?

"Beard shaved can grow again,
When people know the reason,
They will forgive us."

Almanbet said sincerely,
Hero Sirak was fully convinced,
Two make-up lions,
Waved the halters and started off on the journey.

"Let's go quickly, my warrior!"
Two heroes urged each other,
Led Kartkulan steeds forward,
With no stop and with dust rose behind.

Along the rolling hills,
Along the winding paths,
Stepped broad basin,
Went through rough alkali rapids,
They galloped at top speeds all the way,
Like they were going on clouds.

Two heroes were in high spirits,
They came to the edge of a city.
In a dark and blurred forest,
Almanbet jumped off the saddle,
Walked into the lush forest.

No matter in the day or at night,
The ghastly bamboo forest was totally quiet,
A secret pass no one knew hid in it.

This mysterious place,
Was only known by Almanbet:
"Get off, hero Sirak,
Before I come back,
You should wait here and do not leave even a second."

"The city gate far away,
Is the gate of Khan's palace.
There are thousands of soldiers,
Mostly Ketay people.
The palace has its secret,
Please listen to me carefully.

"There are brave sentries beside the gate,
There are ferocious tigers and leopards;
There are mad camels with sharp teeth,
There are huge elephants.
People there are all ferocious,
Stone-hearted and with no emotion.

"Listen carefully from inside,
You can hear the sound outside.
But two people on opposite side of the wall,
Even they shout to each other they still cannot listen clearly.

"I will roll my coat edge up,
Carry my head in my own hand.
From that wide palace gate,
I will walk into the palace.

"When I hold the handle to open the gate,
Like the sound of gunshot,
You will hear the cracking sound.
An illusory world will appear in front of your eyes,
To confuse your nerves.

"Do not think Almanbet has died,

Or try to run away from here,
To keep yourself alive.

"Enter that grand palace,
I need search my way forward cautiously.
I need go through one by one,
The dense doorways and corridors.

"If I find Kunwuer Bayi and others,
I will kill them immediately and mercilessly.
I will drink their blood up,
I will break their throne to pieces,
I will not fold my hands and wait for death,
And listen to the fate.

"You must wait for me till next morning,
When the sun rises and I still do not come back,
That means my life has ended.
My Sirak,
You can decide by yourself till them."

After Almanbet gave all his orders,
They parted sadly.
Almanbet rolled his coat edge up,
Turned round and went to the palace.

Sirak was rather nervous,
He stood there woodenly,
Fixed his eyes on the movement far away.

Curtain of night drew,
Stars spread in the sky,
Almanbet strode,
To the gate of the palace.

When he held the handle and opened the gate,
Deafening sound of firelocks started suddenly,

Lions roared to scare people,
Tigers growled,
Made people frightened.

Ferocious dragon flew on clouds,
Elephant's trunk rolled and swayed.
When common people saw it,
They must be scared out of their wits and dead.
When hero Sirak saw these,
He stood up and sat in turn to control his feeling.
Heartbeat accelerated with a lump in his throat,
Finally the next morning came.

When the morning came,
Hero Almanbet appeared.
He went back to Sirak,
Told him the following things:
"Inside of the palace,
There are all kinds of rooms there,
I looked at every room,
But I did not find Kunwuer anywhere.

"Because the morning was coming,
I had to come back.
There is only one regret,
The stable where they raise mules,
I had no time to search carefully.

"This crafty guy,
No one ever knows where he sleeps at night.
My respected hero Sirak,
The matter of Kunwuer Bayi,
Can never be said clearly."

Two heroes started off again,
And arrived at a ruined place.
Almanbet intended to go,

And checked the tree he grew in the past.

That orchard was not far,
Lion Sirak and Almanbet went side by side,
Arrived at the gate of the orchard soon.

Almanbet even had no time to dismount,
Just embraced a towering tree,
With watery eyes.
His tears fell like pearls,
The towering tree was roaring,
It seemed it was crying together with him.

Almanbet was filled with much deep emotion:
"The world makes people in a trance,
The seedlings I grew casually in the past,
Now they are all towering.

"I left my homeland and become homeless,
I come back after so many years.
This is my first time to meet them,
The seedlings turn into big trees,
Big trees now are like towers.

"Now when I see all these,
I Almanbet feel very upset.
The house built with iron,
Now disappears totally.

"In my naive childhood times,
It is the place I was playing.
Take off clothes, be naked,
With hair swaying on the forehead,
Here is where I grew up.

"I thought there are no other people except Ketay,
I thought there are no other towns except Begin,

How innocent my illusion was.
I played in the water,
Memory of my childhood comes back to me.

"The flower of my love blossomed here,
Fell in love with general's daughter Turna,
We had solemn pledges of love.

"I unbuttoned her waistcoat right here,
I took off her blue boots right here,
I made her chant right here,
I made her silk underpants,
Get red blood.

"But today, I cut her head off,
Made her blood redden my sabre.

"I am so sad today,
People must be surprised.
People who knew it will show sympathy for my suffering,
Understand my difficulties;
People who did not know it will say I am a brute,
Even consider me as a ferocious devil!

"In this merciless world,
How do I get relieved from such pain?

"Having your own subjects can be called a general,
Talk and behave reasonably and confidently,
——Sirak;
Losing your families,
Unable to speak, words lose its weight,
——Sirak;
It is better to die,
Rather than be a hero losing your subjects,
——Sirak;
With people's support, you can stand up straight,

Roaming to other places is the hero's misery,
——Sirak;
Leave home, wander about everywhere,
This is the greatest pain,
——Sirak;
It is better to die,
Rather than cut off from masses and be a puppet,
——Sirak;
No matter how much contribution you make,
The time of disappointing must come to you,
——Sirak."

Fragrance of homeland drifted,
He himself was shaking with misery,
Almanbet's eyes swam with tears,
He could not hold his sorrow back.

Wolf hero Sirak,
Wanted to change his thinking,
By the endless questions:
"Tall walls, gold gates,
I saw such palace in Begin,
Almanbet——
Whose palace is that?

"Pure gold stakes, pure silver posts,
I saw such hitching posts,
Almanbet——
Whose luxury house is that?

"Even expose to the weather for forty years,
They will never fade in color.
Decorate edges with pure gold,
It is precious and unparalleled in the world,
Almanbet——
Whose silk cloak is that?

"With silver nails and gold horseshoes on hooves,
White silk was put on the back,
Go through the streets with inspiring looks.
The figure with head and mane up was drawn on the wall,
I saw such a great steed,
Almanbet——
Where is his master now?

"Pictures are drawn on the wall,
Sit with legs crossed, white beard sways,
Sixty attendants line beside him,
Lower their hands and dare not lift his eyebrow.
Twelve-color long feathers of peacock,
Insert fascinatingly on the edge of the hat,
Black hat, red tassel,
It is hard to find such dignity in the world,
Almanbet——
Which elder is he?

"I saw lake water in Begin,
It was clear and shining.
I saw pasture in Begin,
It was scenically beautiful with grass rippled.
I saw hills in Begin,
They were well-spaced and beautiful,
Almanbet——
What secrets do they have?
Please tell me.
Do not forget,
The landscape of lakes and mountains,
And the fragrance of dirt of the pasture.

"Where is Kunwuer Bayi now,
Where is the troop?
Where is Begin,
How is the landscape of mountains?
Where is Aisanhan and where are common people?

And your father Khan Sorandick,
Almanbet——
Where are they now?

"Regardless of safety, advance bravely,
Where are the rivals who can fight against us?
Capture the rival,
Almanbet——
Where are those arrogant heroes?

"In this uninhabited Gobi desert,
How we can just cry and feel sad here!
With your emotional state now,
Almanbet——
How you can fulfill your dream.

"In Kangkoler where grows full of red willow,
On Saritala plain,
Sit by the sacred white tablecloth,
Then you made promise,
Bit arrow in two and ate naan with salt water,
Almanbet——
It seemed you have thrown that out of your mind,
But just praise your homeland continuously."

Heard what Sirak said,
Heard the indirect discontentment Sirak showed,
Almanbet had thoughts come to his mind,
He lost all control,
Now it got to the boiling point.

He put his hands in front of the chest,
Said in forceful voice,
To Sirak who was full of worries:
"Sirak,
I will not forget my promise."

Bully camel-like Sariala steed,
Wide stirrups made of cast iron,
Almanbet leaped on the steed without stepping in stirrups.
Mounted tall Sariala steed,
The spear waved in his hand,
He was tall and strong as a peak.

"Hero, since you mentioned my hometown,
Let me tell you in details.
That grand palace of gold corridor,
Located in Begin city.
I am not boasting,
Sirak——
That is my father Khan,
Sorandick's palace.
Almanbet who stands in front of you,
Is right the heir of his throne.

"I was raised and cared by him,
Like his own eyes,
That pure gold post,
I am not boasting,
Sirak——
That is my hitching post.

"Almanbet who stands in front of you,
Is the son of noble Khan.
Pure gold decorations on edges,
You saw in Begin,
Even exposed to weather for forty years,
The silk cloak still did not fade in color,
Sirak——
That was made by my mother.

"The picture drawn on the wall,
Sat with crossed legs calmly,
Sixty attendants stood on both sides of him,

Diamonds beset on top of the hat,
Twelve-color feathers of peacock inserted on hat brim,
Black hat, red tassel,
The picture you saw in Begin,
The noble hard to find in the world,
Sirak——
He is my brother, my arm.

"I, eighteen years old left home,
He twelve years old stayed at home.
When I left,
Someone accused him as a bad son for master's fleeing,
Slandered him as a sinner for Khan's fleeing,
Blamed him as an evil person for headman's betraying,
And doubted that he also wanted to betray.

" 'Since one has already fled and betrayed,
The other should take the rap for him',
My poor brother,
Was put on iron chains and even pierced through his lips,
Was deprived of freedom and suffered a lot,
Finally he lost his life.

"The land of my hometown,
Was divided up mercilessly.
My innocent fellow villagers,
Were forced to leave their hometown.
It was Khan Bakburchin,
Who drove them to the battlefields,
And most of them died on the battlefields.

"Sulaba is my ancestor,
This city was right built by Sulaba.
Because brave and industrious Ketay live there,
The city is called Tongsha city.

"The city was granted by my father Khan,

It is me Almanbet to administer.
Then that grand city,
Became more and more prosperous.

"The glittering lake surface,
Even firelock could not shoot to the opposite bank.
Six streams there,
Mingle in that lake.

"I Almanbet return to my homeland,
Tears and blood run from my eyes.
If I go on an expedition,
A hundred thousand troops must follow me.

"I take the gold medal of the palace along with me,
That is the symbol of my status,
I could move troops and administer everything with it,
No one would not respect me as seeing it.

"Splendid carpet was spread on the ground,
They let me sit on the carpet.
Soldiers lifted the carpet in turn,
Ten-day journey,
They finished it in one day.

"Sirak, my fierce wolf,
Please think about it,
This is how honorable a Khan is,
Ten-day journey,
I could finish in one day.

"In the streets of the city,
I went through like small stones,
Someone carried on his back and ran like a bird.
Sirak, my brotherly friend,
This is the hometown I lived in wealth and luxury,
This is Tongsha city where I grew up.

"My six generations ancestors,
Administered this abundant place.
This is the place where my navel blood dropped,
This is the place where I grew up.
Besides me,
My seven generations ancestors,
Administered this place.

"If I appear there today,
Someone would say,
Why does this damned guy come back?

"My orchard has been withered,
My garden has withered and no birds sing there,
My homeland which people respected in the past,
Now has lost its look and becomes bleak and desolate.

"Sirak, my young hero,
Please remember such lesson well,
Because of enemy's invading,
My beautiful homeland becomes this bad now.

"I go through all lands of Arashi,
I respect the Creator very much.
My garden has withered,
My families and relatives are bullied,
My enemies run wild and act on their own will.

"Those two idiots Kunwuer Bayi and Muradiler,
Now lord over all others in Begin,
Arrogant and domineering.
Sirak, my passionate friend,
How I could not feel ashamed on this!

"In grand Begin city,
Look at the glittering lake,
White wild ducks killed by us,

Lived there.

"The green grassland you saw,
Is the place,
Where the fox killed by us lived;
The rolling mountains,
Are the places,
Where the cunning white argali lived.

"I do not know whether you noticed,
Hero Sirak,
The low rolling hills,
Belonged to Begin.

"Such a vast place,
Does not turn to a peaceful area,
This is me, poor Almanbet,
Has no such good luck.

"I went on my way from here,
Now I am here again,
But feel sad and ashamed.
Since I have returned,
I must change the destiny of this place,
Why do I make my heart torn,
And say such sad words?

"Let's go, my hero Sirak,
Many things are waiting for us to deal with,
If we continue to wait here,
There must be more sad words and feelings."

Almanbet sat straight on the horseback,
Lion Sirak was in majestic state.
Steeds jumped and galloped,
Like birds in the sky.
Two steeds shook their heads,

Galloped as hare,
Marched ahead shoulder to shoulder.

Almanbet held the halter,
Inserted the spear on the ground,
Said to Sirak again:
"When I was eighteen years old,
I left my hometown Begin,
My mother and her forty attendants,
Accompanied beside me.

"Arokai's son Kunwuer Bayi,
Said I Almanbet betrayed my homeland,
Reported the news to my father Khan.

"Budankok steed of Ketay set out,
Soldiers sent to intercept me were like sand,
A guy named Budanchan,
Rode on famous Kerckulan steed,
Came to intercept and it was hard for me to run away.

"In that flustering moment,
My precious tobacco pouch of gold handle,
Fell off my hand suddenly.
'I will come back and look for it one day.'
I had no time to pick it up from the ground,
Just whipped my steed and began to run for my life.

"Sirak, please dismount,
We need push grass aside,
Look for it patiently.
That precious tobacco pouch,
May be found."
Almanbet dismounted,
Sirak also dismounted like a bird.

Sirak told himself quietly:

"There is no mark at all,
But he asks to look for the lost pouch here,
What a stubborn person he is."

He reached his hand into the grass,
Lush grass was high to his knees.
The pipe had been broken by horse hooves,
The stove-size bowl had covered with rust,
Half of it was under the dirt.

Sirak pulled the pouch out,
Lifted it high on his head,
Handed it reverently,
Into Almanbet's hand.

Hero Almanbet was overjoyed:
"I give it to you as a prize."
Sirak held it in his hand,
Wiped the rust off,
Watched it carefully over and over again.

Facing such a gold pipe,
A thought came to Sirak:
"This pipe is unusual,
It has the mark of royalty.

"He emphasized his status of a prince again and again,
But we always doubt about it.
He emphasized his status of a noble always,
But we did not believe it entirely.
Now it appears that his status of Khan is true,
This pipe is invaluable,
Calculate with lowest price,
It is still worth sixty gold coins.

"He did not boast about anything,
Every word and every sentence he said is true.

Hero Almanbet,
He is a prince with no doubt."

Almanbet and Sirak went side by side,
Two steeds dashed ahead.
Hero Almanbet said to Sirak again:
From Kerchindu hill,
Ride on the steed and go at top speed.
I will use my spell,
Make the day turn into night,
Make night turn into the day.

"Make heavy clouds cover the sky,
Make the gale blow,
Make snow cover the earth.
Winter will descend in mountains in an instant,
Foot of the mountains get frozen.

"I will drive along the plain,
Kunwuer Bayi's horses,
That wide Peninsula in the river,
Will be fully filled with horses I drive there.

"We go forward straight with no delay,
We will drive the horse flocks in the mountain col.
If we meet horsemen,
Or enemy soldiers as flood,
We need go into battle courageously.

"Please do remember,
You are deaf and dumb.
Shiputa and Tash ferries,
These two ferries of the river are close,
I know the secret of them.

"Here is called Ajat river,
Beasts and livestock never cross from here.

Kunwuer Bayi had made a trick,
He built a secret pass in water,
Not deep on the riverbed,
Not higher than river surface,
But under the water.

"Except Ketay people,
No one knows its secret,
Each step forward is a ridge in the secret pass,
Deep pools and traps are set in the water.
If it is not a well-trained steed,
It is impossible to cross the river.

"This damned Tash ferry,
Has too many unknown secrets.
Underneath is firm, top is covert,
There are blocks on both sides.
It is hard to know its depth,
You have me, Almanbet, to go with you,
So do not worry at all."

Almanbet came to the ferry,
Explained everything cearly.
He cleared the way first,
He jumped into Ajat river,
Only the bottom of the saddle of his steed got wet.

Two heroes crossed the river,
At the time when they were still talking,
They saw horses in the pasture.

They looked ahead carefully,
Horse flocks spread all over the pasture,
Were only dark maroon and light maroon in color,
No horses of other color were among them.

Horses gathered in flocks,

Hundreds of horses were in one group.
"There are brands stamped on horses butts,
They are right the horse flocks,
Belong to Karamark headman Kunwuer Bayi.
We can drive this flock of horses,
To our temporary camp."

Heroes were merry-hearted,
They talked and laughed all the way.
Right at this moment,
A hero rode on a brown stallion,
Appeared and galloped toward them fast.

The tall mount under him,
Was hard to find in the world,
It belonged to Tunidukchy.

Kataler's son Karakuler,
Rode on this steed and galloped,
To the front of them.
He was a young man of rapid intellect,
He doubted about Almanbet,
Asked like this:
"Ride on the yellow steed,
Tie the steed tail,
You, the young man full of confidence,
Where are you from?

He asked in Karamark language,
Then inquired in Ketay language,
Asked many questions,
Like chattering larks and nightingales,
Like friends of no secrets.

Khan Almanbet walked up to him,
And said to him:
"Where are Brute people,

Where are our people?
At this critical moment,
Who has time to talk nonsense.

"I heard Manas from Kirgiz is very powerful,
Heroes fighting against him are just like flies in his eyes.
He is impossible to be shaken like Kebizto mountain,
He never gives his rivals any chance to win.

"No matter how powerful he is,
I will fight against him this time,
Wipe his Ayinla out this time.
I am a Ketay,
And I am a headman of one area,
The young man on the brown steed,
This is my identity."

Almanbet answered and thought:
"Go ahead and approach him,
As long as there is one step far,
I can hold the halter of his steed,
Present this charming stallion,
To hero lion Manas."
Almanbet talked,
And approached him quietly.

Now Karakuler opened his mouth,
He said in suspicious tone:
"You ride on a yellow steed of bright color,
Wear helmet and armor.
You are eloquent and fluent,
Please stop, do not approach.
I guess you are not normal:
You will not draw back your steed when you are fighting,
You will never run away when facing a powerful enemy.
You will send your rival,
Into the earth.

With handsome face and stalwart figure,
You are an unusual hero.

"When you face thousands of enemies,
You are never scared,
Never act with confusion.
You have the majesty like a dragon,
Once you make a shout,
You can make the world shake.

"No one can guess what you are thinking,
Take death calmly and never retreat.
Facing thousands of enemies,
You are brave and do not know what is going back.

"Your towering figure,
Makes me feel nervous once I see you.
You are not a normal warrior,
You are as strong as a ferocious tiger.

"The warrior stands beside you,
I see his information,
He rides on blue steed,
The steed is as tall and strong as a red elephant.
Even if runs forty days with no stop,
It will not pant for breath at all.
Even if it runs for sixty days,
It will not be tired to sweat.

"Its master is as prestigious as the steed,
They are matched well,
He is calm and quiet,
Please tell me about him."

Almanbet had to respond in this way:
"Since you ask me about him,
He is not usual,

This damned Ketay,
He is boiling as he just made a promise.
He said he comes from farthest Begin,
He cannot hear except you shout loudly to him.

"If someone makes him angry,
He says he will press the person into the earth's core.
Pierce the person's heart,
Redden his spear with the person's blood."

Karakuler said after he heard this:
"You are a crafty guy,
Even devil can be deceived.
You are speaking to me,
At the same time you are moving toward me secretly.
Like a poisonous serpent worms into my clothes,
I feel flustered faintly.

"Even my families and relatives,
Are not allowed to approach me.
In Begin city with sixty gates,
There is no place I have never visited.
Khans, deities and Buddha,
I have met a lot of them.
There is no corner I have never visited,
There is no chief of a tribe I do not know.

"The maroon steed you lead,
Is not usual;
It was born in plain and grew in mountains,
Ran and jumped with goats.
It was born in wilderness and grew among rocks,
It always lives together with wild animals.

"It will not lose its way at night,
It will not be scared even gets lash on its head,
Even it is ridden for six months it will not feel tired.

Argali-size thighs are like silver wings,
Sieve-like lungs will never be short of breath.
Its hooves are just right,
Its mane and long tail are also unusual,
It seems that it is not from Begin."

Almanbet responded immediately,
With calm but very careful tone:
"Heard the news of Manas' coming,
Aisanhan was horrified,
He sent out a messenger immediately,
To invite giant Majili.
I have heard the illustrious name of Manas,
I also have heard giant Majili who goes to fight.

"In order to get the trophy in time,
I cannot help starting off upon my journey.
This maroon steed dragged its halter,
Appeared in front of me,
So I pull it with me on my journey.

"I think this is a good sign,
Maybe I can get more gifts.
It makes me very tired to lead this hot-tempered steed,
I am planning to send it to horse flocks on river island."

Almanbet was talking,
And he was approaching the maroon steed too,
Took its bridle off,
Showed a smile around his lips.
When he turned his steed round,
Karakuler uncovered the secrets:
"Riding on the yellow steed,
Talking nonsense,
Your real identity and background,
I have known clearly.

"You are Subala's offspring,
How cannot I know this?
You are Sorandick's son,
You broke with your family,
Killed people and reddened the capital.

"You betrayed your blood relatives,
Went to an alien race for shelter,
How cannot I know you?
You are famous young master Su.

"Now you come back not only by yourself,
You bring one person here.
You let him play deaf and dumb deliberately,
Your tricks and deceiving words,
Do you think I will believe it?

"The person stands beside you,
I have already seen through his fake look.
He is a well-known hero,
His achievements are spreading in the world.

"His felt hat has black edge,
Isn't he Khan Jagurp's son hero Sirak?
In Aranick battle,
He got to be famous and known by the world.

"He presented the honor to Manas with all respect,
He himself is willing to be ruled.
Everyone knows this,
He defeated many heroes,
He got famous far and wide."

Karakuler turned his steed,
Whipped his steed and fled away immediately.
That brown tall stallion,
Galloped with clouds of dust rising behind.

Black mane wolf Sultan Almanbet,
Spurred the steed and chased tight.
He held the sharp spear,
Tight in his hand.

Almanbet approached the rival,
Poked his spear into the rival's hip.

Karakuler's brown stallion,
Was a manic steed,
He was worried it was too hard to be controlled,
So he took the extreme measure.

A bag of six-span long and six-span wide,
Was filled with sand and rocks,
Then put the bag on the horseback.

When he met a critical moment,
When the time of despair came,
In order to avoid being captured,
He would draw his sharp sabre out,
Cut the bag under him,
Spread sand and rocks in the sky,
Then he took the chance to run away.

The brown stallion galloped its hooves,
Ran easily like whirlwind.
Karakuler whipped his steed,
He was panic-striken,
Looked back continually,
He was afraid Almanbet caught and killed him.

Karakuler whipped the brown steed,
Arrived at the surging Ajat river.
The damned brute was very familiar with the environment there,
It leaped with hooves to the sky,
Like a lightning,

The breeching and breastcollar were both broken.
Karakuler fell off the horseback,
And into the rapid river.

He fell into the water,
And disappeared quickly.
This damned bastard was a good swimmer,
He fled away along the bottom of the river,
Avoided their sight.

The brown stallion also disappeared,
Almanbet stood by the river helplessly.
He sighed and felt regretted,
Turned his steed and returned right away.

The maroon steed Kartgulan,
Listened with its ears stood up and looked ahead.
He looked at Almanbet,
Made a loud neigh suddenly,
Then lifted its long tail and ran into horse flocks.

At that time,
Kunwuer Bayi was in his prime time,
Glittering gold was as big as the horse head,
Shining silver was as many as rocks in Gobi,
Gold and silver ingots were as much as sand in the river,
Diamonds were of the size of cow head.

Horses on the island in the river,
Were totally ninety thousand.
What is this? This is wealth.
At least sixty thousand of horses,
Belonged to Kunwuer Bayi.

Nine hundred and thirty horsemen,
Took care of ninety thousand horses.
Eight hundred and sixty horsemen,

Took care of those sixty thousand horses.

Almanbet shouted the name "Manas!" loudly,
Beat drums as loud as the thunders,
Rushed into horse flocks without thinking of his safety.
Horsemen were all not alert,
They ran to their mounts in panic.

Horsemen mounted and gathered immediately,
Pressed forward in swarms,
Shouted the slogan "Kangayi!" and struck back.

Almanbet and Sirak,
Charged and attacked bravely.
One poked with spear,
The other slashed with battleax.

Numerous horsemen in a short while,
Were all defeated,
No single one still kept alive.
They drove captured horse flocks,
Turned round and started off on their retuning journey.

When the dawn came with grey half-light,
They crossed the river.
Sirak asked surprisingly:
"Respected Almanbet,
We drive ninety thousand horses,
A great wealth comes down from heaven.

"The waves are high and the river is surging,
We conquered the rapid and wide river,
But none of the horses fell behind or died in the river,
What is the mystery in it?"
Sirak was waiting for Almanbet's careful answer,
With his eager eyes.

Facing Sirak's question,
Almanbet answered sincerely:
"We started off from Taras,
Not for making sightseeing tours,
Not for killing a Khan,
Not for splitting people here.

"In Begin where five tribes live,
Kunwuer Bayi does not let people live peacefully.
He sends troops out everyday,
Plunder common people and do all manners of evil.
Because of his inexpiable crimes to all,
We come here to crusade against his crimes.

"If his horse flocks have no injuries and deaths,
We may pay a price.
If his horse flocks have heavy casualties,
Maybe most of our soldiers can return home safely.
Now none of the horses is injured or dead,
It is a sign,
It indicates that crisis and death will accompany us.

"Lion Sirak,
I have told you the worry in my mind.
Now you drive horses and go first,
There will be a wilderness in the front,
A peak is in the center of it.
You need climb on its top,
Watch the situation behind you with your telescope.

"The brown stallion fled away yesterday,
Maybe after the whole night galloping,
It has arrived at the palace,
Maybe it is reporting the news,
To the damned guy now.

"Kunwuer Bayi might have called all generals in,

They might have set out on journey in massive columns.
They are like a gale,
Rose clouds of dust and covered the sky.

"He may lead troops even the earth could not bear,
Lead numerous heroes who are regardless of their safety.
Like black blood,
He drives soldiers of five tribes,
All onto the journey.

"You need watch them carefully,
My dear hero Sirak,
You just walk up with no fear.
Until you are one arrow far from them,
You need retreat with no hesitation.
You need swing your legs ceaselessly,
Make your clothes edge wave in the wind,
I will hide in reeds,
Get ready to launch an attack.

"That self-glorified Kunwuer Bayi,
He might think I Almanbet would flee away,
He will walk on air,
He will chase me desperately without giving up,
You should remember my words clearly.

"When the opportunity comes,
I will attack from aside to help you.
I will attack with the loud shout of the slogan,
Charge Karamark desperately.

"I will take his Alekala steed,
Present it to the master witnesses the battle on the hill.
Present fine steed to him,
To relieve the worry in my heart."

Let us put this aside,

Talk about what on earth the brown stallion did,
After it fled away yesterday evening.

The damned brown stallion,
Dashed ahead at top speed with no stop,
Arrived in Begin city the same night.
There was a city moat outside of the city,
Forty-span wide river was rapid and violent.

In this river,
Deep water was surging;
If there was no bridge or boat,
It would be impossible to cross the river.

On the opposite bank of the river,
Tall city wall was built there.
Tunidukchy's brown stallion,
Jumped up and leaped over the river and the city wall.

Please listen carefully,
The truth of that Stallion's report.

That fierce stallion,
Ran straight to Kunwuer Bayi's palace.
Its huge basin-size hooves,
Dug the ground continually.

In that grand city,
Kunwuer Bayi was a great hero.
Aisanhan was the Khan of the city,
Kunwuer Bayi was a matchless general,
They two acted evilly together to do harms to people.

Kunwuer Bayi let Eranguduk,
Know that Manas had been going on the expedition,
Know that giant Majili had died,
Know that Keyiba and Turna,

Had been cut off their heads and displayed to the public.

From soldiers fled back,
They knew the fate of Chabalai,
Then he gathered his generals immediately,
Got packed and prepared weapons well,
Gave out the order to all generals:
"We start off right now with no delay,
We will descend disasters to our enemy.
Troops need prepare well,
You must not be careless in preparation."

He ordered troops prepared to the best,
Huge tent with seven entrances,
Was put up in the garden of the palace.
Generals and ministers,
All gathered together in the tent.

A hundred thousand picked soldiers,
None of them was a common person,
Everyone was fierce and powerful.
They did not have fear at all,
Even if they were blown by heavy battleax,
They would not respond and move.

Hero Kunwuer Bayi of Kakan,
Was cunning and crafty.
His unimaginable schemes and plots,
Were hard to be explained clearly.

Thirty advisers,
Stood on the right of Kunwuer.
Forty generals,
Lined on the left of Kunwuer.

There were another eighty officials,
Everyone got a paper of appointment.

Someone hung prayer beads on neck,
Put the Buddha in the bosom,
Like they were closing the eyes for rest,
Mumbled words in the mouth till the morning.

Generals and governors,
Ministers stood in a line,
Shook their heads and talked ceaselessly.
Chattered and whispered,
It was hard to tell it was laughter or cry.

Kunwuer closed his eyes for rest at his home,
He fell into a magical dream unconsciously:
An eagle hovered in the sky,
Alighted on the head of Kunwuer Bayi.
The eagle spread its huge wings,
Its talons were of infinite force.

Its talons hooked on Kunwuer's belt,
Carried him into the sky.
The eagle beat its wings,
Flew into the clouds in an instant.

It weaved through the clouds,
Arrived in starry universe.
Suddenly Kunwuer Bayi's belt broke,
He fell off from the universe.
In the sky he was like a bird,
Clothes spread as wings were flapping.

If he fell on the ground like this,
How could he keep his life?
But he did not fall on the ground,
If he fell on the ground,
He must lose his life immediately.

He fell all the way down,

Finally he landed on the throne.
With a loud bang,
His bottom touched the throne and head swayed.

Kunwuer Bayi was scared out of her wits,
Did not know what happened.
He opened his eyes and looked around,
It was blurred in front of his eyes.

Yurt-size heart was pounding heavily,
Shook all over and could not calm down.
His artery tightened and blood ran,
Like a rapid river was surging,
Could not stop the crazy shaking of his arms and legs.

He was still suffering from the shock,
The brown stallion's hoof sound came from outside the door.
The magical steed was digging the ground continuously,
Made grieved neigh.

Kunwuer listened to it for a while,
Put on a coat in a hurry,
Stumbled out of the door.

There was a separate doorway,
Which was for Khan to use specially.
The blue soft boots on his feet,
Had its toes perking up,
Coat was swaying with wind.

Kunwuer Bayi walked out of the door,
He saw the brown stallion standing in the front.
The steed panted heavily,
It got sweated all over its body,
Its round butt was bleeding.

Kunwuer Bayi was greatly surprised:

"Could it be that Brute commander Manas,
Has come with his troops?
Could it be that his troops are pressing on to the border?
Could it be that our warrior Karakuler,
Has met with the death on the pasture,
With his blood running? "

He rushed into the palace gate in a hurry,
Rang the eleven bells hanging on the high platform on the right.
When he rang the bells desperately,
The whole Tongsha city was woken up.

Sharp and loud ring,
Went the round of the city in an instant,
From every corner of the city,
Soldiers and generals would gather in a blink of an eye.

On the high platform on the left,
Hung thirty bells.
No matter the day or the night,
As long as the forceful ring sounded,
The bell resounded through the sky of the city.

Kantun city which was called upper Begin,
Aisanhan lived in that city,
He also could hear sonorous bell ring.
The way they delivered the news,
Was just the sonorous ring.

Kunwuer Bayi was busy rushing from one to another,
Hit with both of his hands,
Rang those huge bells.
The news of emergency happened,
Went the round of Begin city of sixty gates.

A hundred thousand soldiers lived in the tents,
Were all woken up from dreams when they heard the bell.

Giant Kunwuer Bayi had his heart in his mouth,
His sleepiness was thrown entirely out of his mind.

He ordered to lead Alekala steed out,
Saddled it and got ready to start off.

This ferocious boar,
Had twenty seven buttonholes on his coat.
He put on the coat and buttoned it,
Put on three layers iron coats,
With nine buttons on his coat.
This swaggering wild boar,
Buttoned his coat and leaped on the steed.

Mountain-size Kunwuer Bayi,
Put on nine layers armor,
Held the halter of Alekala steed.
Took the firelock and bullets up,
Wide belt was tightened on his waist.
The crescent battleax shined in his waist,
Sabre clanged in the sheath,
The long spear was held tight in his hand.

Ketay style red drum,
Even sounded when a fly alighted on it.
Giant Kunwuer Bayi was like a mountain,
Prestigious and frightening.

Devil Niskara,
Was a well-known hero,
He was super intelligent and known wide and far.
He urged his steed and approached Kunwuer,
Said to Kunwuer:
"Hey, hero Kunwuer,
Please do not be flustered, please stop for a minute.

"Brute people who come from afar,

Are very crafty and hard to deal with.
There are a lot of capable heroes among them,
Highly skilled in martial art.
If you fail in the battle,
That will be the biggest satire to you."

Karamark warrior Wushan,
Responded to Niskara,
And advised Kunwuer at the same time:
"Going to single-handed and hurried fight,
It is not an advisable action.

"Except Almanbet,
Others will definitely not come and patrol.
Sorandick's son Almanbet,
Is very hard to be dealt with.

"He is like a mountain,
He will not give in easily.
Let alone he is not single-handed,
There is a Sirak, more ferocious than him,
Accompanies him all the time.

"He is a powerful lion,
His skills are not inferior to you.
Since you have made up your mind,
You just start off right now,
You'd better choose one to protect you,
Between Bolanchu and Sayikali.
If there is something unexpected happens,
We will take concerted action here."

Heard what Wushan said,
Kunwuer Bayi burst into anger,
Gazed at him and said angrily:
"You such a jerkoff,
Ketay's livestock are plundered,

Is this what you are wishing?
Brute people come and plunder our flocks of horses,
Are you happy to see it?

"For the sake of Ketay of red tassel hat,
I am willing to charge ahead without thinking of my safety.
Even if my life is done,
I will lose my life in Kirgiz's hands,
I will dash to enemy with no hesitation.

"For the sake of Kangayi of black tassel hat,
I will not spare my life.
Make powerful Kirgiz people,
Shed blood like water and spread corpses over the plain.

"Do not say Almanbet and Sirak,
Even add Manas and Chuwak,
They launch an attack together,
I will capture them and put them in the prison.

"As long as I go into battle,
Who dare come and fight against me!
I will go and sound their skills out,
To see who is the best one among them.
If I cannot fulfill my promise,
I would rather go to die."

Kunwuer Bayi clouded with fury,
His face was as pale as a devil.
Flames splashed out of his eyes,
Did not care to save anyone's face,
He gasped heavily like whirlwind,
Knocked Alekala steed with his heels,
Went ahead boldly with clouds of dust rose behind.

Kusubar's son Bolanchu,
Whipped his steed and followed tight,

His shout was as loud as thunder.

Heard this earth shaking noise,
People were scared out of their wits.
A hundred thousand troops were like gale howled ahead,
Lush woods waved with the wind.

Kunwuer's warriors all turned out,
Heroes and giants,
Knights who were too heavy to be carried by steeds,
Formed the hundred thousand picked troops.

Take a look at the marching troops!
Horses' tails swayed,
Long spears shined under the sun.
Flags of different colors waved with wind,
Covered the sun in the sky.
Troops in massive columns spread over the earth,
Like flood that swept everything.

A hundred thousand troops,
Followed them tight,
The earth shook under their feet.

Let us put this aside,
Look at the situation,
Of Almanbet and Sirak.

Almanbet rested and fed his steed at Ajat river,
Hero Sirak drove the flocks of horses,
Advanced forward without turning round.
Suddenly, on the glass-flat plain,
A high hill appeared.

Hero Sirak thought:
"This is the hill Almanbet mentioned,
I'd better look backward now.
Wise and clear-minded Almanbet,

He never talks nonsense."

Sirak urged Tilkezler steed,
Went forward along the winding path.

The earth turned light, dim sky turned white,
The night faded away gradually,
Hazy mist disappeared quietly.

The sun rose from the east,
Shined the earth brightly.
Sirak climbed on that hill,
Took out his telescope immediately,
Turned round and looked toward Tongsha city.

He found clouds of dust rose up there,
The sky was covered and everything was blurred,
The earth seemed to be peeled off,
Dense spear points shined under the sun.
Horses' tails swayed,
Troops wormed on the ground,
Dense people were like flood.

Galloping steeds were like surging waves,
Warriors on horsebacks,
Changed and swayed.
Sabre and axes hung in their waists,
Shined cold air under the sunshine,
Firelocks were all carried on the shoulders.

Drums beat, resounded the air,
Horns blew, shook mountains.
White brocade streamers, blue battle flags,
Red signs, black flags,
Flags of different color waved with wind.

Sirak took a look nearer,

Two figures were dashing ahead,
Like two flying birds.
Sometimes the one behind the other, chased each other,
Sometimes they went forward side by side imposingly.

Sirak was lost in thought:
"The guy in the front is arrogant and confident,
It seems he is giant Kunwuer.
I will attack head-on,
Fight it out with him.

"If the death is coming to me,
I will not spare my life.
No one can cheat death in this world,
I will face death calmly."

Thousands of thoughts went through Sirak's mind,
Heroic spirit welled up in his heart.
At the moment of dashing ahead,
He made himself calm down,
What Almanbet said to him,
Was resounding in his ears.

At Talechoku hill yesterday,
Argued with Chuwak,
Hero Almanbet,
Had such words:
"I have never thought about to be your Khan,
Only for the sake of resisting Karamark invasion,
Even if fighting with Manas together,
We must show our attitude and loyalty."

Sirak was worried,
There must be the reason,
For Almanbet to say words.
Sirak thought over and over,
Guessed the secrets of it.

"At the critical moment,
I wish Almanbet does not change his mind,
And turn round and go back to Ketay.
It is a trifle if I die,
But Arashi people will suffer great disasters then.

"Our people's backbone hero Manas,
During the time he does not have his steed with him,
There cannot be disaster to come.
Such terrible things,
Must not let it happen.

"I will do my level best first,
According to Almanbet's guide,
Then wait to see what's going on next."

Hero Sirak dashed ahead bravely,
Without considering his safety.
He talked to himself worriedly,
He was concerned about the safety of Khan Manas.

After the colt ran a distance,
He pretended he was scared and fled back.
His clothes edge waved with wind,
Legs shook continuously.

Wore boots made from thick felt,
Wore a wide and thick belt,
Karamark headman Kunwuer Bayi,
Just acted like what Almanbet said.
He thought when Almanbet saw him,
Almanbet had been scared out of his wits,
Fled for his life in panic,
Kunwuer Bayi became highly conceited.

He did not spare his mount Alekala steed at all,
Whipped it and urged it,

Spear with wood handle of wolf tongue shape,
Swayed in his hand ceaselessly.

His neck stretched like a wild duck's,
Eyes were as red as owl's eyes.
Face was like the color of cooked lamb lung,
Looked thoroughly ferocious.

Shouted the slogan "Kangayi" loudly,
Whipped and urged the steed and chased desperately.

He whipped his steed and followed Sirak,
Came to the place where Almanbet hid.

Almanbet stood up suddenly,
Shouted the name "Manas" loudly,
Rushed out of the reeds,
Blocked in front of Kunwuer.

Heard the voice of Almanbet,
Unsuspecting Kunwuer Bayi,
Was too surprised and nervous.

When Almanbet was in Tongsha,
He had a contest against Kunwuer.
They poked each other with spears,
Slashed each other with battleaxes.
Pulled each other and wrestled with each other,
They knocked each other and were balanced in power.

Arokai's son Kunwuer Bayi,
Had had countless fights against his rivals.
As he was not the best in the world,
How could not he consider his face?
Since the hope was slim,
There was no need to fight.

"I met him again today,
It must be mostly hopeless,
How mysterious life is!

"It is better to fight against this guy,
Rather than lose my life for nothing,
No matter he is Chuwak or Sirak,
I will take them to my next life and pillow them."

Kunwuer Bayi was nervous,
He got sweated all over his body.
He loosed the halter and kicked the steed belly,
Dashed ahead with his whole mind.

Great hero Almanbet,
Got a wind-speed Sariala steed.
He approached from aside,
Aimed at Kunwuer Bayi's soft spot,
Made a severe poke.

Arrogant Kunwuer Bayi,
Had his bottom drifted off the saddle,
He lay on his back on the steed butt,
But he did not fall off on the ground.

The crafty Kunwuer Bayi,
Had made careful preparation,
He wore invulnerable Bulum leather pants,
Put another six-layer iron clothes,
On his legs and the saddle,
Tied them together tight,
It was the excellent idea when he was fighting.

When prime-aged Sariala steed,
Clenched its bit, tossed its head and tail,
Jumped and retreated fast.
When Almanbet turned his steed round,

Dense soldiers like flood,
Surrounded Kunwuer Bayi as an iron barrel,
Protected him tight.

Let us put this aside,
Talk about the heart-stirring battle,
Which would happen at Ajat riverbank.